

martyrology

an anglican martyrology - for the British Isles

Introduction

The base text is the martyrology compiled by Fr. Hugh Feiss, OSB. Copyright © 2008 by the Monastery of the Ascension, Jerome, ID 83338 and available online at the website of the Monastery of Christ in the Desert.

The calendars of each of the three Anglican churches of the British isles contain varied group commemorations, I suggest these entries are read only in the province where they are observed and have indicated that by the use of italics and brackets. However, people, particularly in the Church of England, are woefully ignorant of the history of the other Anglican churches of our islands and it would be good if all entries for the islands are used in each province. The Roman dates are also indicated where these vary from Anglican ones but not all those on the Roman Calendar have an entry.

The introductions to the saints and celebrations in the Anglican calendars in England, Ireland, Scotland and Wales in *Exciting Holiness*, ed. Brother Tristram SSF, The Canterbury Press, 1997, have been added where a saint did not already appear in the martyrology. These have been adapted to indicate the place and date of death at the beginning, as is traditional at the reading of the martyrology. For the place of death I have generally relied on Wikipedia.

For Irish, Welsh and Scottish celebrations not appearing in *Exciting Holiness* I have used the latest edition of *Celebrating the Saints*, Canterbury Press, 2004.

These entries are generally longer than appear in martyrologies and probably need editing down even more than I have done if they are to be read liturgically.

Additional entries from the online martyrology of the Bose community have been used.

I would have liked to include (as does the Bose Martyrology) the celebrations of other faith communities, however as these are movable (based often on lunar calendars) that is not easy to do. An online inter-faith calendar could be consulted to add to this martyrology.

I would like to add more Celtic and Saxon saints and am working on that. Often it is hard to distinguish between saints with the same name or the same saint with alternative dates for commemoration.

Other Sources:

For All The Saints - A Calendar of Commemorations for United Methodists, ed. Clifton F. Guthrie, Order of St Luke Publications, Akron, Ohio, 1995.

A Calendar of British Saints - Orthodox Synaxarion, Fr Benedict Haigh, Bluestone Books, 2004

Ordo of the Community of the Servants of the Will of God

Saints of the Roman Missal, J Michael Thompson, Ligouri, 2012

People's Companion to the Breviary, The Carmelites of Indianapolis, 1997, Volumes 1 and 2

Troparia and Kondakia, New Skete, 1984

Holy Women, Holy Men, Church Publishing, 2010, in the online edition available in May 2018.

Common Prayer: A Liturgy for Ordinary Radicals, ed Shane Claiborne et al, Zondervan, 2010

Blessed Among Us, ed. Robert Ellsberg, Liturgical Press, 2016

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New Book of Festivals and Commemorations [Lutheran], Philip F. Pfatteicher, Fortress Press, 2008

Carmelite Propers for the Liturgy of the Hours, <http://carmelcanada.org/liturgy/office.pdf>

Dominican Propers for the Liturgy of the Hours, <http://opcentral.org/resources/wp-content/uploads/2012/09/Supplement.pdf>

Propers for Congregations Dedicated to the Precious Blood of Christ

Finally, some dates of significance have been added at to the entries. Because non Christians have occasionally been mentioned the phrase and “people of good will” has been added to the usual conclusion of the reading of the martyrology. Events which are entered and are not people should be added at the beginning of the reading of the martyrology when announcing the liturgical day.

In adding to the base text used consideration has been given to the length of the reading for the whole day, so some of the monastic saints mentioned in that have been removed; and to ensuring the presence of more Anglican, women, married, and non-European entries. The original text included many nineteenth century saints and founders of religious communities these have largely been removed. This martyrology naturally reflects my own interests and prejudices.

To reduce the length of the reading of the martyrology readings may be alternated in a two year cycle, first and third etc entry in Year I and so on. Obviously any entry that is going to be observed liturgically ought to be used.

The reading of the martyrology traditionally occurred at the end of Prime, with the reading for the **following** day being read. Traditionally the day in the lunar cycle was also read announced.

The martyrology may be read at the end of a daytime hour, before Compline or separately.

For those praying only Morning and Evening Prayer it might helpfully occur after Evening Prayer for the following day.

Fr Richard Peers,
Liverpool

Reading The Martyrology in the Divine Office

The Martyrology for the *nth* day of X the year of Our Lord 20XX.

[The liturgical day is then given, eg. Monday in the eighth week after Trinity, or the first entry in the martyrology if that supersedes it.]

Other events at the top of the day's entry are also read. Any entry that is to be observed liturgically is mentioned first.

After the Reading from the martyrology:

And elsewhere, many other holy women and holy men, saints of the Most High God and people of good will.

V. Precious in the eyes of the Lord.

R. Is the death of the faithful.

Let us pray.

May holy Mary and all the saints pray for us to the Lord,
that we may obtain from Him, help and salvation,
who lives and reigns for ever and ever. **Amen.**

January

January 1

In Anglican calendars the Naming and Circumcision of Jesus. The celebration of this scriptural festival marks three events: firstly, the naming of the infant; secondly, the sign of the covenant between God and Abraham 'and his children for ever', thus Christ's keeping of the Law; and thirdly, traditionally the first shedding of the Christ's blood. The most significant of these in the gospels is the name itself, which means 'Yahweh saves' and so is linked to the question asked by Moses of God: "What is your name?" "I am who I am," was the reply, thus the significance of Jesus's words: "Before Abraham was, I am." This feast has been observed in the church since at least the sixth century. In the Roman Calendar on the octave of Christmas and the day of Jesus' Circumcision, the Solemnity of Mary the Mother of God, whom the Fathers of the Council of Ephesus in 431 acclaimed Theotokos, because from her the Word assumed flesh and dwelt among us. As mother of Christ, she is mother of us all, and foremost of the saints.

In 533, St. Fulgentius, a monk who served as bishop of Ruspe in Tunisia. He defended orthodoxy against Arianism, which arose from the teachings of the theologian Arius and instigated the Council of Nicaea.

In 1031, St. William of Volpiano, abbot. St. Majolus, abbot of Cluny, sent him to revive monastic life at the monastery of St. Benigne in Dijon. St. Benigne became the hub of a large network of monasteries. William died at the monastery of Fécamp, which he had refounded.

In 1252, at Jablonné in Bohemia, Saint Zdislava of Lemberk, who was extremely kind to the poor. With her wealthy husband, Havel, she built a basilica now dedicated to St. Lawrence and St. Zdislava. She is a patron of Bohemia.

January 2

In the second half of the fourth century, Sts. Basil the Great and Gregory of Nazianzus, bishops and doctors of the church. Both were raised in remarkable Christian families. After studying together in Athens, the two embraced the monastic life at an estate on Basil's family's land. Basil wrote rules for monks, and later, as bishop of Caesarea in Cappadocia, he promoted monasteries as centres of social service. Like Basil, Gregory was a bishop and theologian who opposed the Arian heresy, which held that Jesus, the Son of God, was the greatest of the Father's creations and not His equal. He spent some years as bishop of Constantinople, where he helped to advance the doctrine of the Trinity, and was one of the presiders at the Council of Constantinople.

In 394, St. Macarius, Egyptian monk, known for his austerity. His teachings were handed down by his disciple, Palladius.

In the seventh century, in Ireland, Munchin, abbot. Munchin, a seventh-century monk, affectionately known as 'The Wise', is honoured in Limerick and known as patron of the city. The 'little monk' inaugurated a tradition of prayer and study in a golden period of Irish Christianity and Celtic monastic life.

In 827, St. Adelard, abbot of Corbie, and advisor to the courts of Charlemagne and Louis the Pious.

From 1792 to 1794, the martyrs of the French Revolution, who were canonised in small groups at various times during the twentieth century.

In 1833 in Russia, St Seraphim of Sarov. Born in 1759 at Kursk in Russia, Seraphim entered the Monastery of our Lady at Sarov near Moscow when he was twenty years old. He lived as a Solitary for over thirty years but his gifts as a starets, or spiritual guide, became more widely-known until he found himself sharing his gift of healing spirit, soul and body with the thousands who made the pilgrimage to his monastery. The 'Jesus Prayer' formed the heart of his own devotional life and he stressed the need for all Christians to have an

unceasing communion with the person of Jesus. He is revered in the Russian Orthodox Church as 'an ikon of Orthodox Spirituality.'

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In 1945, Vedanayagam Samuel Azariah, Bishop. Samuel Azariah was born in 1874 in a small village in South India, his father, Thomas Vedanayagam being a simple village priest and his mother Ellen having a deep love and understanding of the Scriptures. Samuel became a YMCA evangelist whilst still only nineteen, and secretary of the organisation throughout South India a few years later. He saw that, for the Church in India to grow and attract ordinary Indians to the Christian faith, it had to have an indigenous leadership and reduce the strong western influences and almost totally white leadership that pervaded it. He was ordained priest at the age of thirty-five and bishop just three years later, his work moving from primary evangelism to forwarding his desire for more Indian clergy and the need to raise their educational standards. He was an avid ecumenist and was one of the first to see the importance to mission of a united Church. He died just two years before the creation of a united Church of South India.

January 3

About 500, St. Geneviève, patron of Paris, who was known for her charitable works. She advised Clovis, King of the Franks. Her relics were thought to have stopped an outbreak of ergotism in 1129. She is often depicted as a shepherdess or holding a candle.

In Wales, in 1874, Morris Williams, priest. Morris Williams (usually known as 'Nicander', his bardic name) was born at Caenarfon in 1809. He was apprenticed to a carpenter. Once his literary and academic gifts became clear, Nicander was helped to enter King's School, Chester, and Jesus College, Oxford, where he graduated in 1835. He was ordained in the same year, serving his first curacy at Holywell. In 1847 he was appointed perpetual curate of Amlwch, becoming rector of Llanrhuddlad in 1859. Nicander assisted with the revision of the Welsh version of the Book of Common Prayer and edited the 1847 edition of *Llyfr yr Holiliau* (The Book of Homilies). He was a pioneer of the Tractarian movement in the Diocese of Bangor and used his considerable poetic gifts to promote its ideals. Some of the poems from his collection *Y Flwyddyn Eglwysig* (The Church Year), published in 1843, were adapted into hymns which had a profound impact on the spiritual lives of Welsh-speaking Anglicans.

In Taiwan, in 1970, Gladys Aylward, missionary.

January 4

In 1309, Blessed Angela of Foligno, visionary and Franciscan tertiary, whose religious experiences and teaching are recounted in *The Book of Divine Consolation*.

In 1821, in Emmitsburg, Maryland, St. Elizabeth Ann Seton, the first native-born American citizen to be canonised. As a young mother with five children, she organised a society in New York City devoted to the relief of poor widows with small children. After she was herself widowed, she became a Catholic. In 1809 she founded the congregation which became known as the Daughters of Charity, which pioneered the American Catholic school system.

January 5

In Egypt, around 400 AD, St. Syncletica, virgin, one of the best known desert ammas. Her life, written in the fifth century, contains a synthesis of monastic spirituality which draws upon the teaching of Evagrius of Pontus. Excerpts from her teaching are included in the collections of the sayings of the Desert monastics.

In 1860, at Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, St. John Neuman, bishop. Born in Bohemia, he went to the seminary there. He emigrated to New York in 1836, where he was ordained. He entered the Redemptorists in 1840. A popular preacher, he became a superior of the American Redemptorists and mentor to several communities of religious women. He was appointed bishop of Philadelphia in 1852, where he ministered tirelessly for eight years, promoting Catholic schools, founding the Sisters of St. Francis of Philadelphia, and writing two German catechisms.

January 6

On the twelfth day of Christmas, the solemnity of the Epiphany of the Lord. In the United States this feast is celebrated on the first Sunday after January 1.

January 7

In 312, at Nicomedia in Bithynia, the martyrdom of St. Lucian, who was a priest at Antioch. He was involved in theological and jurisdictional disputes, but died in communion with the church. His theological school at Antioch emphasised the literal meaning of the Bible.

In Barcelona, Catalonia, in 1275, St. Raymond of Peñafort. After studying law at Bologna, he joined the Dominicans in 1222, eight months after the death of St. Dominic. He made an official collection of canon law, and later became minister general of the Dominicans. He devoted much of his life to preaching among the Moors in Catalonia.

January 8

Around 179, at Hierapolis in Phrygia, the martyrdom of St. Apollinaris, an apologist active during the reign of Marcus Aurelius.

At Venice, in 1455, St. Lawrence Giustiniani, Augustinian canon regular, bishop of Castello, and archbishop of Venice. His way of life was humble and austere, and he was a spiritual writer of note.

In London in 1833, Richard Watson, Methodist theologian. He was one of the most important figures in 19th century Methodism. Watson was born in Lincolnshire and entered the Methodist itinerancy in 1796, serving as President of Conference in Britain in 1826. He was a leading opponent of slavery. Watson was a gifted writer and theologian. In 1823 he began to publish his *Theological Institutes*, which remained a standard for many years. It was the first attempt to systematise John Wesley's theology and, by extension, Methodist doctrine. In 1831, he wrote a well-regarded life of John Wesley.

January 9

In 709 or 710, at Canterbury, St. Adrian. He accompanied St. Theodore to England when the latter was appointed archbishop of Canterbury. Theodore appointed Adrian abbot of St. Augustine's, where for forty years he taught in the important school attached to the abbey.

January 10

Around 400 AD, the death of St. Gregory of Nyssa, the brother of St. Basil, and a noted theologian and spiritual author whose writings influenced Evagrius of Pontus and Pseudo-Dionysius as well as the entire monastic tradition.

In 681, the death of Pope St. Agatho, who at the Sixth Ecumenical Council affirmed the orthodox view that Christ had two wills, divine and human, ending the Monothelite heresy.

In London in 1645, William Laud, Archbishop of Canterbury. William Laud was appointed Archbishop by his friend and ecclesiastical ally, King Charles, in 1633. The aim of both Archbishop and Monarch was to counter the reforming Puritan movement, which emphasised personal and ecclesial austerity as a means of sustaining conversion. Laud was a High Churchman who felt that the majesty of God should be reflected in the liturgy of the church and rigorously set about ensuring that its ministers should practise what he preached. His relentless approach left no room for variance of practice -- but neither did the Puritans -- and the latter had the upper hand in Parliament and eventually impeached him in 1640 and imprisoned him in the Tower of London. His friend the King did not -- or could not -- come to his assistance and he was beheaded.

January 11

In 529, the death at a very old age, of Theodosius, the “cenobiarch”. Born in Cappadocia, he was trained as a monk, and then started a monastery near Bethlehem. The emperor Theodosius made him overseer of all the cenobitic communities in Palestine. He was a staunch opponent of the Monophysite heresy, which held that Christ has only a single nature.

Shortly after 800, St. Paulinus of Aquileia, bishop. He was called to the court of Charlemagne, where he opposed forcing the Saxons to accept baptism. He was involved in theological disputes over adoptionism, the belief that Jesus was born human and became divine, and the procession of the Holy Spirit.

In 1153, David of Scotland, king. The fourth son of Queen Margaret of Scotland, David succeeded his brothers as king, and continued their policy of bringing Scotland closer to Norman England in its secular and religious institutions. In place of decaying Culdee foundations such as those in St Andrews, Melrose and Jedburgh, he introduced monastic communities of Roman observance, favouring reforming orders. These exercised a powerful, civilising influence and became centres of education, care for the sick and relief of the poor. He founded royal burghs and promoted a feudal system in the Norman style. He died in the year 1153.

Rhys Prichard, William Williams and Issac Williams.

Rhys Prichard (known as ‘Yr Hen Ficer’ – ‘The Old Vicar’) was probably born near Llandovery in 1579. He graduated from Jesus College, Oxford, in 1603, a year after his ordination to the priesthood, and was appointed vicar of Llandovery. In 1626 he became Chancellor of St Davids Cathedral. Prichard was one of the most effective communicators of the Christian message in Welsh history. His teachings were contained in easily remembered verses in colloquial Carmarthenshire Welsh. After Prichard’s death his poems were collected by Stephen Hughes in *Canwyll y Cymro* (The Welshman’s Candle). The impact of this often-reprinted volume on Welsh Christianity has been compared with that of Bunyan’s *Pilgrim’s Progress*. He died in the year 1644 and was buried in the churchyard of the cathedral.

William Williams was born at Llanfair-ar-y-bryn, Carmarthenshire, in the year 1717. He underwent a conversion while listening to Howell Harris preach, was ordained deacon and served as curate of Llanwrtyd. His Methodist leanings became clear and the Bishop of St Davids refused to ordain him priest. He died in the year 1791.

Isaac Williams was born at Cwmcynfelyn, near Aberystwyth, in 1802, and educated at Trinity College, Oxford. He was ordained in 1829, and was curate to John Henry Newman. He became a leading figure in the Oxford Movement, contributing to the *Tracts for the Times*, and helping build the first Tractarian church in Wales, at Llangorwen. In 1841 he left Oxford and became a country curate at Bisley and then Stinchcombe, where he died in the year 1865. He was the author of a considerable amount of devotional poetry, including *The Cathedral*, *The Baptistery* and *The Altar*, and some of his hymns are still sung. He was a gentle, quiet, reserved man, committed to prayer and to the pastoral care of his parishes.

In Africa in 1915 Mary Slessor, missionary. Mary Slessor was born into a working-class, Presbyterian family in Aberdeen in 1848. As a child in Dundee, she was enthralled by stories of missions in Africa. For years, she read diligently as she worked in the mills, and eventually, in 1875, she was accepted as a teacher for the mission in Calabar, Nigeria. Her fluency in the local language, physical resilience and lack of pretension

endeared her to those to whom she ministered. She adopted unwanted children, particularly twins who would otherwise, according to local superstition, have been put to death. She was influential in organising trade and in settling disputes, contributing much to the development of the Okoyong people with whom she later settled.

At Chevetogne, in Belgium, in 1960, Lambert Beauduin, monk and ecumenist. Dom Lambert was a monk of Mont César. Convinced of the need for the faithful to participate actively in the liturgy he taught at Sant'Anselmo in Rome and influenced many of the great personalities of the liturgical movement. Dom Lambert was also a convinced ecumenist and established the community at Chevetogne to further the cause of unity with the Orthodox churches. He was also committed to ecumenical dialogue with Anglicans. This caused him to come under suspicion and he was required to leave away from his monastery. Only returning for the last decade of his life. "liturgy is theology" he wrote, "the theology of the people."

January 12

About 529, at Arles, St. Caesaria, a nun, and sister of St. Caesarius, who wrote a rule for her convent.

In 689, St. Benedict Biscop, abbot. He became a monk at Lérins, then journeyed from Rome to England with Theodore of Tarsus and Adrian. He preceded Adrian as abbot of St. Augustine's, Canterbury. Drawing on his experience of continental monasteries, in 674 he founded his own abbey at Wearmouth, which he endowed with books he brought from the continent. His monastery became a centre of liturgical practice, chant and calligraphy. In 682 he founded the monastery of Jarrow, to which he sent young Bede.

At Rievaulx, Yorkshire, in 1167, St. Aelred of Rievaulx, Cistercian abbot. Aelred was born in Hexham, educated at Durham, and spent time at the court of King St. David I of Scotland. He entered Rievaulx in 1134, where he was later abbot for twenty years. He wrote history, biography, sermons, and treatises, including one On Spiritual Friendship. He was profoundly influential through his spiritual writings, which he began at the request of Bernard of Clairvaux, the two having a similar approach to the spiritual life. Because of this, Aelred was often called "The Bernard of the North". He died on this day at Rievaulx in 1167.

January 13

At Poitiers in 367, St. Hilary, the bishop of that city and doctor of the church. For his loyalty to the teaching of the Council of Nicaea, he spent three years in exile in Phrygia, during which he wrote an important treatise On the Trinity.

At Rheims, in 533, St. Remy, bishop, who baptised King Clovis and is honoured as "the apostle of the Franks".

Early in the seventh century, St. Kentigern, monk and first bishop of Glasgow. Kentigern, also known affectionately as Mungo, which means 'darling', is reputed to have been the grandson of a British prince in southern Scotland and to have attended a monastic school at Culross. The story goes that he became a missionary to the Britons living in Strathclyde and was elected their bishop. Following the persecution of Christians, he fled to Wales, where he founded a monastery at Llanellwy, and was succeeded by St Asaph, but eventually returned to Strathclyde where he continued his work of evangelism. He died in the year 603 and his tomb is in St Mungo's Cathedral in Glasgow.

In 1228, Blessed Jutta of Huy, who, widowed and the mother of three small children, worked in a leper colony for ten years. Afterwards she became an anchorite; her mystical experiences were recorded in a life written by Hugh of Floreffe.

In London in 1691, George Fox, founder of the Society of Friends. George Fox was born at Fenny Drayton in Leicestershire in 1624, the son of a weaver, and was himself apprenticed to a shoe-maker. He became something of a wayfarer from 1643 for about three years, loosening all ties with his family and friends. The

'Inner Light of the Living Christ' became his watchword in 1646 and he began to preach that the truth could only be found through the Inner Voice speaking directly to each soul. His society of 'The Friends of Truth' was formed at about this time, clearly a protest against the authoritarianism of the Presbyterian system, and many believers joined. Because of welcoming God into the soul often whilst in a state of trance, which caused much body movement, Gervase Bennet nicknamed them the Quakers in 1650; although meant as a term of abuse, it quickly became a name they themselves adopted. Fox spent several spells in gaol because of his determination to preach where he would and what he willed; he also made many missionary journeys around England, on the continent and to North America and the West Indies. He had a charismatic personality combined with excellent organisational abilities, which proved a solid foundation for ensuring the continuance of his beliefs and practices. He died on this day in 1691.

January 14

The commemoration of Malachi, the prophet.

About 260 AD, St. Felix of Nola, priest. He was imprisoned and tortured under the Emperor Decius.

In the first half of the fourth century, in Cappadocia, St. Macrina the Elder, grandmother of Sts. Basil, Gregory of Nyssa, Peter and Macrina the Younger.

In 1237, St. Sava of the royal family of Serbia, who became a monk on Mt. Athos, and founder and abbot of the monastery of Khilandari. He was made the first archbishop of Serbia in 1219. He worked hard to build up the Serbian church.

January 15

The commemoration of the prophets Habakkuk and Micah.

About 345, St. Paul the Hermit, whose legendary life was written by St. Jerome. St. Antony is said to have visited him shortly before Paul's death. According to these accounts, he broke bread with him. When Paul died, St. Antony buried him with the help of two lions. These events are commemorated in many art works.

About 570 AD, St. Ita of Killeedy. She is known as the "foster-mother of the saints of Ireland", because of the many saints who attended her boys' school. She told St. Brendan that "the three things that please God most are true faith in God with a pure heart, a simple life with a grateful spirit, and generosity inspired by charity."

Around 600, Sts. Maurus and Placid, disciples of St. Benedict, mentioned in the Dialogues of St. Gregory.

At Oxford, in 1915, Richard Meux Benson, priest, founder. Richard Meux Benson, the principal founder of the Society of Saint John the Evangelist, was born on July 6, 1824, in London. As a student at Christ Church, Oxford, he came under the influence of Edward Bouverie Pusey, who became his spiritual mentor and lifelong friend. In 1849 Benson was ordained a priest and became rector of Cowley, a village neighbouring Oxford. In 1866, together with two other priests, he founded the Society of Saint John the Evangelist (SSJE), "a small body to realise and intensify the gifts and energies belonging to the whole Church." SSJE became the first stable religious community for men in the Anglican Church since the Reformation, styled as a missionary order patterned on St. Vincent de Paul's Company of Mission Priests. A branch house was established in Boston in 1870. In 1874 work began in Bombay, and later Poona. By 1880 SSJE had opened a mission house in Cape Town, South Africa, and in 1903 in the Transkei. Benson wrote the original SSJE Rule and served as Superior until 1890.

January 16

Around 96 AD, the martyrdom of St. Priscilla. The important catacomb in Rome named for her is under the care of a convent of Benedictine sisters.

At Arles, in 429, St. Honoratus, monk and bishop, co-founder of the monastery of Lérins, which produced many bishops and influenced the development of monasticism.

January 17

In 356, in Egypt, St. Antony, who is well known from the Life which St. Athanasius wrote about him and from his own letters and sayings. He was born of Christian parents, orphaned young, and then felt called to leave everything to follow Christ. He retired to an old burial ground around 273, and in 286 to an abandoned hilltop fort where he stayed for twenty years. After visiting Alexandria in 311 to support those persecuted under Maximinus, he founded a monastery at Pispir and then retired to a more secluded place, called the "inner mountain". In art he is often shown with a t-shaped stick, a pig, or a cloak.

In 644 St Sulpice the Pious, bishop. Born at Vatan to noble parents he devoted himself to good works and the study of Scripture. Ordained priest he became bishop of Bourges in 624 and set about restoring ecclesiastical discipline and receiving the lives of the poor. Towards the end of his life he entered a monastery. The church of Saint Sulpice in Paris is named after him and from this the Society of Saint-Sulpice, a community of priests dedicated to the training and formation of the clergy was named.

At Kensington in London, in 1932, Charles Gore, Bishop and founder. Born in 1835, Gore became one of the most influential of Anglican theologians. He helped reconcile the Church to some aspects of biblical criticism and scientific discovery, yet was Catholic in his interpretation of the faith and sacraments. He was also concerned to bring Catholic principles to bear on social problems. As an Oxford don and then as a Canon of Westminster, he was renowned for his preaching. In the 1890s, he was the founder -- and first leader -- of the Community of the Resurrection, which in later years settled at Mirfield in Yorkshire. From 1902, he was successively bishop of Worcester, Birmingham and Oxford. He was much mourned at his death on this day in 1932.

January 18

The Confession of St Peter

The beginning of the ministry of the Apostle Peter at Rome has been commemorated in that city from ancient times. The feast, known as the 'Chair of Peter', is a reminder of the chair or cathedra on which a bishop sits and teaches. The traditional readings for the day include Peter's acclamation of Jesus, 'You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God', a confession which has given its name to this commemoration. Since 29 June may be observed as the feast of both Peter and Paul, today's feast allows Peter to be commemorated alone, and mirrors the remembrance of Paul a week later. These two days, the Confession of Peter and the Conversion of Paul, bracket the Week of Prayer for Christian Unity. As Paul's conversion reminds us that we are united in a call to proclaim Jesus among the nations, so Peter's confession reminds us that we are united in proclaiming the divine revelation of Jesus Christ, 'the Son of the living God'.

January 19

The Interior Life of Our Saviour

About 390, in Egypt, St. Macarius the Elder, who was a revered elder at the monastic settlement of Skete. Many of his sayings are preserved in collections of the Sayings of the Desert Fathers. John Wesley wrote of him that "I read Macarius, and sang."

At Worcester, in 1095, St. Wulfstan, bishop and monk. He was a young priest when he joined the small cathedral priory at Worcester. He became bishop in 1062, and abolished the slave trade in Bristol. He was a humble, self-disciplined and generous man and a zealous pastor.

January 20

In the third century, at Rome, St. Fabian, pope, martyred under Decius, and Sebastian, a soldier, martyred under Diocletian. A late legend said Sebastian was tortured by being shot full of arrows. He was invoked as a protector against plague.

In 1107, at Vallombrosa, near Florence, Blessed Benedict of Coltiboni, a hermit attached to the monastery founded there by St. John Gualbert.

At Hampole in Yorkshire, Richard Rolle, hermit, in 1349. Richard Rolle was born in about the year 1300 in Thornton in Yorkshire, where he first began to live the hermit life at the age of eighteen, after breaking off his education at the University of Oxford. After moving his hermitage to several other sites, he finally settled close to the Cistercian nuns at Hampole, where he undertook much of his prolific writing on mysticism and asceticism. He wrote in Latin but also produced many texts directly in English and even in the Northumbrian dialect.

At Mount St Bernard Abbey, Leicester, in 1964, Blessed Cyprian Michael Iwene Tansi. He was one of the first ten Nigerians to be ordained a priest. He was an ascetic and an excellent preacher. In 1950 he joined Mount St. Bernard Trappist abbey in England. He had hoped to be part of a foundation in Nigeria, but died before that was possible. Cardinal Arinze, whom he baptised and to whom he gave first communion, promoted his canonisation.

January 21

At Rome, around 300, St. Agnes, virgin and martyr. According to the legendary account of her martyrdom, when she was thirteen years old she refused to serve the gods in the temple of Vesta. For that she was placed naked in a brothel. The prefect's son was struck blind when he tried to have his way with her; his sight was restored at her intercession. She was then beheaded at the stadium of Domitian, now the Piazza Navona. Because her name is similar to the Latin word for "lamb" (agnus) she is often depicted with a lamb.

In Tarragona, in 259, the death of St. Fructuosus, bishop. According to the authentic acts of his martyrdom, when the emperor Valerian struck at the clergy, Fructuosus and two of his deacons were arrested, condemned and burned to death.

In 861, at Einsiedeln, St. Meinrad, martyr. Born in Germany, he entered the monastery of Reichenau in Switzerland. After doing pastoral work around Lake Zurich, he received permission to become a hermit, and later moved his hermitage to Einsiedeln. He was murdered there 25 years later by two robbers to whom he offered hospitality. Some years later, a priest named Benno founded a Benedictine monastery at Einsiedeln, which has remained there ever since.

January 22

At Zaragoza, in 304 under the Emperor Diocletian, St. Vincent, deacon and martyr, who died of multiple wounds inflicted upon him. In art, he is depicted with a gridiron, a dalmatic and a raven, which is said to have kept birds of prey from his body.

January 23

At Toledo, in Spain, in 677, St. Ildephonse, bishop. He was a monk and abbot before being elected archbishop of Toledo, the primatial see of Spain. He promoted devotion to Mary.

At Heworth, York, in 1645, Mary Ward, religious. Born in 1585, Mary sought to found a new form of religious life for women, more like that of the Jesuits. In the face of much opposition she persevered and her community has continued to this day, now known as the Companions of Jesus.

In Berlin, in 1945, Blessed Nicholas Gross, martyr. He was born near Essen and worked in coal mines and steel mills. He became active in Catholic social action movements, married and was the devoted father of seven children. He became editor of a Catholic workers' paper and was an early opponent of the Nazis, who shut down the paper in 1938. He joined the resistance and because of his knowledge of a plot against Hitler was arrested, condemned, hanged and cremated. The Nazis scattered his ashes on a sewer pond to make sure that no devotion was given to his remains.

January 24

In Hong Kong in 1944, the ordination of Florence Li Tim-Oi, the first woman to be ordained priest in the Anglican Communion.

At Beneventum near Brecon, in 577, Cadoc, abbot. Cadoc was born of royal parentage about the year 497, and was educated at the monastic school of Tathan at Caerwent (Gwent). He established a monastery at Lllancarfan, in the Vale of Glamorgan, which soon became famous. The twelfth-century Life of Saint Cadoc tells us: 'There eagerly flowed together, from various districts of the whole of Britannia, very many clerics to Saint Cadoc, like rivers to the sea, that they might attain to imitate his wisdom and practice; for he always welcomed eagerly all, who steadily toiled in the service of God and paid heed to the divine scriptures.' Cadoc made visits to Ireland to study in the monastery of Lismore, and there was a frequent interchange between Lllancarfan and Irish monasteries. With the coming of the Yellow Plague in the year 547, Cadoc fled to Brittany and established churches there. He returned to Lllancarfan to rule as abbot-king of Glamorgan; and in his old age retired to Beneventum, probably near Brecon. There in the year 577 he was murdered by a soldier as he entered the church.

In Lyons, in 1622, St Francis de Sales, bishop and doctor of the church. He studied rhetoric, philosophy and theology in Paris for six years, then, after a brief stay with his family near Annecy, studied law in Padua. He became a priest and was assigned the task of reconverting from Calvinism a mountainous district of Savoy. He became bishop in 1602 and devoted himself tirelessly to renewal of his diocese according to the reform decrees of the Council of Trent. He was a many writer of letters, pamphlets and books. In 1604 he met a widowed mother of four, Jeanne Frances de Chantal, who became his lifelong friend and the founder of the Visitation Order. He wrote in the Introduction to the Devout Life that all Christians could serve God in holiness no matter what their state in life.

January 25

The Feast of the Conversion of Paul, the story of which is told three times in the Acts of the Apostles. Jesus appeared to Paul as Paul was approaching Damascus and told him, "I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting."

At Marchiennes, in 1048, St. Poppo, who, after a career as a soldier, entered the monastery of St-Thierry, which was part of the monastic reform promoted by Richard of Saint-Vanne. Emperor Henry II appointed Poppo abbot of the monasteries of Stavelot and Malmedy in 1022, and soon Poppo was given supervision of other monasteries, including Saint Maximin of Trier, Echternach and St. Gall.

In 1366, at Ulm, Blessed Henry Suso, Dominican priest and mystic. His books, the Little Book of Truth and the Little Book of Eternal Wisdom, had great influence on subsequent spirituality.

January 26

Sts. Timothy and Titus, disciples of St. Paul and martyrs.

At Bethlehem, in 404, the death of St. Paula the Elder. A Roman noblewoman, she married and had five children before being widowed at 32. With Marcella, also a widow, she formed part of the ascetic circle cultivated in Rome by St. Jerome, who encouraged their study of the bible. When Pope Damasus died, Jerome, Paula and others of their acquaintance went to Palestine and Egypt and finally settled in Bethlehem where they founded several monasteries. Her granddaughter, Paula, succeeded her as head of her monastery.

Between 1109 and 1134, the deaths of Sts. Robert of Molesme, Alberic and Stephen Harding, the founders of the Cistercian Order, which aimed for a secluded, austere life of prayer and work. When their foundation at Molesme no longer provided the sort of life they desired, they and about 20 others left to start the New Monastery at Citeaux. Robert returned to Molesme, and when Alberic died, Stephen succeeded him as abbot. Under Stephen's guidance, the Cistercian order soon flourished. He was responsible for drafting the Charter of Charity, which regulated the relationships between monasteries of the order and called for annual visitations and a general chapter.

In Norway, in 1188, St. Eystein of Trondheim. After studying at St. Victor in Paris, in 1157 Eystein became second archbishop of Trondheim, the metropolitan see of the Norwegian Empire, which included Iceland, Greenland, Orkney, the Shetland Islands, the Western Islands of Scotland and the Isle of Man. He struggled to gain independence for his church from the Norwegian kings and spent some time in exile at Bury St. Edmund's in England.

January 27

In 1927, in Kaunas, Lithuania, Blessed George Matulaitis, bishop. After studies with the Marian Fathers in Lithuania, he did advanced studies at Warsaw, St. Petersburg, and Fribourg. Ordained a priest in 1898, he devoted himself to the poor in Warsaw. He became very ill and was facing death in a paupers' ward when some sisters took him under their care and nursed him back to health. He then joined the Marian Fathers, who had been persecuted by the Czarist government and were on the verge of dying out. Under his leadership, the order revived and spread. He was made bishop of Vilnius in 1918. He resigned in 1925, but then was made apostolic visitor to bring order to church affairs in Lithuania.

In 1540, the death of St. Angela Merici, founder of the Ursuline Order. She became a Franciscan tertiary, and established a support group for unmarried girls in her area. She moved to Brescia during a troubled time in the city's history and established a centre there for unmarried women. When she was almost 60, she and some of her companions took up residence in a house, and this is considered to be the beginning of the Ursuline Order.

January 28

At the Cistercian monastery of Fossanova, St. Thomas Aquinas, Dominican priest and doctor of the church. He was born near Aquino, between Naples and Rome. He was educated at Monte Cassino for eight years, then at the University of Naples, where he became acquainted with the works of Aristotle. He joined the Dominican Order there in 1224, against the wishes of his family. He studied at Paris and Cologne under St. Albert the Great. Thomas lectured on the Bible and the Sentences of Peter Lombard, and in 1256 was appointed a master of theology. He began the Summa contra Gentiles at that time and then taught for ten years in Italy. In 1269, he returned to teach in Paris for three years. He was an exemplary religious, whose theology was nourished by his own spiritual reading and experience. He composed much of the liturgy for Corpus Christi.

January 29

In Brittany, around 570, St. Gildas. He was born in Scotland, moved to Wales and became a monk there. He was a famous teacher, and St. Finnian of Clonard probably studied under him. His book, *On the Ruin of Britain*, blames the conquest of Britain by the Anglo-Saxons on the decadence of the British rulers and clergy. In the eleventh century, Wulstan of York used the book in his *Sermon of the Wolf*.

January 30

In 680, at the monastery of Chelles, St. Bathild. She was an Anglo-Saxon girl, sold into slavery in France, who eventually married King Clovis II and bore him three sons. When she became regent after the death of King Clovis, she ransomed slaves, founded the monasteries of Corbie and Chelles, and in other ways supported the church. In 665 she retired to Chelles, where she lived as a humble nun.

At Burgos, in 1097, St. Adelelmus. A soldier, he came under the influence of St. Robert of Turlande, abbot of the monastery of La Chaise-Dieu, and joined his monastery. After serving briefly as abbot of La Chaise-Dieu, he was invited by Constance of Burgundy, wife of King Alfonso VI of Castille, to move to Burgos. There she built a monastery for him.

At Westminster in London in 1649, Charles Stuart, King and martyr. Born in 1600, the second son of James the First, Charles became heir apparent when he was twelve years old on the death of his brother. He succeeded to the throne in 1625, where he came up against the increasing power of an antagonistic Parliament. Combined with the religious puritanism which was prevalent, this made Charles staunch in his resistance of the power of either force in the land. He frequently dismissed sittings of Parliament and tried to enforce high-church Anglican practice on all, throughout both kingdoms of England and Scotland. Opposition resulted in civil war. After Charles' imprisonment and trial, he was put to death on this day in 1649..

In 1923, at the monastery of Maredsous, in Belgium, Blessed Columba Marmion, abbot. He was born in Dublin in 1858 of an Irish father and a French mother. He studied theology in Rome. He served as a chaplain and seminary professor in Dublin for five years, but then asked to become a monk at Maredsous. After teaching for a while in the abbey school, and preaching in nearby churches, he was assigned to the abbey of Mont-Cesar in Louvain, where he was in demand as a spiritual director and retreat master. He was elected abbot of Maredsous in 1909. His spiritual teaching is distilled in three books, *Christ, the Life of the Soul*, *Christ, the Life of the Monk*, and *Christ in His Mysteries*. He was beatified in 2000, along with Popes Pius IX and John XXIII.

In New Delhi, India, in 1948, the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi.

January 31

In 632, St. Edan, bishop. Cadoc was born of royal parentage about the year 497, and was educated at the monastic school of Tathan at Caerwent (Gwent). He established a monastery at Llancarfan, in the Vale of Glamorgan, which soon became famous. The twelfth-century *Life of Saint Cadoc* tells us: 'There eagerly flowed together, from various districts of the whole of Britannia, very many clerics to Saint Cadoc, like rivers to the sea, that they might attain to imitate his wisdom and practice; for he always welcomed eagerly all, who steadily toiled in the service of God and paid heed to the divine scriptures.' Cadoc made visits to Ireland to study in the monastery of Lismore, and there was a frequent interchange between Llancarfan and Irish monasteries. With the coming of the Yellow Plague in the year 547, Cadoc fled to Brittany and established churches there. He returned to Llancarfan to rule as abbot-king of Glamorgan; and in his old age retired to Beneventum, probably near Brecon. There in the year 577 he was murdered by a soldier as he entered the church.

In Africa in 1862, Charles Mackenzie, bishop. The Universities Mission to Central Africa was formed in response to an appeal by David Livingstone. Charles Mackenzie was consecrated bishop in Cape Town in

1861 to lead this mission from South Africa up the Zambesi towards Lake Nyassa. The missionaries' preaching of the gospel and their efforts to secure the release of slaves provoked opposition from native leaders and Portuguese colonists. Charles succumbed to illness and died only a year after his consecration, a man of transparent and humble Christian devotion.

In 1888, at Turin, St. John Bosco. He was the youngest son of a Piedmontese farmer. After ordination, he was sent for further studies at the theological faculty in Turin. Turin was in the throes of industrialization, nationalism and anticlericalism. John Bosco began working among the displaced youth in the poor sections of the city, opening vocational programs and eventually schools. His boys ministered to the populace during a cholera epidemic in 1854. In spite of anti-religious laws, he was able to found a new religious congregation, the Salesians, named after his hero, St. Francis de Sales, and a congregation of sisters, the Daughters of Mary Help of Christians, and a vigorous group of lay cooperators. He wrote a number of books and was widely regarded as having preternatural powers.

In Rome, in 410, St. Marcella, a disciple of St. Jerome. She died of a beating received from the invading Goths.

In 1642, at Tyburn, in England, the martyrdom of St. Alban Roe, Benedictine monk, and Bl. Thomas Reynolds, priest. Roe, a convert, went to study for the priesthood at Douai and later joined the Benedictines of St. Laurence at Dieulouard (now the Abbey of Ampleforth). In 1618, he was arrested while on mission in England and banished. He returned to England in 1623 and was arrested again in 1626. He spent the next 16 years in prison, always cheerful, always making converts and giving spiritual guidance. He encouraged Blessed Thomas Reynolds as they prepared for death.

February

February 1

At her monastery in Kildare, in 524, St. Brigid, abbess. After St. Patrick, St. Brigid is the most venerated saint in Ireland. She was abbess of a monastery of men and women located about 40 miles southwest of Dublin. Even as a child, she was extremely generous to those in need. Once while she was tending a dying pagan chieftan, she wove a cross of reeds. He asked her the meaning of the cross, and her explanation led him to ask for baptism. A perpetual fire was kept burning in her honour after her death. Hence, fire and a cross are her emblems.

February 2

The Feast of the Presentation of the Lord. This feast is attested from the fifth century in Palestine. It came to Rome in the seventh century under the Greek name, Hypapante. In the Middle Ages it was known as the feast of the Purification of Mary.

In Palestine, in the first century, Cornelius the Centurion. The Acts of the Apostles tell how Peter was instructed by a vision to visit Cornelius' household. At his preaching they were filled with the Holy Spirit, and he baptised them.

In 619, at Canterbury, St. Lawrence, bishop. Lawrence was a monk of St. Andrew's on the Coelian Hill in Rome. He accompanied Augustine on his mission to England and succeeded him as bishop.

February 3

In 316, at Sebastea in Armenia, the death of St. Blaise, bishop. A ritual blessing of the throats with two crossed candles occurs on his feast day. Two miracles attributed to him account for this: While he was being taken to trial, he persuaded a wolf to release a pig it was in the process of killing; the pig's owner brought him food and candles while he was in prison. Also, while in prison, he cured a boy who had a fish bone stuck in his throat. His legend records that he was martyred by being raked with metal wool combs. His emblem is a wool comb, and he is the patron of wool combers.

In the sixth century, St Seiriol, abbot. Seiriol (often known as Seiriol Wyn – 'Seiriol the Fair') was the son of Owain Danwyn ab Einion Yrth ap Cunedda Wledig. During the first half of the sixth century he became the founder and first abbot of Penmon in Anglesey. He also gave his name to Ynys Seiriol, to which he used to retire for periods of prayer and meditation. Another of Seiriol's retreats was at Penmaenmawr. Sir John Wynn of Gwydir Seiriol (often known as Seiriol Wyn – 'Seiriol the Fair') was the son of Owain Danwyn ab Einion Yrth ap Cunedda Wledig. During the first half of the sixth century he became the founder and first abbot of Penmon in Anglesey. He also gave his name to Ynys Seiriol, to which he used to retire for periods of prayer and meditation. Another of Seiriol's retreats was at Penmaenmawr. Sir John Wynn of Gwydir

In 865, at Bremen, St. Ansgar, bishop and patron of Denmark. Ansgar was a monk first at Corbie, then at Corvey. He was a distinguished preacher who was sent as a missionary to Denmark and then to Sweden. His missionary efforts met with initial success, but as the Frankish empire declined, political difficulties undercut what he had accomplished. He was made archbishop of Hamburg and then of Bremen.

[In Scotland today is observed as Saints and Martyrs of Europe.]

February 4

In the first century, Cornelius the centurion. Acts relates the story of Cornelius' conversion twice (in chapters 10 and 11), describing him as "a devout man who feared God."

martyrology

In 1189, St. Gilbert of Sempringham, abbot. After studying in France, he opened a school for boys and girls. He was called to the household of the Bishop of Lincoln and ordained a priest. He helped a group of women form a community in a house next to his church, to which were added, first lay sisters and lay brothers, and then a group of canons regular. Although the beginnings of his order were troubled by conflicts, by the time of his death it had 1500 members in 13 houses in England.

In 856, St. Rabanus Maurus, abbot of Fulda and bishop of Mainz. He was educated at Fulda, and then under Alcuin at Tours. He wrote extensively on theology for monks, clergy and laity, and composed biblical commentaries.

In South Africa, in 1928, Manche Masemola, martyr. Manche Masemola lived her short life in Marishane, a small town near Pietersburg, South Africa, and was declared a martyr by the South African Church less than a decade after her death in 1928. Manche's journey to martyrdom began when she and her cousin joined baptism preparation classes in 1927. Every time she returned, Manche was beaten by her parents. Once her mother tried to stab her with a spear. Eventually her mother stole Manche's clothes, but she ran away naked and hid. When her mother found her, she beat Manche until she died. Manche was killed before she was baptised; however, she had predicted to her priest that she would be 'baptised in her own blood'.

February 5

At Catania, in Sicily, the martyrdom of St. Agatha. She dedicated her virginity to Christ, and for being a Christian and refusing to compromise her pledge to him, she was martyred. Her breasts were cut off, so she is patron of breast ailments. She is also venerated as a protector against fire. She is sometimes depicted holding a platter with her breasts on it. These were sometimes mistaken for loaves of bread, and it became customary to bake and eat St. Agatha's bread on her feast day.

In 1015, near Cologne, St. Adelaide of Vilich. She introduced the Rule of St. Benedict to the convent her father had established there.

February 6

In Japan, St. Paul Miki and companions. Christianity was first brought to Japan by Bishop John of Albuquerque and St. Francis Xavier in 1548-1549. Soon there were tens of thousands of Christians, and a diocese was created in 1588. In 1597 the first martyrdoms took place at Nagasaki. Other persecutions and martyrdoms followed, and after 1645 Christianity had to exist underground until the country was again opened to Westerners in 1865.

In 539, St. Vedast, companion of St. Rémy and bishop of Arras.

In 676, in Flanders, St. Amandus, abbot and bishop, who founded the monasteries of Elnone, near Tournai, and St. Peter's in Ghent.

February 7

At Lucca, in 720, St. Richard. Richard was from Wessex, and was the father of Saints Willibald, Winnibald, and Walburga, Benedictine Anglo-Saxon missionaries in Germany and superiors of the monastery at Heidenheim.

In 1878, Blessed Pius IX, a long-reigning and controversial pope, whose personal magnetism did much to restore the prestige of the papacy. He called the First Vatican Council, whose decrees dealt with the relation of faith and reason and papal infallibility.

February 8

In 1537, St. Jerome Emiliani, founder of the Somaschi Congregation, who were dedicated to the care of needy children. He was perhaps the first person to write a catechism in question and answer form.

At Whitby, in 714, St. Elfleda, abbess. She was offered as a child oblate to St. Hilda by her father King Oswy of Northumbria. She was a friend of St. Cuthbert, and eventually succeeded Hilda as abbess at Whitby.

In 1124, St. Stephen of Muret, abbot and founder of the Order of Grandmont. After visiting Rome, he became a hermit near Limoges. Disciples gathered around him and toward the end of his life he established a very austere monastic community at Muret.

In Italy, in 1947, St. Josephine Bakhita. She was born in the Darfur region of the Sudan. When she was a small child she was captured by slave-traders and sold successively to several different owners. The last, an Italian, offered to free her, and she asked him to take her to Italy. She served as a nanny for a family in Venice. She came to know the Canossian sisters, converted, and joined the Order. Her memoirs were published in 1930 and were widely acclaimed. She was the first African-born saint to be canonised in modern times.

February 9

St. Apollonia, an elderly deaconess of the church of Alexandria, who was burned to death around 249 AD. Before she was burned, all her teeth were knocked out, so she became the patron of dentists and sufferers from toothache.

In the ninth century, Teilo, bishop. Teilo was born at Penally, near Tenby, and studied along with David at Paulinus' school at Llanddeusant, near Llandovery. Legend has it that Teilo, along with David and Padarn, went on pilgrimage to Jerusalem where, it is said, all three were consecrated bishops. What is more certain is that Teilo had episcopal oversight of a number of monasteries in west Wales, the chief being Llandeilo Fawr. With the coming of the Yellow Plague in 547, Teilo fled to Brittany, staying with Samson at Dol for seven years, and founding a number of churches. Soon after his return to Llandeilo Fawr, Teilo died. Three churches – Penally, Llandeilo Fawr and Llandaff – each claimed to have his body. The twelfth-century Book of Llandaff says that 'miracles proved that Teilo's body was undoubtedly brought to Llandaff', and his shrine on the south side of the high altar in the cathedral became a place of pilgrimage. Teilo is one of the patron saints of Llandaff.

At Regensburg about 1080, Blessed Marianus Scotus, a Irish pilgrim who became a Benedictine monk in Regensburg. He began the monastery of Weih-Sankt-Peter on the edge of the city. He was a noted copyist and wrote books and poetry of his own. Disciples were drawn to him from Ireland, and after his death they founded the monastery of St. James in 1111. It became the head of a congregation of eight Irish Benedictine communities in German lands.

At St Petersburg, in 1881, Fyodor Mikhailovich Dostoevsky. In a life marked by much suffering, imprisonment, reprieve from the death penalty, epilepsy and the death of his two children, Dostoevsky believed that authentic community and human fellowship could only be based on a living faith in Christ. His novels are marked by a profound understanding of the nature of evil and rebellion against God.

February 10

Near Monte Cassino, about 545 AD, St. Scholastica. According to St. Gregory's Dialogues, each year Scholastica came to visit her brother, St. Benedict, so they could spend a day in holy conversation. The last time she came to visit, she prayed successfully to be allowed to continue the conversation through the night. Her prayers were answered because her love was greater than Benedict's. Three days later, she died. Benedict had a vision of her soul rising to heaven in the form of a dove. He had her body placed in a tomb he had prepared for himself.

1164, at Premontre, Blessed Hugh of Fosses, the first disciple of St. Norbert and his coadjutor and successor as Abbot of Premontre and head of the Premonstratensian Order.

In 1960, Blessed Aloysius Stepinac. He was born in what is now Croatia. He wanted to enter the seminary, but was drafted into the army. After World War I he studied agronomy for five years. He was active in Catholic organisations. He studied for the priesthood in Rome and was ordained in 1930. In 1937 he became archbishop of Zagreb. He opposed "exaggerated nationalism" and tried to help Jews fleeing from the Nazis. At first he accepted the pro-Nazi regime imposed by Germany in 1941, but within a year he was their most outspoken critic. In 1946 he was arrested by the communists and imprisoned. His jailers tried to poison him.

February 11

The Feast of Our Lady of Lourdes, which commemorates the appearances of Mary in 1858 to a fourteen-year-old girl named Marie Bernarde Soubirous. In the course of these, a miraculous spring began to flow. Pilgrimages to the spot began in 1862, and it is now one of the most visited shrines in the world, at which many miraculous cures have occurred.

At Whitby, in 680, St. Caedmon. He was a herdsman of the monastery, who received a vision telling him to sing about the creation of all things. Caedmon then wrote a poem, the earliest surviving poem in English. Afterwards he became a monk and put his poetic gifts at the service of the church.

At Rome, in 731, the death of Pope Gregory II. He was an excellent theologian and administrator. He stood up to Emperor Leo III's iconoclasm and excessive taxation of Italy. He also ward off an invasion of Rome by the Lombard king Liutprand, who ceded him some territory, the beginning of the papal states. He commissioned and supported St. Boniface in his missionary work among the Germanic tribes. He helped Abbot Petronax to restore Monte Cassino.

In the United States in 1915, Fanny Jane Crosby, hymn writer. Born in 1820, she went blind at six weeks of age. A prolific writer from the age of 8 she wrote many hymns. Her most enduring hymns speak of a personal and heartfelt devotion to Christ, she is the author of "To God be the glory, great things he hath done" and is best known for her "Blessed assurance, Jesus is mine!"

February 12

At the Council of Constantinople, in 381, the death of St. Meletius of Antioch, a kindly man, who worked to overcome the schisms caused by the Arian heresy.

In 821, St. Benedict of Aniane, abbot. Benedict was the son of a Visigoth count. He served as a page in Charlemagne's court and as a soldier. He entered the monastery of Saint-Seine, near Dijon, where he led an extremely austere life. He retired to live as a hermit, but disciples came, and he built a monastery. He was appointed overseer of a number of monasteries in Provence and Gascony, and later was made abbot of the monastery of Kornelimünster, near Aachen, from which he directed the reform of monasteries throughout the Carolingian Empire. He presided at the reform council at Aachen in 816, which imposed the Rule of St. Benedict on all monasteries. He was responsible for several important collections of earlier monastic rules.

At Paris in 1691, Brother Lawrence. born Nicolas Herman in Hériménil, near Lunéville in the region of Lorraine, located in modern-day eastern France. As a young man, Herman's poverty forced him into joining the army, which guaranteed him meals and a small stipend. During this period, Herman claimed an experience that set him on a unique spiritual journey.[2]

He fought in the Thirty Years' War and following an injury, left the army and served as a valet. In June 1640, Nicolas joined the Discalced Carmelite Priory in Paris. He entered the priory as a lay brother and took the religious name, "Lawrence of the Resurrection". He spent the rest of his life with the Parisian community,

where his primary assignments were working in the kitchen and, in his later years, repairing sandals. Despite his lowly position in life and the priory, his character attracted many to him. He had a reputation for experiencing profound peace and visitors came to seek spiritual guidance from him. The wisdom he passed on to them, in conversations and in letters, would later become the basis for the book, ***The Practice of the Presence of God***. The conversations had been conducted and recorded by a notable cleric, the Abbe Joseph de Beaufort, who compiled this work after Brother Lawrence died. It became popular among Catholics and Protestants alike, with John Wesley and A.W. Tozer recommending it to others.

At Calcutta in 1940, Charles Freer Andrews, priest. Affectionately called "Christ's Faithful Apostle" by his friend, the Mahatma Gandhi, Charles Freer Andrews dedicated his life's work to relief and justice for the oppressed and poor in India and around the globe.

Born in Birmingham, England in 1871, in 1904 he joined the Cambridge Brotherhood in India and began to teach philosophy at St. Stephen's College, Delhi. His Indian students and colleagues, with whom he had grown close, referred to him as Deenabandhu, or "Friend of the Poor."

Andrews openly criticised the racist mistreatment of the Indian people by British officials and, in 1913, he successfully mediated a cotton worker's strike in Madras which had the potential to become violent. He traveled to South Africa to help the Indians there, and it was then that he met a young lawyer named Mohandas Gandhi. Andrews was impressed with Gandhi's teaching of non-violence and with his knowledge of the Christian faith, and helped him establish an ashram, or Indian hermitage, devoted to the practice of peace. He eventually returned to England, where he continued to teach about social justice and radical discipleship until his death in 1940.

February 13

In 1237, in a shipwreck off the coast of Palestine, Blessed Jordan of Saxony. After studying at Paris and lecturing there on theology and perhaps mathematics as well, he joined the Dominicans. Two years later, in 1222, he succeeded St. Dominic as master general of the Dominicans. For the rest of his life he traveled extensively, promoting the spread of his order. He wrote widely, including a series of letters to his friend Blessed Diana d'Andalo, who in Bologna founded a Dominican convent around which the first group of third order Dominicans gathered.

In 1469, Blessed Eustochium of Padua. She was the illegitimate daughter of a nun who was badly abused by her stepmother. She was educated at the convent where her mother had been a nun, and later joined it. She suffered demonic attacks or mental illness, but the abbess protected her from public outrage, and Eustochium died peacefully at the age of twenty-five.

At Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, in 1818, Absalom Jones, priest. Absalom Jones was born a house slave in 1746 in Delaware. He taught himself to read out of the New Testament, among other books. When sixteen, he was sold to a store owner in Philadelphia. There he attended a night school for Blacks, operated by Quakers. At twenty, he married another slave, and purchased her freedom with his earnings.

Jones bought his own freedom in 1784. At St. George's Methodist Episcopal Church, he served as lay minister for its Black membership. In 1787, Black Christians organised the Free African Society, the first organised Afro-American society, and Absalom Jones and Richard Allen were elected overseers. In 1792, the Society began to build a church, which was dedicated on July 17, 1794. In October 1794 the African Church was admitted as St. Thomas African Episcopal Church. Jones was ordained priest.

He was an earnest preacher. He denounced slavery, and warned the oppressors to "clean their hands of slaves." To him, God was the Father, who always acted on "behalf of the oppressed and distressed." But it was his constant visiting and mild manner that made him beloved by his own flock and by the community.

February 14

In the last half of the 9th century, Sts. Cyril and Methodius. Cyril studied secular sciences at Constantinople, and succeeded Photius as professor there. His brother Methodius was a state official. Around 860 they were sent as missionaries from Constantinople to the Slavs. They translated the Bible and the liturgy into Old

Slavonic, for which they created an alphabet. They passed through Rome in 867 on their way to Constantinople, carrying the relics of St. Clement, which were placed in the church of San Clemente. Pope Hadrian II endorsed their missionary work. Cyril died in 869. Methodius was consecrated archbishop of Sirmium in 870, with responsibility for the Moravian, Serbo-Croatian and Slovene mission territories. Much of his work was later undone because of conflicts between the Franks, Constantinople and Rome. Cyril and Methodius are, with St. Benedict, the patrons of Europe.

At Rome, in the third century, the martyrdom of St. Valentine. One theory holds that his association with romantic love originated because birds choose their mates around this date.

February 15

Around 1045, St. Sigfrid, the apostle of Sweden. He was probably a monk of Glastonbury. The spring at Husaby, where he baptised King Olaf of Sweden in 1008, was credited with miraculous powers.

In 1682, at Paray-le-Monial, St. Claude de la Colombière. He joined the Jesuits in his youth and studied at Avignon and Paris. He had a special devotion to the Sacred Heart. His devotion was confirmed when he met St. Margaret Mary Alacoque, who was a nun at the Visitation convent in Paray-le-Monial. He went to England in 1676 as preacher for Maria of Modena, duchess of York. He was arrested in 1678, tried, then banished to France. Largely because of him, devotion to the Sacred Heart of Jesus spread throughout the world.

In London in 1730, Thomas Bray, priest. Born at Marton in Shropshire in 1656, Thomas Bray was educated at Oxford and subsequently ordained. He was chosen by the Bishop of London to assist with the work of organising the church in Maryland in the USA but, during an extended delay in his setting out, he managed to organise a system of free libraries, initially for use in America but later instituted in England. This led to his founding the Society for the Promotion of Christian Knowledge (SPCK) in 1698. On his return to Europe in 1699, he also founded The Society for the Propagation of the Gospel.

February 16

In the first century, Blessed Onesimus, of whom St. Paul writes in the Letter to Philemon.

In 310, at Caesarea in Palestine, St. Elias and companions. They were Egyptian Christians, who went to visit their fellow converts who had been sent to the mines in Cilicia in southern Asia Minor. They were arrested on the way home, tortured and finally beheaded.

February 17

In the 13th century, the seven founders of the Servite Order. They were members of a confraternity in Florence dedicated to the Blessed Virgin. They formed a religious community in 1240. The Order was largely responsible for promoting devotion to the Seven Sorrows of the Blessed Virgin Mary.

At Lindisfarne, in 661, St. Fintan, abbot and bishop. He was sent from Iona to succeed St. Aidan at Lindisfarne, and was himself succeeded by Colman, who defended Irish practices at the Synod of Whitby.

At Kampala, in Uganda, Janani Luwum, bishop and martyr. Born in 1922 at Acholi in Uganda his childhood and youth were spent as a goatherd but he quickly showed an ability to learn and absorb knowledge when given the opportunity. Soon after he became a teacher, he was converted to Christianity and was eventually ordained in 1956, becoming Bishop of Northern Uganda in 1969 and Archbishop of Uganda in 1974. Idi Amin had come to power in Uganda in 1971 as the result of a military coup and his undemocratic and harsh rule was the subject of much criticism by the Church and others. After receiving a letter from the bishops protesting at the virtual institution of state murder, Janani and two of Amin's own government ministers were stated as having been found dead following a car accident. It emerged quickly that they had in fact died

on the implicit instructions of the President. Janani's enthusiasm for the good news of Jesus, combined with his willingness to sacrifice even his own life for what he believed in, led him to his martyrdom.

February 18

In Ireland, around 676, St. Colman, abbot and bishop. When the Synod of Whitby decided to follow Roman customs, Colman resigned as bishop of Lindisfarne and returned to Iona. From there he went to the island of Inishbofin, where he founded a monastery. He founded another community for his English followers on the mainland in County Mayo.

In Constantinople, in 806, St. Tarasius, patriarch, who in 787 presided over the Second Council of Nicaea, which restored the veneration of images and legislated some disciplinary matters. Tarasius was a humble person, who disliked pomp and urged his clergy to dress simply.

In 1455, in Florence, Blessed John of Fiesole, known as Fra Angelico. He was already a painter when he joined the Dominicans in 1420. He was ordained in 1429. At San Marco, in Florence, he learned iconography from Greek manuscripts deposited there by Cosmo de Medici. In his paintings at San Marco and elsewhere, he combined the religious fervour of the Middle Ages with the Renaissance love of beauty and nature.

John of Fiesole (Fra Angelico) and Andrei Rublev. John of Fiesole was born near the end of the fourteenth century in Tuscany. In 1407 he became a Dominican friar, taking the name John, and was ordained. After decorating the walls of the friary at Fiesole, his ministry became one of visual preaching through his great skills as a painter of human figures. He was nicknamed Fra Angelico (Brother Angel) because of the beauty of the faces, human and angelic, that he painted. He died at Rome in 1455. Andrei Rublev was born in Russia, probably in the 1360s, and was a monk at the monastery of Saint Sergius. He became a painter of frescoes and icons, and his name is associated with the painting of several great churches in the region around Moscow. He developed a new style, infusing his work with a gentleness and harmony at one with his spirituality, a style hugely influential in the Russian Church. He died around the year 1430 and was canonised by the Russian Orthodox Church in 1988. In honouring them, the Church in Wales remembers today all those whose ministry is exercised through their creativity and artistic skills.

February 19

In 439, Quodvultdeus, bishop of Carthage. He was exiled by the Vandals to Naples, where he died soon afterwards.

At Salisbury, in 1837, Thomas Burgess, bishop. Thomas Burgess was born at Odiham in Hampshire in 1756. Ordained in 1784, he became a prebendary of Durham Cathedral ten years later. After his appointment as Bishop of St Davids in 1803, he began to reform his diocese, concentrating on improving the education and preparation for ministry of the clergy. His efforts culminated in the foundation of St David's College, Lampeter, in 1822. Although he never fully mastered the Welsh language, he encouraged the work of the literary and cultural movement led by 'yr hen bersoniaid llengar' ('the old literary parsons'), who were busy rescuing and reviving the Eisteddfod. Burgess was translated to Salisbury in 1825 and died there in the year 1837. Rowland Williams described him as 'the best English prelate the Principality ever saw'.

February 20

In 743, at Saint-Trond, near Maastricht, St. Eucherius, bishop. He was a monk at the abbey of Jumièges in Normandy. He was chosen bishop of Orleans, but when he opposed Charles Martel's confiscation of church property, he was exiled to Cologne, then to a fortress near Liège. Finally he was allowed to retire to the monastery at Saint-Trond.

martyrology

In 1154, St. Wulfric of Haselbury, a parish priest who became an anchorite. He achieved a reputation for insight and healing, and Kings Henry I and Stephen visited him. He was supported by the Cluniac monks of Montacute, and his life was written by John, abbot of the Cistercian monastery of Forde.

[In Scotland: Today we remember all those who have witnessed to the good news of Jesus Christ throughout Africa. History records many martyrs and other saints from Africa. Amongst them we number: the early saints and martyrs of North Africa such as Perpetua and her companions, Augustine of Hippo, and Monica his mother; the great missionaries of the nineteenth century in Central and Southern Africa, including James Hannington and Mary Slessor, and martyrs like Charles Mackenzie, Bernard Mizeki, and Charles Lwanga and his companions in Uganda; and twentieth-century heroes such as Charles de Foucauld and Janani Luwum and other great figures in our own time. We think of these people, together with all those who have proclaimed the Gospel in Africa, and who continue to proclaim it by word and deed]

At Washington DC, in 1895, Frederick Douglass. Born as a slave in 1818, Frederick Douglass in 1838, Frederick Bailey (as he was then known) escaped and changed his name to Frederick Douglass. At the age of 14, he had experienced a conversion to Christ in the African Methodist Episcopal Church, and his recollection of that tradition's spiritual music sustained him in his struggle for freedom: "Those songs still follow me, to deepen my hatred of slavery, and quicken my sympathies for my brethren in bonds." An outstanding orator, Douglass was sent on speaking tours in the Northern States by the American Anti-Slavery Society. Douglass was highly critical of churches that did not disassociate themselves from slavery.

February 21

In 1072, at Faenza, St. Peter Damian, monk, bishop and doctor of the church. He was born into a poor family in Ravenna. His brother, a priest, provided for his education, and Peter became a professor. In 1035, he joined the community of hermits founded by St. Romuald at Fonte Avellana. Throughout his life he was devoted to the solitary life and the reform of the clergy. His monastery became the centre of a congregation. He supported Pope Leo IX, who established the College of Cardinals. Leo made him a cardinal and he served the church on various missions. He put the eremitical movement on a firm theological basis, and he influenced the growth of the Camaldolese Order.

At Tyburn, in 1595, the martyrdom of St. Robert Southwell, Jesuit priest. After being educated at Douai, he joined the Jesuits in Rome. Sent to England, he attended a strategy meeting of Catholics which was also attended by the composer William Byrd. From that meeting he developed a pamphlet called Mary Magdalene's Funeral Tears. He then became chaplain to the Countess of Arundel and while in her mansion wrote An Epistle of Comfort. He was captured and tortured, imprisoned for three years, and finally hanged, drawn and quartered. By then Robert Southwell was a famous poet. His brutal execution created a revulsion against such barbarous treatment of Catholics.

In Portugal, the three holy children of Fatima. In 1917, an angel appeared to them; then the Blessed Virgin appeared and asked them to say the rosary for the conversion of sinners. Two of them died shortly afterward in a flu epidemic. The third, Lucia, became a nun. She conveyed a request that the world be dedicated to the Immaculate Heart of Mary, which several popes subsequently did.

February 22

In Rome, the feast of St. Peter's Chair, which commemorates St. Peter's years as bishop of Rome. Romans visited the graves of their dead on this day, and the origins of the feast are connected with veneration of a memorial monument to Peter.

In the second century, St. Papias, bishop of Hierapolis. Fragments of his book, The Sayings of the Lord Explained are preserved in the writings of St. Irenaeus. It is said that he listened to the teaching of Christians who had been disciples of the apostles. He says that Mark wrote down the teachings of Peter in his Gospel,

and that Matthew recorded Jesus' sayings in Aramaic. He opposed the teachings of Marcion, who rejected the Old Testament.

In 1297, St. Margaret of Cortona. After becoming the mistress of a young nobleman when she was about twelve years old, she underwent a deep conversion at the age of twenty-one when her lover was murdered. Some Franciscans took her under their wing, and she supported herself and her son by nursing. Eventually she became a member of the Franciscan Third Order of Penitents.

At Weihsien Internment Camp, China, in 1945 Eric Liddell. Missionary. Eric Henry Liddell achieved international renown as an Olympic gold medalist, as an avid rugby player, and as a person totally devoted to his faith in Jesus Christ. Born in 1902 in China, the second son of missionary parents. His best event as a university athlete was the 100 meter and he was highly favoured to win gold in the Paris Olympics of 1924. Liddell, however, chose not to run the 100 metre because the heat was to be held on Sunday. The film, *Chariots of Fire*, is his story. After his graduation from Edinburgh, Liddell returned to North China and served as a missionary from 1925. In 1943, Liddell was interned in the Japanese concentration camp at Weihsein. Having won the respect of his captors, Liddell is remembered by camp survivors for his ministry among them. He died in 1945 shortly before the camp's liberation.

February 23

Around 155, at Smyrna, the martyrdom of St. Polycarp, bishop. According to an account of his martyrdom sent by his community to another town, a mob, having killed a young man named Germanicus, demanded the arrest of Polycarp. When he refused to deny Christ, he was put to death by the sword and his body burned in the town theatre. Earlier, Ignatius of Antioch, on the way to his own martyrdom, wrote to Polycarp asking him to take care of his church. Irenaeus had met Polycarp and praised his zeal for orthodoxy. He also tells of a trip that Polycarp made to Rome to settle the date for Easter.

At Much Wenlock, about 715 AD, St. Milburga, abbess. The monastery of which she was the second abbess was destroyed by the Danes, but refounded by Cluniac monks in 1079. Her gravesite was rediscovered with the help of St. Anselm.

February 24

In England, in 616, St. Ethelbert, King of Kent. He was married to Bertha, a Christian princess from Paris. He was converted by Augustine. He gave Augustine land at Canterbury for a cathedral and monastery, and helped spread the faith to other parts of England.

At the priory of Orsan, in 1116 or 1117, Blessed Robert of Arbrissel, abbot. Robert was born of a poor but very religious family in Brittany. He was educated in Paris, served as a vicar to the bishop of Rennes, then taught at Angers. He retired as a hermit in the forest of Craon in Anjou, where he came into contact with his fellow reformers, Bernard of Tiron and Vitalis of Savigny. His followers were housed in a double monastery that he started at Fontevrault. The nuns lived a life of prayer, following the Rule of St. Benedict. The lay brothers and priests followed the Rule of Augustine. From this developed a religious order with several thousand members.

February 25

At Heidenheim, in 779, St. Walburga, abbess. She was a nun at the double monastery of Wimborne. St. Boniface, her uncle, invited her and her brothers to join him as monk-missionaries in Germany. She spent two years at Tauberbischofsheim under St. Lioba, then joined her brother Winnibald as superior at the monastery of Heidenheim. Boniface appointed their brother Willibald first bishop of Eichstätt, where both he and Walburga were eventually interred.

At Engelberg, around 1131, the death of St. Adelhelm, who was the leader of the founding monks who came there from the monastery of Muri. He became the first abbot of Engelberg.

February 26

In Gaza, in 421, St. Porphyry, bishop. Porphyry left his native Thessalonika to become a monk in the Egyptian desert monastery of Skete. Then he spent time as a hermit along the Jordan River. He became crippled, so he went to Jerusalem. When his friend Mark sold off Porphyry's estates and brought him the money to distribute to the poor, Porphyry was healed. He was ordained a priest, and was then pressured to become bishop of Gaza. During his years as bishop, he struggled against stubborn pagans and was renowned for his generosity to the poor.

February 27

In Alexandria, around 250, during the persecution of Decius, the martyrdom of St. Julian and companions. St. Julian was arrested, but was so feeble he had to be carried to his trial. When he would not renounce his faith, he was beaten, mocked, and burned in a pit of quicklime.

At Bemerton, in Wiltshire in 1633, George Herbert, priest. Born in 1593 into the aristocratic Pembroke family, George Herbert went up to Cambridge in 1614, eventually becoming a fellow of Trinity College. At the age of twenty-five, he became Public Orator in the University and then a Member of Parliament, apparently destined for a life at court. To everyone's surprise, he decided to be ordained and, after spending a time with his friend Nicholas Ferrar at Little Gidding, he was made deacon in 1626. He married in 1629, was priested in 1630 and given the care of souls of the parish of Bemerton, near Salisbury, where he spent the rest of his short life. He wrote prolifically, his hymns still being popular. His treatise, *The Country Parson*, on the priestly life, and his poetry, especially *The Temple*, earned Herbert a leading place in English literature.

February 28

At Worcester, in 992, St. Oswald, bishop. Oswald was of Danish descent. He was a canon of Winchester before becoming a monk at Fleury-sur-Loire. At the recommendation of St. Dunstan, he was appointed bishop of Worcester. He founded a Benedictine monastery at Westbury-on-Trym and turned his cathedral chapter over to monks. Later he built the abbey of Ramsey, which in turn founded the abbeys of Pershore and Evesham. He made Ramsey a center of learning. He was appointed archbishop of York. With Dunstan and Ethelwold, he spearheaded a great ecclesiastical and monastic revival in England in the last half of the tenth century.

In Switzerland, in 1602, the foundation of the Swiss Congregation of the Order of St. Benedict.

March

March 1

Around 589, St. David, bishop, patron of Wales. According to the life of St. David written around 1090, he was ordained a priest and studied for several years with the Welsh St. Paulinus. David founded twelve monasteries, and finally settled at Menevia. The community there lived a very austere life, modeled on that of the Desert Fathers. His last words are supposed to have been, "Be joyful, brothers and sisters. Keep the faith and do the little things you have heard and seen me do."

In Ireland in the sixth century, St. Senan, abbot, who founded several monasteries, most notably on Scattery Island in the estuary of the Shannon.

March 2

In England, in 672, St. Chad. St. Chad was a disciple of St. Aidan. He and three of his brothers became priests. He studied in Ireland, and succeeded his brother Cedd as abbot of Lichfield. He was for a time bishop of York and then of Mercia. His relics are preserved in St. Chad's Cathedral in Birmingham.

At London, in 1791, John Wesley, priest. Remembered in the Church of England on May 24th.

March 3

In 1955, in Philadelphia, Blessed Catherine Drexel. She was born in Philadelphia in 1858 in an affluent family which was very concerned about the poor. An heiress at a young age, she was alerted to the plight of the American Indians by Bishop Martin Marty. She discussed the matter with Pope Leo XIII and visited the missions in the Dakotas, where she met Chief Red Cloud, who admired her. She founded the Order of the Blessed Sacrament to minister to people of color. In 1915 she established Xavier University in New Orleans. She spent the last twenty years of her life in prayerful retirement.

In 1039, at the monastery of Kaufungen, St. Kunegunde, wife of St. Henry II. At her urging, Henry founded the monastery and cathedral of Bamberg and the monastery of Kaufungen, to which she retired after his death. There she spent fifteen years in prayer and service as an ordinary nun. She now shares a joint feast day with St. Henry on July 13.

March 4

In the ninth century, Adrian of May Island, abbot, and his companions, martyrs. Adrian, who according to tradition was of Hungarian descent, settled with many companions in Fife to evangelise the Picts. During the Viking raids he is said to have softened the raiders' fury and to have converted some. A fierce raid in 875 obliged him to retire with his companions to the island of May in the Firth of Forth. There they were killed by the Danes. The island, with a monastery founded by King David I, became an important centre of pilgrimage.

In 1488, in Lithuania, St. Casimir. He was the third child of Casimir IV, king of Poland. As a young man he was very prayerful and active on behalf of the poor. He refused to marry, and at the age of 24 he died of tuberculosis. He is buried in Vilnius. He is the patron saint of Poland and Lithuania.

In 1123, St. Peter of Cava, abbot and bishop. He was a native of Salerno and nephew of St. Alferius, founder and first abbot of Cava. Peter went to Cluny and stayed there for some years. At the urging of Hildebrand (later Pope Gregory VII), Abbot Hugh of Cluny sent Peter back to Cava, and for a short while he was bishop of Policastro. He was elected abbot and the monastery grew rapidly. The monastery was suppressed in 1861 by the government, but re-opened.

March 5

In 475, the death of St. Gerasimus, hermit. Born in Asia Minor, he became a hermit in the desert along the Jordan River. Around him a laura or monastic colony of seventy hermits grew up, and he established a monastery for aspirants as well.

In the sixth century, St. Non. According to Rhigyfarch's Life of Saint David, Non (whom he assumes was a nun) was raped by Sant, King of Ceredigion. She gave birth to a son: Dewi Sant or Saint David. The Welsh version of her story says that he was her only child, but Irish tradition also makes her the mother of two daughters, Mor and Magna. She is said to have moved to Brittany where her cult is centred on Dirinon. Her tomb can be seen there and her life was the subject of a Breton mystery play performed at Dirinon in her honour. In Brittany her protection during childbirth has long been invoked by pregnant women. Non's holy well and the ruins of her chapel are just outside St Davids. She is also connected with Llannon (Ceredigion), Llannon (Carmarthenshire), and traditionally with Altarnon in Cornwall.

In 545, Kieran of Seirkeiran, bishop and monk. Kieran or Ciaran was both bishop and monk. Born in west Cork, but from an Ossory family, he appears to have travelled to Europe where he was ordained. On his return to Ireland, he settled at Seir (Saighir) near Birr, first as a hermit and then as abbot of a large monastery there. He also had a hermitage on the island of Cape Clear, off west Cork. Fascinating tales of his life surrounded by the animals of his neighbouring woods have often been re-told.

March 6

In 608, St. Baldred, bishop. Baldred, thought to have been a devoted disciple of Kentigern, whom he may have succeeded as Bishop of Glasgow, lived as a hermit on the Bass Rock, off the coast of East Lothian. However, he engaged in missionary work on the mainland and became known as the apostle of East Lothian. He died on this day in the year 608.

In Toledo, in 690, St. Julian, archbishop. He lived as a hermit for a while, then became a priest. He was appointed archbishop in 680. He was a prudent, prayerful and kindly man. He was a prolific writer, who wrote especially about eschatology.

In 766, at Metz, St. Chrodegang, bishop. Educated at the abbey of St. Trond, he entered the service of Charles Martel, and then was appointed bishop of Metz. Using the Rule of St. Benedict as a model, he wrote a rule for his clergy, which had great influence. It required the clergy to live in communities. He founded the abbey of Gorze.

In 1280, St. Agnes of Prague, abbess. The daughter of the king of Bohemia, she founded the first house of Poor Clares north of the Alps, joined it, and later became abbess. She was the recipient of some beautiful letters from St. Clare of Assisi.

At Weisbaden, West Germany, in 1984, Martin Niemoeller, pastor. A highly decorated U-boat commander in the first world war, Niemoeller initially supported the National Socialists. He later repented of this and was imprisoned for the duration of the second world war. He is the author of the famous prayer "when the Nazis came for the Communists, I was silent, because I was not a Communist ...".

March 7

In Carthage, in 203, the martyrdom of Sts. Perpetua and Felicity and their companions. Arrested while catechumens, Perpetua, Felicity and three male companions were martyred in the arena. The account of their arrest and martyrdom, part of it the work of Perpetua herself, is an important Christian document.

In 976, at Gorze, John, abbot. He inherited a wealthy estate, but was attracted to religious life. In 933, he and a companion were sent to revitalise the abbey of Gorze. John was made prior. After heading a delegation to the caliph of Cordova, he was elected abbot in 960. He imposed austere reforms which were adopted by other monasteries in the area around Gorze.

March 8

At Dunwich in 647 Felix, bishop, apostle to the East Angles. Born in Burgundy at the beginning of the seventh century, Felix reputedly converted the exiled King Sigebert of the East Angles and, after the King's return to Britain, was consecrated bishop and then persuaded by the King to follow him to effect the conversion of his subjects. He was commissioned by Honorius, Archbishop of Canterbury, to this work and made Dunwich the centre of his new See. He established schools and monasteries and ministered in his diocese for seventeen years.

In 1068, St Duthac, bishop. Duthac was born in Scotland, studied in Ireland, and on his return to Scotland became Bishop of Ross in the eleventh century. He was renowned for his missionary zeal, his compassion, his ready espousal of poverty and the austerity of his life. He was described as the 'saint reckoned to be the most venerated in the land of Ross'. His relics, kept at Tain, were an object of pilgrimage throughout the Middle Ages.

In 1159, St. Stephen of Obazine. He became a priest, and then with a fellow priest went to live as a hermit in the forest of Obazine, not far from Tulle in the Auvergne. A community grew up around them. Near it a house for women was established. The community adopted the Rule of St. Benedict in 1142. In 1147 Obazine and its foundations were accepted into the Cistercian Order.

At Lincoln in 1910, Edward King, bishop. Born in London in 1829, Edward King, both as a priest and then as a bishop, was revered for the holiness of his life and the wisdom of his counsel. He was chaplain, then principal, of Cuddesdon Theological College, followed by a dozen years as a professor of theology in [Oxford](#), during which time he exercised a great influence on a generation of ordinands. In 1885, he was consecrated bishop of the diocese of Lincoln, a position he held until his death. His advocacy of Catholic principles in ritual as well as theology involved him in controversy, but his significant gift to the Church was his example as a pastoral and caring bishop to both clergy and laity.

At Liverpool, in 1929, Geoffrey Studdert Kennedy, priest and poet. Born in 1883, Studdert Kennedy was a young vicar in Worcester who became an army chaplain during the First World War. His warm personality soon earned the respect of soldiers, who nicknamed him 'Woodbine Willie' after the brand of cigarettes he shared with them. After the First World War, he became a writer and regular preacher, drawing large crowds, who were attracted by his combination of traditional sacramental theology with more unconventional theological views. He worked tirelessly for the Christian Industrial Fellowship, but his frail health gave way and he died still a young man.

March 9

In Rome, in 1440, St. Frances, patron of Benedictine oblates. She was educated and guided by an Olivetan monk who was serving at the church of Santa Maria Nuova. Although she wished to become a nun, she was married to a wealthy husband and had three children. She and her sister-in-law strove to be good mothers and spent time praying and visiting the sick. She gathered around her a group of like-minded women, called the "oblates of Tor de Specchi", who became a religious community. She joined them after her husband died.

In the convent of Corpus Domini, in Bologna, in 1463, St. Catherine de Vigri. She joined a group of Augustinian canonesses in Ferrera, and later went with some of them to the Poor Clares. She was sent as superior of a new foundation in Bologna. She wrote a number of books and was a painter of note, as well as

the recipient of supernatural visions. Her body remains incorrupt, and is preserved in the chapel of her convent in Bologna to this day.

In 1857, in Mondonio, St. Dominic Savio. He was mentored by Don Bosco, who wrote that Dominic had extraordinary knowledge of people and future events. Dominic was a leader among his peers and graced with mystical experiences. He died at the age of fifteen.

March 10

In about 700, St Kessog, bishop and martyr. The memory of many of the missionaries who brought the Christian faith to Scotland during the so-called Dark Ages is preserved mainly in the dedications of churches in their honour. The name of Kessog (or Mackessock) is thus preserved as a missionary bishop who laboured in the lands of Lennox among the Picts towards the end of the seventh century. He lived in a cell on Monk's Island, Loch Lomond. According to tradition, he was born of Irish royal descent in Cashel, capital of Munster, and is said to have been martyred near Luss on Loch Lomondside around the year 700.

At Rome, in 483, Pope St. Simplicius. He shepherded the church through a time of political upheaval, built the basilicas of San Stefano Rotondo and Santa Balbina, and sought to alleviate the suffering of the poor. He struggled against the Monophysites, who maintained that Christ had a single nature.

March 11

In 639, St. Sophronius, Patriarch of Jerusalem. He was born in Damascus and traveled widely in his youth. He decided to become a monk. At the monastery of St. Theodosius in Judea, he became friends with John Moschus. The upheavals of the time took them to Egypt, where John Moschus compiled information about the Egyptian monks. They were in the service of the archbishop of Alexandria, John the Almoner, when he fled to Cyprus ahead of the invading Persians. Sophronius was a strong supporter of the Christology of Chalcedon and opposed the Monothelites, who held that Christ possessed no human will. Sophronius was still alive when the Saracens conquered Jerusalem. A number of his writings survive.

In Cordoba, between 822 and 859, St. Eulogius and the martyrs of Cordoba. By 711 the Muslims had overrun almost all of Spain, and gradually the vibrant Christian culture that had developed there was submerged under a prosperous Moorish civilisation. Eulogius was tutored by Abbot Esperaindeo, a learned Christian scholar. Eulogius urged his fellow Christians to resist enculturation into the Muslim world, and this led to martyrdom for many of them. He himself was beheaded.

March 12

Around 250, at Smyrna, St. Pionius, martyr. Pionius, who revered the memory of St. Polycarp, was a learned teacher. He was arrested with Sabina, a slave who had been ill-treated because of her Christian faith, and Asclepiades. The three refused to offer incense to the gods. Pionius was then burned at the stake in the stadium. His last words were "Lord, receive my spirit."

In 817, on the island of Samothrace, St. Theophanes the Chronicler, abbot. Theophanes was the son of very wealthy parents. He was pressured to marry when he was young, but he and his new wife distributed their property and became monks. Theophanes was called to the Second Council of Nicaea where he supported the veneration of images. He wrote a very important historical chronicle for the years 281-813 AD. When he refused to support Leo the Armenian's iconoclastic policies, Theophanes was scourged, imprisoned for two years, and finally banished to Samothrace, where he died after seven days.

In 1022, St. Simeon, the New Theologian, abbot. Reared in Constantinople, he was motivated to change his way of life after reading the lives of the saints. He was trained at the monastery of Studium. He had intense mystical experiences of God. He became abbot of the monastery of Saint Mamas, and his Catecheses to his

monks is a spiritual classic. His demanding spiritual teachings became controversial and he was sent into exile, where he continued to write hymns and works in defence of his spiritual teachings. He died in exile in great peace of heart.

March 13

About 600, St. Leander, bishop of Seville. He spent three years as a monk before being made bishop of Seville around 578. After a mission to Constantinople, he introduced the creed to the Mass to help reinforce the Catholic faith against the Arians. Gregory the Great corresponded with him. Leander wrote a monastic rule. He is honoured as a doctor of the church.

March 14

At Quedlinberg, in 968, St. Matilda. Daughter of a Westphalian count, she was happily married to Henry the Fowler, who became successively Duke of Saxony and German emperor. When he died, she devoted herself to prayer and charitable works, the generosity of which caused friction with her two quarrelling sons, Otto the Great and Henry the Wrangler.

At Rocca di Papa, Italy, in 2008, Chiara Lubich, founder of the Focolare movement. A tertiary Franciscan, Lubich discovered her vocation during the second world war while caring for the victims of the war in her home town of Trent. She conceived of a moment animated by love and named it Focolare or 'hearth'. Focolare fostered the spirit of Vatican 2 with an emphasis on Scripture, liturgical renewal and ecumenism.

March 15

At Rome, in 752, St. Zachary, pope. The last of a line of Greek popes, he supported St. Boniface's missionary efforts in Germany and the claims of Pepin to sovereignty over the Franks. He tried to find a peaceful diplomatic path in the conflicts between the Lombards and the Byzantines on the Italian peninsula. He translated the Dialogues of Gregory the Great into Greek and consecrated the church at Monte Cassino.

In France, in 1660, St. Louise de Marillac. The illegitimate daughter of a lesser nobleman, she was educated at the Dominican convent of Poissy, then was entrusted to the care of a poor spinster who took in orphan girls. Her family arranged her marriage to a secretary of the queen. She was an excellent wife and mother. When her husband became ill, she went through a time of deep spiritual crisis. After his death she associated herself with the work of St. Vincent de Paul, flourished, and went on to found the Sisters of Charity.

March 16

In the eighth century, St. Boniface of Ross, bishop. The name of Cuiritan, or Boniface, is linked with two important Christian sites in Scotland: Restenneth in Angus, where he baptised the Pictish king Nechtan in 710, and founded a monastery; and Rosemarkie on the Black Isle, where in 716 he re-founded a monastery at a place originally associated with Saint Moluag. He is said to have come from Italy, even perhaps from Rome. He was certainly of the Roman, rather than the Celtic, tradition – all his foundations were dedicated to Saint Peter – so Nechtan's Christianity sought its inspiration from the south rather than from the Celtic West. He was famous for founding churches.

In Canada, in 1649, St. John de Brébeuf and companions, martyrs. John and a group of companions went to Quebec as missionaries in 1625, shortly after its founding. He ministered for some years in great hardship among the Algonquins and the Hurons. When the Iroquois waged all-out war on the Hurons, John de Brébeuf and his companions were captured, brutally tortured and killed. Brébeuf endured it all quietly.

In 680, at the Abbey of Hamage, in France, St. Eusebia, daughter of St. Adalbald and St. Rictrudis. She was sent as a child to Hamage, where her great-grandmother St. Gertrude was abbess. She was elected abbess when she was twelve, but her mother thought she was too young, so her mother merged Hamage with the

monastery of Marchiennes, of which she was abbess. Later, the community moved to Hamage and Eusebia led it wisely.

March 17

In Ireland, in the fifth century, the death of St. Patrick, patron of Ireland. Captured in England by Irish pirates when he was a boy, he escaped back to England years later. As the result of a vision, he returned to Ireland as a missionary. He seems to have worked mainly in the north of the island. Two of his writings survive: the Letter to Coroticus and the Confessio; they reveal his humility and his zealous concern for his people.

The commemoration of Joseph of Arimathea, who buried Christ's body in his own tomb.

At Nivelles, in 659, St. Gertrude, abbess. When her father died in 640, she and her mother, Itta, retired to Nivelles to found a double monastery. Gertrude succeeded her mother as abbess. As she neared death, she sent word to St. Ultan, an Irish monk who had settled nearby at Fosse. He told her to have no fear because she would be welcomed to heaven by angels and St. Patrick on his feast. She has been revered as a patron of travellers, of the dying, and also is invoked to protect fields and gardens against mice.

March 18

In Jerusalem, in 386, St. Cyril, bishop and doctor. As a priest, he delivered Catechetical Instructions, 24 of which have survived. Intended for catechumens and the newly baptised, they are an invaluable witness to the teaching and liturgy of the church in the middle of the fourth century. He was bishop of Jerusalem for 35 years, 16 of which were spent in exile.

In 651, St. Braulio, bishop. A student and friend of St. Isidore, he succeeded his own brother John as bishop of Zaragoza. He was a skilled preacher and writer. He hated luxury and was very generous to the poor. His relics were transferred to the church of Our Lady of the Pillar in 1275.

In England, in 979, St. Edward, martyr. The son of King Edgar, Edward was baptised by Dunstan. He became king in a disputed election. His ties with Dunstan and the monastic movement as well as his violent temper alienated many of the nobility, and he was assassinated.

March 19

The solemnity of St. Joseph, husband of the Virgin Mary, a just man of David's lineage, who was the foster-father of the son of God, Christ Jesus, who chose to be called the son of Joseph and to be subject to him as a son to his father. He is venerated with special honour as patron of the church, because the Lord set him over his family. The feast was extended to the universal church after the Council of Trent.

In 797, twenty martyrs of the monastery of Mar Saba, executed by marauding bands.

March 20

On Farne Island in 687, St. Cuthbert, monk and bishop. When he was a young man, he joined the monastery of Melrose, a daughter-house of St. Aidan's foundation at Lindisfarne. From there he was sent to the new foundation at Ripon, where he was a genial guest master. He then served successively as prior of Melrose and Lindisfarne. There he and abbot Eata introduced the Rule of Benedict. After twelve years he retired as a hermit to Lindisfarne and then Farne. Later he served two years as bishop of Lindisfarne before returning to his solitary life. His remains are buried in the Anglican cathedral of Durham, which for more than four centuries was a Benedictine monastery.

In Braga, in Portugal, in 579, St. Martin, bishop. As a young man he went on a pilgrimage to Palestine and there became a monk. In Galicia, he founded monasteries and worked to convert the pagan Suevi. He wrote theological and spiritual works, including several collections of the Desert Fathers and a collection of canonical decrees.

In 1393, at Prague, the martyrdom of St. John Nepomucene. He was ordained a priest and became vicar general of the archbishop of Prague. He incurred the enmity of King Wencelaus IV because he would not reveal what the queen had told him in confession and because he opposed the king's effort to confiscate a Benedictine abbey and turn it into a cathedral. Wenceslaus had him tortured, murdered and thrown into the Moldau River. He is patron of Bohemia.

March 21

In about 530, at Euda in Ireland, St. Enda. Famous for his wild life and military feats he was converted to Christianity by St. Faencha. Ordained at Rome after spending sometime at the monastery of Whithorn, Galloway he returned to Ireland and founded his own monastery in the Boyne Valley before being given one of the Aran Isles where he founded the abbey of Inishmore. Among his disciples was Brendan the Navigator. Buried at Inishmore he and St. Finnian of Clonard are considered the founders of Irish monasticism.

At Monte Cassino, the death of St. Benedict, abbot and patron of Europe. The first mention of a feast of St. Benedict on this day is in the martyrology of St. Bede the Venerable, written around 730. There are several explanations why Bede chose this date. He may have derived it from St. Benet Biscop, the founder of Bede's monastery at Jarrow, who had visited Monte Cassino. Alternatively, Bede may have chosen this day because it was the vernal equinox, and the date was later adopted at Monte Cassino.

At Oxford in 1556, Thomas Cranmer, bishop and martyr. Born in Aslockton in Nottinghamshire in 1489, Thomas Cranmer, from an unspectacular Cambridge academic career, was recruited for diplomatic service in 1527. Two years later he joined the team working to annul Henry VIII's marriage to Catherine of Aragon. He was made Archbishop of Canterbury in 1533 and duly pronounced the Aragon marriage annulled. By now a convinced Church reformer, he married in 1532 while clerical marriage was still illegal in England. He worked closely with Thomas Cromwell to further reformation, but survived Henry's final, unpredictable years to become a chief architect of Edwardian religious change. Cranmer acquiesced in the unsuccessful attempt to make Lady Jane Grey Queen of England. Queen Mary's regime convicted him of treason in 1553 and of heresy in 1554. Demoralised by imprisonment, he signed six recantations, but was still condemned to the stake at Oxford. Struggling with his conscience, he made a final, bold statement of Protestant faith. He was burnt at the stake on this day in the year 1556.

OR:

In the sixteenth century, Thomas Cranmer, Hugh Latimer, Nicholas Ridley and Robert Ferrar, bishops and martyrs. Robert Ferrar was born around the year 1500 in Halifax in Yorkshire. An Augustinian Canon, he was Prior of Nostell, near Pontefract, and surrendered it peacefully at the Dissolution of the Monasteries. He subsequently married, and was perhaps chaplain to Thomas Cranmer, and later to the Duke of Somerset. On the accession of Edward VI, Somerset became Protector, and in 1548 Ferrar was made Bishop of St. Davids. He worked to further the reform of the Church in Wales, but was obstructed by his cathedral chapter, and after the fall of Somerset, was imprisoned. When Mary I acceded to the throne, he was deprived of his see, condemned as a heretic, and burned at Carmarthen on 30 March 1555, one of only three burnings to take place in Wales under Queen Mary. He remarked that if he were seen to stir from the pain of burning, then the doctrines for which he died need not be believed; but he stood in the flames holding out his hands till they were burned to stumps, and he was then struck on the head, ending his suffering.

March 22

At Racine, Wisconsin, in 1879 James De Koven, priest. De Koven was born in Middletown, Connecticut, in 1831, ordained by Bishop Kemper in 1855, and appointed professor of ecclesiastical history at Nashotah House. De Koven came to national attention at the General Conventions of 1871 and 1874, when the controversy over “ritualism” was at its height. In 1871, he asserted that the use of candles on the Altar, incense, and genuflections were lawful, because they symbolised “the real, spiritual presence of Christ” which the Episcopal Church upheld, along with the Orthodox and the Lutherans. To the General Convention of 1874, De Koven expressed the religious conviction that underlay his Churchmanship: “You may take away from us, if you will, every external ceremony; you may take away altars, and super-altars, lights and incense and vestments; ... and we will submit to you. But, gentlemen ... to adore Christ’s Person in his Sacrament—that is the inalienable privilege of every Christian and Catholic heart. How we do it, the way we do it, the ceremonies with which we do it, are utterly, utterly, indifferent. The thing itself is what we plead for.”

March 23

On the Farne Islands in 699 St Ethilwald. A monk and priest at Ripon he ended his life as a hermit in St Cuthbert’s old hermitage.

In Cornwall in the sixth century St Gwinear a Welsh monk and companion of Saint Meriasek. One story tells of him striking the ground three times with his staff and three springs miraculously appearing for him, his horse and his dog. He is reputed to have been martyred in Cornwall by King Theodoric.

At Santa Clara in Peru, in 1606, St. Turibius of Mogrovejo, bishop. He studied canon and civil law and became a jurist. When there was need for a new archbishop of Lima, he was chosen, although he was not in orders. He proved to be a bishop of the stature of St. Charles Borromeo: conscientious, diplomatic and totally dedicated. He arrived in Lima in 1581. He learned the Quechua language and required all parish priests to learn it. He traveled on pastoral visitations throughout his large and mountainous diocese, and baptised and confirmed countless people including St. Rose of Lima and St. Martin de Porres. He is the patron of Peru.

In 1701, at Barcelona, St. Joseph Oriol. Although born of a poor family, he gained a doctorate in theology and was ordained in 1676. To help support his widowed mother, he took a job as a tutor in a wealthy household. After his mother died, he became pastor of a church in Barcelona. He lived very simply in a small rented room. He spent almost no money on himself, spoke little and almost exclusively of spiritual matters. He had great personal magnetism and gifts for hearing confessions and for healing physical ills.

In Lebanon, in 1914, St. Rebecca Al-Rayes. When she was 21 she joined a teaching order called the Mariamette Sisters. When it was dissolved, she entered the monastery of St. Se’man El Qarn. She became blind, and later paralysed, perhaps from bone cancer, and suffered greatly but cheerfully.

March 24

In 505, St Macartan, bishop. Tradition names Macartan as the ‘strong man’ of Saint Patrick, who established the Church in Clogher and spread the Gospel in Tyrone and Fermanagh. An eighth-century manuscript of the gospels, associated with a silver shrine, Domnach Airgid, in the Royal Irish Academy, is linked with the early Tradition names Macartan as the ‘strong man’ of Saint Patrick, who established the Church in Clogher and spread the Gospel in Tyrone and Fermanagh. An eighth-century manuscript of the gospels, associated with a silver shrine, Domnach Airgid, in the Royal Irish Academy, is linked with the early

At Vadestna, Sweden, in 1381, St. Catherine, abbess. She was the fourth of the eight children of St. Bridget of Sweden. She was raised in several convents. She entered into an arranged marriage, but she and her husband lived a quasi-monastic life as brother and sister. After her husband died, Bridget founded a monastery at Vadstena, and then moved to Rome in 1349, and Catherine joined her there the following year. The two of them prayed and urged the pope to return to Rome from Avignon. When her mother died, Catherine spent the rest of her life as abbess of the monastery of Vadstena. She promoted her mother’s canonisation.

About 712, in England at the abbey of Barking, St. Hildelith, abbess. She succeeded St. Ethelburga as second abbess of the community. She was a dynamic leader. St. Aldhelm wrote a treatise on virginity for the community, and St. Boniface esteemed her greatly.

At Thurgarton in Nottinghamshire in 1396, Walter Hilton, mystic. Born in 1343, Walter Hilton studied Canon Law at Cambridge but after a period as a hermit, he joined the community of Augustinian Canons at Thurgarton in Nottinghamshire in about 1386. Highly regarded in his lifetime as a spiritual guide, he wrote in both Latin and English and translated several Latin devotional works. Controversy with 'enthusiasts' and with the Lollard movement gave a sharper definition to his exposition of the aims, methods and disciplines of traditional spirituality. Amongst his major works, Ladder of Perfection declares that contemplation, understood in a profoundly Trinitarian context as awareness of grace and sensitivity to the Spirit, may and should be sought by all serious Christians.

In 1953, Paul Couturier, priest, ecumenist. Born in 1881 in Lyons, France, Paul Couturier was destined from early years for the priesthood. His concern for Christian unity began as a result of his work with Russian refugees in Lyons, and was fostered through his profession at the Benedictine Priory of Amay in Belgium, a community devoted to the growth of understanding between Eastern and Western Churches. He commended the observance of a Week of Prayer for Unity and, in the 1930s, widened his contacts to incorporate people of the Anglican, Lutheran and Reformed traditions. Celebrating the eucharist each day brought into focus his whole life of work and prayer for unity within the Church. The growing circle of friends and followers became an 'invisible monastery', praying for 'the visible unity of the Kingdom of God, such as Christ willed and by means which he wills'.

At San Salvador in 1980, Oscar Romero, bishop. Oscar Arnulfo Romero y Galdamez was born in a small village in El Salvador in 1917. Ordained priest, he was known as a quiet and unassuming pastor. By 1977, amidst the political and social turmoil suffered by his country, he was therefore seen as a neutral choice to be its Archbishop. Courageously, however, he began to speak out against violence and his homilies supported the demands of the poor for economic and social justice. He refused to be silenced and continued to preach even under threat of assassination. Whilst presiding at Mass, Archbishop Romero was assassinated by a gunman.

March 25

The solemnity of the Annunciation, when, in the town of Nazareth, an angel of the Lord told Mary: "Behold you will conceive and bear a son, who will be called Son of the Most High." Mary answered: "Behold the handmaid of the Lord, be it done to me according to your word." And thus the fullness of time had arrived. For us and for our salvation, He who was the Only-Begotten Son of God from eternity was incarnate of the Holy Spirit from the Virgin Mary and became a human being.

At St Albans in the fifth century St. Ermelandus, Abbot.

At York, in 1586, St. Margaret Clitherow, martyr. She was married at the age of eighteen to a wealthy citizen. Three years later, Margaret became a Catholic. She secured a Catholic tutor, whom she may have met during one of her imprisonments for non-attendance at Protestant services. She was witty, good-looking, and good-hearted. She was arrested for sending her son abroad to be educated. She refused to stand trial, because she didn't want anyone to bear the responsibility of testifying against her. She was killed by being crushed to death.

March 26

At Sebaste, about 391, St. Peter, bishop. Peter was the son of St. Basil the Elder and St. Emmelia, and brother of St. Basil the Great, St. Gregory of Nyssa and of St. Macrina, who raised him. He joined the family

monastery and served as abbot of the men's community. He was appointed successor to Eustathius, bishop of Sebaste in 380.

At Billerbeck, in Germany, in 809, St. Ludger of Münster, bishop. Ludger was born in Frisia and spent much of his life doing missionary work there. He studied at Utrecht under Abbot Gregory, at York under Alcuin, and spent several years studying the monastic life at Monte Cassino. He was sent by Charlemagne to evangelise the Saxons, and established a clerical community under the Rule of Chrodegang at Münster.

At Folkestone in 1883, Harriet Monsell, religious, founder. Of Irish parentage, Harriet Monsell (née O'Brien) was born in 1811. After the death of her clergyman husband, she went to work in a penitentiary at Clewer near Windsor. Here, under the guidance of the local Vicar, T T Carter, she was professed as a Religious in 1852 and became the first Superior of the Community of St John the Baptist. Under her care, the community grew rapidly and undertook a range of social work in a variety of locations, with foundations in India and America by the 1880s. The sisters cared for orphans, ran schools and hospitals, and opened mission houses in parishes. In 1875 Mother Harriet retired as Superior through ill-health.

March 27

At Salzburg, about 718, St. Rupert, bishop. He did missionary work in what is today Austria, choosing the ruined Roman town of Juvavum as his headquarters and naming it Salzburg, after its salt mines. He built a church and a monastery dedicated to St. Peter, and the monastery of Nonnberg for women. The monasteries followed the Rule of St. Benedict, and Rupert was both abbot and bishop.

March 28

At Jerusalem, around 450, St. Hesychius, priest. He was a monk and served several bishops as a priest. Some sermons and biblical commentaries attributed to him survive.

In the seventeenth century, in Scotland, Patrick Forbes, bishop, and the Aberdeen Doctors. Patrick Forbes was Bishop of Aberdeen from 1618 to his death in 1635, a time of upheaval for the Church in Scotland. He was widely recognised as a man 'guid, godly and kynd'. His background was Presbyterian, but he applied himself diligently to his episcopal duties. He was also Chancellor of the University of Aberdeen and, through his work there, his name is associated with several colleagues: Robert Baron, first Professor of Theology in Marischal College; William Leslie, Principal of King's College; James Sibbald, Minister of St Nicholas, Aberdeen; Alexander Scroggie, Minister of Old Aberdeen; Alexander Ross, Minister of New Aberdeen; and John Forbes, second son of the bishop and Professor of Divinity in King's College. They encouraged sound learning and personal godliness, and in the partisan atmosphere of the time found a way to transcend the confessional limits of theological thinking and to work for harmony, tolerance and mutual understanding. They strenuously opposed the National Covenant which abolished episcopacy in Scotland. For refusing to subscribe to it, John Forbes was deprived of his chair in 1639, and went into exile.

March 29

In 326 or 327, in Persia, the martyrdom of Sts. Jonas and Barachisius, monks and martyrs. When they encouraged imprisoned Christians, they were themselves arrested. Jonas was flogged, kept out all night in the cold, thrown into a tub of burning pitch, and finally crushed. Barachisius was tortured with hot pitch, suspended during the night from one foot, impaled, crushed and then had burning pitch poured down his throat.

At London in 1788, Charles Wesley, priest. Remembered by the Church of England on 24th May with his brother John.

In the sixth century, St Woolos, king. Woolos or Gwynllyw was the son of Glywys, whose kingdom of Glywysing stretched from eastern Carmarthenshire to Gwent. His early military exploits led him to be known as Gwynllyw Filwr ('Gwynllyw the Warrior'). He married Gwladys, the daughter of Brychan Brycheiniog (having first abducted her, according to the earliest version of his life). Their son was Cadoc, one of the greatest of the Welsh saints. Woolos built a church on the site in Newport where the cathedral bearing his name now stands. Legend has it that he chose that particular place because he found a white ox with a black spot on its forehead there. Woolos and Gwladys are said to have settled in a nearby hill-fort, where they spent the rest of their days devoutly 'enjoying the fruits of their labour, and taking nothing which belonged to other persons'.

Around 1195, St. Berthold, founder of the Carmelite Order. Said to have been a Norman French crusader, he is reputed to have established a colony of hermits on Mount Carmel in 1185. He first appears in Carmelite literature in the fourteenth century. He is not observed in current Carmelite calendars.

At Bournemouth in 1866, John Keble, priest, remembered in the Church of England on July 14th. Born in 1792, the son of a priest, John Keble showed early brilliance as a scholar, becoming a Fellow of Oriel College, Oxford, at the age of nineteen, a few years before his ordination. He won great praise for his collection of poems, *The Christian Year*, issued in 1827, and was elected Professor of Poetry in Oxford in 1831. A leader of the Tractarian movement, which protested at the threats to the Church from liberal developments in both politics and theology, he nevertheless did not seek preferment and in 1836 became a parish priest near Winchester, a position he held until his death in 1866. He continued to write scholarly books and was praised for his character and spiritual counsel.

March 30

In the seventh century, in Egypt, St. John Climacus. He lived for many decades as a hermit, and in his old age he became abbot of the monastic community at Mt. Sinai. He had studied the writings of Evagrius of Pontus and used them in writing his *Ladder to Paradise*, a very influential book in Eastern monasticism. His treatise, *To the Shepherd*, emphasises humility and purity of heart.

In 1472, at Vercelli, Blessed Amadeus of Savoy. As a youth he was devout but troubled by epilepsy. He was married to Yolande, daughter of the King of France. When he was put in charge of the province of Brescia and made governor of Piedmont, he worked for peace both with his brother Philip and with the Sforzas of Milan. He was a good administrator and very generous to the poor. He died before he was forty, and his last admonition to his family and administrators was "Be just. Love the poor and the Lord will grant peace to the whole length of the land."

In Moscow, in 1879, St Innocent of Alaska, bishop. Known as the Enlightener of Alaska and Siberia, he became familiar with the language of the people he served and taught skills such as blacksmithing and carpentry. He was later made Metropolitan of Moscow.

March 31

The commemoration of St. Amos, the prophet.

At the monastery of Mar Saba in Palestine, in 794, St. Stephen, the nephew of St. John Damascene, with whom he entered that monastery at an early age. Stephen served in the community in various capacities until he was 32, then became a hermit. He was a wise and compassionate guide for others, had the gift of healing, and was very fond of animals.

In 1046, at Borgo San Donnino, near Parma, St. Guy, abbot. After spending time as a hermit, he joined the monastery of Pomposa, and when the abbot resigned to become a hermit, Guy became abbot. He invited St. Peter Damian to spend two years at the monastery teaching sacred scripture.

At London in 1631, John Donne, priest and poet. Born in about the year 1571 and brought up as a Roman Catholic Donne was a great-great nephew of Thomas More, although this seems to have had little influence on him, as he led a somewhat debauched youth and was extremely sceptical about all religion. He went up to [Oxford](#) when he was fourteen, studied further at [Cambridge](#) and perhaps on the Continent, and eventually discovered his Christian faith in the Church of England. After much heart-searching, he accepted ordination and later the post of Dean of St Paul's Cathedral. Much of his cynicism dissolved and he became a strong advocate for the discerning of Christian vocation, and in particular affirming his own vocation as a priest, loving and loved by the crucified Christ. The people of London flocked to his sermons. He died on this day in the year 1631. His love-poetry and religious poems took on a renewed life in the twentieth century and his place both as a patristic scholar and as a moral theologian are confirmed by his prolific writings and the publication of his sermons.

In 1945, at Ravensbrück, Germany, Blessed Natalie Tulasiewicz. She was a school teacher with an advanced degree in Polish literature. When the Nazis took prisoners of war from Poland to work in Germany, she voluntarily moved to Hanover, where she worked in a factory and organised religious activities for the prisoners. She was arrested and tortured, then taken to Ravensbrück, where again she organised religious activities. On Good Friday, she gave a talk on Christ's Passion and Resurrection; two days later she was executed in the gas chamber.

April

April 1

In 304, during the persecution of Diocletian, the martyrdom of Sts. Agape and Chionia. With their younger sister, Irene, they were arrested for hiding copies of the Christian scriptures. When they refused to sacrifice to the gods or deliver up the Scriptures, they were burned to death.

In the fifth century, in the Judean desert, St. Mary of Egypt. After a dissolute youth in Alexandria, she converted before an icon of the Blessed Virgin Mary in Jerusalem. She then spent the next 47 years as a solitary in the Judean desert east of the Jordan River. Her story was often retold in the Middle Ages, which saw her as a model of repentance. She is usually depicted with the three loaves she took out into the desert with her, or with a lion, which her legend says helped to bury her.

In 1132, St. Hugh of Grenoble, bishop. He went to Rome to be consecrated bishop of Grenoble by Pope Gregory VII and to receive spiritual advice about temptations from which he suffered. As a bishop he was an ardent reformer, seeking to free his diocese of simony, concubinage and ignorance. After two years he went to a Benedictine monastery, where he stayed for a year. The pope ordered him back to his diocese. He supported St. Bruno's effort to establish the Grand Chartreuse and would have become a Carthusian if the pope had allowed it. The feast of his nephew, Hugh, abbot of the Carthusian monastery of Bonnevaux, is also celebrated this day.

In 1245, St. Gilbert of Caithness, bishop. Gilbert de Moravia appears to have been a member of the family of the Lords of Duffus in Moray. He was for many years Archdeacon of Moray, and in 1223 was elected Bishop of Caithness. A devout churchman and an able statesman, his great work was the erection of a new cathedral at Dornoch, but his long episcopate was beneficial to his diocese in every way.

At London in 1872, Frederick Denison Maurice, priest. Born into a Unitarian family in 1805, Frederick Maurice became an Anglican in his twenties and was then ordained. He was one of the founders of the Christian Socialist Movement, in which his particular concern was providing education for working men. As a theologian, Maurice's ideas on Anglican comprehensiveness have remained influential. His best-remembered book, *The Kingdom of Christ*, demonstrated his philosophical approach to theology. His radicalism was revealed in his attack on traditional concepts of hell in *Theological Essays*, which cost him his Professorship at [Kings College](#), London, in 1853. In 1866, however, he was given a chair in [Cambridge](#), which he held until his death.

April 2

In Caesarea in Palestine, in 306, Sts. Apphian and Theodosia, two students of Eusebius of Caesarea who were executed during the persecution of Diocletian.

In 1507, at Plessis-les-Tours in France, St. Francis of Paola. He spent his twelfth year in a Franciscan monastery, and a few years later became a hermit. Disciples gathered around him, and he organised them into "the hermits of Brother Francis of Assisi," who were later called "Friars Minims". The order embraced charity, penance and humility, and during Lent fasted from meat, eggs and dairy products. He encouraged devotion to the wounds of Christ and to Mary. At its apogee in the mid-sixteenth century, the order had 450 houses.

April 3

In 824, St. Nicetas, abbot. While he was head of the monastery of Medikon on Mount Olympus, he was summoned to Constantinople by Emperor Leo the Armenian. He first resisted, then gave in to the

emperor's iconoclasm; he recanted and was imprisoned. Released after the emperor's death, he became a hermit, saying the scandal he had caused made him unworthy to return to his monastery.

In 1253, St. Richard of Chichester. He studied at Oxford and Paris, and became chancellor of Oxford. St. Edmund of Abingdon, archbishop of Canterbury, appointed him his diocesan chancellor. He went into exile with St. Edmund to Pontigny and was ordained there in 1243. Over the opposition of King Henry III he was appointed Bishop of Chichester. When he was finally allowed to take up his duties, he proved himself a model bishop. He is often remembered liturgically on the day of the translation of his relics 16th June.

April 4

At Memphis, Tennessee, in 1968, the assassination of Martin Luther King Junior.

In 636, at Seville, St. Isidore, bishop and doctor. A great scholar, he received an excellent education and was a prolific and popular author, mainly of histories. He wanted to contribute to the formation of a Catholic, Visigothic culture. He became bishop of Seville after the death of his predecessor and brother, St. Leander. His aims can be summed up in his advice: "If anyone wants to be always with God, he ought to pray often and to read often as well." His burial place at Leon, on the route to Compostela, became a popular place of pilgrimage.

In Sicily, in 1589, St. Benedict the Moor. Born of parents who were African slaves, he was given his freedom. He joined a group of Franciscan hermits, became their superior, and when their group was disbanded, joined the Observant Franciscans as a lay brother. He served as a cook, and was appointed superior and novice-master before being allowed to return to his position as a cook.

April 5

At Vannes, in Brittany, in 1419, St. Vincent Ferrer. He joined the Dominicans and was a student and teacher at a number of Dominican faculties in Catalonia and then at Toledo. He was a very effective preacher. When he couldn't convince his friend, the anti-pope Peter de Luna, to negotiate with his rival, Vincent became a roving preacher and stressed the need for repentance. He finally helped convince Benedict to resign, and then spent the rest of his life as a preacher in Normandy and Brittany.

April 6

At the monastery of St. Gall, in 912, Blessed Notker, sometimes called "the stammerer". He studied music and letters under three great teachers at the abbey: the Irish monk Marcellus, Radpert, and Tutilo. Notker became a monk and was appointed librarian, guest-master, teacher and master of the abbey school. He is most known for his Book of Hymns, and may have invented the liturgical sequence.

In 1203, in Denmark, St. William of Eskil, abbot. William was a member of the regular canons at Saint-Geneviève in Paris. He was invited by the bishop of Roskilde in Denmark to form monastic life there.

In 1252, St. Peter of Verona, Dominican priest and martyr. Although his parents were Cathars, he was raised a Catholic. He was a popular preacher. Appointed inquisitor in northern Italy, he incurred the enmity of the Cathars. He was murdered by a man who later became a Dominican brother.

April 7

St Brynach, abbot. A hermit who settled in Pembrokeshire, Brynach was apparently of Irish origin. He was said to have visited Rome and Brittany before landing in Wales at Milford Haven. From there he travelled to Llanboidy, Cilmaenllwyd and Llanfrynach (all places with churches dedicated to him), eventually settling at Nevern. There he lived a life of extreme asceticism, spending hours in prayer on Carn Ingli, the mountain

above his cell. Local traditions about Brynach also mention his close relationship with the natural world, befriending and taming wild animals, and being able to converse with the birds. He represents a strand of early Welsh Christianity that reflects similar ideas and ideals to those of Francis of Assisi.

In 1719, in France, St. John Baptist de la Salle. He studied at St. Sulpice and at Rheims, was ordained, and earned a doctorate in theology. He became involved in opening a school for poor boys in Rheims. He invited the teachers to live in his home, so he could train them properly. Before long he dedicated himself and his considerable wealth to the creation and advancement of the Brothers of Christian Schools. The educational principles he and his collaborators fashioned on the basis of their experience had a profound effect on the way young people were educated.

About 180, probably in Palestine, St. Hegesippus, a pioneering church historian.

In 1241, Blessed Herman Joseph. From a poor family, he was educated by the Premonstratensian canons and joined their monastery in Steinfeld. He eventually was ordained. He had many mystical experiences.

At Moscow, in 1925, St Tikhon, bishop. As Bishop of Alaska and the Alutians Tikhon established positive relationships with many Christians in North America, not least Bishop Grafton of Fond du Lac. He was later elected Patriarch of Moscow and suffered greatly during the Communist revolution.

April 8

At Corinth, about 170, St. Dionysius, bishop. Excerpts from some of his letters are preserved in Eusebius' Ecclesiastical History.

At the abbey of Pontoise, in 1095, St. Walter, abbot. He was a professor before becoming a monk. He was appointed abbot of the new monastery of Pontoise. He didn't like the job and fled three times: first to Cluny, then to an island in the Loire River, and finally to Pope Gregory VII, who told him to return to his post as abbot. Walter was an energetic promoter of the Gregorian Reforms.

In 1761, Griffith Jones, priest. A native of Pen-boyr in Carmarthenshire, Griffith Jones was born in 1683. He was a shepherd and, after attending the grammar school in Carmarthen, he was ordained in 1708. In 1711 he became Rector of Llandeilo Abercywyn, and five years later Rector of Llanddowror. His reputation as a preacher drew large numbers of people from all over South Wales to hear him. An increasing awareness of widespread illiteracy in Wales led him to set up a system of circulating schools, held for three months at a time in churches, barns or private houses. People of all ages were taught to read with the Welsh Prayer Book and Bible as their textbooks. By the time of Griffith Jones' death in 1761, 158,000 people had been taught to read in 3,495 of his schools. This astonishing achievement played a major part in the Welsh spiritual awakening of the eighteenth century.

In 1816, in France, St. Julie Billiart. She was an energetic young woman, active in her parish. When she was in her early 20s, someone attempted to murder her father, and the shock made her an invalid. During the French Revolution she had to go into hiding. In 1804 she was one of the first members of a new order, which became the Sisters of Notre Dame de Namur. The new congregation was devoted to education; there was no distinction between lay and choir sisters, and there was no enclosure. Their main form of self-discipline was class preparation and teaching. Under her inspiration and that of her colleague, Françoise Blin de Bourdon, the congregation flourished.

April 9

In 1140, at Aureil in France, St. Gaucherius, abbot. After receiving a good education, he decided to become a hermit. Gradually people flocked around him and he founded monasteries for men and women under the

Rule of St. Augustine. St. Lambert of Angoulême, St. Faucherus, and St. Stephen of Muret, founder of Grandmont, were among his disciples.

At Flossenburg in 1945, Dietrich Bonhoeffer, Lutheran pastor. Bonhoeffer was born in 1906 into an academic family. Ordained in the Lutheran Church, his theology was influenced by Karl Barth and he became a lecturer: in Spain, the USA and in 1931 back in Berlin. Opposed to the philosophy of Nazism, he was one of the leaders of the Confessing Church, a movement which broke away from the Nazi-dominated Lutherans in 1934. Banned from teaching, and harassed by Hitler's regime, he bravely returned to Germany at the outbreak of war in 1939, despite being on a lecture tour in the United States at the time. His defiant opposition to the Nazis led to his arrest in 1943. His experiences led him to propose a more radical theology in his later works, which have been influential among post-war theologians. He was murdered by the Nazi police in Flossenburg concentration camp.

In Wales today are remembered, saints, martyrs and missionaries of South America.

April 10

The commemoration of Ezekiel, the prophet.

At Chartres, in 1029, St. Fulbert, bishop. He studied at Rheims. When his teacher, Gerbert of Aurillac, became Pope Sylvester II, he summoned Fulbert to Rome as an advisor. When Sylvester died, Fulbert became a canon at Chartres, where he built up the school. He was appointed bishop there in 1007, and energetically carried out his duties. His extant writings include poems, sermons and letters.

At Munich in Bavaria in 1347, William of Ockham, priest. Born at Ockham in Surrey in about the year 1285, William entered the Franciscan Order and, as a friar, he first studied and then taught at Oxford. His writings were ever the subject of close scrutiny, this being a time when heresy was suspected everywhere, it seemed, but he never received any formal condemnation. Later in life, he entered the controversy between the rival popes and had to flee for his life. His much-used principle of economy -- often referred to as 'Occam's Razor' -- stated that only individual things exist and that they are directly understood by the thinking mind and that this intuitive knowledge is caused naturally. His doctrine of God led him to destroy the thirteenth-century concept of the relationship between theology and philosophy and took the study of the philosophy of religion to a new level.

At Kings Cliffe in Northamptonshire in 1761, William Law, priest. Born at Kings Cliffe in 1686, William Law was educated at Emmanuel College Cambridge and, after ordination as a deacon, became a fellow of the College in 1711. When George I came to the throne in 1714, William declined to take the Oath of Allegiance, being a member of the Non-Juror party who believed the anointed but deposed monarch James II and his heirs should occupy the throne. He lost his fellowship but in 1728 he was made a priest and in the same year published *A Serious Call to a Devout and Holy Life*, which much influenced such people as Samuel Johnson and John and Charles Wesley. In it he stresses the moral virtues, a personal prayer life and asceticism. He returned to Kings Cliffe in 1740, where he led a life of devotion and simplicity and caring for the poor. He remained there for the rest of his life.

At New York in 1955, Pierre Teilhard de Chardin, priest. Pierre Teilhard de Chardin was a ground-breaking paleontologist and Christian mystic whose vision encompassed the evolution of all matter toward a final goal in which material and spiritual shall coincide and God shall be all in all. Teilhard was born in 1881. In 1899, he entered the Jesuit novitiate. Teilhard did research at the Natural History Museum in Paris, leading to the Sorbonne where he completed his doctorate in paleontology. Teilhard struggled with the Roman Church that was suspicious of his seemingly radical and heterodox writings. He was forbidden to teach and had to defend himself against charges of heresy. Teilhard remained loyal. After his death, many came to recognise his vision as a deeply Christian one that sought to

reconcile the Biblical vision of God's final triumph over sin and disunity with the discoveries of evolutionary science.

He died on April 10, 1955: Easter Sunday.

April 11

In Gaza, around 550, St. Barsanuphius, monk. After joining a monastery, he became a hermit. Many people came to him for advice, but he communicated with them only indirectly through two associates, Serios and John the Prophet. He left behind some 850 letters whose spiritual teachings on prayer, the presence of God, humility and obedience were very influential.

In 714, at Crowland, in East Anglia, St. Guthlac, hermit. After fighting as a brigand on the Welsh border, he became a monk at Repton. After two years he became a hermit, taking St. Antony of Egypt as his model.

In 1079, St. Stanislaus of Krakow, bishop and martyr. From a knightly family, he became a priest and canon at Krakow Cathedral, and was appointed bishop there in 1072. He was a zealous reformer of his clergy and patron of the poor. He fell afoul of King Boleslaus II, who killed him. He is patron of Poland.

At Lichfield in 1878, George Augustus Selwyn, Bishop. Selwyn was born in 1809, educated at Cambridge and ordained as curate of Windsor. In 1841 he was made the first Bishop of New Zealand and remained there for twenty-seven years, during the first years travelling when few roads or bridges existed. In the wars between colonists and Maoris he stood out heroically for Maori rights, at the cost of fierce attacks from both sides and grave personal danger in his efforts to part the warriors, until later he was revered as one of the founders of New Zealand as well as of its Church. He taught himself to navigate and gathered congregations in the Melanesian Islands. His Constitution for the New Zealand Church influenced the churches of the Anglican Communion and he was a chief founder of the Lambeth Conferences of bishops. In 1868 he was persuaded to become the Bishop of Lichfield.

April 12

At Rome, in 352, Pope. Julius I, a strong defender of the faith against the Arians. He built the church of Santa Maria in Trastevere.

At Verona, in about 371, St. Zeno, bishop. About ninety of his sermons survive. They show him fully orthodox in his theology. He was known for his austere life.

In 1634, William Forbes, bishop. Born in Aberdeen in 1585, William Forbes was for a time Professor of Logic in the university there. He ministered in Alford and Monyauk, then at St Nicholas' Church, Aberdeen. A theologian of European rank, his strongly patristic, eucharistic theology led him into controversy. His work has been used in international talks between Anglicans and Roman Catholics in modern times. He was nominated by Charles I in 1633 to be the first Bishop of Edinburgh, but he died within two months of his consecration.

In 1927, at Naples, St. Joseph Moscati. He received a medical degree in 1903 and went to work at a hospital called the Incurabili, where he organised a treatment for rabies sufferers. He developed a form of holistic medicine. He was a professor for several years before becoming director of the Incurabili. He was a daily communicant and treated the poor for free.

April 13

In the Crimea, in 654, St. Martin I, pope and martyr. While serving in Constantinople he learned about the Monothelite theory that Jesus did not have a human will. When he became pope he called a council at Rome which condemned Monothelitism. The Emperor Constans II had him kidnapped and taken to

Constantinople, where he was imprisoned and scourged. He was then exiled to the Crimea. He wrote to the church of Rome, telling them he felt they had neglected him after his arrest. He died of starvation.

In 1113, at the monastery of Vast, Blessed Ida of Boulogne. She was the daughter of Duke Godfrey IV of Lorraine, the wife of Eustace II, count of Bologne, and the mother of the crusader rulers Godfrey and Baldwin. When she was widowed she spent much of her considerable wealth helping monasteries. She was a spiritual associate of Cluny and a friend of St. Anselm.

In Wales, in 1124, St. Caradoc, hermit. He was a harpist at a royal court in south Wales. He became a hermit and priest and spent many years at St. Ismael's cell.

April 14

At Lyons, in 688, St. Lambert, bishop. He served at the court of King Clotaire, then became a monk at Fontenelle. He succeeded the founder, St. Wandrille, as abbot in 668 and was chosen archbishop of Lyons about 679.

In 1117, St. Bernard, founder of the Benedictine monastery of Tiron. He was a monk in several monasteries before joining the hermits in the forest of Craon, where Blessed Vitalis of Savigny and Blessed Robert of Arbrissel also stayed. Eventually he founded an abbey at Tiron, where he enforced his strict interpretation of the Rule of St. Benedict. The abbey became the center of a Benedictine congregation. Among its foundations was one on Caldey Island off the south coast of Wales. In the 17th century the Tironian Benedictines merged with the Maurists.

Near Rotterdam, in the Netherlands, in 1433, Blessed Lydwina. She was injured in an ice-skating accident when she was fifteen and spent the rest of her life as an invalid. Her health became worse as time went on, but she learned to unite her sufferings with those of Christ. She had many visions and other preternatural experiences. Her life was written by two of her contemporaries: John Gerlac, her cousin, and Thomas a Kempis.

April 15

Around 500, in Wales, St. Paternus or Padarn, abbot and bishop.

In 1565, at Kotor, Montenegro, Blessed Hosanna. She had visions from an early age, and at twenty-one she made vows as an anchoress. She supported herself by needlework. She was honoured as a peacemaker and is a patron of ecumenism.

In 1889, on the island of Molokai, Blessed Damien De Veuster. He joined the Fathers of the Sacred Hearts of Jesus and Mary in 1857, and in 1863 went as a missionary to Hawaii. In 1873 he offered to go to serve permanently among the lepers on Molokai. Controversy surrounded his efforts to help the lepers. Robert Louis Stevenson wrote in his defence.

April 16

In 304, under Diocletian, at Zaragosa, St. Optatus and companions, martyrs. Prudentius wrote a hymn about them.

In the sixth century, St. Padarn, bishop. The Welsh Triads describe Padarn as one of the 'three blessed visitors of the Island of Britain', along with David and Teilo. There is a tradition that the three saints travelled together on pilgrimage to Jerusalem. It is said that Padarn was presented with a choral cope there and the saint thus became regarded as a singer and musician. Padarn founded a major ecclesiastical centre at Llanbadarn Fawr in Ceredigion, of which he may have been the first bishop. Padarn's churches may be linked

to the network of Roman roads and this might suggest that this connects the saint with residual Romano-British Christianity in mid-Wales (Padarn being the Welsh version of the common Latin name Paternus). This could imply that his missionary work preceded that of his two fellow 'blessed visitors'.

In 665, St. Fructuosus, archbishop of Braga. He became a priest and used his large inheritance to found monasteries. He wrote several rules for families who decided to enter monastic life.

In 1116, St. Magnus of Orkney. After a warlike youth, Magnus refused to fight any more. When his cousin Haakon sent men to kill him in order to gain sole control of the earldom of Orkney, Magnus refused to defend himself. He died praying for his killers. His remains were buried in 1136 in the cathedral dedicated to him at Kirkwall on Mainland Orkney; they were rediscovered in 1919.

In 1783, in Rome, St. Benedict Joseph Labre. At first he was educated to become a priest, but he decided instead to join the strictest religious order he could find. When the Trappists, Cistercians and Cartesians turned him down, he decided to become a permanent pilgrim, having only the clothes on his back and no place to sleep. He walked to all the main pilgrim shrines in Europe, relying on whatever people voluntarily gave him. He settled in Rome about ten years before his death. He is the patron of homeless people.

In 1879, at Nevers, St. Bernadette Soubirous. She was born at Lourdes in 1844, and never had very good health. She had not yet made her first communion when, at the age of fourteen, she experienced a series of apparitions, which no one else beheld. People were convinced by her sincerity and common sense. She entered the Sisters of Notre Dame at Nevers in 1864, where she lived as an exemplary religious and shunned all publicity. She said she was a broom that Our Lady had used, and now she was back in the corner. After 1870, Lourdes became the most popular pilgrimage site in Europe.

In 1923 Isabella Gilmore, deaconess. Born in 1842, Isabella Gilmore, the sister of William Morris, was a nurse at Guy's Hospital in London and in 1886, was asked by Bishop Thorold of Rochester to pioneer deaconess work in his diocese. The bishop overcame her initial reluctance and together they planned for an Order of Deaconesses along the same lines as the ordained ministry. She was ordained in 1887 and a training house developed on North Side, Clapham Common, later to be called Gilmore House in her memory. Isabella herself retired in 1906 and, during her nineteen years of service, she trained head deaconesses for at least seven other dioceses. At her memorial service, Dr Randall Davidson predicted that "Some day, those who know best will be able to trace much of the origin and root of the revival of the Deaconess Order to the life, work, example and words of Isabella Gilmore."

April 17

In 1134, St Stephen Harding, abbot. Robert of Molesme, Alberic and Stephen Harding, along with their companions, are honoured as the founders of the New Monastery in 1098 which in a short while came to be called the Abbey of Citeaux. If the title of 'founder' of the Cistercian Order can be ascribed to any one man that person would be Stephen Harding, elected abbot in 1101 until his death in 1134. Today, however, the charism of the founder of the Order is more usually located in the group of twenty abbots who assembled for the General Chapter of 1123, among whom most significantly was Bernard of Clairvaux. It was from Abbot Stephen that Bernard received his monastic formation, and if nothing else, Stephen Harding is honoured for discernment in recognising and fostering the outstanding gifts of this young monk. The desire of the Cistercians was to live the Rule of Saint Benedict more integrally, to rediscover the meaning of the monastic life and to translate their discovery into structures adapted to their age. The white monks were not satisfied with compromises or accommodations. It was essential values that concerned them, not an archaeological reconstruction of a past monastic age.

In 1680, in Montreal, Saint Kateri Tekakwitha. When she was four, her parents died in a smallpox epidemic which left her disfigured and partially blind. She seems to have decided not to marry, even before she became a Christian in 1676, when she was twenty. She left home to move to a Christian village near

Montreal. There she led an exemplary life for three years, before her death at the age of twenty-four. In 1980 she became the first native American to be beatified.

In Persia, in 341, St. Simeon Barbsabae, bishop, and his companions, martyrs. They were martyred under King Sapor II when they refused to worship the sun.

In 617, St. Donnan and his companions, martyrs. Donnan (or Dounan) was an Irish missionary, roughly contemporary with Columba, who worked in Galloway, Argyll and the islands of the Inner Hebrides. He established a monastery on the island of Eigg where he and fifty-two companions were massacred by Viking pirates in around the year 617.

April 18

Around 328, the death of St. Alexander of Alexandria, Patriarch. When he became Patriarch in 312 he had to deal with controversies over the date of Easter and the Melitian schism, which concerned the treatment of Christians who had lapsed during persecutions. Soon these were overshadowed by the conflict over the views of the Alexandrian priest Arius, who taught that Christ was less than fully God and also not fully human, since in him the Logos took the place of the human soul. Alexander responded with tactful overtures, but Arius appealed to bishops elsewhere. The conflict soon spread to much of the Christian world and so Constantine called a general council at Nicaea. Alexander attended, accompanied by his deacon and successor, St. Athanasius.

In 639, St. Laserian, abbot. Laserian, often called affectionately 'Mo-laise', was Abbot of Old Leighlin. The cathedral, sheltering among the hills of County Carlow in Ireland, is a place of peace and beauty. It is said that Laserian may have received his training in Iona. His name is honoured in Scotland (Arran) as well as in other parts of Ireland (Inishmurray, off the coast of County Sligo).

April 19

In 1054, in Rome, St. Leo IX, pope. He was born in Alsace and educated at Toul. He was bishop there for twenty years, where he was an energetic reformer of both clergy and monasteries. He was named pope in 1049, and entered the city dressed as a pilgrim. He immediately began a series of reform synods in Italy, France and Germany. He assembled an impressive body of advisors and helpers, including Hildebrand and Frederick of Liège, who became popes after him, as well St. Hugh of Cluny, Peter Damian and Humbert of Moyenmoutier. Humbert was sent to Constantinople to reconcile differences with the Patriarch over Leo's policies in Sicily; he ended up excommunicating the Patriarch, who retaliated by excommunicating Humbert and the pope. But by then, Leo had died in his bed, which he had placed next to his coffin in St. Peter's. The mutual excommunications were lifted during the pontificate of Pope John Paul II.

In Carthage, around 250, during the persecution of Decius, St. Mappalicus and companions, martyrs. St. Cyprian wrote of them that they were "firm in their faith, patient under suffering, victorious over torture."

In 1012, St. Alphege of Canterbury, monk, bishop and martyr. He was appointed by St. Dunstan as abbot of Bath, where he was a very strict superior. In 984 he became bishop of Winchester, and in 1005, archbishop of Canterbury. Danish thugs murdered him when he wouldn't pay tribute money. King Cnut had his body transferred to Canterbury in 1023. St. Thomas a Becket commended himself to God and St. Alphege just before he died.

At Wittenberg, in Saxony, in 1560, Philip Melanchthon, reformer. Born in 1497 in Bretten, like Luther he believed the writing of St Paul to be key to understanding the New Testament and was the author of the Augsburg Confession in 1530. He hoped for peace among Christians and lamented the "rage of the theologians."

April 20

In the French Alps, in 374, the burial of St. Marcellinus of Embrun, bishop. He was an African missionary who was appointed bishop of Embrun by Eusebius of Vercelli.

In 640, St Beuno, abbot. Beuno was probably born at Llanymynech and educated at the monastic school at Caerwent. He returned home and established a monastery there, later moving to Berriew. When the English invaded Wales Beuno left, calling with Tysilio at Meifod, and travelling on to Gwyddelwern near Corwen where he made another foundation. He then went to Holywell and finally to Gwynedd. There he settled at Clynnog in Arfon which was to become the centre of his cult. He was the greatest of the missionary saints of North Wales and he and his followers built many churches. Beuno died on the Sunday after Easter in about the year 640, and it is said that on his deathbed he had a vision of heaven. He was buried at Clynnog.

In 722, St Maelrubha of Applecross. Born near Derry in the year 642, Maelrubha joined Congall's community in Bangor. Around the year 671, however, he followed the Irish practice of 'wandering for Christ'. After two years of missionary work in the northeast of Scotland, he settled in the remote peninsula of Applecross, whence he founded many churches. He died at the age of eighty in the year 722.

About 930, Blessed Hugh of Anzy, who was an associate of Blessed Berno in the reform of the Abbey of Baume and the founding of Cluny. He was appointed prior of Anzy-le-Duc where he preached against paganism and built a hospital.

In 1317, St. Agnes of Montepulciano. She joined the Sisters of the Sack and became superior of a community of theirs near Viterbo. Later she returned to Montepulciano and founded a Dominican convent there. Her tomb became a popular pilgrimage spot.

April 21

St. Anselm, bishop and doctor. Anselm was born in Aosta in 1033. He went to study in Burgundy, where his mother had relatives. He was drawn to Bec by the fame of Lanfranc, who was teaching there; he joined Bec and became prior and abbot. He visited England several times on abbey business, and when Lanfranc died he was appointed archbishop of Canterbury. Almost immediately he clashed with King William Rufus. He went into exile and stayed with St. Hugh at Cluny, and at Lyons and Rome. He returned to England when Henry I became king. Henry and Anselm came into conflict over the investiture of clerics in their offices; that was finally settled, and for his last three years at Canterbury Anselm enjoyed friendly relations with the king. He was always in his heart a Benedictine monk, and love is the key theme of his letters and the prayers he wrote. Guided by his motto, "faith seeking understanding", he also wrote a number of brilliant and extremely influential theological monographs, including *Why God Became Man* and the *Proslogion*.

In 185, at Rome, St. Apollonius, martyr. He was a high-ranking Roman who was arrested for being a Christian. He addressed an eloquent apology for Christianity to the senate and was executed.

Around 600, St. Beuno, abbot. He founded a number of monasteries in north Wales and was an advisor, and perhaps uncle, to St. Winefride.

April 22

At Constantinople, in 536, the death of St. Agapitus, pope. He was a learned man and a friend of Cassiodorus, with whom he planned to start a university in Rome. He was elected pope when he was already elderly. He went to Constantinople to dissuade Justinian from invading Italy. He failed in that mission, but managed to have the Monothelite patriarch of Constantinople replaced by St. Mennas.

In 1091, at the abbey of Brauweiler, Blessed Wolfhelm, abbot. He was educated at the cathedral school at Cologne, where he became a canon. He then joined the Monastery of Saint Maximinus at Trier, but was called back to the abbey of Saint Pantaleon in Cologne. He was abbot successively of Gladbach, Siegburg and Brauweiler. In his theological writings, he argued for the real presence of Christ in the Eucharist and against the idea that pagan and Christian philosophy are necessarily in conflict.

April 23

About 303, at Lydda in Palestine, in the persecution of Diocletian, St. George, martyr. A number of extravagant stories were written about him from 500 AD, to which in the Middle Ages a tale about his slaying a dragon and saving a maiden were added. He became the patron of England, as well as of Venice, Genoa, Portugal and Catalonia.

In 994, at Toul, St. Gerard, bishop. He was born and educated at Cologne, became a canon, and then was chosen bishop of Toul. There he established a school and staffed it with some Irish and Greek monks. He enlarged the ancient monastery of St. Evroult, and founded the oldest hospital in the city. In 1050, St. Leo IX, a native of Toul, canonized Gerard, making him one of the first saints to be officially canonized by a pope.

In 997, in Prussia, St. Adalbert of Prague, bishop and martyr. He was born in Bohemia and educated by another St. Adalbert, archbishop of Magdeburg. He became archbishop of Prague in 982. He took his responsibilities very seriously, perhaps because of the influence of St. Mayol of Cluny and St. Gerard of Toul, who were at his consecration. He didn't make much headway with his people, so he went to Rome and became a Benedictine monk at the monastery of St. Boniface and Alexis. He returned to Bohemia and established a Benedictine monastery at Brzeznov. He went to Rome again, but at the urging of Emperor Otto III and St. Willigis of Mainz, returned and settled in Poland. He was murdered by Prussians when he was on a missionary journey. His body was buried at Gniezno, and his veneration spread very rapidly.

In Perugia, in 1262, Blessed Giles, one of St. Francis' first and most beloved disciples. He preached unsuccessfully to the Saracens in Tunis, then spent the rest of his life in Italy. He had ecstatic experiences, one of which he said was his fourth birth, after his birthday, his baptism, and his entry into the Franciscan community.

April 24

At Canterbury in 624, Mellitus, bishop. Mellitus was a Roman abbot and sent to England by the Pope, Gregory the Great, to undergird the work of Augustine, who consecrated him Bishop of the East Saxons with his see at London and his first church that of St Paul. After some local setbacks and having to reside in northern France, he and his fellow bishops were recalled to England, but Mellitus was unable to return to London. He was made archbishop in the year 619 and died on this day in the year 624. He was buried close to Augustine in the Church of Ss Peter & Paul in Canterbury.

In Switzerland, in 1622, St. Fidelis of Sigmaringen, martyr. Born Mark Roy, he earned a doctorate in philosophy at Freiburg in Breisgau, then became a tutor. He earned doctorates in civil and canon law in 1611. He quickly gave up the practice of law, became a priest, and joined the Capuchins. At the request of the bishop of Chur, he was sent to the canton of Graubünden to preach to the Protestants under the auspices of the new Roman Congregation for the Propagation of the Faith. One day as he finished preaching, he was assaulted by twenty armed men; refusing to renounce his faith, he was murdered.

In France, in 1969, St. Mary Euphrasia Pelletier, who founded the Good Shepherd Sisters at Angers. She drew her spirituality from seventeenth-century writers such as St. John Eudes.

In 1957, Blessed Mary Hesselblad. Born in Sweden of Lutheran parents, she emigrated to the United States as a young girl. She trained as a nurse. In 1902, after 20 years of deliberation, she joined the Catholic Church. She went to Rome and asked to be admitted to the Carmelite convent which occupied St. Bridget of

Sweden's old home on the Piazza Farnese. After finishing her novitiate she was allowed to take the vows and habit of a Brigittine. She toured the four surviving Brigittine monasteries and after a few years started her first house in Rome. In 1929, she occupied the house in the Piazza Farnese, after the Carmelites vacated it. In 1935 she opened a convent at Vadstena. During the war she used the house in Rome to help Jews and others threatened by the Nazis. Her order now has 37 houses including two in England one of which is at the shrine of Holywell in north Wales.

April 25

In the first century, St. Mark, evangelist. He has been venerated as a martyr especially at Alexandria, Venice and Reichenau.

In 1218, at the Benedictine abbey of St. Syrus in Piacenza, St. Franca Visalta of Piacenza. She was placed in the monastery as a child oblate. When she was elected abbess, the nuns had her deposed because she was too strict. She found refuge in a Cistercian abbey, where she became abbess also.

In 1667, in Guatemala City, St. Peter of St. Joseph Betancur. Born in the Canary Islands, he decided to go to South America to help the poor people there. He stayed for the rest of his life. Around him a group of like-minded individuals gathered, who evolved into the Bethlehemite Congregation. He is credited with starting the procession held on Christmas Eve known as las posadas, which means "lodgings".

April 26

Our Lady of Good Counsel

About 645, in the forest of Crecy, St. Riquier. Converted by Irish missionaries, he became a priest and missionary. As he grew older, he retired to live a solitary life in the forest of Crecy. A monastery grew up there. After his death it was united with the monastery at Celles, and renamed Saint Riquier.

In 865, at the abbey of Corbie, St. Paschasius Radbertus, abbot. He was a foundling raised by nuns at Soissons. He became a monk at Corbie, which had an excellent library. He studied theology there, and in 843 or 844 was elected abbot. He resigned in 849 and devoted the rest of his life to study and writing. He spent some years at the monastery of Saint Riquier. He wrote several biblical commentaries, the letter *Cogitis me* which was important in the development of the doctrine of the Assumption, and a book on the Eucharist which championed the real presence of Christ and taught that by receiving the Eucharist people became part of Christ's mystical body, the church.

In 1396, St. Stephen of Perm, bishop. He was born of Russian Christian parents in an area about 500 miles northeast of Moscow occupied by the mostly pagan Zyryani people. He joined a monastery in Rostov and became an expert on Byzantine theology. He learned the Zyryani language, so he could become a missionary among them. He invented an alphabet for their language, so they wouldn't have to pray in Russian.

In 1937, Albert Ernest Laurie, priest. Born in Edinburgh in 1866, Albert Laurie became a lay reader at Old St Paul's Church to finance his theological studies. He was ordained in 1890, and continued to serve there under Canon Mitchell Innes. When Canon Innes left, Laurie was unanimously elected rector of Old St Paul's. His entire ministry was spent in that one church. It was marked by personal holiness, faithful teaching and devoted pastoral ministry, especially to the poor of the Old Town.

April 27

About 107, in Palestine, St. Simeon, the son of Clopas, who succeeded James the Less as bishop of Jerusalem. He survived the fall of the city but was martyred by crucifixion under the Emperor Trajan.

In 470, St Assicus (Tassach), bishop. Tassach was a close friend of Patrick, and as bishop of Raholp in Ireland, near Saul, attended Patrick on his death-bed. Tradition ascribes to him the skills of a brass-worker and coppersmith. He died on this day in the year 470.

In 915, St. Tutilo. He became a monk at St. Gall in Switzerland at the time of Blessed Notker, and was an outstanding artist and musician.

At London, in 1894 Christina Rossetti, poet. Christina Rossetti was born in 1830 and was associated with the Pre-Raphaelite Brotherhood, of which her older brother, Dante, was a prominent member. Her elder sister became an Anglican Religious. Christina's own fame rests upon her poetry, which dealt mainly with religious subjects but also the sadness of unrequited or disappointed love. She was the author of the Christmastide carol *In the bleak mid-winter*.

April 28

In 1841, St. Peter Chanel, martyr. Born near Lyons, he was ordained in 1827. He served as a parish priest for several years, then joined the Society of Mary in order to become a missionary. After teaching in a seminary for several years, he was sent to the islands of the South Pacific when these were entrusted to his order. He sailed with eight missionaries from Le Havre to Valpaíso in Chile, and from there for Tonga. On the way they happened to land on the island of Futuna. Peter agreed to stay there as a missionary, along with a Marist brother and a European trader who was to act as a translator. Peter had some success in making converts, but earned the animosity of the king of the island and was killed with clubs and an axe.

In 1182, at Turov in Belarus, St. Cyril, bishop. He was a monk and a recluse before being chosen bishop. A number of his writings survive: twelve sermons, twenty-four prayers, an Exhortation to the Monastic Life, and a penitential. He spent the last three years of his life in retirement in his monastery.

In 1716, St. Louis Marie Grignon de Montfort. He was born in Brittany and educated by the Jesuits. He had limited social skills and preferred solitary prayer. After his ordination, he struggled to find his proper ministry and developed his spirituality centred on Our Lady and the Cross. He went on preaching missions in Brittany, and wrote a number of devotional works. From his ministry derive the Montfort Fathers and the Daughters of Divine Wisdom.

April 29

In 1380, in Rome, St. Catherine of Siena, doctor of the church. Catherine was born [the] next to the last of 25 children in a prosperous Sienese family. She chose a life of virginity, which so angered her parents that they turned her into a servant. She joined a group of lay Dominicans, but spent much of her time in prayer and soon developed an intense spiritual life. When she was 21 she began to spend more time in charitable work and in preaching. Her confessor and friend, Blessed Raymond of Capua, supported her in these endeavours. In 1375 she supported a young political prisoner as he prepared to face execution and knelt with him as he was beheaded. In 1377 and 1378 she wrote her Dialogues, which summarise her spiritual teaching. She worked tirelessly to bring peace among Christian states and to reform the church. She urged Pope Gregory XI to return to Rome from Avignon. She fasted in support of Pope Urban VI, and that may have hastened her death. Whatever the extent of her literacy, she knew the Bible well, and she speaks of the great Christian mysteries with depth and accuracy. In 1970 she was declared a doctor of the Church, the first time the title was given to a lay person.

April 30

In Rome, in 1572, Pope St. Pius V. He joined the Dominicans at 14, and lectured for them at the University of Pavia. He held various offices in the Inquisition and was made a cardinal in 1557. As bishop of Mondovì, he

was a strict reformer who practiced an ascetical way of life. At the papal election of 1566, he was the successful candidate of the reforming party led by St. Charles Borromeo. He began immediately implementing the reforms of the Council of Trent, starting with Rome itself. He called for the Christian states of Europe to oppose the advance of the Muslims in the Mediterranean, an effort which bore fruit in the battle of Lepanto. He insisted that bishops be conscientious in their pastoral charge and issued new liturgical books.

In 1672, Blessed Marie of the Incarnation Guyart. She was born in Tours. She was married at 17 and [the couple] had one son, Claude, who became a Benedictine and her first biographer. Her husband died a year later. She worked to support herself and her son until he was twelve, then put him in the care of her sister and joined the Ursuline Convent in Tours. In 1639 she went to Quebec, where she set up a convent and school. Although her work came close to being destroyed by fire or war several times, she carried on teaching, learning the native languages of Iroquois, Hurons and Algonquins, and writing dictionaries to help with translations of the Bible and the catechism. Her convent became an advice center for the missionary enterprise in French Canada. She wrote thousands of letters of counsel and encouragement.

At Bombay in India, in 1922, Pandita Mary Rambai, translator of the Scriptures. Mary Ramabai was born in 1858, the daughter of a Sanscrit scholar who believed in educating women. Converting to Christianity, she nevertheless remained loyal to many aspects of her Hindu background, pioneering an Indian vision of the faith. She became well known as a lecturer on social questions, becoming the first woman to be awarded the title 'Pandita'. She spent many years working for the education of women and orphans, founding schools and homes. Personally, she lived in great simplicity and was a prominent opponent of the caste system and child marriage.

May

May 1

Sts. Philip and James, apostles. Their feasts are celebrated together, because the basilica later known as that of the Twelve Apostles was dedicated to the two of them. Philip is mentioned a number of times in the gospels. James the Less was bishop of Jerusalem and was martyred in 61 AD. His emblem is a fuller's club, the instrument of his martyrdom. Remembered by the Roman Catholic church on 3rd May, who today celebrate:

St. Joseph the Worker, a carpenter of Nazareth, who by his labour provided for the needs of Mary and Jesus and introduced the Son of God to human work. On this day on which there are commemorations of human labour in many countries, Christian workers venerate him as an example and protector.

The commemoration of Jeremiah, the prophet.

May 2

This day is set aside to remember all who witnessed to their Christian faith during the conflicts in church and state in England, which lasted from the fourteenth to the seventeenth centuries but were at their most intense in the sixteenth century. Though the reform movement was aimed chiefly at the Papacy, many Christian men and women of holiness suffered for their allegiance to what they believed to be the truth of the gospel. As the movement grew in strength, it suffered its own internecine struggles, with one group determined that they were the keepers of truth and that all others were therefore at least in a state of ignorance and at worst heretical. In the twentieth century, ecumenical links drew the churches closer to each other in faith and worship and all now recognise both the good and evil that evolved from the Reformation Era.

In Alexandria, in 373, St. Athanasius, bishop and doctor of the church. In opposition to the Arians, Athanasius was a tireless champion of the true divinity of the Son of God. He was chosen patriarch of Alexandria in 328. By then he was already a noted theologian. He spent the next forty-six years alternating between leading his diocese and enduring exile. He is the author of *The Life of St. Antony*.

At Saint Gall in Switzerland, in 926, St. Wiborada, martyr. She worked as a bookbinder at Saint Gall, then assisted her priest brother, Hatto. When he joined Saint Gall, she became a recluse. She was killed by the invading Huns.

In 1172, at Avranches, Blessed Achard of St. Victor. He was probably born in England of Anglo-Norman parents. He studied and taught at the Parisian abbey of St. Victor, where he became the second abbot in 1155. In 1162, he was made bishop of Avranches in Normandy. As bishop there, he supported the foundation of the Premonstratensian monastery of La Lucerne, where his tomb is still venerated.

May 3

In 1010, at the monastery of Heiligenberg, St. Ansfrid. Appointed bishop of Utrecht by Henry II, he was a conscientious pastor. He founded two monasteries and retired to one of them before he died.

In 1695, Henry Vaughan, poet. Henry Vaughan was born in 1622 at Scethrog in Breconshire and studied medicine in London before returning home to practise. When the Civil War broke out, he joined the Royalist army, seeing action in Cheshire and being captured. In the following few years his younger brother, William, was killed, the king was executed, the Church Henry knew and loved was suppressed, and his beloved young wife, Catherine, died. In 1650 he published his first volume of religious verse, setting himself to work in the style of John Donne and, especially, George Herbert. His poetry analyses his experiences and shows an intense awareness of the divine meanings in ordinary things. In his troubles, Henry Vaughan found

the crucified Saviour and, finding him, he found also light and hope and peace. He died at Scethrog on 23 April 1695, and was buried in the churchyard of Llansantffraed.

At Paris, in 1915, Servant of God Elisabeth Leseur. A devout laywoman, Leseur engaged in a spiritual correspondence with many. Married to a convinced atheist she was sure that she would one day be a priest. After she died of breast cancer he was, indeed, ordained priest in 1923.

May 4

At Engelberg, in Switzerland, in 1126, Blesseds Conrad, Adelhelm, Frowin and Berchtold. Conrad of Seldenbüren founded the abbey of Engelberg about 1120 and [then] entered the community. When he went to Zurich to settle a claim on some property he had given to the abbey, he was murdered. His body was incorrupt until it burned in a fire in 1729. Engelberg was first settled by monks from Muri, led by Blessed Adelhelm. After the community suffered under the rule of three unworthy abbots, Blessed Frowin was sent from St. Blasien in the mid-1140s to revitalise the monastery. Like St. Blasien, Engelberg was a double monastery. It continued to be one until the early sixteenth century, when the sisters moved to Sarnen. Frowin was a very well-read man and established a renowned scriptorium and library at Engelberg. He wrote a compendium on theological anthropology called *In Praise of Free Will* and *A Commentary on the Our Father*. His immediate successor, Berchtold, continued his work and left behind a theological treatise.

At Lorch, in Austria, in 304, during the persecution of Diocletian, St. Florian. He surrendered to the governor's soldiers and was scourged, flayed, and thrown into the river Emms with a stone around his neck. He is venerated as the patron of firefighters.

In Poland, in 1505, Blessed Ladislas of Warsaw. He was educated in Warsaw and joined the Observant Franciscans. He was sent on an evangelising mission to Lithuania. He organised a campaign of prayer to protect Poland from an invasion of Tatars and Turks, whose advance was then stopped by extraordinary floods.

[In England: Saints and Martyrs of the Reformation Era]

May 5

In 449, at Arles, St. Hilary. When his relative St. Honoratus was called from Lérins to be bishop of Arles, he took Hilary with him. At the age of 29, Hilary was chosen to succeed Honoratus. As bishop he continued to live as a monk.

In the seventh century, St Asaph, bishop. The biographer of Saint Kentigern (Cynderyn) states that when he founded a monastic settlement on the banks of the river Elwy, one of his favourite pupils was a nobly born boy named Asaph. The biography includes a story which underlines Asaph's obedience to his spiritual master. When Kentigern was recalled to Strathclyde to become Bishop of Glasgow, Asaph was unanimously appointed Bishop of Llanelwy (which later became known as St Asaph in English). He remained there for the rest of his life and was buried there. The cluster of names connected with Asaph in northern Flintshire (Llanasa, Pantasa and Ffynnon Asa) suggests that this may have been his native area.

In 1038, at Hildesheim, St. Gothard, bishop. He was educated by the canons of Niederaltaich and joined them. When the monastery became Benedictine, Gothard became a monk and then abbot. He championed the renewal of monastic life and reformed the monasteries of Tegernsee, Hersfeld and Kremsmünster. When Gothard was sixty, Henry II appointed him bishop of Hildesheim. He was an energetic bishop, with a special concern for the destitute.

May 6

In Numidia, in North Africa, in 259, during the persecution of Valerian, Saints Marian, a reader, and James, a deacon, martyrs. When taken prisoner, they confessed their faith and were tortured on the rack and imprisoned. In prison they experienced various visions, which were shared with the Christian community. They and some companions were executed by the sword.

At Lindisfarne, in 698, St. Edbert, bishop. He was the successor to St. Cuthbert, and like Cuthbert used to spend times in solitude on an island. He was buried with St. Cuthbert, and his bones were moved to Durham with Cuthbert's.

May 7

At the monastery of Beverley, in 721, St. John, bishop. He was born in Yorkshire, educated at Canterbury under St. Aidan, and became a monk at Whitby, where he was distinguished by his learning and concern for the poor. He was consecrated bishop of Hexham in 687, and ordained Bede to the priesthood. In 705 he became bishop of York. He founded the monastery of Beverley and retired there.

May 8

In Milan, in 303, St. Victor the Moor, martyr. He was born in North Africa and served in the Pretorian guard. He was martyred in Milan, and he is patron of that city.

In 615, at Rome, St. Boniface IV, pope. He succeeded St. Gregory the Great, and like him was very supportive of monasticism. He transformed the Pantheon into the Church of St. Mary and the Martyrs. He held a synod in 610, the acts of which were transmitted to England and elsewhere. He also corresponded with St. Columbanus.

At Norwich in 1417, Julian, hermit. On this day in the year 1373, when Julian of Norwich was thirty years old and suffering from what was considered to be a terminal illness, she experienced a series of sixteen visions, which revealed aspects of the love of God. Following her recovery, she spent the next twenty years of her life pondering their meaning and recorded her conclusions in what became the first book written by a woman in English, *The Revelations of Divine Love*. At an unknown point in her life, she became an anchoress attached to the Church of St. Julian in Norwich.

May 9

In 1879, Blessed Mary-Teresa Gerhardinger. Born in Bavaria, she joined the Canonesses of Our Lady by whom she had been educated. When she joined, the congregation was being refounded after its suppression by Napoleon. She was superior of the congregation for forty years and established schools in the United States and other countries. They are now known as the School Sisters of Notre Dame.

May 10

In Ireland, in 602, the death of St. Comgall, abbot. He seems to have studied with St. Finian of Moville. He founded the abbey of Bangor on Belfast Lough. St. Columba was his friend, and St. Columbanus was his disciple. A metrical rule in Irish is attributed to him. It says: "These are your three rules, have nothing dearer: patience and humility and the love of the Lord in your heart."

In 1569, in Spain, St. John of Avila. He studied law at Salamanca, but switched to Alcalá to study philosophy and theology under Dominic de Soto. He was ordained in 1525. He gave away his inheritance and devoted himself to preaching and offering spiritual guidance. He was a friend of St. Ignatius of Loyola and an adviser of St. Teresa of Avila. Luis of Granada wrote his biography.

At Herrnhut in Saxony, in 1760, Nicolaus Ludwig von Zinzendorf. Nicolaus von Zinzendorf was a Count of the Holy Roman Empire who always had more interest in religious matters than in affairs of court. He developed his own "theology of the heart," which placed great emphasis on a close personal relationship with the suffering Saviour. This "heart religion" was not just inner emotion, however, but was to result in a life totally devoted to the Saviour. "All of life becomes a liturgy," said Zinzendorf, and even the most mundane task can be an act of worship. He was an early advocate of ecumenism, and in America he attempted to bring Protestant denominations together. He was a prolific hymn writer, and many of his hymn texts remain in use today in the Moravian Church and beyond.

At Molokai, Hawai, in 1889, St Damien of Molokai, priest. Born in Tremelo, Belgium on January 3 of 1840. He was the seventh of seven brothers. From a tender age he stood out for his piety. At the same time, he loved to play and, above all, run.

At the age of 19 he decided to enter the Congregation of the Sacred Hearts. On his folder he wrote: "silence, presence of God, prayer." He loved very much nocturnal adoration of the Most Blessed Sacrament. Years later he would write that without Adoration he "would not have been able to persevere in casting my lot with that of the lepers in Molokai". Every day he asked for the grace to be sent one day to the missions. Finally in 1863 his dream became reality. He left from the port of Brema in Germany, headed for the Hawaiian Islands. Serving the lepers on the island, he carried out all the professions that he was able: doctor, carpenter, workman, cook, teacher, etc. Many lepers did not have fingers or hands, and so Fr. Damian even made the coffins and dug graves for them. Although he had an irritable temperament for all the things that contradicted his priestly duties, he became a child with the children. He had great charisma: he not only gave, but he gave with love. Children were the favourite of Fr. Damian. They found in him a father and a mother who loved them. His home was always full of leper children who ate with him. They were his true family. In 1885 his illness was diagnosed: he had contracted leprosy. He died four years afterwards. It was the 15th of April 1889.

May 11

In the Benedictine Confederation, today is the feast of the saintly abbots of Cluny.

Blessed Berno was a monk of St. Martin's in Autun, before becoming abbot of Baume, Gigny and finally Cluny. He died in 927.

St. Odo studied in Paris before entering Baume, where he became abbot in 924. He succeeded Berno as abbot of Cluny in 927. He extended the Cluniac observance to many monasteries and collaborated with several popes in reform and peacemaking efforts. He wrote poetry and a life of St. Gerald of Aurillac. He died at Tours in 942.

St. Majolus inherited estates in Provence which were overrun by Saracen invaders. He studied at Lyons and became archdeacon of Macon. When he was urged to become bishop of Besançon, he joined Cluny. He succeeded Aymard as abbot in 965. He collaborated with Otto the Great and Otto II in the reform of the church, but refused the latter's suggestion that he become pope. He was known as a warm and likeable man with a strong contemplative bent. He died in 994.

St. Odilo became abbot of Cluny that same year. He was known for his austere life and charity toward the poor. With Abbot Richard of Saint-Vanne he gained acceptance for the "truce of God" and sanctuary for those seeking refuge in a church. He inaugurated All Souls' Day. He died at Souvigny in 1049.

St. Hugh was the son of a count, and entered Cluny at 14. He was ordained when he was 20, was made prior the next year, and five years later became abbot, an office he held for sixty years. Under him every dimension of the Cluniac reform was expanded. He traveled extensively on behalf of the reform papacy. He was an excellent diplomat, as well as a sincere spiritual leader of a vast monastic federation. He died in 1109.

Blessed Peter the Venerable was elected abbot of Cluny in 1122. His predecessor, Pontius, was not a competent manager. Peter was a well-educated man and built up a good library at Cluny. He promoted the Cluniac reform in Spain and had the Koran translated into Latin, and later wrote a polemical work against Islam. He defended Jews and heretics against persecution. After some of Peter Abelard's theological ideas

were condemned, Peter the Venerable offered him a place of refuge and later effected a reconciliation between Abelard and St. Bernard . Peter died in 1156.

May 12

In Rome, in the second century, Sts. Nereus and Achilleus, martyrs. According to an inscription about them written by Pope St. Damasus, they were members of the Pretorian guard who suddenly converted to Christianity and were martyred for their faith.

In 403, St. Epiphanius of Salamis, bishop. Born of Jewish parents, he converted to Christianity with his sister, and then joined a monastery in Gaza. He journeyed among the monks of Egypt and became an intransigent opponent of Arianism and other heresies. After many years as a monk in Palestine, he became bishop of Salamis on Cyprus.

In 732, St. Germanus, bishop of Constantinople. As patriarch he condemned Monothelitism and the iconoclastic policy of Emperor Leo III.

In 1743, Thomas Rattray, bishop. Thomas Rattray came of a long-established Perthshire family. He was distinguished while still a layman for his theological writings. As a liturgical and patristic scholar, and drawing on early Eastern liturgies, he exerted a decisive influence on the Scottish Communion Office of 1764, and thus on the eucharistic worship of the Episcopal Church in Scotland and in the United States of America. He was a leader among those who contended that the appointment of a bishop belonged properly to the clergy of the diocese, with the approbation of the laity. His election as Bishop of Brechin in 1727 was declared void by the College of Bishops. He was later elected Bishop of Dunkeld, and became Primus in 1739. An example of piety and strictness of life, he was one of the most learned bishops of his time.

May 13

Our Lady of Fatima

The Blessed Virgin Mary is venerated under this title following apparitions to three shepherd children — Lucia, Jacinta and Francisco — in Portugal in 1917. The message of Fatima includes a call to conversion of heart, repentance from sin and a dedication to the Blessed Virgin Mary, especially through praying the Rosary.

In Rome, the dedication in the former Pantheon of the Church St. Mary and the Martyrs by St. Pope Boniface IV. It was later dedicated to all the saints.

At Tongres, in Belgium, in 384, St. Sevastius, bishop. He was one of the strongest supporters of St. Athanasius in the latter's long struggle against the Arians.

In Cordoba, in 931, Sts. Argentea and Wulfram. Argentea was the daughter of a nobleman who resisted the Moors for many years. At last his sons negotiated a surrender of their castle. Argentea then became a solitary in Cordoba, where she lived with her brother. Wulfram came to Cordoba to preach the gospel, and was quickly arrested. Argentea met him, publicly declared her faith, and was also arrested. Both were executed.

In 2003, René Voillaume, priest. Reading the biography of Charles de Foucauld as a sixteen year old Voillaume was inspired. Once ordained priest, in 1933, he moved to the Algerian desert with companions to live as de Foucauld had lived. The Little Brothers of Jesus eventually spread around the world.

May 14

In the first century, the martyrdom of St. Matthias, apostle. He was chosen to succeed Judas.

In Ireland, in 637, St. Carthach, bishop and abbot. He founded several monasteries, spent some time at Comgall's monastery at Bangor, and finally founded a monastery at Lismore. He died as a hermit at nearby Inch.

In Oslo in 1043, St. Hallvard, martyr. He was sailing his boat in Oslo fjord when a pregnant woman called to him to save her from her enemies. Hallvard rescued her and offered to give them the value of what she had stolen. Unsatisfied with this arrangement, one of them shot both Hallvard and the woman with arrows.

May 15

In Egypt, in 346, St. Pachomius. The son of comparatively wealthy parents, he learned to read and write Coptic in his youth. He was conscripted into the army and, impressed by the kindness of Christians, became a Christian when his military service was over. He became a disciple of the hermit Palamon. Moving to Tabennesi, where disciples gathered around him, he organised a community of monasteries.

About the ninth century, St. Rupert of Bingen, the patron saint of St. Hildegard's monastery there. According to the account of St. Hildegard, Rupert and his mother Bertha lived as hermits at Bingen for a few years before he died at the age of 20.

In 1130, in Spain, St. Isidore the Farmer, who was canonised in 1622 at the same ceremony with Saints Ignatius Loyola, Francis Xavier, Teresa of Avila and Philip Neri. He was a humble peasant who married a peasant girl, Maria de la Cabeza, who is also venerated as a saint. He is patron of Madrid and of the United States National Catholic Rural Life Conference. In art he is shown with a plough.

Edmwnd Prys and John Davies, priests. Edmwnd Prys was born in Llanrwst in 1544 and educated at St John's College, Cambridge. In 1576 he was appointed Rector of Ludlow and Archdeacon of Merioneth, and settled in Tyddyn-du, Maentwrog, which was his home until his death in the year 1623. He was a close friend of William Morgan, whom he assisted with his translation of the Bible. Prys was a gifted Welsh poet, representing a Protestant humanism that wove together the strands of the Renaissance, the Reformation and the skills of the traditional Welsh poetic art. His *Salmau Cân* (1621), a collection of metrical psalms, combines careful translation and high poetic quality. It was reprinted over a hundred times and was used for congregational singing for many generations. He died in the year 1623. John Davies was born in around the year 1567 in Llanferres, Denbighshire, and is renowned as one of the greatest scholars in Welsh history. He graduated from Jesus College, Oxford, and in 1604 became Rector of Mallwyd in Merionethshire where he lived for the remaining forty years of his life. He was responsible for revising the language of the Welsh Bible of 1620, establishing a text that would remain unaltered for over three centuries, and may also have revised the language of the 1621 Welsh Prayer Book. His concern for spiritual well-being led him to translate *Llyfr y Resolusion* from a work by Robert Parsons and to produce a new edition of *Y Llyfr Plygain*, the shortened prayer book intended for use by the laity in their homes. He died in the year 1644.

May 16

Around 250, St. Alexander of Caesarea, bishop of Jerusalem and martyr. He studied in Alexandria. He went to Jerusalem where he was urged to become auxiliary bishop. He succeeded to that see. Origen says he was the kindest of prelates. Eusebius of Caesarea made use of the fine library Alexander assembled at Caesarea.

About 440, in Numidia, St. Possidius, bishop. He was the friend and biographer of St. Augustine. In his diocese of Calama, he worked hard to combat the Donatists, schismatic rigourists who denied the validity of sacraments administered by Catholic bishops who had been unfaithful in times of persecution. He was driven from his diocese by the invading Vandals.

About 575, St. Brendan of Clonfert. He founded several monasteries in southwest Ireland. Mount Brandon is named after him, and he is the hero of the immensely popular medieval story, the Sea Voyage of St. Brendan.

In 1265, in Bourdeaux, St. Simon Stock, who was an important figure of the development of the Carmelite Order. His relics are now venerated at Aylesford in Kent.

In 1657, St. Andrew Bobola, martyr. He was born of Polish parents and joined the Jesuits in Vilnius. He served as parish priest in several churches. Cossack brigands who wanted to expel Catholics from the area captured him and tortured him horribly.

At Highgate in London, in 1877, Caroline Chisholm, social reformer. Caroline Jones was born in 1808. On her marriage to Archibald Chisholm, she took her husband's Roman Catholic faith. They emigrated to Madras in 1831 where she set up a school for soldiers' daughters. In 1838, the family moved to Australia and, almost immediately, Caroline began to work for the vulnerable immigrants arriving at Sydney. She was especially concerned for the women, who were often lured and bullied into brothels. She set up a free Registry Office to help them obtain legitimate work and a shelter and she campaigned for improved conditions. She returned to Britain in 1846 to press for emigration reform and founded the Family Colonisation Loan Society. Her Christian ministry and action led to the ending of what had virtually been the institutionalisation of the abuse of poor women.

May 17

In 1592, in Villareal, St. Paschal Baylon. He came from a family of shepherds and eventually joined the Observant Franciscans at Loreto. He performed various physical tasks in friaries in Spain. Once, during the religious wars in France, he was sent there with letters to the minister general of the order. He was known especially for his devotion to the Eucharist.

May 18

In 526, St. John I, pope and martyr. He was a friend of Boethius. Elected pope, he sought to promote the union of East and West. Theodoric the Goth, the Arian ruler of Italy, sent him to Constantinople to bring an end to the persecution of Arians in the Eastern Empire. John's mission was mostly successful, but Theodoric, fearing a conspiracy, executed Boethius and imprisoned John, who died.

In 1160, St. Eric of Sweden, king and martyr. After consolidating the place of Christianity in Sweden, he tried to spread Christianity in Finland. On the feast of the Ascension he went to Mass in Uppsala. From the church he went out with a few men to meet a large force of Danish soldiers, who killed him.

May 19

In 988, at Canterbury, St. Dunstan, bishop and abbot. He was well educated and spent time at court. He decided to become a monk, but there were no longer any Benedictine monasteries in England. King Edmund gave him Glastonbury, an old monastic site. During a period in exile, he gained first-hand experience of the reformed version of Benedictine life at Ghent. He then became in quick succession bishop of Worcester, London and Canterbury. He collaborated with young King Edgar, and with two other Benedictine reformers: St. Oswald, who revived Westbury-on-Trym and later became a bishop, and St. Ethelwold, who refounded Abingdon and became bishop of Winchester. Under them there was a revival of Benedictine life and culture in England.

In 1296, St. Peter Celestine, pope. Peter joined the Benedictine monastery of Santa Maria di Faifula, but soon became a hermit. Around him there grew up a congregation of Benedictines, whose combination of cenobitic and solitary life resembled that of the Camaldolese. In 1293, when he was over 80, he returned to being a hermit. At 85 he was elected pope. Acknowledging his ineptitude, he soon resigned.

May 20

At York, in 804, Alcuin, deacon. Alcuin was descended from a noble Northumbrian family. Although the date and place of his birth are not known, he was probably born in the year 735 in or near York. He entered the cathedral school there as a child, continued as a Scholar and became Master. In 781, he went to Aachen as adviser to Charlemagne on religious and educational matters and as Master of the Palace School, where he established an important library. Although not a monk and in deacon's orders, in 796 he became Abbot of Tours, where he died in the year 804. Alcuin wrote poetry, revised the lectionary, compiled a sacramentary and was involved in other significant liturgical work.

In 1201, William of Perth (or Rochester). Tradition has it that William was a baker from Perth. Renowned for his acts of charity, he is said to have given every tenth loaf he baked to the poor. He adopted an abandoned boy and brought him up. On pilgrimage to Jerusalem in the year 1201, however, this youth murdered William on the road between Rochester and Canterbury. Though venerated as William of Rochester, he was never canonised.

In 1444, St. Bernardino of Siena. He became a Franciscan and developed a deep commitment to poverty and to study. He became a traveling preacher. One of his favourite themes was devotion to the Holy Name of Jesus. He was also a theological writer of note. He taught moderation in the pursuit of wealth and ethical behaviour in business.

May 21

At Rome in 327, Helena, Protector of the Holy Places. The Empress Helena only achieved power in the Roman Empire when her son Constantine became Emperor, in the year 306. Although she had previously been abandoned by her husband, her son raised her to a position of great honour. As Helena was a Christian she gave her support to their cause and, in the year 326, she made a pilgrimage to the Holy Land. There she provided the wherewithal to found the building of a basilica on the Mount of Olives and another at Bethlehem. According to a much later tradition, she discovered the cross on which Christ was crucified. In the Eastern Church, she is commemorated on this day, together with her son Constantine.

In England, in 1170, St. Godric of Finchale. He was born of an Anglo-Saxon peasant family and became first a peddler, then a maritime trader. He made pilgrimages to Rome, Jerusalem and Compostela. After much soul-searching he became a hermit at Finchale. He became associated with the Benedictine Priory at Durham, but was also esteemed by the Cistercians. He wrote hymns. He died at a very advanced age, nursed by monks from Durham, after spending 60 years at Finchale.

At Jalisco, Mexico, in 1927, St Christopher Magallanes and Companions, martyrs. He was born in Totaltiche, Jalisco (Guadalajara) on July 30, 1869. A priest with a burning faith, a prudent director of his brother priests and pastor full of zeal, he was dedicated to the human and Christian improvement of his faithful. When the persecutors of the Church closed the Seminary of Guadalajara, he offered to found a seminary in his parish to protect, guide and train future priests, and obtained an abundant harvest. On 25 May 1927 he was shot in Colotlán, Jalisco. In front of the executioner he had the strength to comfort his minister and companion of martyrdom, Father Agustín Caloca.

At Tibhirine, in Algeria, 1996, Christian de Chergé and companions, Trappists. Prior of Atlas Abbey, Christian and his community lived a life of service and dialogue with their Muslim neighbours. Rebels raided the monastery and kidnapped seven monks who were murdered on this day.

May 22

In Corsica, in the sixth century, St. Julia, martyr. She was put to death by Saracen raiders.

In 990, St. John of Parma, abbot. He was a contemporary and helper of St. Majolus of Cluny and abbot of the Abbey of St. John in Parma.

In 1310, St. Umiltà of Florence. She was a wife and mother, and then joined the monastery of St. Perpetua near Bologna with her husband. She became an anchoress for twelve years, before being called to found a female branch of the Vaollombrosian Benedictines.

In 1457, St. Rita of Cascia. She was born into a peasant family, who married her to a violent and unfaithful man. When he was killed in a vendetta after they had been married for 18 years, she became a nun. She cared for the sick nuns, counselled visitors, and experienced extraordinary spiritual events.

At Międzybóž, Podolian Voivodeship, Kingdom of Poland, in 1760, the Baal Shem Tov, Jewish mystic. Rabbi Israel ben Eliezer of Mezbizk was the founder of Hassidic Judaism. He communicated great joy and believed in finding the divine in all our actions and in every moment.

May 23

In 259, at Carthage, Sts. Montanus, Lucius and companions, martyrs. These eight martyrs, about whom contemporary accounts survive, were arrested and imprisoned in the same persecution of Valerian as St. Cyprian. They gave calm testimony to their faith, supported each other in love, and were executed by the sword.

At Padstow in Cornwall, in 564, Petroc, abbot. Often known as 'the captain of Cornish saints', Petroc seems to have been the son of a Welsh chieftain who, on arrival in Cornwall, founded a monastery at Lanwethinoc, now called Padstow (from Petroc's Stow), and later on another at Bodmin. Most of his life, however, seems to have been lived as a hermit, though he travelled regularly to visit monasteries. He died at Treravel and was buried at Padstow. Many churches in Devon and Cornwall are dedicated to his memory.

In 1077, St. Leontius of Rostov, bishop and martyr. A monk of the monastery of the Caves at Kiev, he became bishop of Yaroslavl. He did successful missionary work there, but died of mistreatment at the hands of pagans.

In 1173, St. Euphrosyne of Polotsk, in what is now Belarus. The daughter of a prince, she became a nun and then a solitary. She copied books to support herself. She undertook a pilgrimage to Jerusalem and died there.

May 24

On this day in 1738, John Wesley had a profound spiritual experience, often referred to as his 'conversion'. He famously recorded in his Journal:

"About a quarter before nine while [the speaker] was describing the change which God works in the heart through faith in Christ, I felt my heart strangely warmed. I felt I did trust in Christ, Christ alone for my salvation; and an assurance was given me that he had taken away my sins even mine, and saved me from the law of sin and death."

Born at Epworth Rectory in Lincolnshire, John Wesley was the son of an Anglican clergyman and a Puritan mother. He entered Holy Orders and, following a religious experience on this day in 1738, began an itinerant ministry which recognised no parish boundaries. This resulted, after his death, in the development of a world-wide Methodist Church. His spirituality involved an Arminian affirmation of grace, frequent communion and a disciplined corporate search for holiness. His open-air preaching, concern for education and for the poor, liturgical revision, organisation of local societies and training of preachers provided a firm basis for Christian growth and mission in England. John died on 2 March 1791. Charles shared with his brother John the building up of early Methodist societies, as they travelled the country. His special concern

was that early Methodists should remain loyal to Anglicanism. He married and settled first in Bristol and later in London, concentrating his work on the local Christian communities. His thousands of hymns established a resource of lyrical piety which has enabled generations of Christians to re-discover the refining power of God's love. They celebrate God's work of grace from birth to death, the great events of God's work of salvation and the rich themes of eucharistic worship, anticipating the taking up of humanity into the divine life. Charles died on 29 March 1788.

In 450, St. Vincent of Lérins, monk. He is most known for a book he wrote called the *Commonitorium*, which includes criteria for discerning true Christian tradition.

In 592, St. Simeon the Younger, Stylite. He lived for 40 years on top of a pillar near Antioch.

In 1153, St. David of Scotland. He was the youngest son of King Malcolm and St. Margaret. He was orphaned at eight, raised in the court of Henry I, and became king of Scotland in 1124. He was an effective king and a strong supporter of the church. St. Aelred of Rievaulx (January 12), who served in his household before becoming a Cistercian, wrote a panegyric of him.

May 25

In 735, at the abbey of Jarrow in Northumbria, St. Bede the Venerable, monk and doctor of the church. Raised in the monastery, he was educated by abbots Benedict Biscop and Ceolfrith. He lived a quiet, prayerful life of study, in which he was a dedicated teacher not only of his fellow monks but of the Anglo-Saxon people. His biblical commentaries and his *Ecclesiastical History of the English People* are highly esteemed to this day. He spent his last days translating the Gospel of John into English. St. Boniface called him "the candle of the church, lit by the Holy Spirit".

In Somerset in 709, Aldhelm, abbot and bishop. He was a man of intense learning and scholarship who rivalled Bede in ability. He was also eccentric and unconventional. His letters are almost impenetrable due to the overuse of simile, metaphor and alliteration. He also created a collection of one hundred riddles on biblical themes.

Although his letters were difficult to understand, Aldhelm had a desire to communicate the message of the gospel effectively. In an attempt to teach the gospel to the illiterate of his diocese, he wrote hymns which were accompanied by the playing of the harp. Aldhelm would also intersperse his preaching with clowning and songs, and realised the value of entertainment in communicating a message. His aim was to 'win men's ears, and then their souls'.

In 705 Aldhelm became the first Bishop of Sherborne, and continued to rule the monastery at Malmesbury introducing the Benedictine Rule into the community. He founded churches at Sherborne, Wareham and Corfe and several monasteries, including those at Frome and Bradford-on-Avon.

May 26

In the Church of England: At Canterbury in 604 St Augustine, Archbishop of Canterbury. Augustine's date of birth and origins are unknown. What is known is that he was prior of the monastery of St Andrew at Rome in 596 when he was instructed by Pope Gregory the Great to lead a group of 40 monks to England to preach to the heathen English. (Bede recounted the story of Gregory being intrigued by the sight of fairhaired boys in the slave market at Rome and conceiving the idea of a mission to their homeland.) Though Augustine famously turned back to Rome while the mission party was passing through Gaul, this was not so much cold feet on his part as a desire by the highly conscientious Augustine to inform the Pope of the mission party's corporate reticence and to ask his advice. Returning with a papal letter of encouragement, Augustine led the monks on to England, landing at Thanet in Kent in 597.

After some initial wariness, Augustine was well received by King Ethelbert of Kent, whose wife, Bertha, had been brought up in the Christian faith and, indeed, had a Frankish bishop, Luidhard, as her chaplain. Augustine was allowed the use of the old Roman church of St Martin in Canterbury as his base and here he and his

companions established the daily rhythm of the Benedictine Rule. Whether it was the personal influence of the new arrivals or because their presence had emboldened the queen and her chaplain is not known, but very soon afterwards King Ethelbert asked to be instructed in the faith and prepared for baptism. The king's conversion naturally gave a great impetus to the spread of Christianity and though Bede was careful to state that compulsion was not used there can have been few in Kent who could not see that Christianity was the faith of the future. An indication of this was that on Christmas Day, 597, Augustine is said to have baptised more than ten thousand people near the mouth of the Medway. Shortly afterwards he crossed over to Gaul and was consecrated bishop by Virgilius, the Metropolitan of Arles. Ethelbert sponsored a meeting with the existing Celtic bishops in the West of Britain. The conference took place in Malmesbury in 603, but Augustine badly mishandled it, appearing imperious and arrogant. It took another sixty years before an accommodation was reached at the Synod of Whitby. Nevertheless Augustine is revered by Anglicans as the first of a line of over one hundred archbishops, whose enthronement takes place in 'St Augustine's chair' in Canterbury Cathedral. From his day to the present, there has been an unbroken succession of archbishops of Canterbury.

In 1085, St. Gregory VII, pope. He was educated in Rome and spent some time in Cluny, but he does not seem to have become a monk. Elected Pope, he devoted his considerable energies to the movement named after him, "The Gregorian Reform". This movement had two intertwined aims: freedom of the church from secular control, and a celibate clergy appointed for religious reasons only.

At Rome, in 1595, St. Philip Neri. He was born in Florence in 1515, and educated by the Dominicans at San Marco. In 1532 he spent a year at San Germano, during which he frequently visited Monte Cassino. He moved to Rome. He lived a solitary life, supported himself by tutoring, and studied theology from the works of St. Thomas Aquinas. In 1544 he had a mystical experience which changed his life. In 1551 he became a priest. People gathered around him, attracted by his charm, good humour and deep devotion to Christ. They met to discuss a book, prayed, and then either walked to a church or sang. From them developed the Congregation of the Oratory.

At Geneva, on 26 May 1564, John Calvin, reformer. The French reformer John Calvin was born at Noyon in Picardy in 1509 and, since he was intended for an ecclesiastical career, he received the tonsure and his first benefice at the age of twelve, not untypical at this time. It proved to be the only 'order' he ever received. Two years later he began studying theology at Paris but for some reason changed to law and moved to Orléans where he came under his first Protestant influences. He broke with the Roman Church in 1533, having had a religious experience which he believed commissioned him to purify and restore the Church of Christ. The first edition of his *Institutes* appeared in 1536, being basically a justification of Reformation principles. Calvin accepted a position in Geneva which involved organising the Reformation in that city and, with a few absences, spent most of the the rest of his life there, becoming the undisputed master of the moral and ecclesial lives of the citizenry. His pre-eminence could be seen in that he wrote to the Protector Somerset in England indicating to him what changes he felt should be made and corresponded similarly with other nations' leaders. During all this, his literary output never wavered. His immense reputation and influence have continued in the churches of the Reform to the present day. He died on this day in 1564.

May 27

In the Roman Calendar today is commemorated St Augustine of Canterbury.

About 304, at Silistria in Bulgaria, St. Julius. Julius served in the Roman army for seven military campaigns. When he refused to sacrifice to the gods, he explained to the prefect: "It was Christ who died for our sins to give us eternal life. This same, man, Christ, is God and abides for ever and ever. Whoever believes in him will have eternal life."

In Wales in the seventh century. Melangell (or Monacella), abbess, said to have been the daughter of an Irish king. In order to avoid an arranged marriage she fled to Wales, hiding in the remote valley of Pennant (now

Pennant Melangell) in Montgomeryshire. There she lived a life of quiet prayer, which was interrupted one day by Brochwel Ysgithrog, prince of Powys. He was hunting a hare which took refuge under the folds of Melangell's cloak. Melangell made such an impression on Brochwel that, once he had heard her story, he gave her the valley of Pennant to be a sanctuary for ever. She gathered around her a community of holy women. Hares became known as 'wyn Melangell' ('Melangell's lambs') in Pennant Melangell and were specially protected there. Melangell's shrine has recently been restored and her beautiful and peaceful valley is once again a place of pilgrimage.

May 28

At Canterbury on the 24th May in 1089, Lanfranc, Archbishop. Lanfranc was born in Pavia, Italy, around the year 1005. At the age of thirty-five, he became a monk of Bec, in Normandy, where he founded the school which rose rapidly to renown throughout Europe. In 1062 William of Normandy appointed him Abbot of Caen, then in 1070 Archbishop of Canterbury. Lanfranc was a great ecclesiastical statesman, overseeing administrative, judicial and ecclesial reforms with the same energy and rigour that the Conqueror displayed in his new kingdom. Lanfranc did not forget his monastic formation: he wrote Constitutions for Christchurch, Canterbury, based on the customs of Bec, and appointed many Norman abbots to implement his vision in the English abbeys.

At Paris, in 576, St. Germanus. He lived a quasi-monastic life for about fifteen years, then was ordained. He was made abbot of St. Symphorien in Autun, then bishop of Paris. He took care of the poor, worked for peace, and promoted the veneration of the saints. He was buried at Saint-Germain-des-Pres.

In 812, at Gellone, St. William. William was the son of the count of Toulouse, and served at Charlemagne's court. He led successful campaigns against the Moors, and was appointed duke of Aquitaine. He founded monasteries for men and women at Gellone, with the help of Benedict of Aniane. Later he abandoned his weapons at the church of St. Julian at Brioude and entered his monastery at Gellone.

In 1117, St. Gizur of Iceland. He was the grandson of Gizur the White, one of the first Icelandic rulers to embrace Christianity.

May 29

At Rome on 6th August 1978 Pope Paul VI. Giovanni Battista Montini was born on 26 September 1897 in the village of Concesio, in the province of Brescia, Lombardy. He was ordained priest on 29 May 1920 and worked in the Roman Curia, the Vatican civil service, until he was made Archbishop of Milan in 1954. He was elected Pope on 21 June 1963, successfully saw the Vatican Council through to its completion, promoted the renewal of the Church's life and especially of the liturgy. He also promoted ecumenical dialogue and the proclamation of the Gospel to the modern world. He was canonised by Pope Francis in 2018.

About 347, St. Maximinus, bishop of Trier. He was a fearless opponent of Arianism, and gave aid to St. Athanasius and St. Paul of Constantinople when they were banished by Arian rulers.

May 30

In Northumberland in 1906 on December 30th, Josephine Butler (née Grey) worker for social justice. Josephine was born in April 1828, and baptised on this day that year, in Northumberland. She married an Anglican priest in 1852. She became incensed by the way contemporary society treated prostitutes. From 1869, she campaigned for the repeal of the legislation which put all opprobrium onto the women concerned. The issue became international after she travelled in Europe addressing meetings in 1874–5. Her campaign succeeded with the repeal of the Contagious Diseases Act in 1883. She was a devout Anglican and a woman of prayer, basing her spirituality on that of Catherine of Siena, whose biography she wrote.

In 727, St. Hubert of Liège. He succeeded St. Lambert as bishop of Maastricht and worked as a missionary in the Ardenne. He is patron of hunters.

In 1431, at Rouen, St. Joan of Arc. She declared that she had visions from God which instructed her to lead France to victory in its protracted war with England. She was captured in battle, and though she defended herself courageously, was convicted of heresy in a politically motivated trial. She was turned over to the English, and at the age of nineteen was burned at the stake. As she died she called on the name of Jesus. In 1456, the Pope declared her innocent of the charges.

In Uganda in 1933, Apolo Kivebulaya, Priest, Evangelist in Central Africa. Apolo Kivebulaya's first contact with Christian teaching was in 1884 and he was baptised the following year, becoming a teacher in the Church of Uganda. He went as an evangelist and catechist to Boga in the Belgian Congo and was ordained priest in 1903. He built many churches and prepared countless catechumens for baptism. He spent the rest of his life at Boga, training teachers, supervising the school and evangelising the people of the forest. His greatest achievement was the translation of St Mark's Gospel, apparently from the Lunyoro version, into the pygmy language. After his death on this day in the year 1933, the Church Missionary Society sent British missionaries to carry on his work.

May 31

The Church today recalls the visit of Mary to her cousin Elizabeth, as recorded in Luke's Gospel. The celebration of the feast first occurred at a Franciscan Order General Chapter in 1263, but quickly spread throughout Europe. Since it is a celebration clearly described in the gospel, the Churches of the Reformation were less inclined to proscribe it than they were other Marian feasts, particularly as it was the occasion for Mary to sing her great hymn of praise in honour of her Lord and God, the 'Magnificat'. Just as Luke sees John the Baptist as the last of the prophets of the old covenant, he uses John's leaping in Elizabeth's womb as the first time John bears witness to Christ as the promised Messiah. Thereby he links the old covenant with the new. He seems to be saying that just as the old covenant clearly points to Jesus, so does its last prophet, yet to be born.

June

June 1

The Most Precious Blood of Our Lord Jesus Christ

Around 165, in Rome, St. Justin Martyr. Justin was a Greek, born in Samaria. He studied various philosophies in a quest for the vision of God. One day on the seashore he met an old man who told him about the Hebrew prophets and Christianity, and Justin's search was ended. He became a Christian philosopher at Ephesus, and then at Rome. There he wrote his major works of Christian apologetics. He taught that the divine Logos had been at work throughout human history to prepare the world for His coming in the flesh. Justin was beheaded with six other Christians under Marcus Aurelius.

In 1035, at Trier, St. Simeon of Syracuse. Born in Sicily, he was educated at Constantinople and became a monk in the Sinai. He was sent on a harrowing journey to Normandy to raise funds for his monastery. On the way he became friends with Abbot Richard of Verdun and Abbot Eberwin of Trier. After accompanying Archbishop Poppo of Trier on a pilgrimage to Palestine, he returned to Trier where he became an anchorite.

June 2

In 177, the martyrs of Lyons and Vienne, whose fate is described in a letter preserved in the Ecclesiastical History of Eusebius. Lyons was terminus of a trade route to the Eastern Mediterranean, and the Christians there had close ties with the church in Asia Minor. At Lyons, they were at first ostracised, then accused of treason and cannibalism. A number were arrested and tortured and executed. Throughout their ordeal, these martyrs showed remarkable charity for their persecutors.

In 304, at Rome, Saints Marcellinus and Peter. They were arrested and then beheaded for their faith. They are commemorated in the first Eucharistic Prayer. Constantine built a church over their tomb, and his mother, St. Helena, was buried there.

At New York, in 1987, Anthony de Mello, priest. An Indian Jesuit, de Mello used stories and a playful spirit to enable people to 'wake up'. He imparted great freshness to meditation techniques and to communicating the gospel and was in much demand as a retreat giver.

June 3

In Uganda, in 1886, St. Charles Lwanga and companions. The unstable young king, Mwanga was angered when Christian pages in his court would not yield to his sexual advances. Most of them were burned to death, and they prayed as they died. After Mwanga's death, Christianity advanced rapidly in his territory. Anglicans and Roman Catholics unite on this day to remember those who witnessed in Uganda for Christ, even unto death.

In 545, at Tours, St. Clothilde. A Burgundian Christian, she married Clovis, king of the Franks, about 492. Four years later he was baptised at Rheims. After his death in 511, Clothilde tried to keep peace among her unruly relatives. She eventually retired to Tours, where she devoted herself to prayer and almsgiving.

About 618, at Glendalough, St. Kevin. He was educated by monks and ordained a priest. He became a hermit at the upper lake at Glendalough and established a monastery for those who gathered around him. Many stories are told about his fondness for animals.

At Rome, in 1963, Saint John XXIII, pope. He was born of a poor family in the Piedmont, attended a seminary, and earned a doctorate in theology in Rome. He worked as secretary to Bishop Giacomo Radini-Tadeschi of Bergamo, taught in the diocesan seminary, edited the diocesan newspaper, and began a lifelong project of editing the visitation documents of St. Charles Borromeo. He was conscripted and served terms

of military service both before and after his ordination. In 1925 he was sent as apostolic visitor to Bulgaria, where he spent ten frustrating years. Then he was sent as apostolic delegate to Greece and Turkey. There he set up a network to help people escape from the Nazis. Next he served as papal nuncio to France. In 1953 he was made cardinal and patriarch of Venice. In 1958 he was elected pope, and set himself to opening the church to dialogue with contemporary society's needs, achievements and aspirations, so that the church could bring Christ to the world. To that end he called the Second Vatican Council. He also wrote several important social encyclicals. He died in 1963, after the council was well under way. The Roman Calendar observes his feast on 11th October, the day of the opening session of the Second Vatican Council in 1962.

June 4

In 308, at Sisak in Croatia, Quirinus, bishop and martyr. After a spirited defense of his faith before a magistrate, Quirinus was beaten. According to contemporary accounts, he said: "I am exercising my priesthood here and now by offering myself up to God." He was finally tossed into the Raab River with a millstone tied around his neck. His body is buried in Santa Maria in Trastevere.

In 387 in North Africa, St. Optatus of Milevis, bishop. He was an apologist for the Catholic church against the Donatists, who differed in their understanding of the sacraments, an argument which had its beginnings in what they regarded as infidelity and laxity among some clergy during the persecution of Diocletian. Optatus insisted on the catholicity of the church and the need to be in communion with the bishop of Rome.

At Padstow in the sixth century, Petroc Abbot. The large number of ancient church dedications to Petroc (also known as Pedrog) suggests that he was of outstanding importance among British Celtic saints, though little reliable historical information is available. He seems to have been the son of a Welsh chieftain who, on arrival in Cornwall, founded a monastery at Lanwethinoc, now called Padstow (from Petrockstowe), which became the chief centre for his monastic and missionary activities. He seems to have lived as a hermit for most of his life, and is said in later life to have withdrawn to a hermitage on Bodmin Moor. He died at Treravel and was buried at Padstow, though by the eleventh century the Augustinian Canons at Bodmin claimed to possess his relics. He is justly honoured as the 'captain of Cornish saints'.

June 5

In Frisia, in 754, St. Boniface, bishop and martyr, the apostle of Germany. He was born in Devon, and educated in a local monastery and then at the abbey of Nursling, where he was a very effective teacher. When he was forty, following in the footsteps of Sts. Wilfrid and Willibrord, he left England to do missionary work in Frisia and Germany. With a mandate from Pope Gregory II, he evangelised and organised the German church. He founded many monasteries, and recruited missionaries from English monasteries, such as his cousin Lull, who succeeded him as archbishop of Mainz, Sturm, abbot of Fulda, Burchard, bishop of Würzburg, and Lioba, abbess of Bischofstein. In 741, Boniface was called to reorganise the Frankish church. In his old age, he resigned his positions and went back to Frisia as a missionary. There, while waiting for some candidates for Confirmation, his party was attacked by robbers. He refused to fight back and was killed. Christopher Dawson judged that Boniface "had a deeper influence on the history of Europe than any [other] Englishman who ever lived."

June 6

In Papua New Guinea in 1945, Ini Kopuria Founder of the Melanesian Brotherhood. As a native policeman, Ini Kopuria's job took him all over Guadalcanal in the Solomon Islands, but a vision of Jesus, calling him to do different work for his people, led him to a life of evangelism in which he aimed to take and live the gospel in the remotest villages and islands in Melanesia. He began a Brotherhood for Melanesians in 1925 and, with help from his bishop, prepared a Rule and made vows himself in which he dedicated his life and his land to God. Men were asked to make only a five-year commitment to service within the community and many

came to join him and stayed for much longer. It quickly grew into one of the largest religious communities in the Anglican Communion and its method of evangelism proved highly effective.

In 550, St Jarlath of Tuam, bishop. Very little is known of this saint. He is said to have belonged to a noble family in County Galway and to have been a disciple of Enda. He founded a monastery at Cluain Fois; later he moved two miles away to Tuam, of which he is asserted to have been bishop. His life and learning lie behind the Christian traditions in the diocese where St Mary's Cathedral stands on the site of the earliest place of worship. The chancel arch, which marks the entrance to the sanctuary, is strikingly composed of six semi-circular concentric and recessed arches. This impressive example of Hiberno-Romanesque architecture is justly famous.

At Magdeburg, in 1134, St. Norbert, bishop and founder of the Premonstratensian Order. Born into a noble family, he underwent a radical conversion when he was thrown from his horse. He was ordained, gave away his possessions, and with papal permission, became a traveling preacher. He founded a very austere monastery for Canons Regular at Premontre in 1121, which became the head of a large order. He was made bishop of Magdeburg in 1126.

In the first century, St. Philip the Deacon. In art he is usually shown baptising the eunuch of the Queen of Ethiopia.

In 1840, St. Marcellin Champagnat. While he was in the seminary, he and some of his fellow seminarians conceived the plan to found religious orders of priests, sisters and brothers dedicated to Mary. During the next twenty-five years Fr. Champagnat worked toward that end and was the founder of the Marist Brothers.

June 7

In Eichstätt, in 786, St. Willibald. He was the son of St. Richard, nephew of St. Boniface, and brother to St. Winnibald and St. Walburga. His father died at Lucca while he was on a pilgrimage to Rome, and Willibald went on to the Holy Land. When he returned, he spent ten years at Monte Cassino, which had recently been restored by Pope Gregory II. About 740 the pope sent Willibald to help St. Boniface in Germany. Willibald became bishop of Eichstätt and founded the double monastery at Heidenheim, where he lived while he was bishop for forty-five years.

In Ireland, in the sixth century, St. Colman of Dromore, bishop and monk. He was a disciple of St. Ailbhe of Emly. He built a monastery at Dromore and was the first bishop there. St. Finnian of Moville was his disciple.

In Antwerp, in 1626, Blessed Anne of St. Bartholomew. She was a peasant girl who became the first lay sister to be professed at St. Teresa of Avila's reformed monastery. She was St. Teresa's traveling companion and was with Teresa when she died. Six years later Anne was sent with a group of sisters to found a convent at Paris. There she was yielded to the urging of her fellow sisters and made profession as a nun. She became superior at several convents before she founded one in Antwerp, where she was greatly venerated.

June 8

In 560, at Saint-Quentin, St. Médard, bishop. He became a priest when he was 33, and was an outstanding preacher and missionary. He was ordained bishop by St. Remy. Medieval tradition invoked him as an intercessor for those suffering from toothache.

At Longleat in Wiltshire, on 19th March in 1711, Thomas Ken Bishop of Bath & Wells, Non-Juror, Hymn Writer, 1711 Thomas Ken was born at Berkhamstead in 1637 and educated at New College, Oxford. He was ordained priest in 1662 and worked first in a poor parish in the diocese of Winchester and then at Winchester College for ten years. He served as chaplain to King Charles II for two years and was then

consecrated Bishop of Bath and Wells. After the king's death and the accession of the Roman Catholic James II, the new king proposed to rescind the Restoration penal laws, but Thomas and six of his fellow bishops refused to comply with this and were imprisoned on this day in 1688. Such was the integrity of Thomas that, when the king abandoned his throne and fled and the king's Protestant daughter Mary was offered the throne, together with her husband William of Orange, Thomas felt unable in good conscience to forswear his living, anointed monarch. He was deprived of his See, along with many other non-jurors, as they became known, and for a time there was schism in the Anglican fold. Thomas spent his final twenty years in quiet retirement, anxious not to make trouble, and renounced his rights to his bishopric. He wrote many hymns, still much used.

In 1926, in Kerela, India, Blessed Mariam Theresia Chiramel Mankidiyan. Her mother died when Mariam was twelve, and Mariam had to leave school. She and some companions became very involved in the life of their parish. Mariam had many mystical experiences, some of them controversial. She and her companions eventually formed a religious order, which has prospered in India.

At Dublin, in 1889, Gerard Manley Hopkins, priest, poet. A convert to Catholicism, Hopkins initially believed his Jesuit vocation meant he should not write or publish poetry. Spending most of his life in obscure parish placements it was only after his death that his poetry, with its dynamic use of rhythm gained popularity.

June 9

In 373, in Syria, St. Ephraem, deacon and doctor of the church. When he was 18, he was baptised in Nisibia. When the Persians took over the city, he went to live in a cave near Edessa, and there he wrote the theological works and hymns that earned him designation as a doctor of the church. Near the end of his life, he was chosen to oversee distribution of food supplies in the Edessa region during a famine, because he could be counted on to be honest and impartial.

In 597, at Iona, St. Columba or Columcille. He was born in Donegal of parents of royal descent. He was ordained a priest and founded monasteries at Derry, Durrow and Kells. He loved learning. When he was forty he and some companions moved to Iona, from where they evangelised the inhabitants of Scotland. He wrote poetry and was transcribing a psalter the day before he died. For the next century, Iona was a great centre of evangelisation, particularly for Northumbria.

The first Book of Common Prayer came into use on the Day of Pentecost, June 9th, 1549.

June 10

In England, about 656, St. Ithamar of Rochester, the first Anglo-Saxon to be consecrated a bishop.

June 11

In the first century, St. Barnabas, apostle. Barnabas was a Levite born on Cyprus. His original name was Joseph, but he was called "son of encouragement", probably because of his cheerful disposition. He sold his property and shared the money with the rest of the disciples. He partnered with Paul on many missionary endeavours.

In 888, St. Rembert, archbishop of Bremen-Hamburg. Rembert was a monk of the Belgian monastery of Torhout, when St. Anskar called him to assist with the mission to Scandinavia. He succeeded Anskar as bishop and wrote his predecessor's life.

June 12

In the Egyptian desert, about 400, St. Onuphrius, a hermit.

Near Stockholm, about 1080, St. Eskil, bishop, who was martyred when he urged Christians not to take part in a pagan ceremony.

John Skinner and John Skinner Priest, 1807; and Bishop, 1816 John Skinner the elder was born at Birse in Aberdeenshire in 1721. After studying at Aberdeen he was appointed schoolmaster at Monymusk, where he became an Episcopalian. He was ordained in 1742, and served the charge of Longside for sixty-five years. A devoted pastor and man of liberal sympathies, he was a noted historian and a considerable poet. In 1753 he was imprisoned under the Penal Laws for six months for conducting worship, and his son John, then nine, shared his imprisonment. He died in the year 1807. This son, as incumbent of the Longacre Chapel in Aberdeen, was made coadjutor Bishop of Aberdeen in 1782, succeeding to the See in 1786. In 1788 he was elected Primus. Three notable events are associated with him: the consecration of Bishop Seabury for the Episcopal Church in America in 1784, the death of Prince Charles Edward shortly after he became Primus, and the repeal of the Penal Laws –largely as a result of his persistent efforts –in 1792. His wisdom and statesmanlike qualities guided the Episcopal Church as it emerged from long years of adversity, and laid the foundations for its future advance, not least by helping to make possible the union of many of the Qualified Chapels with the Scottish Episcopal Church. He died in the year 1816.

June 13

Evagrius Ponticus, a monk and spiritual master of the Egyptian desert, died on the feast of the Epiphany in the year 399. Ordained a lector by St Basil, he became a member of the clergy of Caesarea, where he remained faithful to his bishop until the latter's death. He then moved to Constantinople and was ordained a deacon by his friend Gregory of Nazianzus, who asked Evagrius to join forces with him in the arduous struggle against the Arians. After Gregory left Constantinople, Evagrius spent a certain amount of time serving the new patriarch Nettarius, until a dramatic sequence of events "exiled Evagrius to the desert," in his own words. His spiritual struggle in the desert, not entirely chosen but fully accepted, was not without fruit. There Evagrius worked out a synthesis of theology and practical monasticism that was unique for his time. His sensitivity to psychological issues and his finely tuned analytical skills made him one of the greatest spiritual guides in antiquity. Maximus the Confessor, Isaac the Syrian, and Symeon the New Theologian, to name only the best-known fathers, all looked to Evagrius for inspiration.

In 1231, near Padua, St. Anthony, doctor of the church. He was born in Portugal and became a canon regular at Coïmbra, where he spent eight years in prayer and study. He joined the Franciscans and was sent to Morocco as a missionary. He became ill in Africa and went to Italy, where he met St. Francis and became a renowned preacher and teacher of theology. He died at the age of 36. It is thought that the tradition which makes him the patron for finding lost articles originates from an incident when a novice ran away with his psalter. Anthony's prayer that it be returned was answered, when a heavenly vision commanded the novice to return the psalter.

At Beaconsfield in 1936, Gilbert Keith Chesterton, writer. Born in 1874, Chesterton was one the intellectual giants of his day, and was known for his writing that spanned fields as diverse as literary criticism, fiction and fantasy, satire, and Christian apologetics. As a young man, Chesterton had been fascinated with spiritualism and the occult, but his faith grew stronger over the years, as he devoted himself to the defence of what he called "orthodoxy," which was for him, among other things, an acknowledgement of the mystery and paradox of Christian faith in an age of increasing skepticism. His spiritual journey toward the ancient faith of the Church culminated in his conversion to the Roman Catholic Church in 1922.

At Jerusalem, in 1965, Martin Buber, philosopher. Buber's book *I and Thou*, is rightly seen as a landmark text in which he shows how when we treat others as objects we ourselves are diminished. Fleeing Nazi Germany for Jerusalem Buber went on to cross faith boundaries in the extent of his influence. His collections of Hasidic tales contain much wisdom and spiritual insight.

June 14

The commemoration of the prophet Elisha whose story is told in the First and Second Book of Kings. Elisha, the son of Shaphat - who was, according to tradition, a prosperous farmer of the Jordan valley - received his prophetic vocation through Elijah's mediation.

His task was that of continuing the legacy of Elijah's prophetic work, as two biblical episodes recount: the story of Elisha's call to the prophetic life, and the narrative of Elijah's ascension into heaven in a fiery chariot. The two-thirds of Elijah's spirit requested by Elisha represent the portion of inheritance that firstborn sons received from their families in that time.

Elisha, whose name means "God saves," carried out his ministry during the second half of the ninth century BCE. He announced the life-giving power of Israel's God with his words and with works done in God's name, for the benefit of the poor and the suffering in particular. In the Northern Kingdom he courageously called for faithfulness to the one God in a time of uncertainty with regard to the future of the monarchy in Israel.

Elisha died at the beginning of the eighth century BCE, after giving his last instructions to Joash, king of Israel.

In Wales, around 500, St. Dogmael. Little is known about him, though he seems to have been active in south Wales and later in Brittany. His name was perpetuated at St. Dogmael's abbey, of which Caldey was a cell.

In Constantinople, in 847, St. Methodius, patriarch. He was born and educated in Sicily and went to Constantinople to secure a government job. Influenced by a monk whom he met there, he joined a monastery, then built his own monastery on the island of Chios. He went to Rome to secure the support of Pope Paschal for those who defended the use of holy images against the revived iconoclasm of Emperor Leo V, the Armenian. When he returned to Constantinople he was thrown into prison for seven years and treated very badly. When the empress Theodora reversed the iconoclastic policies of her predecessors, Methodius was released from prison and appointed patriarch. He instituted the annual Festival of Orthodoxy, still observed on the first Sunday of Lent, and wrote the creedal Synodicon, which is read during the Festival.

In London in 1691, Richard Baxter Puritan Divine. Richard Baxter was born at Rowton in Shropshire in 1615. In 1633 he was at the court of Charles I, but was so disgusted with the low moral standards there that he returned home in order to study divinity. He was ordained but after the promulgation of an infamous Oath in 1640, which required obedience to a string of persons ending in the trite phrase 'et cetera', he rejected belief in episcopacy in its current English form, and went as a curate to a poor area of the West Midlands. He opposed the Civil War and played a prominent part in the recall of Charles II, but his continuing dissatisfaction with the way episcopacy was practised led him to decline the See of Hereford. This refusal led him to be debarred from further office in the Church, though he continued to contribute to its life as a prolific hymn writer. His writings breathe a spirit of deep unaffected piety and moderation, and his book *The Reformed Pastor*, published in 1656, illustrates the great care he took in his pastoral organisation.

June 15

In Rome, during the persecution of Diocletian around 300, Sts. Vitus, Modestus and Crescentia. During the Middle Ages, St. Vitus was one of the Fourteen Holy Helpers. His intercession was invoked for epilepsy and similar conditions.

In Egypt, about 380, St. Orsiesius, who was chosen by the Pachomian monks as a successor to St. Pachomius.

At Pibrac, near Toulouse, in 1601, St. Germaine. She was a poor child with physical disabilities. Her parents segregated her from her healthy step-siblings and when she was old enough, put her to work tending sheep. Gradually, she was recognised as a holy woman. She died at the age of twenty-two.

In London, in 1941, Evelyn Underhill, Spiritual Writer, 1941 Born in 1875, Evelyn Underhill was in her thirties before she began to explore religion. At first, she wrote on the mystics, most notably in her book *Mysticism*, published in 1911. Her spiritual journey brought her in 1921 back to the Church of England, in which she had been baptised and confirmed. From the mid-1920s, she became highly-regarded as a retreat conductor and an influential spiritual director. Of her many books *Worship*, published in 1936, embodied her approach to what she saw as the mystery of faith.

June 16

In the last half of the sixth century, St. Aurelian. He was bishop of Arles and papal vicar for Gaul. He founded monasteries for men and women and wrote a rule for them. He corresponded with Pope Virgilius, cautioning him to proceed circumspectly in the controversy over the synod of the "three chapters", at which the emperor had condemned works of Theodore of Mopsuestia, Theodoret of Cyr, and Ibas of Edessa.

In 1106, St. Benno of Meissen, bishop. He was a monk at Hildesheim, then bishop of Meissen. He was entangled in a controversy between the emperor Henry IV and the Saxon nobility, and again in the investiture struggle between the emperor and the papacy. He was exiled and spent time as a missionary to the Slavs. Martin Luther was vehemently opposed to Benno's canonization in 1523.

In 1246, at Aywières near Liège, St. Lutgard. Sent to a Benedictine convent school, she was a worldly young girl until she had a conversion experience, which brought her close to Christ. When she was twenty-four she sought a stricter monastic life and moved to the Cistercian monastery at Aywières. Although she never mastered the French spoken there, she became a highly esteemed counselor and healer.

At Dover, in 1253, Richard, Bishop of Chichester. 1253 Richard de Wych (or of Droitwich as it is now known), was born there in 1197 and worked hard for his yeoman father to restore the family fortunes. Later he studied at Oxford and Paris and then in Bologna as an ecclesiastical lawyer. When he returned to England in 1235, he was made Chancellor of Oxford, and eventually Chancellor to the Archbishop of Canterbury, Edmund of Abingdon. When Richard eventually became Bishop of Chichester, he was seen as a model diocesan bishop: progressing around his diocese on foot, visiting and caring for his clergy and people, generally being accessible to all who needed his ministry. He insisted that the sacraments be administered without payment and with a proper dignity. Whilst on a recruitment campaign for the Crusades, he fell ill at Dover and died there on 3 April 1253. His mortal remains were translated to Chichester on this day in the year 1276.

In Strasbourg in 1361, John Tauler, priest. A Dominican and one of the best loved Christian witnesses of the medieval West. Born into a wealthy family, John entered the Dominican convent of Strasbourg at the age of fourteen and received a traditional scientific, theological and spiritual education. He lived in a time of serious contradictions to the Gospel, even within his Order, which on more than one occasion had necessitated a direct intervention on the part of the Dominican general chapter. All of this motivated John to reevaluate his faith in depth. To remedy the decadence he saw in the spiritual lives of both religious and lay Christians, Tauler formed the "friends of God," groups of Christians committed to living a life of faith more firmly centered on listening to the Gospel and on personal prayer. For years, Tauler was involved in intense apostolic activity in the Dominican convents of Alsace and in the Beguinnages of the region, where he taught an approach to seeking the experience of God's presence that was inspired both by the theological vision of the church fathers and by the mysticism of Meister Eckhart. Under his guidance, entire generations of Christians discovered a spirituality that sustained them in their everyday lives of faithfulness to the Gospel. At his death, Tauler left a collection of Sermons that stand out in medieval mystical literature for their clarity and restraint.

At Durham in 1752, Joseph Butler, bishop. Born in 1692 at Wantage, Joseph Butler was the son of Presbyterian parents and studied at the dissenting academy of Tewkesbury. He abandoned Presbyterianism in 1714 for the Church of England and, after studying at Oxford, was ordained priest in 1718 and began preaching the sermons which won him his fine reputation. He became Bishop of Durham and is ranked among the greatest exponents of natural theology and ethics in England since the Reformation.

June 17

In the fourth century, St. Bessarion, a monk of the Egyptian desert, renowned for his fasting and dispossession.

In the fifth century, St. Hypatius, founder and abbot of a monastery near Chalcedon. He was a defender of orthodox Christology against Nestorianism, a heresy which undercut the unity of Christ's two natures in a single divine person.

In Pisa, about 1161, St. Rainerius, the patron of the city. He was a merchant who converted, spent time in Palestine, and finally returned to Pisa where he lived in association with several monasteries, but never took vows.

Samuel and Henrietta Barnett Social Reformers, 1913 & 1936 Samuel Augustus Barnett was born in Bristol in 1844 and educated at Wadham College, Oxford. To trace the beginnings of great movements is always difficult, but it is clear that following his ordination, Samuel was closely concerned with the inception of the Charity Organisation Society, and worked alongside Octavia Hill. From 1873 to 1894, he was Vicar of St Jude's Whitechapel, where his unorthodox methods, including evening schools and entertainments, aroused much criticism. However, he soon became recognized as a loyal priest, devoted to the religious and cultural improvement of the East End of London. In all his work, Samuel was ably assisted by Henrietta his wife. Henrietta Octavia Weston Rowland was born in Clapham in 1851 and, before her marriage to Samuel in 1873, had been a co-worker with Octavia Hill. In her later years she founded Hampstead Garden Suburb; a community in which all classes might live together. Samuel's spiritual gifts, combined with Henrietta's robust energy and assertive personality, made for a dynamic expression of Christian faith. Samuel died on this day at Hove in 1913; Henrietta died at Hampstead Garden Suburb on 10 June 1936.

June 18

About 431, St. Amandus of Bordeaux, bishop. St. Paulinus of Nola was instructed in Christianity by Amandus. Paulinus tells us that Amandus was raised a Christian, was well instructed in the Scriptures, and lived an exemplary life.

In 1165, St. Elizabeth of Schönau. She went to the Benedictine monastery of Schönau when she was twelve. Eleven years later, coping with a bout of depression, she had the first of many visionary experiences. Like Hildegard of Bingen, with whom she corresponded, she issued prophetic calls for Christians to be true to the vocations God had given them. She left behind a considerable body of writing which survives in numerous manuscripts.

In Zimbabwe in 1896, Bernard Mizeki apostle of the MaShona, martyr. Born in Portuguese East Africa, Bernard Mizeki went to work in Cape Town and there he was converted to the Christian faith by the Cowley Fathers (The Society of St John the Evangelist). He then gave his life as a translator and evangelist among the MaShona in what is present day Zimbabwe. He was murdered on this day in 1896 in a tribal uprising and is revered throughout Central Africa as a witness to the gospel of Christ. The site of his martyrdom has become an important place of pilgrimage for many Africans.

June 19

At Val-di-Castro, in 1027, St. Romuald, abbot. After seeing his aristocratic father kill a relative in a duel, he joined the Cluniac monastery at San Apollinare-in-Classe near Ravenna. He became a hermit and founded hermitages in northern Italy. Peter Damian was his disciple, and together they established Fonte Avellana and Camaldoli, austere eremitical communities following the Rule of St. Benedict.

In Milan, in the second century, Sts. Gervase and Protase. St. Ambrose discovered their relics in the presence of St. Paulinus of Nola and St. Augustine. While their relics were being carried to the newly constructed cathedral, a blind man was cured.

In 1009, at Braunsberg. St. Boniface of Querfurt, bishop and martyr. Influenced by St. Romuald, he became a monk. Inspired by St. Adalbert of Prague, whose life he wrote, he became a missionary among the Slavs. He was murdered with eighteen companions while trying to evangelize Prussian tribes.

In 1113, Blessed Odo of Cambrai. A renowned teacher of the arts and sciences, he was moved by a book of St. Augustine to become a monk. He refounded the monastery of St. Martin, which adopted the Rule of St. Benedict and soon became a flourishing community of sixty monks and sixty nuns. He was made bishop, but was forced into exile by Emperor Henry V, and spent much of his last seven years writing books of theology.

In Tibet in 1929, Sundar Singh of India, Sadhu, Evangelist, Teacher of the Faith. Born of wealthy Sikh parents, Sundar Singh was converted to Christianity after experiencing a vision. He was baptised in the Anglican Church at Simla in 1905. In an endeavour to present Christianity in a Hindu form, he donned the robes of a 'Sadhu' or holy man and travelled much around the Indian sub-continent. He even made a visit to Tibet, where he persisted in strenuous work, despite ill-health. He went missing there, presumed murdered.

June 20

In the early third century, at St. Alban's, St. Alban, martyr. He was evidently a Roman citizen who became a Christian and then was martyred with his Christian mentor, who is honoured as St. Amphibalus.

Julius and Aaron are the first Welsh citizens whose names are known to us. Gildas records that they were citizens of Caerleon-on-Usk, who died for their faith during the persecution by the Emperor Diocletian (c. 304–5). The Book of Llandaff mentions a church dedicated to them which was perhaps built over their graves. It is clear that the memory of these two Romano-British martyrs continued to be venerated without a gap from the Roman period through into medieval times and beyond. Their death provides us with a tenuous but potent link with the very beginnings of Christianity in Britain.

Fillan Abbot, eighth century Fillan (Faelan, Fulan), a common Irish name, was borne by several saints. The eighth-century Fillan was of Irish birth, became a monk and accompanied his uncle Congan (Corrigan) to Scotland. He was a solitary at Pittenweem, Fife, where he was chosen as abbot. After some years he resigned and retreated to Glendochart. His name is associated also with Lochalsh, Renfrewshire and Strathfillan in the vicinity of Killin and Crianlarich, where an abbey bearing his name was built. A well with his name has long been associated with cures for mental ailments. His memory was held in great affection, and relics, especially his staff and bell, played an important part in later Scottish history.

In 537, near Naples, St. Silverius, pope and martyr. For his opposition to Monophysitism, he was arrested by Belisarius, Justinian's general, taken into exile, and then returned to Italy, where he died of ill treatment.

In Thessalonika between 1391 and 1397, Nicola Cabasilas, a lay theologian and the author of some of the most important spiritual treatises in Byzantine Christianity. Nicholas was born in Thessalonika around the year 1322, into one of the city's well-established middle class families. He learned the prayer of the heart from a disciple of Gregory Palamas, and received an advanced legal and literary education at Constantinople's academy of philosophy, eventually earning a reputation as one of the greatest Byzantine humanists. The era in which he lived was rife with ecclesial and political tensions, and Nicola played an

important role in settling disputes at court and in helping resolve the controversies that had arisen regarding the teaching of the hesychasts of Mt. Athos. He also wrote important treatises, calling for social justice and condemning the practice of usury.

The election of Kallistos I as Patriarch of Constantinople seemed to forecast better times for the Byzantine world, and Cabasilas decided to withdraw from public life. In peace and silence he placed his profound human and spiritual maturity at the service of his contemporaries, writing *The Interpretation of the Holy Liturgy* and *Life in Christ*. These are full-fledged spiritual manuals accessible to lay readers, who are called, as are all Christians, to become holy as they live their daily lives. According to Cabasilas, believers are sanctified through the sacraments and prayer, which allow each person to welcome Christ into his or her heart. Nicholas died sometime between the years 1391 and 1397, without leaving a word of testimony about the last years of his life. He was canonised, in 1983, by the Patriarchate of Constantinople.

June 21

At Rome, in 1591, St. Aloysius Gonzaga. Over the objections of his powerful family, he joined the Society of Jesus. He embraced a regime of severe mortification. At 23, he died while ministering to victims of an outbreak of the plague. St. Robert Bellarmine, his spiritual director, said Aloysius' example was so extreme that others should not be encouraged to follow it.

In 866, St. Ralph of Bourges, bishop. As archbishop, he used his great learning and wealth to promote Christian education. He wrote a book of pastoral guidance for clergy.

June 22

In the Common Worship calendar, Alban First Martyr of Britain, c.250. Alban was a citizen of the Roman city of Verulamium (now St Albans in Hertfordshire) who gave shelter to a Christian priest fleeing from persecution, hiding him in his house for several days. Greatly influenced by his devotion to prayer, Alban received instruction from the priest and was converted. When the priest's hiding-place was discovered, Alban dressed himself in the priest's cloak and was arrested in his place. Tortured by the Roman authorities, Alban refused to renounce his faith. He was beheaded on this day, probably in the year 250, and so is acknowledged as the first British martyr. The remains of his shrine stand today as a place of pilgrimage in the Cathedral and Abbey Church of St Alban.

In 1535, in London, St. John Fisher, bishop, cardinal and martyr. The son of a draper in Beverley in Yorkshire, he distinguished himself as a student at the University of Cambridge and stayed on there in various capacities. In 1502, he resigned his positions to become chaplain to Lady Margaret Beaufort, a great benefactress of Cambridge. He was made chancellor of the university in 1504, and in the same year was appointed bishop of Rochester. He was a champion of church reform, but an opponent of Luther. When he opposed Henry's divorce from Catherine of Aragon and the break with Rome which followed, he was imprisoned in the Tower of London. After he was beheaded, Henry VIII had his head impaled on London Bridge for two weeks. It was removed to make room for the head of Sir Thomas More.

Also in London, in 1535, St. Thomas More, martyr. While studying at Oxford, he became enthusiastic for Greek and humanist ideas. He then studied law in London. His first wife bore him four children, and when she died, he remarried. His household was a centre of learning, prayer and hospitality. Henry VIII liked him and appointed him lord chancellor in 1529. When Henry wanted to marry Ann Boleyn, More resigned his office and his family was reduced to poverty. He was imprisoned in the Tower of London for fifteen months, tried, convicted and four days later, beheaded.

In 431, St. Paulinus of Nola, bishop. He was born in Bordeaux of a very wealthy and prominent family. He married, but when the couple's only child died, they decided to give away much of their wealth. They settled at Nola, near Naples, and after giving away more of their goods, each became a hermit near the tomb of St.

Felix of Nola. He was chosen bishop of Nola in 409. He wrote numerous works of which some poems and letters survive.

June 23

At Ely, in 679, St. Etheldreda (or Audrey), abbess. The daughter of the king of East Anglia, and the sister of three saints, she was married to a prince named Tonbert. When he died shortly thereafter, she retired to the Isle of Ely to live a life of prayer. Five years later she was married to Egfrid, son of King Oswy. To help her avoid this marriage of political convenience, Wilfrid, the bishop of York, allowed Etheldreda to enter the monastery of Coldingham. A year later, Wilfrid made her abbess of Ely.

In 1213, in modern-day Belgium, Blessed Mary of Oignies. According to her biographer and disciple, Jacques de Vitry, she was the daughter of wealthy parents in Nivelles. She was married at 14, and later she and her husband turned their house into a hospital for lepers. She had the "gift of tears," a highly esteemed manifestation of the virtue of compunction. Toward the end of her life, she occupied a cell close to the Augustinian monastery at Oignies. Her fame and example influenced the development of the Beguines and the Crosier Order.

Moluag of Lismore Bishop, 592 Moluag was an Irish missionary who came to Scotland about the same time as Columba and established a missionary community on the island of Lismore, Loch Linnhe, where the church of St Moluag subsequently became the seat of the bishopric of the Isles. He and his followers worked mainly in the Pictish areas. He was consecrated bishop and established other centres of mission at Rosemarkie on the Black Isle where, according to tradition, he died in the year 592.

June 24

In Palestine, the solemnity of the birthday of St. John the Baptist. Because of the special circumstances of his birth, described in the opening chapters of Luke's Gospel, John's birthday is celebrated in addition to his death. This is one of the oldest feasts in the church's calendar. St. Augustine says it is fittingly celebrated at this time of year, when the days start to grow shorter, because John's task was to decrease so that Christ might increase.

In 1193, St. Bartholomew of Farne, one of Cuthbert's hermit successors on the Farne islands, off Lindisfarne. Bartholomew was born in Whitby, but ordained in Norway. He became a monk at Durham, then went to live in Cuthbert's cell on Inner Farne. He had some difficulties with two other hermits there, but overall was a cheerful and kindly man.

June 25

In 465, in Aquitaine, St. Prosper. He was a lay theologian who was involved in the semi-Pelagian controversy over grace and free will. In addition to writings related to that controversy, he wrote a chronicle of world history.

In 592, St Moluag of Lismore, bishop. Moluag was an Irish missionary who came to Scotland about the same time as Columba and established a missionary community on the island of Lismore, Loch Linnhe, where the church of St Moluag subsequently became the seat of the bishopric of the Isles. He and his followers worked mainly in the Pictish areas. He was consecrated bishop and established other centres of mission at Rosemarkie on the Black Isle where, according to tradition, he died in the year 592.

In 1142, St. William of Vercelli, abbot. After leading a life of penance and pilgrimage in his youth, he settled as a hermit in a mountainous area inland from Naples. Disciples gathered around him, and he established a severe monastery there, which became known as Montevergine and developed to be the head of a

Benedictine Congregation. William went on to found several additional monasteries, eventually settling at Salerno, where he was an advisor to Roger II, king of Naples and Sicily.

The Augsburg Confession (1530) On this day in 1530, a confession of faith was presented to the emperor Charles V during the imperial diet of Augsburg. It bore the signatures of representatives of the different cities that had supported the Protestant Reformation. In the years immediately following Martin Luther's excommunication, this was the most serious attempt that had been made to reach an understanding between Reformers and Catholics.

The Reformers had been accused of heresy by many, and several, led by Phillip Melantone, had agreed to respond to the judgments of the principal Catholic controversialists. They sought to highlight both their fundamental consensus with Catholics in matters of faith, and the reasons why their divergence with regard to certain religious practices and abuses was serious enough to have led to the Reformation.

The Augsburg Confession, which is still a fundamental document for the churches belonging to the Lutheran tradition, was written in two parts. The first part is doctrinal in nature, and the second part deals with practices that were widespread in the Church at that time. Luther acknowledged the document as a faithful expression of the Gospel, but the Confession was not sufficient to halt the growing division among Christians, which by that time had reached the dimensions of a full-fledged rupture.

In a deeply significant way, it was in Augsburg that Catholics and Lutherans chose to sign the joint agreement on Justification in 1999, thus resolving the issue that had done more than any other to divide the two Christian minds of the West.

June 26

At Rome, in the fourth century, Saints John and Paul, martyrs, to whom in the fifth century a basilica on the Coelian Hill in Rome was built on earlier foundations. They are mentioned in the first Roman Canon.

In 1178, St. Anthelm, bishop of Belley. He was a secular priest, serving as provost of Geneva, when he joined the Carthusians. He became the seventh prior of the Grand Chartreuse, and summoned the first general chapter of the order. He resigned to live as a hermit, but was sent to be prior of the monastery of Portes. He was then appointed bishop of Belley. In that office he took special care of a group of women solitaires and a leper house.

Robert Leighton Archbishop of Glasgow, 1684 Robert Leighton was born in 1611, the son of a puritanical physician. He studied at Edinburgh and on the continent where he was influenced by the piety and tolerance of the French Jansenists. In 1641 he became minister of Newbattle, but was highly critical of the Covenanting policy of those days. In 1652 he was sent to negotiate with Cromwell the release of Scots prisoners taken in battle at Worcester, and Cromwell's influence caused him to be appointed in the following year as Principal of Edinburgh University where he exercised a remarkable influence. At the Restoration he accepted the bishopric of Dunblane, the least remunerative, in the hope that he might use that office for the healing of the schisms within the Scottish Church. 'My sole object has been to procure peace and to advance the interests of true religion.' His plans for an accommodation with the Presbyterians led to his appointment as Archbishop of Glasgow in 1670. After four years he resigned the archbishopric following his failure of his efforts at reconciliation. He retired to the south of England where he died in the year 1684.

In 1975, St. Josemaria Escribá, founder of the Opus Dei movement. He studied theology and law and was ordained in 1925. While continuing his studies in Madrid, he had the inspiration for Opus Dei, which at its inception was a movement of men, mostly graduate students, who wanted to put the gospel into action. In Franco's Spain, Opus Dei grew rapidly and achieved considerable influence. Because the movement's members were secretive, suspicions about them arose. Escribá developed a constitution and received papal

approval in 1947. Since then the movement, still controversial, has spread throughout the world. He was beatified in 1992 and canonised in 2002.

At New York, in 1929, Isabel Florence Hapgood, writer. A lifelong and faithful Episcopalian, she was a force behind ecumenical relations between Episcopalians and Russian Orthodoxy in the United States. Between 1887-1889, Hapgood traveled extensively through Russia. Her love of Russian Orthodoxy and its Divine Liturgy led her to seek the permission of the hierarchy to translate the rites into English. The work, *Service Book of the Holy-Orthodox Catholic Church*, took eleven years to complete. It received support of the Russian Orthodox bishops in North America, particularly Archbishop Tikhon who was later to give Hapgood's work a second blessing when he became Patriarch of Moscow.

At Basel Switzerland, in 1988, Hans Urs von Balthasar, priest. Balthasar was greatly influenced by the Fathers, the Protestant theologian Karl Barth and the mystic Adrienne von Speyr. In his writing he is particularly concerned at the theological meaning of Truth, Goodness and Beauty. He described his work as "kneeling theology" drawing attention to its contemplative origin and in contrast to the "sitting theology" of the academy.

June 27

In 444, in Alexandria, St. Cyril, bishop and doctor. Cyril succeeded his uncle, Theophilus, as bishop of Constantinople. He was a vigorous, even heavy-handed, supporter of orthodoxy. He presided at the Council of Ephesus, which condemned the Christological views of Nestorius.

In 1066, St. George of the Black Mountain, monk. He spent time in several monasteries, and lived on Mount Athos. His great work was to translate the Bible and the Greek theological heritage into his native Georgian language.

In 1360, Richard FitzRalph Archbishop of Armagh, Reformer. Popularly known as 'Saint Richard of Dundalk', Richard was a learned scholar who was Dean of Lichfield and Chancellor of Oxford University before becoming Archbishop of Armagh. He is affectionately honoured in Dundalk, County Louth, the place of his birth, for his compassionate and caring nature. An important figure in Irish Church History, he was deeply concerned for the people of Dundalk and Drogheda who suffered during the Black Death, and for the welfare of the poor. This, however, did not prevent him from criticizing the mendicants of the day. Some of his teaching and writing influenced John Wyclif, later providing insights about a Christian stewardship of possessions. It is said of the pilgrims who visited his tomb, that they 'Many a mile did walk but had never seen so good a man as Richard of Dundalk.' He died on this day in the year 1360.

In 1838, Alexander Jolly Bishop of Moray, 1838 Born in Stonehaven in 1756, Alexander Jolly was educated at Aberdeen, ordained in Peterhead and sent to minister at Turriff. After almost twelve years he moved to Fraserburgh where he spent the rest of his life. A man of great learning and deep personal devotion, he was consecrated in 1796 as coadjutor to Bishop Macfarlane, who had superintendence of Moray, Ross and Argyll and Caithness. When Caithness was disjoined in 1798 Alexander was unanimously elected by the four presbyters of Moray as their diocesan. His wisdom guided the Church through the difficult years which followed the repeal of the Penal Laws, and his learning and saintly life brought considerable prestige to the Church he loved. He died in the year 1838.

In Cambrai, France, in 1794, Blessed Madeleine Fontaine and three companions. These four members of the Daughters of Charity of St. Vincent de Paul were arrested when they refused to take the oath demanded by the Revolutionary Convention. They were condemned to the guillotine during the Terror, a month before Robespierre and two months before Joseph Lebon, who supervised their condemnation and execution, were themselves sentenced to die.

In 1879, at La Pierraz, Switzerland, Blessed Marguerite Bays. A dressmaker, she spent her entire life in the parish where she lived. She was miraculously healed from cancer at the moment Pius IX declared the dogma of the Immaculate Conception. Later she received the stigmata.

June 28

In 202, St. Irenaeus of Lyons, bishop. Irenaeus was a Greek, born in Asia Minor, where he knew St. Polycarp. He was well educated in Greek philosophy and literature and studied in Rome under St. Justin Martyr. He was a priest in Lyons during the persecution of Marcus Aurelius, and traveled to Rome to argue against the Montanist heresy, a rigorist sect which claimed special prophetic gifts. He returned to Gaul to become bishop of Lyons. He wrote a large and effective work *Against the Heresies of the Gnostics*.

Before the fifteenth century, on the island of Valaam, in Lake Ladoga, in Finland, Sts. Sergius and Germanus, founders of the monastery of Valaam.

In Lovere, Italy, St. Vincenza Gerosa. She was the confounder with Bartolomea Capitanio of a congregation of Sisters of Charity. The two women met through charitable work. Their community is now known as the Sisters of the Child Mary.

In 1935, at West Park, New York, James Otis Sargent Huntington, priest, monk and founder. In the Rule for the Order of the Holy Cross, James Huntington wrote: "Holiness is the brightness of divine love, and love is never idle; it must accomplish great things." Commitment to active ministry rooted in the spiritual life was the guiding principle for the founder of the first permanent Episcopal monastic community for men in the United States. James Otis Sargent Huntington was born in Boston in 1854. After graduation from Harvard, he studied theology at St. Andrew's Divinity School in Syracuse, New York, and was ordained deacon and priest by his father, the first Bishop of Central New York. In 1880 and 1881 he ministered in a working-class congregation at Calvary Mission, Syracuse. While attending a retreat at St. Clement's Church, Philadelphia, Huntington received a call to the religious life. Huntington and two other priests began their common life at Holy Cross Mission on New York's Lower East Side, ministering with the Sisters of St. John Baptist among poor immigrants. The taxing daily regimen of Eucharist, prayer, and long hours of pastoral work soon forced one priest to leave for reason of health. The other dropped out for lack of a vocation. Huntington went on alone; and on November 25, 1884, his life vow was received by Bishop Potter of New York. The Order attracted vocations, and as it grew in the ensuing years the community moved, first to Maryland, and, in 1902, to West Park, New York, where it established the monastery which is its mother house. Huntington served as Superior on several occasions, continuing his energetic round of preaching, teaching and spiritual counsel until his death in 1935.

June 29

The solemnity of Sts. Peter and Paul, apostles. Peter was martyred in Rome during the reign of Nero. He was a Galilean fisherman, whom Jesus chose to be leader of the apostles. After denying Christ, Peter visited the empty tomb and became a leader and spokesman for the Christian community. He went to Rome, and the apocryphal Acts of Peter recount that when he was leaving the city during a persecution, he met Jesus and asked him, "Where are you going, Lord?" Jesus replied, "I am going to Rome to be crucified again." So Peter went back, and according to an ancient tradition, was crucified there upside down. What are very probably his remains were discovered under St. Peter's Basilica in Rome in the 1960s. A medal from the first half of the second century shows him as a sturdy man with a curly beard. His emblems are keys and an upside-down cross.

St. Paul was a Jew from Tarsus, 200 miles north of Jerusalem; he was a Roman citizen and a Pharisee well educated in the Jewish scriptures. After persecuting Christians, he was converted by a meeting with the Lord on the road to Damascus. He took the Christian gospel throughout the eastern Mediterranean and developed Christian doctrine in his preaching and letters. He defended the place of Gentiles in the church

and centred his preaching on Christ crucified and risen. He was beheaded in Rome around 65 AD and buried where the basilica and monastery of St. Paul Outside the Walls now stand. His emblem is a book or a sword.

The commemoration of Benjamin, the patriarch.

In 1316, on a ship in the harbour of Palma, Majorca, Blessed Raymund Lull. He was born on Majorca, which had a mixed population of Christians and Muslims. He was wealthy, well-educated, happily married, and well-connected. He led a very worldly life until he was about 30. Then he had a vision of Christ, which convinced him he must devote the rest of his life to church reform, and bringing the Moors to Christ. He never gained much official support. He learned Arabic and wrote prolifically on theological and philosophical topics. Eventually he did go to North Africa several times to preach, but the Muslim authorities treated him roughly and deported him. He died on the ship that brought him back from North Africa after he had been stoned and left for dead there.

June 30

The commemoration of the Christians martyred in Rome under Nero. Two-thirds of Rome burned in July, 64. Nero was accused of starting the fire, or at least not trying to have it put out. He announced that the Christians were responsible and ordered their arrest and execution. Tacitus, the Roman historian, who was nine years old at the time, later wrote that Nero "persecuted with every refinement the notoriously depraved Christians."

In 1066, at Salanigo, near Vicenza, blessed Theobald of Provins. Theobald (or Thibaut) was the son of the Count of Champagne. Inspired by stories of the desert fathers, he became a hermit and pilgrim before settling at Salinigo, where he led a small group of followers. Shortly before his death, he made religious profession as a Camaldolese.

At Palma de Mallorca in 1316, Raymond Lullo. Lullo was born in 1232 into a noble family on the island of Maiorca, a land of meetings but also of frequent clashes among Jews, Christians and Muslims. He spent his entire life seeking to understand Islamic culture in its difference in order to offer its people the life-giving Gospel message. In an era of violent battles, expulsions and massacres, Lullo always sought out the route of dialogue. He taught himself Eastern languages, studied the Arabic philosophical tradition, and made many trips along the North African coast, carrying no arms except those of his faith and intelligence. He earned an international reputation as a theologian and philosopher. At the end of his life he was permitted to present his original theological method in the great universities of the era, thus receiving a partial recompense for the humiliation he had suffered at the hands not only of the Saracens but also of his fellow Christians, few of whom had understood him.

The circumstances in which Lullo died are unclear, but his death seems to have occurred upon his return from one of his many voyages in Saracen territory. An extremely prolific writer, he left about three hundred works, which became important references for later scholars such as Nicolò di Cusa, Pico della Mirandola and Giordano Bruno. Certain traditions about the last years of Lullo's life claim that he was received into the Franciscan Order and died a martyr. He is commemorated today by the Franciscans.

July

July 1

The commemoration of Aaron, Moses' brother.

About 466, in Egypt, St. Shenute, abbot of the White Monastery. He emphasised obedience, discouraged all study, and cautioned against extreme asceticism.

In the sixth century, St Serf, bishop. Serf is one of the heroes of the Celtic Church known to us only through fragments of his story which are not always consistent. Tradition locates his activity at Culross and in the foothills of the Ochils, where he evangelized the Pictish tribe occupying the land to the north of the Forth. Also associated with him is the village of Dysart, a name derived from his retreat or 'desertum'. Serf is thought to have been a disciple of Palladius and to have fostered and educated Kentigern, which would place his activity in the first half of the sixth century.

In the sixth century, St Euddogwy, bishop. Euddogwy is the third Celtic saint to whom Llandaff Cathedral is dedicated (The Cathedral Church of SS. Peter and Paul, with SS. Dyfrig, Teilo and Euddogwy). Little is known of him. It would seem that he was a nephew of Teilo, and a monk of Llantwit Major. On the death of Teilo, Euddogwy was elected Bishop of Llandaff by the abbots of the South Wales monasteries, and consecrated in the year 569.

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At Tyburn, in 1681, St. Oliver Plunkett, bishop and martyr. Born of a prominent Irish family, he went to Rome with Fr. Pier Francesco Scarampi, who was the papal envoy to the Confederation of Kilkenny. He was ordained in Rome in 1654 and worked there till 1669 when he was appointed archbishop of Armagh. He returned to Ireland and worked tirelessly to consolidate the organization and pastoral effectiveness of the church, sometimes clandestinely, sometimes openly. He was arrested in 1679 and taken to England where he was tried, convicted, hanged, drawn and quartered in 1681. His 230 surviving letters show him to have been a learned and devout pastor, who courageously followed his conscience.

In 1813 and 1873, Hohn and Henry Venn, priests. John Venn was born at Clapham in March 1759, where his father, Henry Venn Senior, was a curate. Later that year, Henry took his family to Huddersfield, where he had been appointed vicar, and they remained there until 1771. John was educated at Sidney Sussex College, Cambridge, and became rector of Little Dunham in Norfolk and eventually of Clapham in 1792. He was one of the founders of the Church Missionary Society in 1797. It was here that he also became a central figure in the group of religious philanthropists known as the Clapham Sect. John was also an active participator in the movement for the abolition of the slave trade. John's son, Henry Venn, was born at Clapham in 1796. After his time in Cambridge, he was ordained and held various livings, but in 1846 he devoted himself entirely to the work of the Church Missionary Society. He was secretary for thirty-two years and his organising gifts and sound judgement made him the leading spirit in the counsels of the Society. In his later years, he was recognised as a leader of the evangelical body of the Church of England. John Venn died at Clapham on this day in 1813 and his son Henry died at Mortlake on 13 January 1873.

July 2

At Winchester, in 862, St. Swithin, bishop and advisor to Aethelwulf, King of Wessex. Swithin was an exemplary bishop who was known for his humility and charity to the poor.

In 1139, St. Otto, bishop of Bamberg. He sought to mediate between the Pope and the German emperors during the investiture conflict. He founded a number of monasteries and organised the evangelisation of Pomerania.

July 3

St. Thomas the Apostle. There are several traditions about where he went after Pentecost, the strongest possibility being the Malabar coast of southern India, which he could have reached via trading ship. The Malabar Christians are descended from both natives and Jews from the diaspora who converted in the earliest days of Christianity; the language of their liturgy is Syriac, though their vernacular is Malayalam. They maintained strong ties with the East Syrian Christians of Mesopotamia. According to the Christians of Malabar, Thomas was martyred near Madras in 73 AD.

July 4

In 1336, St. Elizabeth of Portugal. The daughter of King Pedro II of Aragon, she was married to King Diniz of Portugal. He was an able ruler, but fathered a number of children out of wedlock. Elizabeth saw to their upbringing. She tried to mediate between her husband, their son Alfonso, and King Ferdinand IV of Aragon. She was very active on behalf of the poor, and when her husband died she went to live with the Poor Clares at Coimbra.

In the fourth century, St. Peblig. Tradition has it that Peblig was the son of the would-be Roman Emperor Macsen Wledig (Magnus Maximus) and his wife Elen or Helen. Macsen left Britain in 383 at the start of an ultimately unsuccessful attempt to seize the throne of the Western Empire. Sulpicius Severus describes Macsen's wife as a devoted disciple of Martin, the ascetic Bishop of Tours. If Peblig was indeed her son he may have embraced some of Martin's teachings and practices. Peblig (the Welsh form of Publicius) is remembered as the founder of the Church of Llanbeblig, within the walls of the Roman settlement of Segontium near the later Caernarfon. He seems to have played an important part in ensuring the survival of Christianity in that area of Wales in the troubled period during and after the withdrawal of the Roman legions.

In 740, St. Andrew of Crete. He was born in Damascus and became a monk of Saint Sabas. Around 700 he was appointed archbishop of Crete. He is renowned for his sermons and hymns.

In 973, St. Ulrich of Augsburg, bishop. He was educated at Saint Gall, where he knew St. Wiborada. He became a priest and in 923, bishop of Augsburg. After the Magyars invaded in 926, murdering St. Wiborada and plundering Augsburg, Ulrich set about rebuilding the city. He founded the monastery of St. Stephen in 968 and restored the monastery of Saint Afra. Each day he visited the hospital in Augsburg to wash the feet of twelve poor people and distribute alms. He resigned his see in 972 to become a monk, and died the next year. He was the first person to be formally canonised by a pope.

July 5

In the fifth century, St. Palladius, bishop. According to tradition, Palladius, a deacon at Rome but probably a native of Gaul, urged Pope Celestine to send Bishop Germanus of Auxerre to the British Isles to combat the Pelagian heresy. He was himself sent as bishop two years later in 431 to continue this work. He landed in Ireland before the beginning of Patrick's mission. He appears to have been expelled from Ireland after a short time. He continued his work in Scotland where his name is linked with Airthrey near Stirling, with which Serf, possibly a disciple of his, is also associated. He is also linked with Fordoun in the Mearns, where he is said to have died. He is thought to have been the teacher of Ternan.

In 1530, St. Antony Zaccaria. He studied medicine and practiced as a doctor in Cremona for a while. He became a priest and ministered in Milan. There he founded the Clerks Regular of St. Paul, known as the Barnabites. Like the Theatines, Somaschi, Oratorians and Ursulines, his order was dedicated to church reform. He preached effectively, promoted devotion to the Blessed Sacrament, and lived austere.

In 1091, Blessed William of Hirsau. A monk of St. Emmeram in Regensburg, he was sent to Hirsau, which had recently been resettled by monks from Einsiedeln. He modelled monastic life there on the observances of Cluny. Hirsau became a centre of monastic reform in its own right. William wrote treatises on music and astronomy which survive.

At Neuilly-sur-Seine, France, in 1948, Georges Bernanos, writer. Bernanos was a devout Catholic and a writer. His *Diary of A Country Priest* describes how a young priest is serving God precisely to the degree that he himself believes he is doing so badly. He was convinced that without saints the church was a soulless institution that would once again crucify its Saviour.

July 6

In 518, St. Moninne of Killeavy, abbess. Sometimes called Darerca or Bline, Moninne founded a small monastery for women (eight virgins and one widow, according to one tradition). She continued in Killeavy, not far from Newry, the spirit of the teaching and pastoral concern of Patrick and Brigid. She died on this day in about the year 518.

At Konstanz, now in Germany, in 1415, Jan Hus, priest, reformer. Born in 1372 Hus was a Czech priest who became leader of the Czech reform movement, which called for a return to scripture and living out of the word of God in one's life. As preacher at Bethlehem Chapel in Prague, he talked to the people in their native language. Hundreds gathered every day to hear his call for personal and institutional reform. Clerics he had offended had him exiled from Prague, but he continued his ministry through the written word. Hus took the radical step of appealing directly to Christ rather than to the hierarchy for the justification of his stance. When the Council of Constance opened in 1414, Hus traveled there hoping to clear his name of charges of heresy. Hus had been given a pledge of safe conduct from the emperor, but his enemies persuaded council officials to imprison him on the grounds that "promises made to heretics need not be kept." Although several leaders of the Council of Constance were in favour of moderate church reform, the council's prime objective was the resolution of the Great Western Schism, which had produced three rival popes at the same time. The council therefore tried to secure a speedy recantation and submission from Hus. He maintained that the charges against him were false or twisted versions of his teachings, and he could not recant opinions he had never held. Faced with an ultimatum to recant or die, Hus chose the latter. As he approached the stake on July 6, 1415, he refused a last attempt to get him to recant and said: "The principal intention of my preaching and of all my other acts or writings was solely that I might turn men from sin. And in that truth of the Gospel that I wrote, taught, and preached in accordance with the sayings and expositions of the holy doctors, I am willing gladly to die today." His death did not end the movement, and the Czech reformation continued. Hus' rousing assertion "Truth will conquer!" is the motto of the Czech Republic today.

In 1902, near Rome, St. Maria Goretti, martyr. Her father died when she was 10, and she took care of her younger siblings while her mother worked in the fields. When she was 12, a twenty-year old neighbour, Alessandro, tried to rape her. When she resisted, he stabbed her. She was taken to the hospital, and died there of her wounds. Before she died, she forgave Alessandro, who repented his sin and testified on behalf of her canonisation.

July 7

Around 200, St. Pantaenus, who taught at the Christian school at Alexandria and was revered by St. Clement of Alexandria, who was his pupil.

In 1304, Pope Benedict XI. He was a Dominican and succeeded Boniface VIII in 1303. His one year as pope was devoted to dealing with the complex political situation he inherited from his predecessor. Benedict was not particularly effective, but he was a humble and austere friar who did his best.

In Nicaragua, in 1977, Blessed María Meneses. She was born and raised in Nicaragua, where she joined the Salesian sisters. She spent most of her life working in Costa Rica, where her primary concern was to encourage those who were wealthy to help those who had little. She founded a school, a clinic, recreation centres, food distribution centres, and even established a village to provide decent homes for the poor.

July 8

In the first century, Sts. Aquila and Prisca, disciples of St. Paul. This couple lived in Corinth, Ephesus and Rome, and in each place they were prominent contributors to the Christian community.

About 674, St. Disibod, bishop and Irish missionary to Germany. According to St. Hildegard's telling of his life, with two companions he founded a monastery near Bingen, which became a centre of evangelisation in the region. The monastery was resettled from Hirsau in the twelfth century. It was a double community, and St. Hildegard lived there for over twenty years before moving to Bingen to found her own community for women. She wrote a life of Disibod.

Around 689, St. Kilian, bishop, an Irish missionary who with some companions evangelised the area around Würzburg. He and two companions were murdered, reportedly for criticising a royal marriage.

In 1153, blessed Pope Eugene III. He was from the area around Pisa and became a monk at Clairvaux in 1137, then abbot of a Cistercian monastery outside of Rome. He was elected pope in 1145, which St. Bernard thought was a mistake, because Eugene had so little experience. However, he proved to be a vigorous church leader. He had to deal with many complex political issues. He also called the Second Crusade, which was a failure. When Eugene died, Peter the Venerable wrote of him to St. Bernard: "Never have I known a truer friend, a more trustworthy brother, a kinder father." St. Bernard wrote his treatise *On Consideration* for Eugene to guide him in his responsibilities as pope.

July 9

In China, between 1648 and 1930, 120 martyrs, who were canonised on October 1, 2000. Christianity had been brought to China by Nestorian missionaries in the seventh century, and by Franciscans in 1294. In the late 16th century Jesuits and later other missionaries reached the country. The first Chinese priest was ordained in 1658. The Jesuits missionaries had tried to integrate the Christian liturgy into Chinese culture, particularly by incorporating veneration of ancestors. A Vatican decision against these Chinese rites in 1704 was a major setback to the missionary effort in China. Beginning in 1748 there was a series of sporadic persecutions culminating in the death of 25,000 Catholics during the Boxer rebellion at the end of the 19th century. Many of these martyrs were catechists. In 2000, Saint John Paul II canonised Saint Augustine Zhao Rong and companions, martyrs, who died in 1815.

In the Netherlands, in 1572, St. Nicholas Pieck and companions, the martyrs of Gorcum. A group of Calvinists successfully besieged the town and rounded up the Catholic clergy. Nineteen of them were killed: eleven Franciscans led by Nicholas Pieck, four secular priests, and four other religious priests. Not all of these priests had led exemplary lives, but in the end they chose to die rather than renounce their Catholic faith.

At Breslau, in Silesia, now in Poland, in 1677, Angelus Silesius, priest and mystic. A convert to Catholicism from the Lutheranism of his childhood, Silesius joined the Franciscans. He is best known for his spiritual poetry and for perceiving the all-pervasive presence of God.

July 10

About 770, in Belgium, St. Amalburga, who was invested as a nun by St. Willibrord. Her relics were kept by the monks of Saint Peter in Ghent.

In 1073 and 1074, St. Antony Pechersky and St. Theodosius Pechersky, who were both abbots of the monastery of the Cave of Kiev and contributed significantly to the establishment of monasticism in Russia. Theodore led the monastery in efforts to serve the poor and to evangelise the surrounding region. He wrote: "[Christ] sought us out, found us, carried us on his shoulders, and set us at the right hand of the Father. Is he not merciful and the lover of humankind?"

July 11

About 550 AD, at Monte Cassino, St. Benedict, abbot. This was the date on which it was claimed that his relics were transferred to the abbey of Fleury-sur-Loire. It is celebrated as Benedict's feast day, because March 21, the date commemorating his death, falls in Lent.

In 155, St. Pius I, pope. The Muratorian Canon says he was the brother of Hermas, who wrote The Shepherd. Pius was pope when Marcion was excommunicated and when Justin Martyr was teaching in Rome.

In the early eighth century, at Disentis, in Switzerland, St. Placidus, martyr, and St. Sigisbert, abbot. Sigisbert went from the monastery of Luxeuil to be a missionary on the Rhine and then founded a hermitage at Disentis. Placidus was an influential friend of Sigisbert. In or around 720, the local ruler had Placidus killed, and Sigisbert died shortly thereafter. About 750 a monastery which still exists was established on the site of Placidus' murder.

In 969, at Kiev, St. Olga. She succeeded her pagan husband, Igor, as ruler of the new Russian kingdom of Kiev. She converted to Christianity, but was not notably successful in persuading her subjects to embrace the new faith. Still, with her grandson, St. Vladimir, she is regarded as the founder of Russian Christianity.

July 12

In the first century, St. Veronica, who is said to have wiped Jesus' face with a cloth when he was on the way to Calvary. The first report of this event is from the fourth century. Her story was connected with a widespread devotion to the Holy Face of Jesus in the Middle Ages.

In 1073, St. John Gualbert, abbot of Vallombrosa. John entered the monastery of San Miniato in Florence, but left after four years to seek a more austere way of life. He visited St. Romuald's hermitage at Camaldoli, and then set up his own monastery at Vallombrosa, about twenty miles east of Florence. His monks were to live austere lives devoted to contemplation. He incorporated lay brothers into the life of his monastery. His congregation grew to fifty monasteries and joined the Benedictine Confederation in 1966.

In the seventh century, St. Drostan (Tristan) of Deer, abbot. Little is known of Drostan (Tristan). He is said to have been of royal descent, a nephew or companion of Columba, with whom he visited Buchan, and who left him in charge of the new monastic foundation at Deer (Aberdeenshire); but his name suggests he was of Pictish origin. His name occurs in many dedications in the north-east of Scotland. He seems also to have been venerated in Galloway and Glen Urquhart.

At Basel, in the old Swiss Confederacy, in 1536, Desiderius Erasmus, priest. An Augustinian friar, Erasmus longed for the renewal of the Church in Gospel simplicity. He is often seen as the quintessential Christian humanist. He was horrified when renewal in the church led to division.

At Uppsala, in Sweden, in 1931, Nathan Söderblom, bishop. An ecumenist Söderblom gathered leaders of the reformed churches together and was friend of George Bell. He saw a profound connection between liturgy, personal prayer and social justice.

At Arnières-sur-Iton, France, on the 29th July, 1894 St Louis Martin, and at Alençon, France, on 28th August 1877, St Zélie Martin, parents of St Therese of Lisieux. Married in 1858, the parents of nine children, five of whom survived, Zélie and Louis are the first married couple to be canonised together for having achieved holiness in family life. Zélie died young, Louis built a monastic style cell for himself in the attic of the family home where he could read and pray. He communicated to Therese his deep and sentimental love of nature. All five surviving daughters entered the Lisieux Carmel.

July 13

The commemoration of the prophet Joel and the scribe Ezra.

In the first century, St. Silas, a Jewish Christian who went on a mission from the church of Jerusalem to Antioch, and later accompanied Paul on some of his missionary work. He seems to be the Silvanus mentioned in the First Epistle of Peter as a brother whom Peter knew and could trust.

In 1024, at Bamberg, St. Henry II and his wife, Kunegunda. Henry was the son of Henry the Wrangler, duke of Bavaria. After receiving a clerical education, he unexpectedly became Emperor in 1002. Henry and his wife Kunegunda were supporters of monasteries and benefactors of the poor. Henry was sometimes high-handed in his political dealings, but he was genuinely devoted to Christ. Pope Pius X declared him a patron of Benedictine oblates.

July 14

In 1610, in Peru, St. Francis Solano. He joined the Observant Franciscans in Spain and when he was forty was sent to Peru. He ministered in remote areas for twenty years, putting into practice the reforms ordered by St. Turibius of Mogrovejo. He spent his last years in Lima, where he was very critical of the lifestyle of the wealthy elite.

At Kahnawake, Quebec in 1680, St Kateri Tekawitha, martyr.

John Keble, priest. Born in 1792, the son of a priest, John Keble showed early brilliance as a scholar, becoming a Fellow of Oriel College, Oxford, at the age of nineteen, a few years before his ordination. He won great praise for his collection of poems, *The Christian Year*, issued in 1827, and was elected Professor of Poetry in Oxford in 1831. A leader of the Tractarian movement, which protested at the threats to the Church from liberal developments in both politics and theology, he nevertheless did not seek preferment and in 1836 became a parish priest near Winchester, a position he held until his death in 1866. He continued to write scholarly books and was praised for his character and spiritual counsel. Yet he is still best remembered for the sermon he preached in Oxford, considered by some the beginning of the Oxford Movement, delivered on this day in 1833. He died in Bournemouth on 29th March, 1866.

July 15

Swithun was Bishop of Winchester in the ninth century, though little is known of his life. He was bishop for ten years and appears to have been the trusted adviser of Egbert, his king in Wessex. He had asked to be buried 'humbly' and not in a great shrine and, when he died on 2 July 862, his request was fulfilled. However, when a new cathedral was being built, Ethelwold, the new bishop, decided to move Swithun's remains into a shrine in the cathedral, despite dire warnings that to move the bones would bring about terrible storms. He was duly translated on this day in the year 971 and, though many cures were claimed and other miracles

observed, it apparently rained for forty days, as forecast. Thus the feast-day of Swithun became synonymous with long, summer storms, rather than as an occasion for celebrating Christian simplicity and holiness.

At Lyons, in 1274, St. Bonaventure, bishop and doctor of the church. He was born near Orvieto in 1221 and joined the Franciscans. He studied in Paris and became a professor there. He was elected minister general of the order in 1257. He worked to bring unity in the order and wrote the definitive life of St. Francis. He was made a cardinal in 1273, and in 1274 played a major part in the council of Lyons, which aimed to bring union between the Eastern and Western churches. He left to posterity a large number of writings in which theology and spirituality are inseparable.

In 1015, St. Vladimir of Kiev. He was educated under the supervision of his grandmother, St. Olga. With the help of Viking adventurers he captured Kiev. He launched a war against the Poles, which brought him into contact with the West and Christianity. He converted to Christianity and invited missionaries from Constantinople to convert his people.

July 16

The commemoration of Our Lady of Mount Carmel. The sacred scriptures speak of the beauty of Mount Carmel where the prophet Elijah defended the faith of Israel in the living God. There, at the beginning of the thirteenth century, under the title of Saint Mary of Mount Carmel, the Order of Carmelites had its formal beginning. From the fourteenth century this title, recalling the countless blessings of its patroness, began to be celebrated solemnly, first in England and then gradually throughout the whole Carmelite Order and more widely.

In 784, St. Fulrad, abbot of Saint-Denis near Paris. Besides looking out for his monastery, he was an important advisor to the Carolingian court.

At Einsiedeln, in Switzerland, the commemoration of Our Lady of the Hermits.

Osmund, bishop of Salisbury. Born the son of a Norman count, Osmund came to England in the wake of William the Conqueror and was quickly promoted to Chancellor in 1072. Six years later he became Bishop of Salisbury and completed the building of the new cathedral at Old Sarum. He was a scholar and a good administrator but was best loved for his lack of avarice and ambition, traits apparently not common in the new hierarchy of Church and state. He took part in collecting the information for the Domesday Book and was present at Sarum when it was presented to the king in 1086. Osmund died on 4 December 1099 and his remains were translated to the new cathedral in Salisbury on this day in the year 1457.

July 17

At Milan, around 400, St. Marcellina. She was older sister and advisor of St. Ambrose. She vowed virginity before Pope Liberius, and St. Ambrose dedicated his treatise on virginity to her.

In 855, at Rome, St. Leo IV, pope. A monk of the monastery of San Martino, near St. Peter's in Rome, he was elected pope when the Saracens were threatening Rome. He strengthened the defences of the city by building the Leonine wall and organised a fleet that defeated the Saracens in a sea battle off Ostia in 849. He was a vigorous leader in ecclesiastical matters. He was concerned that the liturgy be properly celebrated and made many gifts to churches. He was a saintly person admired for his personal integrity.

July 18

In 1614, in Rome, St. Camillus de Lellis. As a youth he served in the army and gambled away his fortune. He spent some time in a hospital, and when he was well, stayed on as a nurse and then administrator. He

became a priest and set about establishing his own hospitals. He founded an order which aimed to practice “old-fashioned charity but with up-to-date technical skill.”

About 390, in Nitria, St. Pambo. He was born in Egypt about 303. He was one of the first disciples of St. Ammon. He was ordained about 340 by St. Macarius of Egypt and was known especially for his restraint in speech. He believed that the monastic life and living a charitable life in the world are “both perfect before God. There are other roads to perfection besides being a monk.”

In 1123, St. Bruno of Segni. He studied at Bologna and Siena, and was appointed bishop of Segni by Pope St. Gregory VII. He worked energetically on behalf of the Gregorian Reform and the First Crusade. After meeting opposition to his reforming efforts, he joined Monte Cassino, where he became abbot in 1107. Paschal II later told him to resign the abbacy and return to his diocese. Bruno was a leading commentator on the Bible.

At St Pancras, London on 18th April in 1883, Elizabeth Gerard, deaconess. Elizabeth Catherine Ferard was encouraged by Bishop Tait of London to visit deaconess institutions in Germany and, in November 1861, she and a group of women dedicated themselves 'to minister to the necessities of the Church' as servants in the Church. On this day in 1862, Elizabeth Ferard received the first deaconess licence from Bishop Tait. She went on to found a community of deaconesses within a religious sisterhood, working first in a poor parish in the King's Cross area of London and then moving to Notting Hill in 1873. When her health failed, she passed on the leadership to others and died on Easter Day 1883.

In 1918, St Elizabeth of Russia, religious and martyr. Elizabeth of Hesse-Darmstadt was born in 1864 and embraced Russian Orthodoxy upon her marriage to Grand Duke Sergei, the fifth son of the Tsar of Russia. In 1905 Sergei was assassinated, and Elizabeth gave away her jewellery, sold her most luxurious possessions, and opened the Martha and Mary home in Moscow, to foster the prayer and charity of devout women. Elizabeth and seventeen women were dedicated as Sisters of Love and Mercy. Their work flourished: soon they opened a hospital and engaged in a variety of philanthropic ventures. After the 1917 Revolution, amid the terrible persecution of the Church, Elizabeth and two sisters from her convent were arrested and transported to Alapaevsk. On 17 July 1918 the Tsar and his family were shot dead, and the following night Elizabeth, a sister named Varvara, and members of the royal family, were murdered in a mineshaft. In 1984 Elizabeth was recognised as a saint by the Russian Orthodox Church Abroad, and then by the Moscow Patriarchate in 1992.

July 19

The Church of England remembers on this day St Gregory of Nyssa and his sister Saint Macrina. In Cappadocia, in 397, St. Macrina the Younger. She was the eldest of the ten children of St. Basil the Elder and St. Emmelia. When her fiancé died, she vowed not to marry. She helped raise her brothers, St. Basil St. Gregory of Nyssa and St. Peter of Sebaste. She and her mother turned their home into a monastery for women, to which she welcomed impoverished women and servants.

In Egypt, in 450, St. Arsenius. He was born in Rome, but served in the court of the Emperor Theodosius in Constantinople. He left there to become a monk at Scetis in Lower Egypt, where he lived a very solitary life. Many sayings are attributed to him and one of his letters survives. He urged monks to attachment to their cells, perseverance, abstinence from food and sleep, and constant prayer.

July 20

The commemoration of the prophet Elijah. The prophet Elijah appears in Scripture as a man of God who lived always in his presence and fought zealously for the worship of the one true God. He defended God's law in a solemn contest on Mount Carmel, and afterwards was given on Mount Horeb an intimate experience of the living God. The inspiration that was found in him from the very beginnings of the

Carmelite Order so pervades its whole history that the prophet may deservedly be called the founder of the Carmelite ideal.

At Antioch in Pisidia in 304, Margaret, martyr. Margaret, also called Marina, gave her life during the Diocletian persecutions at the beginning of the fourth century. Her preaching before her death is said to have converted many to the Christian faith.

In 430, St. Aurelius, bishop of Carthage. Aurelius was the leader of the church of North Africa and presided over a number of synods dealing with the Donatist and Pelagian heresies. He introduced the chanting of psalms during Mass to encourage greater lay involvement. He was a friend of St. Augustine who held him in high esteem.

In 1566, Bartolomé de las Casas was the sixteenth-century Dominican priest who became known as 'the defender of the Indians' in 'the new world' of America. Born in 1484 at Las Casas in Seville, Bartolomé arrived in Haiti in 1502 and underwent a conversion after witnessing the injustices inflicted on the Indians. Proclaiming that Jesus Christ was being crucified in the poor, he went on to spend a lifetime challenging the Church and the Empire of his day. He was consecrated Bishop of Chiapa in Mexico in 1543 where he continued his prophetic rôle and emerges as a man of unquestioned courage and a theologian of remarkable depth, whose vision continues to set in relief the challenge of the gospel in a world of injustice. He died on 18 July 1566.

July 21

In 1619, while on business in Portugal, St. Laurence of Brindisi, doctor of the church. He was born of Venetian parents in Brindisi, in the Kingdom of Naples. He became a Capuchin and a scholar of languages. He was a very successful and dedicated preacher in Italy and then in Austria and Bohemia. Laurence became minister general of the Capuchins and held other offices in his order. He was chaplain of the army which repulsed the Turks at the battle of Szekes-Fehervar in 1601. His spirituality was Christ-centred and exalted Mary.

In the late third century St. Victor of Marseilles, martyr. Little is known about him, but Cassian founded a monastery dedicated to him at Marseilles. Excavations have uncovered early fourth century tombs on the site.

July 22

In the first century, St. Mary Magdalene, who was the leader of the women who accompanied Jesus and the apostles on their journeys. She was present at Jesus' crucifixion, burial and resurrection. Jesus sent her to announce the resurrection to the others, and so she was called the "apostle of the apostles." In the West, her story was conflated with that of the sinful woman who anointed Jesus' feet and with that of Mary, the sister of Martha and Lazarus. Sts. Jerome and Gregory the Great accepted this identification, but St. Bernard and other early Cistercians did not. A medieval legend has it that after the resurrection, Mary Magdalene settled in France, but this has no historical basis.

In 668, at the abbey of Fontenelle in Normandy, St. Wandrille, abbot. He was a married court official when he and his wife decided to separate and become religious. He was successively a monk under St. Baudry at Montfaucon, a hermit, a visitor at St. Columban's monastery at Bobbio, and a monk of the abbey of Romain-Moûtier. On the basis of this wide experience, he founded the monastery of Fontenelle, which followed the Rule of St. Columban.

July 23

In 1373, at Rome, St. Bridget of Sweden. She was the daughter of a powerful nobleman and married another, with whom she had eight children. When her husband died, Bridget spent three years at the Cistercian monastery of Alvastra. She had visions, and as a result of one built a monastery at Vadstena, which became the beginning of the Order of the Most Holy Savior. Each monastery in the order was to include both nuns and monks. It spread throughout Europe to number 70 monasteries. Bridget moved to Rome where she worked to get the pope to return to Rome from Avignon and to bring peace between France and England. Throughout her life, Bridget was active in helping the poor.

At Ravenna, at an unknown date, St. Apollinaris, bishop and martyr.

In 435, at Marseilles, St. John Cassian. He was probably born in Eastern Europe. He went on pilgrimage to the Holy Land and became a monk in Bethlehem, then went to study the monastic life of the Desert Monks in Egypt. Around 400 he was ordained a deacon by St. John Chrysostom in Constantinople. After John Chrysostom was deposed, Cassian joined a delegation who traveled to Rome on his behalf. Around 415, Cassian founded two monasteries in Marseilles. He wrote two books on monasticism and spirituality, the *Conferences* and the *Institutes*, which were very influential.

In the fifth century, St. Declan, bishop. Declan of Ardmore in west Waterford, was a prince of the tribe of Decies, among whom there were Christians prior to the coming of Patrick. It is believed that when Patrick was escaping from slavery, he received hospitality among the Christian Decies. The round tower (over thirty metres in height) at Ardmore is probably the best surviving example of its kind. Declan is believed to have lived and died in the fifth century.

July 24

In Ireland, probably in the fourth century, St. Declan, who evangelised the area around Ardmore in County Waterford.

In Russia, in 1015, Sts. Boris and Gleb. They were the sons of St. Vladimir. Their brother Svyatopolk had them killed. The Russian church honoured them as martyrs because they refused to resort to violence when they were unjustly attacked.

In 1292, St. Kunegunda, Queen of Poland. She was the daughter of Margaret of Hungary. When she was to be married to Boleslaw, the future king of Poland, she asked for a salt mine as her dowry, since she knew it was something the people of Poland needed.

At Bekaa Kafra, Lebanon in 1898, St. Sharbel Makhlof, priest. St. Sharbel was a Lebanese monk, born in a small mountain village and ordained in 1858. Devoted to the Blessed Virgin Mary, he spent the last twenty-three years of his life as a hermit. Despite temptations to wealth and comfort, Saint Sharbel taught the value of poverty, self-sacrifice and prayer by the way he lived his life.

July 25

In the first century, St. James the Greater, apostle. He was John's brother and followed Jesus with him. The two brothers witnessed the cure of Peter's mother-in-law, the raising of Jairus' daughter, Jesus' transfiguration, and Jesus' agony in the garden of Gethsemane. He was executed by Herod Agrippa about 44 AD, the first of the apostles to die. Tradition says that his body was transported to Spain and buried at Compostela, which became a great pilgrimage shrine. In his role as apostle and martyr, he is depicted with a cross or a sword. As a pilgrim, he carries a pilgrim's staff and scrip decorated with scallop shells. As patron of the reconquest of Spain from the Moors his emblem is a knight on a white horse.

Probably in the 3rd century, St. Christopher. There undoubtedly was an early Christian martyr named Christopher, but nothing is known for sure of his life. The Golden Legend told of him carrying a child across a river; the child turned out to be Christ. For this reason Christopher became the patron saint of travellers

In 408, St. Olympias. She was tutored by a well-educated and devout woman. She married, but her husband died soon afterward. At Santa Sophia in Constantinople she established a community for women who wanted to devote themselves to church service. She was a friend of St. John Chrysostom, who urged her community to found a hospital and orphanage. When John Chrysostom was sent into exile, she continued to support him, and for that his successor Atticus suppressed her community.

At Zwolle, Utrecht, in 1471, Thomas à Kempis, priest. The name of Thomas à Kempis is perhaps more widely known than that of any other medieval Christian writer. The Imitation of Christ, which he composed or compiled, has been translated into more languages than any other book except the Holy Scriptures. Millions of Christians have found in this manual a treasured and constant source of edification. His name was Thomas Hammerken, and he was born at Kempen in the Duchy of Cleves about 1380. He was educated at Deventer by the Brethren of the Common Life, and joined their order in 1399 at their house of Mount St. Agnes in Zwolle (in the Low Countries). He took his vows (those of the Augustinian Canons Regular) there in 1407, was ordained a priest in 1415, and was made sub-prior in 1425.

July 26

In the first century, Sts. Joachim and Anne. They are not mentioned in the Scriptures, but their names are given in the apocryphal Protoevangelium of James.

July 27

In Nicomedia, probably in the early fourth century, St. Pantaleon, martyr, who was venerated as one of the fourteen holy helpers. Legend said he was a physician who treated the sick without requiring payment. A number of churches claim to have relics of his blood; the ones at Ravello are said to liquefy on this day. His emblem is a pharmacist's vial.

At Rome, in 431, St. Celestine I, pope. He opposed the Novatianists, a rigorist, schismatic sect. He built the basilica of Santa Sabina and restored Santa Maria in Trastevere. He exercised authority over the entire church, intervening in disputes among Christians in North Africa, Thessalonica and Gaul, and sending emissaries to England and Ireland. He held a synod in Rome in 430 which condemned Nestorius and helped prepare the way for the Council of Ephesus, which the next year declared Mary the Mother of God.

In 916, St. Clement of Ohrid and companions. Clement was the leader in the establishment of the Bulgarian church under King Boris I.

At Durham in 1901, Brooke Foss Westcott, bishop. Born in 1825, Westcott was first ordained and then became a master at Harrow School. Whilst there, he published a series of scholarly works on the Bible, his expertise eventually leading to his election as Regius Professor of Divinity at the University of Cambridge in 1870. With Fenton Hort and J B Lightfoot, he led a revival in British biblical studies and theology. He became influential too in the field of Anglican social thought and was significant in the founding of the Clergy Training School in Cambridge (later renamed Westcott House in his memory). In 1890, he was consecrated Bishop of Durham.

At Dachau concentration camp in Bavaria, in 1942, Blessed Titus Brandsma, Born at Bolsward (The Netherlands) in 1881, Blessed Titus Brandsma joined the Carmelite Order as a young man. Ordained a priest in 1905, he earned a doctorate in philosophy in Rome. He then taught in various schools in Holland and was named professor of philosophy and of the history of mysticism in the Catholic University of

Nijmegen, where he also served as Rector Magnificus. He was noted for his constant availability to everyone. He was a professional journalist, and in 1935 he was appointed ecclesiastical advisor to Catholic journalists. Both before and during the Nazi occupation of The Netherlands he fought, faithful to the Gospel, against the spread of Nazi ideology and for the freedom of Catholic education and of the Catholic press. For this he was arrested and sent to a succession of prisons and concentration camps where he brought comfort and peace to his fellow prisoners and did good even to his tormentors; in 1942, after much suffering and humiliation, he was killed at Dachau. He was beatified by John Paul II on November 3, 1985.

July 28

In 198 AD, St. Victor I, pope. He was an African. He urged all Christian communities to follow the Roman method of calculating the date of Easter. Victor asked Marcia, a mistress of the emperor Commodus, to secure the release of the Christians condemned to work in the mines in Sardinia.

About 565, in Brittany, St. Samson of Dol. He was ordained a priest, then became a monk, perhaps on Caldey Island. He ministered in Ireland and Cornwall before going to Brittany, where he seems to have lived and worked as a monk, bishop and missionary.

At Leipzig in 1750, Johann Sebastian Bach, composer. A devout Christian, Bach composed for three denominations, and consistently inscribed his composition "solī Deo gloria".

July 29

In the first century, St. Martha. She is mentioned three times in the gospel: when she asked Jesus to tell Mary to help her; at the raising of Lazarus; and just before the passion, when Martha, Mary and Lazarus entertained Jesus at dinner. Later legend had her travel to the south of France. As patron of householders, she is depicted with a bunch of keys or a ladle. The Church of England in common with benedictine calendars remembers Martha, Mary and Lazarus on this day.

In Troyes, in 479, St. Lupus, bishop. He was married to a sister of St. Hilary of Arles. After some years of marriage they parted to become religious. Lupus became a monk at Lérins, and shortly afterwards, bishop of Troyes. In 429 he accompanied St. Germanus of Auxerre on a mission to England to prevent the spread of Pelagianism, a heresy which downplayed the role of grace.

In 1030, St. Olaf, the patron saint of Norway. After spending his youth as a marauding Viking, he became a Christian. In 1016 he became King of Norway. He insisted on the rule of law. He wanted to make Norway a Christian country, but his use of force alienated the people.

In 1099, Blessed Urban II, pope. He studied under St. Bruno and became a monk, and later prior, at Cluny. When he was elected pope in 1088, he had to cope with an anti-pope and the hostility of Emperor Henry IV. He carried on the reform policies of Gregory VII by holding synods to attack simony, lay investiture and clerical marriage. In 1095 at Clermont, he proclaimed the "Truce of God" as law and, in response to a request from the Byzantine emperor, called for the First Crusade.

July 30

About 450, at Imola, St. Peter Chrysologus, bishop and doctor of the church. He was a deacon at Imola before being appointed archbishop of Ravenna. As archbishop he built churches, reformed the church, championed St. Leo the Great's teaching on the Incarnation, and was a renowned preacher.

At Kingston-upon-Hull in 1833, William Wilberforce, social reformer. William Wilberforce was born in 1759 in Hull. Converted to an Evangelical piety within the Church of England, Wilberforce decided to serve the faith in Parliament instead of being ordained, becoming a Member of Parliament at the age of twenty-one.

He was a supporter of missionary initiatives and helped found The Bible Society. Settling in Clapham in London, he became a leader of the reforming group of Evangelicals known as the 'Clapham Sect'. Of all the causes for which he fought, he is remembered best for his crusade against slavery. After years of effort, the trade in slaves was made illegal in the British Empire in 1807 and Wilberforce lived to see the complete abolition of slavery, just before his death

In 1942, St. Leopold Mandic. His parents were Croatian. He became a Capuchin priest and served in Capuchin monasteries in Venice, Zara and Padua. He had hoped to dedicate himself to the reunion of the Eastern and Western churches, but his main apostolate turned out to be hearing confessions.

July 31

In Rome, in 1556, St. Ignatius Loyola. He was born of a prominent family in the Basque province of Guipúzcoa. He led a fairly wild life. He became a soldier and was injured in the French siege of Pamplona. During his convalescence he underwent a conversion. He visited Montserrat and spent a year as a hermit at Manresa, during which time he struggled with scruples and wrote the Spiritual Exercises. He and some companions began to study for the priesthood in Spain and then in Paris. From this core of companions emerged the Society of Jesus. Ignatius became head of the Society and lived in Rome. His body is buried in the church of the Gesù.

In 448, at Ravenna, St. Germanus of Auxerre. He studied law and became a public official. In 418 he was chosen as bishop of Auxerre. He went to England in 429 and 445 to counter the teachings of Pelagius. He died in Ravenna while on a mission to the imperial court on behalf of the Bretons.

August

August 1

In 1787, in Italy, St. Aloysius de' Ligouri, bishop and doctor. He was born near Naples, studied law and worked as a lawyer. Despite his father's opposition, he abandoned the law and in 1726 was ordained a priest, doing missionary work as a preacher and confessor. He organised prayer groups for laymen. In 1732 he founded the Redemptorists, who were influential in combating Jansenism. His Moral Theology (published first in 1753-1755) was very influential. He was forced to become bishop of a small diocese, and thoroughly reformed it. He met with much opposition within and without his order, but persevered and died at the age of 91.

In 984, St. Ethelwold, a native of Winchester. He was ordained a priest there with St. Dunstan. When Dunstan became abbot of Glastonbury, Ethelwold entered the abbey. Ethelwold became abbot of Abingdon, then bishop of Winchester. With Dunstan and Oswald, he worked for the restoration of monasticism, learning and the arts in England. A translation of the Rule of Benedict and the composition of the Regularis Concordia have been attributed to him.

In 1546, St. Peter Faber, one of Ignatius of Loyola's earliest companions. He was born in Savoy to a farming family. After joining Ignatius' company, he took part in several Catholic-Protestant dialogues, then devoted himself to the Catholic Reform. To that end he preached in Germany, Portugal and Spain. He had a winning personality, and influenced St. Peter Canisius and St. Francis Borgia.

In 1868, at La Mure, St. Peter Julian Eymard. He became a Marist priest, then founded the Blessed Sacrament Fathers and Sisters, whose spirituality focused on adoration of the Eucharist. He founded the Priests' Eucharistic League and the Confraternity of the Blessed Sacrament. His memoria is observed on August 2nd.

August 2

In 371, St. Eusebius, bishop of Vercelli. He lived a monastic life with some of his clergy. He was exiled for some years because he refused to endorse an Arian-inspired condemnation of St. Athanasius. He was kept in captivity and mistreated in Palestine, Cappadocia and Egypt. When he was released he spent time traveling in support of church unity and in opposition to Arianism, and then returned to Vercelli.

August 3

In the first century, St. Lydia. She was a Jewish proselyte whom Paul baptised in Philippi. She offered Paul hospitality.

August 4

In 1859, at Ars, France, St. John Vianney. He began his education for the priesthood when he was twenty and was ordained in 1815, when he was 29. He was assigned to the remote village of Ars, where he spent the rest of his life as a zealous parish priest and sought-after confessor.

In London, in 2003, Metropolitan Anthony of Sourozh, bishop. Andrei Bloom was born in Switzerland and moved to Paris after the revolution. He came to faith as a teenager while reading Mark's Gospel. He moved to England after the second world war and became much sought after as a teacher of the spiritual life and supporter of ecumenism.

August 5

In the late second century, Saints Addai and Mari, who, tradition says, evangelised the area in Mesopotamia around Edessa.

In 642, in the battle of Maserfield, St. Oswald. He was converted by St. Columba's monks at Iona, after he took refuge there during a dynastic struggle. Having become king of Northumbria, he called Aidan from Iona to help convert his territories.

August 6

At Hiroshima, Japan, in 1945, the first use of a nuclear weapon in warfare.

The Feast of the Transfiguration of the Lord.

In Spain, in 304, Sts. Justus and Pastor, martyrs. They were schoolboys during the persecution of Diocletian. They declared their Christianity and were martyred.

In 523, St. Hormisdas, who spent much of his time as pope working successfully to restore unity to the church in the wake of the Acacian schism over Monophysitism.

August 7

In 1967, in New York state, the founding of the communities of New Skete.

In 258, at Rome, during the persecution of Valerian, Pope Sixtus II and his companions, martyrs.

In Augsburg, in 304, St. Afra, martyr.

In 642, St Boisil of Melrose. Boisil, or Boswell, became Abbot of the Abbey of Melrose which Aidan had founded. Bede describes him as a man of great virtue. Among his disciples were Cuthbert and Egbert. He died around the year 642.

In 1547, in Naples, St. Cajetan. He was born in Vicenza, and studied theology and law at Padua. He became a priest and founded oratories dedicated to service of the incurably ill. Together with John Peter Caraffa, later Pope Paul IV, he founded the Theatine Order, which aimed to renew priestly ministry.

At East Grinstead in 1866, John Mason Neale, priest. John Mason Neale was born in 1818 and, whilst an undergraduate at Cambridge, was influenced by the ideas of the Tractarians. He was a founder of the Cambridge Camden Society, which stimulated interest in ecclesiastical art and which played a part in the revival of Catholic ritual in the Church of England. Whilst Warden of Sackville College, East Grinstead, a post he held from 1846, Neale founded the Society of St Margaret, which grew into one of the largest of Anglican women's Religious communities. Neale is remembered as an accomplished hymn-writer and his influence on Anglican worship has been considerable.

At Geneva, in 1878, Catherine Winkworth, translator, hymn writer. Winkworth is celebrated as the premier translator of German hymns and chorales into English.

She was born in London in 1827, but grew up in Manchester where she spent most of her life. Her lifelong fascination with German hymns and chorales began during a yearlong visit to Dresden, Germany, in 1848. Her first set of translations, *Lyra Germanica*, 1855, contained 103 hymns. Her translations were immensely successful in expressing the theological richness and spirit of the German texts; *Lyra Germanica* went through numerous editions and reprints and remains today a monumental contribution to the history of hymnody. Among the most well known of Winkworth's translations are "Jesus, priceless treasure," "Now thank we all our God," "Praise to the Lord, the Almighty," and "Deck thyself, my soul, with gladness." She is also remembered for her advocacy for women's rights and for her efforts to encourage university education

for women. In support of her advocacy for women, Winkworth sought inspiration in German literature and made it available in English translation. Notable are her translations of the biographies of two founders of sisterhoods for the poor and the sick: Life of Pastor Fliedner, 1861, and Life of Amelia Sieveking, 1863. Winkworth was traveling to an international conference on women's issues when she died of a heart attack on July 1, 1878. She was 51. She was buried at Monnetier, near Geneva. Her life and work has been honoured with a monument in Bristol Cathedral.

August 8

In 1221, in Bologna, St. Dominic. He was born near the Abbey of St. Dominic of Silos in Spain and named after its patron. He became a canon regular at Osma. With Bishop Diego of Azevedo, Dominic devoted himself to converting the Cathar heretics in southern France. Their method was to live in poverty and engage in patient theological discussion. After ten years, Dominic founded an order dedicated to contemplation, sacred studies and preaching, and the order grew rapidly.

In 1091, St. Altman, bishop of Passau. He was a canon and teacher in Paderborn and a chaplain to Emperor Henry III. As bishop of Passau, he installed canons regular at Göttweig, Sankt Pölten and Sankt Florian, and introduced the Cluniac reforms to Kremsmünster. He spent years in exile because of his support of Gregory VII's decrees against simony and clerical marriage.

In 1909, Saint Mary MacKillop. She was born in Australia of Scottish parents. With the help of Fr. Julian Tenison Woods, she founded the Sisters of St. Joseph of the Sacred Heart, dedicated to Catholic education and care for the poor. The order grew rapidly, but met with many difficulties from certain bishops who wanted diocesan control of the order. These gave her ample opportunity to practice heroic virtue.

August 9

In 1942. St. Teresa Benedicta of the Cross (Edith Stein). She was born in Breslau into a large Jewish family. She became an atheist when she was fourteen. She studied psychology, literature and philosophy. Edmund Husserl was one of her professors. She converted to Catholicism after reading the Autobiography of St. Teresa of Avila. For ten years she taught philosophy and studied St. Thomas Aquinas and mysticism. She joined the Carmelites in 1933, just after Hitler became chancellor of Germany. She was transferred to a convent in the Netherlands, but was arrested in 1942 and executed at Auschwitz.

In 560, St. Felim. According to tradition, Felim ('Fedilimth' in Adamnán's life of Columba) was the father of Columba. The abbey on Trinity Island in Lough Oughter, not far from the diocesan cathedral, recalls the early days of Christianity in Cavan and the neighbourhood. A later Norman doorway from the island is now incorporated in the present cathedral. Felim died on this day in about the year 560.

In 610, St. Crumnathy, religious. The Monastery at Achonry in County Sligo was founded by Finnian of Clonard at some date in the sixth century, and was established under Nathi as a centre of prayer and study.

In Florence, about 1242, Blessed John of Salerno. He was an early follower of St. Dominic and preached against the Cathars in Italy.

At Spruce Island, Alaska, on December 25th 1837, St. Herman: Wonderworker of All America. Herman was the first saint to be canonised by the Orthodox Church in America.

Herman was born in Russia, near Moscow, in 1756. Naturally pious from an early age, Herman entered the monastery at 17. He was never ordained. For many years he secured permission to live as a hermit, attending the liturgies of the monastery only on holy days.

In 1793, Herman set out with others to do missionary work in Alaska. They settled on Spruce Island, near Kodiak, and named their community "New Valaam" in honour of their home monastery. Herman lived and worked in the area for the remainder of his life.

He advocated for and defended the Aleuts against sometimes- oppressive authorities, particular Russian and European colonists with commercial interests. He cared lovingly and sacrificially for all who came to him, counselling and teaching them, and tirelessly nursing the sick. He especially loved children, for whom he often baked biscuits and cookies. He so captivated his listeners that many would listen to him through the long hours of the night and not leave his company until morning. The people he served often referred to Herman as their North Star.

At Auschwitz, in 1942, St Edith Stein, religious and martyr. Edith Stein was born into a devout Jewish family in 1891 in Breslau, Germany (now Wroclaw, Poland). She considered herself an atheist until in 1921 she read the autobiography of Teresa of Avila and was convinced of the truth of Christianity. She was baptised and became a leading voice in the Catholic Women's Movement in Germany. With Hitler's rise to power, Edith was concerned with the mounting tide of anti-Semitism. She became a Carmelite, taking the name Teresa Benedicta of the Cross. After the terror of Kristallnacht (9 November 1938), she was sent secretly to the Netherlands, but when that country fell to the Nazis the Gestapo rounded up all Roman Catholic Jews to be sent to the death camps. Edith Stein was arrested on 2 August 1942, saying as she was taken from her convent, 'We go for our people'. Edith Stein was deported to Auschwitz and was executed just a week later.

At Brandenburg an der Havel, in 1943, Blessed Franz Jagerstatter, martyr. A Catholic peasant in Austria he was baptised, married and worked as sexton in a small parish. He felt deeply that his Christian faith did not permit him to fight in Hitler's army. Under pressure, even from bishops and priests, he refused to fight and was beheaded.

At London, in 1641, Augustine Baker, priest, religious. Augustine Baker was born David Baker in Abergavenny in 1575. After studying at Oxford, he became a lawyer and was made Recorder of his home town. In 1600, he narrowly escaped death when crossing a dangerous bridge, an escape he attributed to divine providence, and he turned from a faithless life to Christianity. His parents had been sympathetic to Rome, and David Baker became a Roman Catholic in 1603. He was clothed as a Benedictine monk in Italy, taking the name Augustine, and was ordained priest. He travelled much between England and the Continent, recording the history of the English Benedictines from the earliest times, and wrote extensive works on spirituality in which he explored the life of prayer. His writings were subsequently edited into a classic of mystical theology *Sacra Sancta*, or *Holy Wisdom*. He died in London of the plague on 9 August 1641, and was buried in the churchyard of St Andrew's, Holborn.

At Alresford in Hampshire, in 1921, Mary Sumner, founder of the Mothers' Union. Mary Elizabeth Sumner (née Heywood) was born in 1828 at Swinton. In 1848, she married a young curate, George Henry Sumner, nephew of Archbishop Sumner, who was himself to become Bishop of Guildford in 1888. A mother of three children, Mary called a meeting in 1876 at which the Mothers' Union was founded, providing a forum in which to unite mothers of all classes in the aim of bringing up children in the Christian faith. Baptism and parental example were its two basic principles. At first a parochial organisation, it grew steadily into an international concern, encouraging the ideal of a Christian home.

August 10

In 258, in Rome, the martyrdom of St. Lawrence. He was one of the seven deacons in charge of the church's goods and alms. He was martyred under Valerian four days after the martyrdom of Pope St. Sixtus. Later legend adds several charming stories. Lawrence sold the church's goods and gave the money to the poor. When asked by the prefect of Rome to produce the church's valuables, he pointed to the poor. When he was being broiled alive on a grill, he asked to be turned so the other side could be done.

About 590, St. Blaine, who was born on the Scottish island of Bute. He studied and became a monk in Ireland, then returned to Bute where he founded a monastery and became a missionary and bishop.

August 11

In 1253, St. Clare of Assisi. When she was 18, Clare heard St. Francis preach. She renounced marriage and asked him for further instruction. She abandoned her former life, and Francis arranged for her to stay in a Benedictine convent. Her sister joined her. Francis eventually settled them near the church of San Damiano on the edge of Assisi. At first, Clare and her convent lived in extreme austerity, but with time she moderated that. She spent her life in service to her sisters in religion.

In the fourth century, at Rome, St. Susanna.

About 560, in the Abruzzi, St. Equitius, a monastic founder and preacher who was a contemporary of St. Benedict.

At Rednal in the West Midlands in 1890, John Henry Newman, priest. John Henry Newman was born in 1801. His intellectual brilliance saw him appointed to a Fellowship in Oxford at the young age of twenty-one. His Evangelical roots gradually gave way to a more Catholic view of the Church, particularly after liberal trends both in politics and theology appeared to undermine the Church of England's authority. Newman was one of the leaders of the Tractarians who defended the Church and he is associated especially with the idea of Anglicanism as a Via Media or middle way between Roman Catholicism and Protestantism. He continued to make an original and influential contribution to theology after he joined the Roman Catholic Church in 1845. He established an Oratorian community in Birmingham in 1849 and towards the end of his life was made a Cardinal.

August 12

About 732, at Lérins, St. Procarus and companions, martyrs. When the Saracens were coming to devastate the island, he used the available boats to save boys studying in the school and the younger monks. Most of those who remained on the island were murdered by the Saracens.

In 480, St Muredach, bishop. Muredach was an 'old man', perhaps a presbyter, in Patrick's household. At the conclusion of his mission to the West, Patrick left his companion to be bishop in west Sligo and Mayo. One tradition says that, at the end of his life, he went to live as a hermit on the island of Innishmurray. He died on this day in about the year 480.

In 590, St Blane. Blane received his education at Bangor in County Down under Comgall. He came to the island of Bute to work with his uncle, Catan, the centre of whose missionary operations was a settlement at Kingarth on Kilchattan Bay. There are many indications of the work of these two missionaries in Argyll, and Blane moved eastwards to Strathearn, where the medieval Dunblane Cathedral stands on the site of one of his foundations. The place and date of his death are uncertain, although the year 590 is now generally accepted.

In 1805, Ann Griffiths, poet. Ann Thomas was born at Dolwar Each, Llanfihangel-yng-Ngwynfa, in 1776. At the age of twenty, Ann underwent an experience of conversion and she joined the Methodist Society in Pontrobert the following year. After her father's death in 1804 Ann married Thomas Griffiths, but died in August 1805, shortly after the birth of their child. Ann's hymns are among the greatest treasures of Welsh Christian literature. Most of them were learnt by heart by her illiterate maid, Ruth Evans. She repeated them to her husband, John Hughes, who wrote them down. Ann's verses combine a depth of personal spiritual experience with a profound understanding of the central truths of the Christian faith. Eight of her letters also survive and Ann Thomas was born at Dolwar Each, Llanfihangel-yng-Ngwynfa, in 1776. At the age of twenty, Ann underwent an experience of conversion and she joined the Methodist Society in Pontrobert the following year. After her father's death in 1804 Ann married Thomas Griffiths, but died in August 1805, shortly after the birth of their child. Ann's hymns are among the greatest treasures of Welsh Christian literature. Most of them were learnt by heart by her illiterate maid, Ruth Evans. She repeated them to her husband, John Hughes, who wrote them down. Ann's verses combine a depth of personal spiritual

experience with a profound understanding of the central truths of the Christian faith. Eight of her letters also survive and give an insight into the depths of her character and her beliefs.

At Charing Cross, London, in 1827, William Blake, poet. For Blake, poetry and art were the expression of his spiritual vision. Obsessed with Christ he rejected the petty moralism of much religion and the cruelty of industrialisation. Thomas Merton writes of Blake that his was “fundamentally the rebellion of the stars. It was the rebellion of the lover of the living God.”

August 13

About 236, in the mines of Sardinia, the martyrdom of St. Pontian, pope, and St. Hippolytus, an antipope. Hippolytus, a theologian, was a critic of Pope Pontian and several of his predecessors, whom he thought were tainted with the Sabellian heresy and too lax regarding forgiveness. Hippolytus and Pontian were both arrested and deported to Sardinia and died there of maltreatment.

In 587, at Poitiers, St. Radegund. She was a Thuringian princess who was captured by the Franks and later married to Clothaire, the youngest son of Clovis. Clothaire was a womanizer who became tired of Radegund's charitable activities. When he murdered her brother in 550, she fled the court. She founded a monastery near Poitiers, which became a center of culture. St. Venantius Fortunatus settled there and wrote poems extolling the community. Radegund was a great collector of relics, and when she obtained a relic of the Holy Cross, St. Venantius was inspired to write two hymns (*Vexilla Regis prodeunt* and *Pange lingua gloriosi*), which are still sung during Passiontide.

In 662, in the Caucasus, St. Maximus the Confessor. He was born of an aristocratic Byzantine family and became a monk and abbot. He moved to Alexandria to escape the invading Persians and there wrote a number of theological works, some of which opposed Monothelitism, the heresy which held that Christ had no human will. He traveled to Rome in defence of orthodoxy, and there in 653 both he and Pope St. Martin I were arrested by the Emperor Constans and sent into exile. Maximus was tried and tortured several times; he died in exile near the Black Sea. His theological and mystical writings are highly regarded to this day.

At Lisburn in Ireland in 1667, Jeremy Taylor, bishop. Jeremy Taylor was born in Cambridge in 1613 and educated there at Gonville & Caius College. He was ordained in 1633 and, as the Civil War got under way, he became a chaplain with the Royalist forces. He was captured and imprisoned briefly but after his release went to Wales, where the Earl of Carbery gave him refuge. He wrote prolifically whilst there, notably *The Rule and Exercise of Holy Living* in 1650 and of *Holy Dying* the following year. In 1658 he went to Ireland to lecture and two years later was made Bishop of Down and Connor. He found many of his clergy held to Presbyterianism and so ignored him; and the Romans rejected him as a Protestant. In turn, he treated both sides harshly.

At Mayfair in London, in 1910, Florence Nightingale, social reformer. Florence Nightingale was born in 1820 into a wealthy family. In the face of their opposition, she insisted that she wished to train in nursing. In 1853, she finally achieved her wish and headed her own private nursing institute in London. Her efforts at improving conditions for the wounded during the Crimean War won her great acclaim and she devoted the rest of her life to reforming nursing care. Her school at St Thomas's Hospital became significant in helping to elevate nursing into a profession. An Anglican, she remained committed to a personal mystical religion which sustained her through many years of poor health until her death.

At Marylebone, London, in 1912, Octavia Hill, social reformer. Octavia Hill was born in 1838 into a family active in social work, and, during her teens, she was influenced by the friendship of F D Maurice and John Ruskin. Earning her living through teaching, Octavia was appalled at the conditions in which most of her pupils lived. Borrowing money, she bought some slum properties and began to manage them in a more sympathetic way, insisting on financial viability rather than mere charity. The success of the scheme led to its

extension and Octavia became a pioneer of housing reform. Strongly motivated by her faith, she never allowed her growing fame to undermine her personal humility.

August 14

In 1941, at Auschwitz, the martyrdom of St. Maximilian Kolbe. He was born in Russian-controlled Poland and became a Franciscan. He had a very strong devotion to Mary. He suffered from tuberculosis, but found energy to do pastoral work and publish several religious magazines in Poland, Japan and India. When the Nazis conquered Poland he recommended non-violent resistance and extended help to thousands of Polish and Jewish refugees, though he shared the traditional Polish prejudice against Jews. At Auschwitz he voluntarily took the place of a prisoner singled out for death and starvation. After two weeks of starvation, he was killed by lethal injection.

In the sixth century, St. Fachtna, bishop. Fachtna was described as being 'a wise and upright man' and one with a great gift for preaching. He was founder of the community of Rosscarbery in West Cork. He lived and died in the sixth century.

In 958, at Einsiedeln, Blessed Eberhard. He resigned his position as provost of Strasbourg cathedral to join his friend Benno, the former bishop of Metz, at his hermitage at Einsiedeln. After Benno's death, Eberhard became the first abbot of the community, and during a famine used its resources to feed the hungry.

In 1196, in Latvia, St. Meinhard. He was an Augustinian Canon in Segeberg Abbey in Holstein, and then traveled to convert the pagan tribes in what is now Latvia. He made his headquarters at Ikšķile near Riga, and was made bishop there.

At Hayneville, Alabama, in 1965 Jonathan Myrick Daniels, seminarian, martyr. Jonathan Myrick Daniels was born in Keene, New Hampshire, in 1939. He was shot and killed by an unemployed highway worker in Hayneville, Alabama, August 14, 1965.

From high school in Keene to graduate school at Harvard, Jonathan wrestled with the meaning of life and death and vocation. Attracted to medicine, the ordained ministry, law and writing, he found himself close to a loss of faith when his search was resolved by a profound conversion on Easter Day 1962 at the Church of the Advent in Boston. Jonathan then entered the Episcopal Theological School in Cambridge, Massachusetts. In March 1965, the televised appeal of Martin Luther King, Jr. to come to Selma to secure for all citizens the right to vote drew Jonathan. Jailed on August 14 for joining a picket line, Jonathan and his companions were unexpectedly released. Aware that they were in danger, four of them walked to a small store. As sixteen-year-old Ruby Sales reached the top step of the entrance, a man with a gun appeared, cursing her. Jonathan pulled her to one side to shield her from the unexpected threats. As a result, he was killed by a blast from the 12-gauge gun.

The letters and papers Jonathan left bear eloquent witness to the profound effect Selma had upon him. He writes, "The doctrine of the creeds, the enacted faith of the sacraments, were the essential preconditions of the experience itself. The faith with which I went to Selma has not changed: it has grown ... I began to know in my bones and sinews that I had been truly baptised into the Lord's death and resurrection ... with them, the black men and white men, with all life, in him whose Name is above all the names that the races and nations shout ... We are indelibly and unspeakably one."

August 15

The Solemnity of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary. Belief in the Assumption grew by analogy to Christ's ascension and from the stories of the translation into heaven of Old Testament saints like Enoch and Elijah. Christians thought that if because of her relation to Jesus she was preserved from sin, then she was also preserved from bodily corruption, the result of sin. Beginning in the fifth century accounts of Mary's Assumption begin to appear, and by the ninth century there was a feast of the Assumption in the

West. By the 20th century the doctrine was almost universally accepted by Catholics. Having consulted the bishops of the world, Pius XII declared Mary's assumption a dogma in 1950.

In 430, in North Africa, St. Alypius, a lifetime friend of St. Augustine. In 393 he became bishop of Tagaste.

In 1568, in Poland, St. Stanislaus Kostka. The devout son of wealthy and influential parents, he was educated at a Jesuit school in Vienna. He joined the Jesuits in Rome, but died the next year.

August 16

In Hungary, in 1038, St. Stephen. Stephen was the son of the first Christian king of Hungary and the husband of Gisela, the sister of St. Henry II. When he became king, Stephen promoted the growth of the Hungarian church and founded the monastery of St. Martin at Pannonhalma, the motherhouse of the Hungarian Benedictines.

In 1378, St. Rock, who was widely venerated as the saint to be invoked for protection against the plague. He is usually depicted with a bubonic sore, an angel, and a dog who cared for him.

In 1490, at Toledo, St. Beatrice da Silva. After spending 30 years in a Dominican convent, she founded the Congregation of the Immaculate Conception of the Blessed Virgin Mary.

In 1816, Charles Inglis, bishop. Charles Inglis was the son of a rector of Glencolumbkille in County Donegal in the Diocese of Raphoe. He emigrated to Pennsylvania where he studied for ordination and served at Trinity Church, New York. After the American Revolution, on 12 August 1787, he was consecrated at Lambeth Palace as the first Bishop of Nova Scotia (a diocese which then included the provinces of Quebec and Ontario) and the first bishop in the British Empire overseas. He died in the year 1816 and is commemorated on this day in his home parish at Glencolumbkille.

At Taizé, France, Roger Schutz, pastor, monk, founder. Brother Roger was a Swiss Protestant but dreamed of reconciling within himself and within a community of brothers the divisions of western Christianity. He gathered a community of brothers, Catholic and Protestant, and to them have been attracted young people in their thousands year after year.

August 17

In 1308, St. Clare of Montefalco. She was a member of a community of penitents who lived under the guidance of her sister Joan. They adopted the Augustinian Rule in 1290, and the next year Clare became abbess.

In 1736, St. Joan of the Cross. She was born in Saumur in France. She took over her family's religious goods shop and ran it efficiently, but avariciously. A woman showed up one day and asked for alms, and gradually St. Joan became a great champion of the poor. She founded a community of Sisters of Providence who were devoted to helping the needy.

August 18

In 1641, St. Jane Frances de Chantal. Born into a devout and prominent family, she received thorough religious education from her widowed father. At twenty she married the Baron de Chantal. He was killed in a hunting accident and she raised their three surviving children. St. Francis de Sales became her spiritual director and dear friend. On his advice she founded the Congregation of the Visitation, who would work outside the convent. St. Francis wrote his treatise *On the Love of God* for them. Although the sisters eventually had to accept enclosure, the order spread rapidly.

About 319, in Palestine, St. Helena, the mother of Constantine. In 326, Helena went to Palestine and there established several churches, liberated prisoners, and helped the needy. A sermon of St. Ambrose in 385 credits her with having found the cross on which Jesus died.

In 1255, Blessed Leonard, abbot of the monastery of Cava in Campania.

On this day the Community of the Servants of the Will of God at Crawley Down remember their founders, Fr William Sirr, Fr Gilbert Shaw and Fr Robert Gofton-Salmond.

August 19

In 1680, in Caen, St. John Eudes. He was educated by the Jesuits and joined the Oratorians, where under the tutelage of Charles de Condren he learned the Christocentric spirituality of Bérulle. After working among plague victims for several years, John preached the first of over one hundred six- to eight-week-long missions he undertook on behalf of the poorly evangelized people of Normandy. In 1643 he left the Oratorians and established a seminary in Caen. He promoted devotion to the Sacred Heart of Jesus as token of Jesus' sharing in humanity's nature and suffering.

In 1297, at Brignoles in Provence, St. Louis of Anjou. He was the son of the King of Naples and was held in captivity at Barcelona for seven years. He was tutored by Franciscans and determined to join their order. Pope Boniface VIII finally allowed this, but insisted Louis become bishop of Toulouse. Louis died not long afterward, at the age of 23.

At Paris, in 1662, Blaise Pascal. A brilliant thinker, Pascal in his *Pensées* presents a defence of Christianity based on the evidence of the human heart. In Jesus Christ, he believed, we learn that God exists and that we are sinners.

August 20

At Clairvaux, in 1153, St. Bernard. Born of aristocratic parents, he entered Cîteaux in 1112, when he was twenty-two. Three years later Stephen Harding sent him to found Clairvaux, from which over 300 Cistercian monasteries were subsequently founded, including Rievaulx and Mellifont. Bernard possessed a charismatic personality and a brilliant literary style. He was extremely influential in the church of his day: a champion of austere monastic observance, an opponent of theological innovation, a preacher of the Second Crusade, a goad to bishops and popes, a defender of the Jews, and a mystic who experienced and preached the love of God.

The commemoration of Samuel, the prophet, who anointed David.

In 685, in France, St. Philbert, who founded the monasteries of Jumièges and Noirmoutier.

In 1348, Saint Bernard Tolomei. He was born in Siena and became a law professor there. He became a hermit and founded the Benedictine Congregation of Our Lady of Monte Oliveto, which expanded rapidly. He died while he and his confreres were ministering to victims of a plague in Siena.

William and Catherine Booth, founders of the Salvation Army. William Booth was born in Nottingham in 1829, the same year as Catherine Mumford was born in Ashbourne, Derbyshire. They were married in 1855. A passionate preacher, William's style was criticised by his fellow Methodists and he left them in 1861, founding his own revivalist mission in Whitechapel four years later. The Christian Mission, as it was known, evolved into the Salvation Army by 1878. Both William and Catherine were famous for preaching and their movement developed into a world-wide denomination. It coupled moral fervour with a strong social commitment to the poor. Catherine died on 4 October 1890 and William on this day in 1912.

August 21

In Rome, in 1914, St. Pius X. He was a kind and simple man. On the one hand, his papacy introduced innovative reforms affecting the liturgy and began the codification of canon law; he founded the Biblical Institute in Rome. On the other hand, he was deeply suspicious of new movements in theology and biblical studies, and of democratic forms of secular government, which he condemned as "modernism".

In 480, at Clermont in the Auvergne, Sidonius Apollinaris. He was from an aristocratic Gallo-Roman family, received a classical education and married. He spent some time in the court of the Emperor in Rome, where he was both an official and a writer of occasional verse. In 469 he was appointed bishop of Clermont-Ferrand. He was a conscientious bishop, gave much of his property to charity, and defended his people against the Visigoths.

August 22

The commemoration of the Queenship of Mary.

In 1285, at Todi, St. Philip Benizi. He came from a prominent family. After studying medicine and philosophy at Paris and Padua, he joined the newly founded Servites in Florence. He wanted to remain a brother and serve the rest of the community, but was ordained and given various positions in the order. He was elected general of the order in 1267. He was known as an effective leader and peacemaker.

August 23

In the fifth century, St Tydfil, martyr. The early Welsh genealogies claim that Tydfil was one of the twenty-five daughters of Brychan Brycheiniog, whose family formed one of the three saintly tribes of Wales, and who also had eleven sons. She was buried at what became Merthyr Tydfil. It is said that she was on the way to visit her aged father when she was murdered by pagans. Her brother Rhun avenged her, but was killed at the moment of victory. Unfortunately, this story derives from the creative pen of the romantic poet and literary forger Iolo Morganwg. It may contain elements of folk tradition, but it is more probably the result of imaginative speculation about local place names.

In 1617, at Lima, St. Rose. As an adolescent, she took St. Catherine of Siena as her model. She followed some of Catherine's more extreme ascetical practices, and like Catherine became a Dominican tertiary. She set up an infirmary in one room of her family's house and cared for poor people there.

August 24

In the first century, St. Bartholomew the apostle. Little is known about him; he is usually identified with Nathanael. Tradition has it that he was martyred by being flayed alive. He is usually shown holding a knife or with his flayed skin folded over one arm.

In 684, St. Audoenus, bishop of Rouen. He served several kings as a court official, then became bishop of Rouen. He was an excellent bishop and founded monasteries.

In 1856, St. Emily de Vialar, who, after spending fifteen years caring for the sick and destitute, founded the Congregation of Sisters of St. Joseph, which under her leadership established convents in North Africa, the Balkans, Australia and Burma.

At Ashford, in Kent, in 1943, Simone Weil, mystic. Born to a secular Jewish family, a brilliant thinker, she was drawn increasingly to Christianity and to the person of Jesus Christ. However, she chose to remain on the threshold of the church. One of her key spiritual practices was to pray the Lord's Prayer in Greek. In

England she refused to eat more than those in occupied France were allowed to eat. For Weil the Platonic notion of metaxy is important, every separation is a link. Every wall is a means of communication, like a wall between two prisoners that may be tapped in order to communicate.

August 25

In 683, St Ebba of Coldingham, abbess. Ebba was the sister of the Northumbrian prince Oswald and shared his exile on Iona. She refused to marry, received the veil from Finan of Lindisfarne, and was granted land for a convent, but withdrew to establish a mixed community on the Northumbrian coast near Coldingham. Such communities were not uncommon in the Celtic tradition, but this one developed a name for laxity and luxury, possibly because Ebba, whom Bede calls a 'pious woman and handmaid of Christ' was not able to exert the strong leadership which such a community required. She died about the year 683, and around the time of her death the monastery was destroyed by lightning.

In 1270, in Tunis, St. Louis IX, King of France. He was an extremely influential political figure, but his personal integrity, humility and restraint are the reasons he is honoured as a saint. He and his wife Margaret, the oldest daughter of the count of Provence, had 11 children. He went on the Second Crusade in 1248, was captured and held prisoner, then returned to France in 1254, where he spent fifteen years implementing governmental and social reforms in France and promoting international peace. He died on the way to another crusading effort in Palestine.

In 303, St. Genesius of Arles. As a young notary, he was required to write a decree of persecution against the Christians. He quit his job on the spot and was later apprehended and beheaded.

In 1648, St. Joseph Calasanz. He was born in Aragon and educated at Lérida and Valencia. He became a priest and later went to Rome. He opened a free school there, and created a community which developed into the Piarist Order.

August 26

In the third century, in Rome, St. Tarsicius, who was murdered while taking communion to the sick or to prisoners.

In 295, in Numidia. St. Maximilian. He was prosecuted and executed because he wouldn't do military service. A reliable account of his martyrdom survives.

In 1078, Blessed Herluin, founder of the abbey of Bec.

Saint Teresa of Jesus' Transverberation "The chief among Teresa's virtues was the love of God, which our Lord Jesus Christ increased by means of many visions and revelations. He made her his Spouse on one occasion. At other times she saw an angel with a flaming dart piercing her heart. Through these heavenly gifts the flame of divine love in her heart became so strong that, inspired by God, she made the extremely difficult vow of always doing what seemed to her most perfect and most conducive to God's glory" (Gregory XV in the Bull of Canonisation0).

August 27

At Ostia, in 387, St. Monica. She was born of a devout family. She married Patricius, who was not baptised until 370, the year before he died. She loved her son Augustine, and prayed for him throughout his turbulent youth. She followed Augustine to Milan, where she was guided by St. Ambrose. She lived to see Augustine baptised and shared a mystical experience with him before her death at the age of 55.

In the fifth century, St. Poemen, a desert father who is celebrated for his pithy sayings. He was abbot of a monastery at Skete and in Terenuthis.

In 543, in France, St. Caesarius. He was from an aristocratic family and as a young man entered the monastery of Lérins. When he was thirty-three he became bishop of Arles. He was a frugal, pious and rigorous bishop. He required that the divine office be offered publicly and modified it so that lay people could participate. He was a popular preacher, and his sermons were widely diffused. He founded a monastery for nuns and wrote a rule for them, and one for monks as well.

In 1848, Blessed Dominic Barberi, an Italian Passionist priest who saw to the founding of four houses of his order in England, where he preached missions. He received John Henry Newman into the Catholic church at Littlemore in 1845.

August 28

In 430, at Hippo in North Africa, St. Augustine, bishop and doctor of the church. Born at Tagaste in what is now Algeria, he studied in Carthage, became a teacher, and spent ten years as an adherent of the Manichean sect. Influenced by his reading of Plato and by Christian monastics, and urged by St. Ambrose and his mother Monica, he was baptised in 387. He returned to Africa and led a monastic life with some companions. He later wrote a monastic rule which influenced St. Benedict; it was adopted by many later religious groups. His theological works have shaped Western Christianity. He was ordained priest in 391 and became bishop of Hippo in 396. He was an active bishop in a time of upheaval, and died during a siege of Hippo by the Vandals.

About 405 in Egypt, St. Moses the Black, an Ethiopian brigand who became a monk at Skete. When some Berbers threatened his monastery, he would not let the monks use force to defend their monastery and was murdered by the raiders.

August 29

The Feast of the Passion of John the Baptist. He condemned the ruler Herod Antipas for his illicit marriage to Herodias, second of his ten wives, who was both his niece and his brother's wife. Herodias was offended and connived with her daughter to have John the Baptist beheaded. Various customs connected with the summer solstice gravitated around his feast. John the Baptist is usually portrayed dressed in rough garments, with a lamb or a cross of reeds.

In 1844, in Waterford, Blessed Ignatius Rice, the founder of the Irish Christian Brothers. He was born in county Kilkenny of prosperous tenant farmers. He received some education, and went to work for his uncle. He married, but his wife died. He became a millionaire, and decided to devote himself to teaching poor boys. He founded two orders of teaching brothers who now work throughout the world, especially among the poor.

August 30

About 670, St. Fiacre. Legend has it that he was born in Ireland and went to France where he became a hermit, planted a garden, and opened a hospice. His hermitage was long a pilgrimage spot. He is the patron saint of gardeners and of the taxi drivers of Paris.

In 1588, in England, St. Margaret Ward. After she helped a missionary priest escape from prison, she was arrested and tortured. She would not tell where the priest was hiding or renounce her faith and so was hanged.

At London in 1688, John Bunyan, writer. Born at Elstow in Bedfordshire in 1628, John Bunyan was largely self-educated and used the Bible as his grammar. He read very few other books, and they were all piously

Protestant in nature, yet he produced *Pilgrim's Progress*, probably the most original text of spiritual genius that century, telling the story of the man Christian on his journey through life to God. It was not written while he was a prisoner in Bedford gaol, as often stated, but during a confinement some years later. History tells us little of the man but what is clear from his writings is that the salvation of the soul was what mattered most to him.

At Fond du Lac, Grafton, in 1912, Charles Chapman Grafton. Charles Grafton was born in Boston, and confirmed at the Church of the Advent— then a leading parish implementing the principles of the Oxford Movement. After graduation he moved to Maryland to study with the Tractarian Bishop William Whittington who ordained him deacon and priest.

Grafton served a number of parishes in Maryland but experienced a growing attraction to the religious life. In 1865, he left for England to meet Edward Bouverie Pusey. In the following year, after a series of meetings held at All Saints, Margaret Street, Grafton and two others took religious vows and the Society of St. John the Evangelist had its beginning. In 1872, Grafton returned and was elected fourth Rector of the Church of the Advent, Boston.

In 1888, Grafton was elected second bishop of Fond du Lac. Perhaps the most famous event during Grafton's long episcopate was the ordination of his successor in 1900. He invited the Russian Orthodox Bishop Tikhon and the Old Catholic Bishop Anthony Kozlowski to participate. The service stirred up reaction across the country with the publication of a photograph (called derisively "The Fond du Lac Circus") that showed all eight Episcopal bishops and the two visiting bishops in cope and mitre. When the dust finally settled, the legitimacy of traditional catholic ritual and vestments had thereafter gained a permanent place in the liturgy in the Episcopal Church.

In 1954, Blessed Ildephonse Schuster, Benedictine abbot, and cardinal bishop of Milan. He became a Benedictine and devoted himself to historical studies, particularly regarding the liturgy. He taught at St. Anselmo and was elected abbot of St. Paul Outside the Walls. He was made bishop of Milan and a cardinal in 1929. In the tradition of St. Charles Borromeo, he emphasised pastoral visitations; when he died he was on his fifth round of visits to the 900 parishes in his diocese. He denounced profane activities, promoted housing for poor immigrants who came to Milan from the south of Italy, and emphasised the Eucharist. He was at first a supporter of the Fascists, but vigorously opposed the entry of Italy into the Second World War. He aided Jews fleeing from Germany and as the war was coming to an end, tried to arrange a surrender that would spare Milan from further destruction.

August 31

In the first century, St. Joseph of Arimathea and Nicodemus. Joseph was a disciple of Jesus. After the crucifixion he obtained Jesus' body and arranged for his burial. Many legends grew up about him. In versions of the Grail Legend, which arose in the 12th century, Joseph was connected with the cup which was said to have caught Christ's blood on Calvary, and in one version, the cup was brought to Glastonbury Abbey in England.

In 358, St. Paulinus, bishop of Trier, who was a strong supporter of Athanasius during the latter's exile in the West. Paulinus was himself exiled by the emperor Constantius and sent to Phrygia where he died. In 396 his relics were brought back to Trier under St. Felix, bishop of that city.

In 651, St. Aidan. He was a monk of Iona. He was sent as a missionary to the English, and with the help of St. Oswald, the king of Northumbria, he won many converts by his asceticism and gentleness. In 635 he was consecrated bishop of Lindisfarne, and there he established a monastery and became its first abbot.

September

September 1

The commemoration of the Judges, Joshua and Gideon.

In Switzerland, probably in the fourth century, St. Verena, a martyr.

In Palestine, in 459, St. Simeon Stylites the Elder. He is the earliest and best known of the pillar saints. After some years as a monk in several monasteries and as a hermit, he began living on a pillar nine feet high and six feet in diameter. He spent the rest of his life on such pillars, where he continued the extreme asceticism of his early life. He preached from his pillar twice a day, urging people to act justly and pray.

About 710, near Arles, St. Giles, abbot. He was venerated as one of the Fourteen Holy Helpers as a patron of beggars, lepers, the physically handicapped, nursing mothers, shepherds, blacksmiths and horses. One of the legends of his life has it that he protected a deer from hunters, so he is sometimes depicted with a deer.

In Marseilles, France, in 1274, St. Douceline, a Beguine. She was a traveling missionary, an ecstatic, and a counsellor to Charles of Anjou.

September 2

In the sixth century in Sicily, St. Nonnosus, a monk of the monastery of Mount Soracte. He is venerated particularly at Freising and Bamberg.

About 1070, in Denmark, St. William of Roskilde, bishop.

In 1792, 191 canonised martyrs, almost all of them bishops and priests, who were murdered by mob violence in Paris on September 2 and 3.

At Copenhagen, in 1872, Nikolai Grundtvig, bishop. Born in 1783, the son of a Lutheran pastor, Grundtvig inherited from his father a lifelong appreciation for classical Lutheran orthodoxy rooted in sacramental practice, a stark contrast from the dry rationalism common to Danish Lutheranism at the time. From his mother, Grundtvig received a fascination with the literature, legends, and poetry of the Norse. Grundtvig was a student all his life. His academic passions were largely in history and theology, but education, he believed, opened one's heart and mind to a vigorous love of life. Grundtvig also believed in the power of poetry. He thought that poetry had the capacity to speak to the souls of human beings more deeply than prose, particularly in matters of the heart and the life of faith. During his lifetime he composed more than a thousand hymns, a number of which are still sung today: "Built on a rock the Church doth stand," "O day full of grace," and "God's word is our great heritage." Toward the end of his life, Grundtvig's vision was taking hold and his influence upon both church and nation continued to increase. He was made a bishop in 1861.

The church in Papua New Guinea has been enriched by martyrdom twice in the twentieth century. James Chalmers, Oliver Tomkins and some companions were sent to New Guinea by the London Missionary Society. They met their death by martyrdom in 1901. Forty years later, during the Second World War, New Guinea was occupied by the Imperial Japanese Army and Christians were severely persecuted. Among those who died for the faith were two English priests, Vivian Redlich, who trained at Chichester Theological College and John Barge, who remained with their people after the invasion of 1942 but were betrayed and beheaded, together with seven Australians and two Papuan evangelists, Leslie Gariadi and Lucian Tapiedi.

September 3

In 604, at Rome, St. Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the church. Highly educated, he served for some years as a secular administrator. When his father died, he gave his family's property to the church, and in 574 became a monk in a monastery he had established in the family mansion on the Coelian Hill in Rome. In 578 he was made a deacon of Rome, and in 579 he was sent as diplomatic representative of the pope to Constantinople. He was elected pope in 590 while he was helping victims of a plague in Rome. He proved to be a skilled administrator and diplomat. He sent missionaries to England. His extensive writings, including the life of St. Benedict in his Dialogues, were widely read in the Middle Ages.

In the first century, St. Phoebe, whom Paul commends in the epistle to the Romans as "a deaconess of the church of Cenchrae".

In 676, St. Aigulf, martyr. He was a monk of Fleury and then abbot of Lérins.

September 4

The commemoration of Moses, prophet and lawgiver.

In 422, at Rome, St. Boniface I, pope. When he was elderly, he was chosen pope in a disputed election. He eventually was recognised as the pope and proved effective. He supported St. Augustine against the Pelagians.

In 514, Oengus Mac nisse of Dalriada, bishop. Oengus Mac Nisse (or Macanisius), the first Bishop of Connor in County Antrim, is thought to have been at Kells as a hermit earlier in his life. The story told of him may reveal his sense of dedication: instead of carrying his Gospel-book in his satchel as was customary, he bore it on his shoulders 'hunched up or on all fours'. He died on this day in the year 514.

At Dorchester in 650, St. Birinus, bishop. Birinus was born in the mid sixth century, probably of northern European origin, but he became a priest in Rome. Feeling called by God to serve as a missionary, he was consecrated bishop, and sent to Britain by the pope. He intended to evangelise inland where no Christian had been before but, arriving in Wessex in 634, he found such prevalent idolatry that he looked no further to begin work. One of his early converts was King Cynegils and thereafter he gained much support in his mission, as well as the town of Dorchester for his See. He died in about the year 650 having earned the title 'Apostle of the West Saxons'.

In the early ninth century, St Ida of Herzfeld. She was married to Eckbert, a Saxon ruler, and bore him five children. She nursed him in his last illness, and then embraced a life of austerity, prayer and kindness to the poor.

At Lamberéné, Gabon, in 1965, Albert Schweitzer, writer. A Lutheran, Schweitzer is best known for his book *The Quest for the Historical Jesus*. However, his work as a medical doctor and his support for this work in what was then French Equatorial Africa continued to the end of his life.

September 5

About 698, at the monastery named after him, St. Bertin, abbot. He was a monk of Luxeuil, who was sent to assist Omer when the latter was made bishop of Thérouanne, with the mission of converting the Morini people.

In 1997, Saint Teresa of Calcutta. She was born of Albanian parents in 1910 in Skopje, which is now part of Macedonia. She joined the Loretto Sisters when she was 18, was sent to India and was assigned to teach in Calcutta. In 1946 she received a call to serve the poorest people in India, and two years later she founded the Missionaries of Charity. The order grew rapidly. She received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1979. After she

received the call from Christ to found her order, she received no further consolations and even felt God's absence very intensely.

September 6

The commemoration of Zechariah the prophet.

About 772, in Bavaria, St. Magnus of Füssen. He was a monk of St. Gall who preached the gospel in Bavaria. He established a monastery which served as a missionary centre.

In 1181, Blessed Eskil of Lund. He spent time at Clairvaux, where he became a friend of St. Bernard. He encouraged the foundation of several monasteries, including Alvastra, the first Cistercian monastery in Sweden.

At Tierra del Fuego in 1851, Allen Gardiner, missionary. Allen Francis Gardiner was born in 1794 and joined the Royal Navy as a young man. He resigned in 1826 and, on the death of his wife in 1834, dedicated himself to missionary work. He pioneered a mission to the Zulus in South Africa for the Church Missionary Society and founded the city of Durban. He then went to South America to investigate the possibility of evangelism amongst the indigenous tribes. He travelled extensively and founded the South American Missionary Society in 1844. With seven other missionaries, he died of starvation.

September 7

About 560, at Nogent-sur-Seine, St. Cloud. A member of the Merovingian royal family, he became a hermit, and spent his time passing on the faith to the local people.

In 1106 at Gubbio John of Lodi, hermit and bishop. John was born in Lodi Vecchio in 1025. In the 1060s he became a hermit at the Camaldolese monastery of Fonte Avellana. He became a disciple and the personal secretary of Peter Damian, who was the prior of Fonte Avellana. After Damian's death in 1072, John wrote a biography of Damian (1076-1082). John later became prior of Fonte Avellana. In 1104 he became Bishop of Gubbio, and held this office until his death.

September 8

The Birthday of Our Lady. This feast came to the West in the seventh century. We know nothing about Mary's birth, though there are ancient traditions which suggest it occurred at Nazareth or Jerusalem.

In 438, St. Isaac the Great, bishop of the Armenians. He was married and fathered one child before his wife died. He seems then to have become a monk as well as a bishop. During his episcopate Armenian Christianity and culture flourished. Isaac combined elements of Byzantine and Syrian Christianity in an Armenian mode. One of his associates developed an Armenian alphabet, and many Christian works were translated at his instigation.

In 725, St. Corbinian, apostle of Bavaria. He was born at Châtres near Troyes and became a recluse there. A community grew up, but he found it too distracting for him to lead it, so he went to Rome. Pope Gregory II sent him to Bavaria as a missionary.

In 1555, St. Thomas of Villanova. He studied at Alcalá, then joined the Augustinian friars at Salamanca. He was appointed bishop of Valladolid in 1544. He held a synod and drew up guidelines for his diocese which foreshadowed the disciplinary decrees of the Council of Trent. In his reform efforts, Thomas was very kindly. Famous for his austerity, he had a special concern for the poor.

In 1853, at Marseilles, Blessed Frederick Ozanam. He was born in Milan and raised in Lyons. He went to study at Paris where he became acquainted with Lacordaire, Montalembert, and especially Emanuel Bailly, whom he assisted in founding the Society of St. Vincent de Paul. He earned doctorates in both law and literature. He became a professor at Paris, was happily married, and had a daughter. He was very devoted to the church, to his students, to scholarship, and to the poor.

September 9

In 545, St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise, religious. Ciaran from Connaught was the founder of the great monastery on the east bank of the river Shannon at Clonmacnoise, where the ancient chariot-road through the centre of Ireland crossed the river. It was an outstanding centre of prayer and study and monastic life. Many missionaries went out from there to the European continent, including Virgilius (Fergal), Archbishop of Salzburg, and Alcuin's teacher, Colgu. Among the books written there were the Annals of Clonmacnoise, the Book of the Dun Cow, and the Annals of Tigernach (Tierney). The stones, the cross of the scriptures and the stone churches encircling 'the great stone church', a thousand years old, make an impressive sight.

In 1654, in Cartagena, Colombia, St. Peter Claver. He was born in Catalonia and became a Jesuit. St. Alphonsus Rodriguez inspired him to become a missionary. He went to Colombia, and there devoted his long life to working among the slaves. He learned one African language and also used translators in his ministry. He worked with those who were ill, and also ministered to Protestant sailors and Muslims.

At Zell am See, in Austria, in 1880, Charles Fuge Lowder, priest. Charles Lowder was born in 1820 and came under the influence of the Oxford Movement during his studies at Exeter College in the early 1840s. After ordination, he became increasingly drawn to a Tractarian and ritualist expression of the faith, especially after his move to London in 1851, despite the fierce opposition such Catholic spirituality faced within the Church. As a curate in Pimlico and Stepney, and then as the first Vicar of St Peter's, London Docks, Lowder came to epitomise the nineteenth-century Anglo-Catholic 'slum priest'. Dedicated to the poor and destitute, he was tireless in his parish work.

September 10

About 580, St. Finnian of Moville. He was born near Strangford Lough in Ulster, and studied under St. Colman and St. Ninnian. He went to Rome where he was ordained and returned to Ireland to found the monastery of Moville. Finnian was educated at the Abbey of Nendrum on Mahee Island on Strangford Lough in County Down. After spending twenty years in Scotland as student and missionary he came to Movilla (some five miles from Bangor) to found his monastery. There is a tradition that the Psalter, called the Cathach (the 'battle-book'), now in the Royal Irish Academy, was one of Finnian's books. Some scholars say that Finnian introduced to Ireland its first copy of Jerome's Vulgate version of the Scriptures. Several Finnians are associated with the famous story of Columba's secret copying of the manuscript without permission; the king's judgement against Columba was supposed to have led to his exile in Iona.

At Evesham on 30 December in 1039 St Ecgwin, bishop. The foundation of the abbey dedicated to Our Lady at Evesham is attributed to an early eighth-century Bishop of Worcester called Egwin. Very little is known about him, since the earliest account of his life, written in Latin c. 1020, is almost entirely composed of fables. However it does contain some local material which may reflect older traditions; among these is the account of the appearance of Our Lady to a swineherd at a place on the Avon where Egwin built the Church in her honour. This would be the earliest record of the appearance the Blessed Virgin Mary in England. Since 1952 Evesham has become the place of an annual pilgrimage to Our Lady; the Catholic Church there is dedicated to St Mary and St Ecgwin. In the Middle Ages St Ecgwin was commemorated on 30 December: September 10 is the day of the translation of his relics in 1039.

William Salesbury in 1584 and William Morgan, bishop in 1604. William Salesbury was born in Llansannan, Denbeighshire, around the year 1520, and was educated at Oxford. In 1551 he published Kynniver llith a ban,

a version of the epistles and gospels from the 1549 Book of Common Prayer, the first substantial translation of the Scriptures into Welsh. He co-operated with Bishop Richard Davies on the 1567 translations of the New Testament and the Prayer Book.

William Morgan was born at Ty Mawr, Wybrnant, Penmachno, in 1545, and educated at St John's College, Cambridge. In 1572 he became Vicar of Llanbadarn Fawr and six years later Rector of Llanrhaeadr-ym-Mochnant. Here he worked on the first complete translation of the Bible into Welsh, published in 1588. This masterpiece, as Gwenallt remarked, turned the Welsh language into 'one of the dialects of God's Revelation'. Morgan was consecrated Bishop of Llandaff in 1595, and encouraged scholarship and preaching in his diocese. In 1601 he moved to the see of St Asaph, and he died in the year 1604. His translation of the Bible had a lasting impact on the spiritual life, language, literature and national consciousness of Wales.

In 1641, near Lancaster Castle, the martyrdom of St. Ambrose Barlow. He joined the Benedictines at Douai and was ordained in 1617. He spent twenty-four years working as a missionary around Liverpool. He was much loved for his zeal, simplicity of life and good humour. He was arrested shortly after suffering a stroke. When he wouldn't promise to stop ministering, he was condemned, hanged, drawn and quartered.

September 11

In Rome, Sts. Protus and Hyacinth, martyrs. Their tombs were discovered in 1845 and they are mentioned in a number of ancient documents, but nothing is known about them beyond the fact they died for their faith.

About 350, in Egypt, St. Paphnutius, a disciple of St. Antony and supporter of St. Athanasius. He became bishop of the Upper Thebaid area in Egypt.

In 384, St Deiniol, bishop. Deiniol Wyn ('Deiniol the Blessed') was a grandson of Pabo Post Prydain. He helped his father, Dunawd, to found the famous monastery of Bangor Iscoed on the banks of the Dee in Flintshire. There is a suggestion (possibly the product of medieval ecclesiastical politics) that he then went to South Wales and was consecrated bishop there by Dyfrig. What is certain is that Deiniol founded a monastic school at Bangor Fawr in Arfon from which the Diocese of Bangor derives its origin. David's biographer records that Deiniol was present at the great Synod of Llanddewibrefi. He may also have spent some time in Ireland and in Brittany. He is said to have died in 384 and to have been buried on Bardsey Island. His cult was widespread in North Wales and there are also a few churches and holy wells in the south that bear his name.

In 1227, Blessed Louis of Thuringia, the husband of St. Elizabeth of Hungary. They were a very happy couple and had three children before Louis died at the age of 27 while on crusade.

September 12

In Ireland, in the sixth century, St. Ailbhe, a bishop and missionary much revered in Ireland, though little is known about his life. Much of the recorded life of Ailbhe is a confusion of valueless legends and contradictory versions. Yet the tradition of a holy man, a powerful preacher and teacher in the region of Cashel, cannot be set aside lightly. There is just a possibility that Ailbhe may represent an evangelistic initiative arising from a Christian British colony in Ireland independent from that of Patrick. The monastic Rule attributed to Ailbhe was probably composed some two hundred years after the saint's death. The original was in metrical form, and it is likely that the author attributed it to Ailbhe out of respect for his doctrine and leadership of the Church. Ailbhe died around the year 526.

In 1622, six Japanese Christians who were martyred by burning at Omura, a few miles north of Nagasaki.

September 13

In 407, in the region around the Black Sea, St. John Chrysostom, bishop and doctor. John was born about 350 in Antioch, raised by his mother, and well educated in secular and religious subjects. He had been a monk for seven years when his health declined. After he recuperated, he was ordained a priest in Antioch, where he was given charge of the poor. He was esteemed as a brilliant preacher and biblical commentator. He was appointed bishop of Constantinople, which earned him the animosity of Theophilus, bishop of Alexandria, who wanted the appointment. John's integrity led him to undertake a thorough reform of the church of Constantinople, and his straightforward talk angered some. He reduced the size of the bishop's household and gave the money to set up hostels for the needy. With his friend St. Olympias, he provided services for widows. Because of the enmity of Theophilus and the Empress Eudoxia, John was twice exiled and finally died from exhaustion.

In 453, St. Maurilius, who served as bishop of Angers for thirty years.

September 14

The feast of the Exaltation of the Holy Cross. The cross on which our Lord was crucified has become the universal symbol for Christianity, replacing the fish symbol of the early Church, though the latter has been revived in recent times. After the end of the persecution era, early in the fourth century, pilgrims began to travel to Jerusalem to visit and pray at the places associated with the life of Jesus. Helena, the mother of the emperor, was a Christian and, whilst overseeing excavations in the city, is said to have uncovered a cross, which many believed to be the Cross of Christ. A basilica was built on the site of the Holy Sepulchre and dedicated on this day in the year 335.

In Jerusalem, in 1214, St. Albert, bishop. Albert was a canon regular, who was made bishop first of Bobbio and then of Vercelli. He was an effective diplomat and peacemaker, and for that reason in 1205 he was sent to Palestine as Latin Patriarch of Jerusalem and papal legate. From his episcopal see in Acre he worked to keep peace among the crusaders and between them and the Muslims. He wrote a rule for some hermits who lived on Mount Carmel, who became the nucleus of the Carmelite Order. He was murdered during a procession on the feast of the Exaltation of the Holy Cross.

St. Peter of Tarentaise, bishop. His devout family was hospitable to monks, and Peter became acquainted with the Cistercians. He joined them and became abbot of the monastery of Tamié. He was appointed bishop of Tarentaise. He was an exemplary bishop and mediated in various disputes. He was a strong supporter of Pope Alexander III against the antipope Victor IV.

September 15

The memorial of Our Lady of Sorrows.

In 178, St. Valerian, one of the martyrs of Lyons and Vienne.

About 687, at Jumièges, St. Aichardus, abbot. He was educated at a monastery school at Poitiers, refused to live at court, and became a monk.

At Carthage in 258, Cyprian, bishop and martyr. Born in Carthage in about the year 200, Cyprian was a teacher of rhetoric and a lawyer in the city before his conversion to Christianity. He gave away his pagan library and set his mind to study the sacred Scriptures and the commentaries that were beginning to proliferate. He became a priest and then, in the year 248, was elected Bishop of Carthage by the people of the city, together with the assembled priests and other bishops present. He showed compassion to returning apostates, whilst always insisting on the need for unity in the Church. During the persecution of Valerian, the Christian clergy were required to participate in pagan worship; Cyprian refused and was first exiled and then condemned to death.

In 1510, St. Catherine of Genoa. She was born into a prominent family and received a good education. Her family forced her into a political marriage before she was 16. She was beautiful and intense; her husband, Giuliano, was undisciplined and unfaithful. Ten years into the marriage, her husband had a conversion, and the couple went to live and work in a hospital. She worked tirelessly to help those in need. She was also a mystic whose thoughts are contained in two works, a treatise on purgatory and a Dialogue between the soul and the body.

In 1929, Blessed Anton Schwartz. He received his early education at the Cistercian abbey of Heiligenkreuz and with the Benedictines at the Schottenstift in Vienna. After his ordination, he worked with poor apprentices and workers and championed their cause even before the publication of *Rerum novarum*. He founded an order dedicated to helping the working poor.

September 16

In 253, at Rome during the Decian persecution, St. Cornelius, pope and martyr. During his few months as pope, he had to deal with the Novatian schism and the related issue of how to deal with those who denied their faith during persecution and later repented. He earned the support of St. Cyprian, with whom he corresponded, though the two did not always agree.

About 432, in Scotland, St. Ninian. Ninian was born in about the year 360 and was the son of a Cumbrian chieftain who had himself converted to Christianity. It seems he visited Rome in his youth, where he received training in the faith. He was consecrated bishop in the year 394 and returned to Britain, where he set up a community of monks at Candida Casa from where they went out on missionary journeys as far as Perth and Sterling.

In 921, in Bohemia. St. Ludmila. She converted to Christianity with her husband, Duke Borivoy of Bohemia. She helped raise her grandson, St. Wenceslas, as a Christian. She was murdered by a party which opposed the Christianization of the country.

In 1087, Blessed Victor III, pope. From a prominent family, he became a monk at Cava and at Benevento, where he was given the name Desiderius. He spent time as a hermit and as a student of medicine in Salerno. He then joined Monte Cassino and became one of its greatest abbots. He rebuilt the abbey and promoted literature and learning. He was made a cardinal and served in various mediating roles until he was elected pope against his will. He died two years later.

In 1122, St. Vitalis of Savigny. He received a good education, then became a hermit. With his disciples he formed the abbey and order of Savigny, which followed the Rule of St. Benedict. He was an effective preacher and spoke his mind. His order was incorporated into the Cistercians in 1147.

In Oxford in 1882, Edward Bouverie Pusey, priest. Edward Pusey was born in 1800 and educated at Oxford, where he became a Fellow of Oriel College in 1823. He became an expert in biblical languages and criticism and in 1828 he was appointed Regius Professor of Hebrew in Oxford, the same year he was ordained. His patristic studies and firm adherence to a Catholic interpretation of doctrine made him one of the leaders of the Oxford Movement. He was significant in encouraging the revival of Religious Life within the Church of England and was a noted preacher. His austere way of life made him much revered by his contemporaries and they founded Pusey House and Library in Oxford in his memory, following his death

September 17

About 705, St. Lambert, bishop and martyr. When bishop Théodard of Maastricht was murdered, Lambert succeeded him. Exiled during political turmoil, he spent seven years with the monks of Stavelot-Malmédy. When he was restored to his see, he proved a dedicated bishop and missionary. There are conflicting accounts of his death, but he was quickly venerated as a saint and martyr.

In 1179, St. Hildegard of Bingen. She was sent as a young girl to be educated by Jutta, a recluse attached to the Abbey of Disibodenberg. Eventually a community of nuns formed around Jutta. Hildegard joined it and some years later became its leader. From an early age, Hildegard experienced visions, and these became the basis of several theological works, the first of which was the *Scivias*. She also wrote hymns, a musical morality play, a commentary on the Rule of St. Benedict, a book of natural history and medicine, and hundreds of letters to people of all stations. Around 1150 she moved her community to the Rupertsberg near Bingen. In her later years she went on preaching tours in the Rhineland.

At Acre in the Holy Land in 1214, St Albert of Jerusalem, bishop. Albert Avogadro was born about the middle of the twelfth century in Castel Gualteri in Italy. He became a Canon Regular of the Holy Cross at Mortara and was elected their prior in 1180. Named Bishop of Bobbio in 1184, and of Vercelli in 1185, he was made Patriarch of Jerusalem in 1205. There, in word and example, he was the model of a good pastor and peace-maker. While he was Patriarch (1206-1214) he formed the hermit brothers of Mount Carmel into a collegium and wrote a Rule for them. He was murdered at Acre on September 14, 1214 by the Master of the Hospital of the Holy Spirit, whom he had rebuked and deposed for immorality.

In Rome, in 1621, St. Robert Bellarmine, bishop and doctor of the church. He was born in Tuscany and received an excellent early education before joining the Jesuits. He studied at Padua and at Louvain, where he taught for seven years. He became a renowned preacher and theological controversialist. He began teaching in Rome in 1576 and worked on many projects, including a revision of the Latin Vulgate Bible, a catechism, and a revision of the church calendar. He worked as a mediator in the controversy over grace between Molina and Báñez. When he was made archbishop of Capua he emphasized the education of adults and the clergy. He was recalled to Rome in 1605 and spent the rest of his life there. In his latter years, he was involved in the controversy over Galileo's championing of Copernicus' idea that the earth revolves around the sun. He was a friend of Galileo's, but he could not reconcile Galileo's position with his own literal interpretation of Scripture. In his old age he wrote books *On the Ascent of the Mind to God* and *On the Art of Dying Well*.

In 1895, in Kraków, Blessed Sigmund Felínski, bishop. He was born in territory then under Russian rule. His mother spent twelve years in Siberia for her Polish nationalism and support of the rights of farmers. He was educated at Moscow and Paris, and studied for the priesthood in St. Petersburg; after his ordination he ministered there. In 1862 he was appointed bishop of Warsaw, which was also under Russian rule. After eighteen months he was exiled to Siberia for twenty years. He spent his last years ministering around Kraków.

September 18

In 1603, at Osimo, St. Joseph of Cupertino. He came from a poor family and had a very deprived childhood. He had a short attention span and a hot temper. He was nonetheless devout, and at seventeen joined the Capuchins. He was dismissed soon after that. He worked as a servant for a Conventual Franciscan community, joined them, and was ordained. He lived austere in service to his order, but was visited with many supernatural phenomena. These brought him to the attention of the Inquisition, which treated him severely. He was canonised in 1767.

In Zambia, in 1911, Dag Hammarskjöld. Born in Sweden in 1905, Hammarskjöld became Secretary General of the United Nations in 1953. The posthumous publication of his journal *Markings* revealed his deep spirituality and faith.

September 19

About 305, in the region of Naples and Benevento, St. Januarius, bishop and martyr. Little is known of him except that he was a bishop who died for his faith. A relic of his blood is kept at Naples, and it mysteriously liquefies three days each year.

In 690, St. Theodore, bishop of Canterbury. Theodore was born at Tarsus in Cilicia in about the year 602. He was an Asiatic Greek and had been educated in Athens before being appointed Archbishop of Canterbury by the Pope. He was raised straight from being a sub-deacon to the archiepiscopal see but proved his worth by immediately undertaking a visitation of the whole of England soon after his arrival. He set about reforming the Church in England with the division of dioceses and summoned the Synod of Hertford on 24 September 673, probably the most important Church council in the land, as it issued canons dealing with the rights and obligations of both clergy and Religious: it restricted bishops to working in their own diocese and not intruding on the ministry of their prelate neighbours; it established precedence within the episcopacy; it ensured that monks remained stable to their monastery and obedient to their abbot; and many other matters were dealt with to effect the good order of the Church. The canons were based on those of the Council of Chalcedon. Theodore proved to be the first Archbishop of Canterbury to have the willing allegiance of all Anglo-Saxon England.

In 1591, St. Alphonsus de Orozco, an Augustinian friar who served all classes of people with equal zeal. He was an effective preacher at the royal court of Madrid. He wrote many devotional and mystical books.

September 20

Between 1839 and 1867, Sts. Andrew Kim, Paul Chong, and companions, martyrs of Korea. A Korean named Yi Sung-hun was baptised in China in 1784 by a French missionary, and returned to found the first Catholic community in Korea in the house of Kim Bom-u. The next year the government dispersed the community and arrested, tortured and exiled Kim Bom-u, who died shortly afterwards. Between 1791 and 1831 the numbers of Catholics increased, but hundreds were martyred. French missionaries arrived in Korea in 1837. Persecution was intense until a treaty with France in 1886. There were further persecutions in 1905 and more recently in North Korea, where the church is still underground.

In 311, St. Methodius of Olympus, bishop and martyr, who left behind works called *On the Resurrection* and *The Banquet of the Ten Virgins*.

In 1534, near London, Blessed Thomas Johnson, one of ten Carthusians who were starved to death because they would not recognize the king as head of the church.

At Nukapu in Melanesia, in 1871, John Coleridge Patteson, bishop and martyr. Born in London in 1827, John Coleridge Patteson came under the influence of George Augustus Selwyn while John was still a scholar at Eton. Patteson went on to be ordained and, in 1855 at the age of twenty-eight, left Britain to begin his life's work among the Islanders of the South Pacific, founding the Melanesian Mission and becoming the first bishop of those Islands. His system of evangelisation was to train indigenous clergy and so to equip local people to share the gospel in a way that was within their own culture. This novel educative approach quickly bore fruit and Christianity spread rapidly. Also working in Melanesia were 'blackbirders', essentially European slave-traders, who carried off Islanders to work in British and other colonies in Australasia. When Patteson and his fellow-workers landed on the island of Nukapu, they were mistaken for such men. They were attacked and brutally put to death by the inhabitants.

Saints, Martyrs and Missionaries of Australasia and the Pacific The gospel of Jesus Christ was brought to Australasia and the Pacific largely by European and American missionaries over the last two centuries. They worked in difficult, often hostile, conditions amongst native peoples and settlers. Many gave long years of their lives, travelling enormous distances between islands, or across the Australian continent, preaching and ministering to their charges. We give thanks for the work of people like Peter Chanel, missionary in Fiji, and the first martyr of this region; John Coleridge Patteson, martyred in Melanesia on this day; and those

martyred in New Guinea. We remember the example of George Augustus Selwyn, first bishop and one of the founding fathers of New Zealand; and of Ini Kopuria, a native policeman who founded a thriving religious community in Melanesia. In commemorating these lives we celebrate all who have witnessed to the faith of Christ in Australasia and the Pacific.

September 21

St. Matthew, apostle and evangelist. He was a tax collector who followed Jesus from Capernaum. The gospel attributed to him seems to have been produced around 80 AD, perhaps in Syria, for a Jewish audience. His emblem is a man, because he begins his gospel with the human genealogy of Jesus.

The commemoration of the prophet Jonah.

About 575, St. Cadoc, one of the most revered Welsh saints.

In 1246, in Russia, Sts. Michael of Chernigov and Theodore, who were murdered by the invading Tatars when they refused to deny their faith.

At Hilversum in the Netherlands, in 1996, Henri Nouwen, priest. A Dutch Catholic priest, Nouwen taught at both Harvard and Yale. Later he joined the L'Arche communities in a search for a more authentic living out of the gospel.

September 22

About 287, at Martigny in Switzerland, St. Maurice and companions, martyrs. Maurice was an officer in the Roman army who suffered martyrdom with many of his men when they refused to offer a sacrifice to the gods.

In 530, St. Felix IV, pope, who was a fine administrator. He was known for his humility and concern for the poor.

In the seventh century, St. Emmeram, bishop, who was a missionary around Poitiers and in Bavaria. After his murder, his body was taken to Regensburg and buried in a monastery dedicated to him.

In 1770, at Turin, Blessed Ignatius of Santhià. A Capuchin friar, he was a dedicated and effective spiritual guide.

September 23

At Rome, St. Linus, who tradition says was the first bishop of Rome. He is mentioned after Peter and Paul in the First Eucharistic Prayer.

At Iona, in Scotland, in 704, St. Adomnán, abbot. Adomnán, Eunan, ninth Abbot of Iona, was born near Raphoe, in County Donegal about the year 624, a relation of Columba whose Life he wrote – a vivid and warmly human account of the famous saint of Iona. At the age of fifty-five, he was elected Abbot of Iona. He travelled widely, in Evangelistic endeavours and on political missions. He was concerned to bridge the gulf between the Celtic and Roman traditions and travelled between Scotland and England in negotiation. He accepted the Roman way of dating Easter and abandoned the Celtic style of tonsure, but these reforms were strongly resisted by his own community. At the Synod of Birr in 697 he played a leading part, drawing up the law code which bears his name. It was designed to raise the status of women and was enacted by the Synod. It is possible that he remained in Ireland for the rest of his life, returning to Iona just before his death on this day in the year 704.

In 1527 and 1529, Sts. Christopher, Antony and John, three young Indian boys in Mexico who became Christians and were murdered by Indians hostile to Christian missionary efforts.

In 1940, in Kraków, Blessed Bernardina Maria Jablonska. She joined the Albertines Sisters, whose founder, St. Albert Chmielowski, made her their leader when she was twenty-four. She held that position for thirty-eight years.

In 1968, St. Pius of Pietrelcina, known as Padre Pio. He was born near Naples, joined the Capuchins as a young man and became a priest. Not long afterward he began to feel the pains of the stigmata. He was a controversial figure; the offerings his fame brought him were used to construct a hospital to relieve the suffering of the sick.

September 24

In Hungary, in 1046, St. Gerard of Csanad, bishop and martyr. He was born in Venice and entered the monastery of San Giorgio Maggiore there. He went on pilgrimage to Jerusalem, and ended up in Hungary. King Stephen made him tutor of his son, Emeric and then bishop of Csanad. There was a backlash against Christianity after King Stephen's death, and St. Gerard was killed.

About 1218, Blessed Robert of Knaresborough. He was born in York; as a young man he became a hermit and devoted himself to prayer and care of the poor.

In 1862, Blessed Anton Martin Slomsek, bishop of Maribor in Slovenia. He studied for the priesthood at Celovec, where he became an ardent supporter of Slovenian culture and language. He wrote a catechism in Slovenian and promoted education. As bishop, he promoted foreign missions and ecumenical understanding.

September 25

In the sixth century, St. Finnbar of Caithness, bishop. Several saints are commemorated under the names Finnbar and Finian (or Finnian). They include the two Irish abbots, Finian of Clonard and Finian of Movilla, Fin Barre of Cork, and the early sixth-century churchman Vinniau, who corresponded with the Welsh scholar Gildas. One of these may also be identified with Vinnianus who wrote a Penitentiary. A view at present widely accepted identifies Finian of Movilla with the patron saint of Kilwinning in Ayrshire and Kirgunczeon in Kirkcudbrightshire, but this view may have to be revised in favour of Vinniau. The place names preserve a medieval form of Finian (Waning) which is nearer to the Brittonic Vinniau. There are several Irish stories linking a Finian with the diocese of Whithorn before the eighth century. If the stories and the place names belong together, Wynni (to give him his local name) may be one and the same as the correspondent of Gildas, whose dates will have straddled 500. Gildas spent his adult life in Wales, but is traditionally held to come from one of the British kingdoms of the north, usually assumed to be Strathclyde. His correspondent may have been the author of the Penitentiary.

In 623, St. Fin Barre of Cork, Hermit and abbot. From his hermitage at Gougane Barra in west Cork, Fin Barre travelled down the river Lee to found his school and Monastery among the marshes of what is now Cork City. In his lifetime he was honoured as a teacher and described as 'this loving man, Barre of Cork'. He died on this day in the year 623.

In 1487, at Sachseln in Switzerland, St. Nicholas von Flue, hermit. His father was a prosperous farmer; his mother, a very pious woman, perhaps of Italian parentage, who came from Wolfenschiessen. She initiated her sons into the spirituality of the Friends of God, which derived from the Rhineland mystics. Nicholas married and had ten children. He was a farmer and a military man; after his military service, he became an important official in the canton of Unterwalden. In 1467, with the consent of his spiritual advisor and his wife, he became a hermit, eventually settling in Ranft, where for many years he lived fed only by the Eucharist.. He

was venerated as an advisor and helped feuding Swiss cantons avoid a civil war. The cause for the beatification of his wife, Dorothy, is underway.

At Langres, St Ceolfrith, abbot. He was a monk under St. Wilfrid at Ripon, before joining St. Benet Biscop at Wearmouth. He became head of the new community at Jarrow, and during a plague only he and a boy, probably St. Bede, survived. He succeeded Benet Biscop as abbot. Bede describes him as “a man of acute mind, conscientious in everything he did, energetic, of mature judgment, fervent and zealous for his faith.” Coelfrith arranged the preparation of three beautiful complete codices of the Latin Bible, one of which he meant to take to Pope Gregory II; however, he died on the way to Rome. The bible, now known as the Codex Amiatinus, is in the Laurentian Library in Florence.

In 1054, at Reichenau, Blessed Herman “Contractus”. He was crippled and mentally very bright. He wrote works on many subjects, especially liturgical music.

In 1392, St. Sergius of Radonezh, abbot. He became a hermit, and a monastery dedicated to the Holy Trinity grew up around him. He was a respected mediator as well as a man of prayer. Many of his disciples were important ecclesiastics. He is the most popular Russian saint.

At Southwark in 1626, Lancelot Andrewes, bishop. Born in 1555 in Barking, Lancelot Andrewes studied at Merchant Taylors' School and then Pembroke Hall, Cambridge. After ordination, he held several posts before accepting appointment as bishop, first of Chichester, then of Ely and finally of Winchester in 1619. Andrewes was present at the Hampton Court Conference in 1604, which furthered the reform of the Church of England, and he was also a translator of much of the Old Testament of what is known as the 'Authorised Version' of the Bible. His preaching and his writings proved highly influential and his holiness of life and gentle nature endeared him to all who met him.

September 26

In the late third century, in Syria, Saints Cosmas and Damian, martyrs. Little is known about them historically, but legendary stories about them are numerous. One legend has it that they practiced medicine without charging fees. They are patrons of physicians, nurses, dentists, barbers and pharmacists. They are usually portrayed with medical instruments or pharmacists' vials.

In 611, St. Colmán Elo. He was influenced by St. Columba, and founded a monastery at Lynally in Offaly, not far from Durrow.

In 1004, at Grottaferrata, St. Nilus. He was born at Rossano in Calabria. When he was thirty, he underwent a conversion. He joined a Byzantine monastery after his wife and daughter died in an epidemic, eventually becoming abbot of Sant'Adriano. During an Arab invasion, his community took refuge at Monte Cassino. Just before his death, he founded the monastery of Grottaferrata near Rome.

In 1885, at Lyons, St. Teresa Couderc. As a young girl, she wanted to join a religious community in order to devote herself to rechristianizing the countryside. She did so, and later was one of the founders of the Religious of the Cenacle, dedicated to giving retreats for women. The development of the order was very rocky, but Teresa bore all of her reversals of fortune with remarkable equanimity.

In 1899, at Gars in Bavaria, Blessed Caspar Stanggassinger. He felt called to be a priest from an early age and went to the junior seminary at Freising when he was ten years old. He joined the Redemptorists and was ordained. He was assigned to work in Redemptorist seminaries, but died of an infection when he was 28.

In London in 1942, Wilson Carlile, priest. Wilson Carlile was born in 1847 in Brixton. He suffered from a spinal weakness all his life, which hampered his education. He entered his grandfather's business at the age of thirteen but soon moved on and learned French fluently, which he used to good advantage in France

trading in silk. He later learned German and Italian to enhance his business but was ruined in the slump of 1873. After a serious illness, he began to treat his religion more seriously and became confirmed in the Church of England. He acted as organist to Ira D Sankey during the Moody and Sankey missions and, in 1881, was ordained priest, serving his curacy at St Mary Abbots in Kensington, together with a dozen other curates. The lack of contact between the Church and the working classes was a cause of real concern to him and he began outdoor preaching. In 1882, he resigned his curacy and founded the Church Army, four years after the founding of the Salvation Army. Under his influence it thrived and he continued to take part in its administration until a few weeks before his death

September 27

In 1660, in France, St. Vincent de Paul. He was born of a peasant family and studied theology at Toulouse. He joined the circle of Pierre de Bérulle and was much influenced by St. Francis de Sales. When he served as a parish priest, he organised a confraternity of women to care for the sick poor. In 1625 he founded an order of priests, the Congregation of the Mission, which was dedicated to preaching and revitalising Catholicism in France. With Louise de Marillac he founded the Daughters of Charity, a group of religious women. They wanted to work among the poor, so to avoid being bound by enclosure, they did not make permanent, public vows. By his preaching and seminary work, Vincent de Paul contributed to the renewal of the clergy in France. He was an opponent of Jansenism.

September 28

In 929, St. Wenceslas, Duke of Bohemia. His father died and he was raised by his Christian grandmother St. Ludmila. His mother, a pagan who converted when she married, regained control of her son by having Ludmila strangled. Wenceslas assumed rule and exiled his mother. He was a just and decisive ruler. His brother Boleslas had him murdered on the way to church. He is the "good King Wenceslas" of the Christmas carol.

In 419, in Palestine, St. Eustochium. She was the daughter of St. Paula and a disciple of St. Jerome, who wrote her a number of letters which survive. Eustochium went with her mother to Palestine and helped her superintend the monasteries she founded in Bethlehem. She learned Greek and Hebrew and assisted Jerome in translating the Bible.

In 782, in Germany, St. Lioba. She was a relative of St. Boniface and, like him, was born and raised in England. She became a nun at Wimborne, where she impressed people with her single-mindedness and enthusiasm for learning. In 748 Boniface requested nuns to help with his evangelisation, and she and St. Walburga were among the thirty nuns sent to help him. She was abbess of the monastery Tauberbischofsheim and founded a number of others. She was a patient, warm and intelligent woman who urged her monks to live moderate lives and required that they learn to read Latin.

In 1494, in Pavia, Blessed Bernardino of Feltre. He studied at Padua. When he met St. James of the March, a disciple of St. Bernardino of Siena, he joined the Observant Franciscans. He became a renowned preacher, straightforward and uncompromising. He was very opposed to usury, and to counter the predations of unscrupulous lenders he established low-rate loan institutions (called monte di pietà) for the poor.

At Nagasaki, Japan, in 1637, St Lorenzo Ruiz and companions, martyrs, Saint Lorenzo (Lawrence in English) Ruiz (died September 29, 1637), also known as Laurentius Ruiz de Manila or San Lorenzo Ruiz de Manila, is the first Filipino saint canonized by the Roman Catholic Church. San Lorenzo Ruiz is thus the protomartyr of the Philippines. He was killed along with many others for refusing to leave Japan and renounce his Roman Catholic beliefs during the persecution of Japanese Christians under the Tokugawa Shogunate in the 17th century.

September 29

The feast of Michael, Raphael, Gabriel and all the angels.

In 1349, Blessed Richard Rolle of Hampole. He studied at Oxford, and became a hermit in his late 20s. He eventually settled at Hampole, not far from a priory of Cistercian nuns. He spent his time praying and counselling; he wrote several works, among them *The Fire of Love*. One of his maxims is that "The holy lover of God shows himself neither too merry nor full heavy in this habitation of exile, but he has cheerfulness with maturity."

In 1364, Blessed Charles of Blois. He spent most of his life trying to gain the dukedom of Brittany, to which Duke John III had designated him heir. He was not successful and at one point spent nine years in the Tower of London. Throughout the struggle, he tried to minimize the effects of the war on his subjects. He once suspended a siege so his troops could go Mass.

September 30

In 420, at Bethlehem, St. Jerome, doctor of the church. He was born to a wealthy family and received an excellent education; Aelius Donatus, the grammarian, was one of his teachers. He spent years traveling, and in 370 became a monk at Aquileia. He was quarrelsome, and left in 374 for Antioch, where he spent four years as a hermit. He learned Hebrew from a converted Jew who had become a monk. He then studied the Bible under St. Gregory Nazianzen in Constantinople. In 382 he went to Rome, worked for Pope Damasus and began a revision of the Latin Bible. In Rome a group of Christian women gathered around him and lived a quasi-monastic life. In 385 he departed for Palestine, where some Roman women joined him in Bethlehem. He was involved in a number of controversies, particularly over the virginity of Mary and the teachings of Origen.

About 330, in Armenia, St. Gregory the Enlightener, bishop. He was born in 260, when Armenia was under Persian occupation. In 314, he was appointed bishop. He created a native Armenian clergy and organised the church. In 330 he withdrew to a hermitage.

At Newburyport, Massachusetts, in 1770, George Whitefield, priest. Whitefield entered Pembroke College, Oxford as a servitor, one unable to pay tuition and who thus served higher ranked students in exchange for free tuition. There he came under the influence of John and Charles Wesley and was a member of the "Holy Club." In 1736, he was ordained a deacon, and in 1738, he followed John Wesley to Savannah, Georgia. He returned to England in 1739 to obtain priest's orders to raise funds for his Bethesda orphanage in Georgia. His preaching attracted a wide following in England, Wales, and Scotland. Whitefield, who subscribed to the Calvinist position then prevalent in the Church of England, broke with the Wesleys, the latter being theologically drawn to Arminianism. Whitefield formed and was president of the first Methodist conference, but left that position after a short time to focus on evangelistic efforts.

In 1876, in the region of Turin, Blessed Frederick Albert. He was a royal chaplain for some years, then became a parish priest in a large parish outside of Turin. He worked long and hard in service of his people. He talked Pope Pius IX out of making him a bishop. He died after a fall from scaffolding in a church he was working on; it was to be the centre of a farming commune where young people would cultivate church land.

October

October 1

In 332, in Armenia, St Gregory the Enlightener, bishop. Gregory is called 'The Enlightener' or 'The Illuminator' because he brought the light of Christ to the people of Armenia towards the end of the third century. Of royal descent, he seems to have become a Christian while in exile in Cappadocia. Returning to Armenia as a young man, he succeeded in converting King Tiridates to Christianity. With the help of the king, the country was converted and became the first national state to become officially Christian. A cathedral was built in Valarshapat but Gregory centred his work in nearby Echmiadzin, which is still the spiritual centre of the Armenian Orthodox Church. He was consecrated Bishop (Katholikos) in Caesaria in Cappadocia, and was succeeded by his son, Aristages, who attended the Council of Nicæa. Gregory died around the year 332. The writings attributed to him come from about a century after his time but probably preserve the spirit of his teaching.

In 1897, in the Carmelite convent in Lisieux, St. Thérèse Martin. Her mother died when she was four and she was raised by her sister, Pauline, who entered the Carmelites when Thérèse was nine. Two other sisters entered the same convent. After gaining special permission from the pope, Thérèse herself entered the community at the age of fifteen. She embraced a "little way" to holiness based on humility and trust in God, a way all people could follow. She devoted her life and prayer to saving souls, especially priests'. In the last months of her life, she suffered an agonizing illness and trials of faith; she died of tuberculosis at 23. She left behind three autobiographical texts, several hundred letters, poems and other writings.

In France in 533, St Remigius, bishop. Born in about the year 438, the son of the Count of Laon, Remigius studied at Rheims and was elected bishop and metropolitan of the city when he was only twenty-two years old. In the year 496, he baptised Clovis I, King of the Franks, and about three thousand of his subjects. Under the king's protection, Remigius preached the gospel, created dioceses, built churches and baptised many more Christians. His name is linked to the ampulla of chrism oil used at the coronation of French monarchs, together with the gift of healing. He died on 13 January in the year 533 and his mortal remains were translated to the abbey of St Remi on this day in the year 1049.

In the mid sixth century, in Constantinople, St. Romanus, a convert from Judaism. He was a deacon who wrote a large body of exquisite hymns.

In 566, St. Nicetius of Trier. He was born in Auvergne, became a monk, and then was appointed bishop of Trier. He was a zealous bishop who was not afraid to criticise royalty for their lapses.

At Amsterdam in 1683, Anthony Ashley Cooper, Earl of Shaftesbury. Born in 1801, Ashley Cooper was first elected to the House of Commons in 1826. In 1851, he succeeded his father as Earl of Shaftesbury and sat in the House of Lords. His service in parliament was marked from the beginning by a desire to reform social abuses, an impulse which derived from his strong Evangelical Anglican piety. He campaigned successfully for measures to improve housing and also create schools for the poor. He pioneered legislation on conditions of employment, for example, in mines and factories, particularly with respect to the protection of children. He became the epitome of the Victorian Christian philanthropist, working within the political system to redress social evils.

October 2

The feast of the Holy Guardian Angels.

In 679, St. Leger, bishop of Autun. He was abbot of the monastery of Saint-Maxence near Poitiers, which he reformed using the Rule of St. Benedict as a guide. As bishop, he restored order to his troubled diocese and reformed the monasteries within it. He was murdered in the course of a political struggle.

In 1879, Blessed Antony Chevrier. He was a priest of the diocese of Lyons who worked among the poor. A group of other priests came to live with him and share his work.

October 3

In 959, near Namur, St. Gerard of Brogne. He was ordained in 919 and founded a monastery on his estate at Brogne. He spent several decades reforming many monasteries according to the Rule of St. Benedict.

In 1281, St. Thomas Cantilupe, bishop of Hereford. He was born into a prominent family, and studied at Oxford, Paris and Orleans. He was ordained and served several terms as chancellor of Oxford, and in 1275 was appointed bishop of Hereford. He was an energetic and effective bishop, affable and austere, who worked to assure high quality pastoral care. He quarrelled with Archbishop Peckham of Canterbury, who excommunicated him. He went to Rome to appeal his case and died there. He was canonised in 1320 after a thorough inquiry.

In 1923, at Maredsous in Belgium, Blessed Columba Marmion. He was born of an Irish father and a French mother. He studied for the priesthood in Dublin and Rome and was ordained in 1881. He served as a parish priest, chaplain and seminary professor for five years, then entered Maredsous. He helped found the abbey on Mont César at Louvain, serving as prior and professor there. He preached retreats and edited several publications, including the *Revue Bénédictine*. He was elected abbot in 1909. He helped repopulate the Monastery of the Dormition in Jerusalem after the British expelled the German monks. His retreats formed the basis for his several popular books. He was beatified in 2000.

At Chichester in 1958, George Kennedy Allen Bell, bishop. George Bell was a major voice in the Church of England during the Second World War and a major figure on the ecumenical stage during the post-war era. Born in Hampshire in 1883, Bell trained for ordination at Christ Church, Oxford, and Wells Theological College. Ordained to the priesthood in 1908, he served for several years in inner city Leeds among the poor and disenfranchised, an experience that would shape the remainder of his ministry. He became the chaplain to the Archbishop of Canterbury, Randall Davidson, in 1914, becoming Dean of Canterbury in 1924 and Bishop of Chichester in 1929.

During the rise of the Third Reich in Germany, Bell took an active role in securing safe haven in England for Jews and non-Aryans who wanted to escape the terror of the Nazis. He developed a close association with Dietrich Bonhoeffer and the Confessing Church in Germany. He was a signer of the Barmen Declaration, the manifesto of the Confessing Church that stood in opposition to Hitler's regime. In the post-war era, Bell was a staunch critic of the cold war and the nuclear arms race. Bell's continuing legacy is surely his stature as an ecumenist. Since his appointment to the See of Chichester, Bell had taken a keen interest in the reunion of the churches and he devoted considerable time to ecumenical projects. After the war, Bell was a tireless advocate for the cause of unity and is to be numbered among the founders of the World Council of Churches in which he held leading offices. Through his ecumenical commitments, Bell developed a friendship with Giovanni Montini, the Cardinal Archbishop of Milan, who was to become Pope Paul VI.

October 4

In 1226, at Assisi, St. Francis. Francis was born in 1182, the son of a cloth merchant. He was a worldly young man. At 20, he became a soldier. He spent one year as a prisoner of war, the next as an invalid. He underwent a conversion and began caring for lepers. He broke with his father and spent several years as a solitary, praying, helping the poor, begging, and rebuilding three churches: San Damiano, St. Peter's, and St. Mary of the Angels or the Portiuncula. In 1208, in the Portiuncula, a reading from the gospel of Matthew clarified his vocation: he was to have no possessions and preach the gospel. Many followers gathered around him and the organisation of the order gradually took shape. St. Clare and Francis founded a female branch, the Second Order, in 1212, and in 1221, he founded the Third Order. He received the stigmata at La Verna in 1224. While visiting St. Clare he composed the *Canticle of the Sun*; he had the verse about "Sister Death" sung to him as he was dying.

About 350, St. Ammon, a monk of Nitria, who founded nearby Kellia for monks who wished to live in greater solitude. When Ammon died, St. Antony is said to have had a vision of his soul ascending to heaven.

October 5

In 1399, at Nuremberg, Blessed Raymund of Capua. He came from a noble family, studied at Bologna, and joined the Dominicans. He served in Rome, Florence and Siena, where he met St. Catherine and became her guide. Raymund supported her efforts to launch a crusade against the Turks and end the Western Schism. He later became Master General of the Dominicans and worked to reinvigorate the order.

In 1347, in the convent of the Hospitallers of St. John at Beaulieu, in France, St. Flora. A fifteenth-century life of the saint reports that she was devoted to prayer but suffered demonic attacks, especially temptations against chastity. One story says that the prioress challenged her as she was sneaking some of the monastery's bread to poor people; when she opened her cloak, the bread had turned to flowers.

In 1926, Blessed Bartholomew Longo. With his wife, Countess Anna De Fusco, he worked to evangelize people in the area of Pompeii, where he established a shrine, orphanages, a printing house and other enterprises.

In 1938, in Krakow, St. Faustina Kowalska. She was born into a poor family, and after working as a maid, joined the Sisters of Our Lady of Mercy at 19. She worked as a lay sister in various jobs while developing her interior life. She had a vision of Divine Mercy, in which multi-coloured rays of mercy flowed from Christ's heart. She kept a diary, which has been published. Pope John Paul II dedicated the Second Sunday after Easter to the Divine Mercy.

October 6

In 1101, St. Bruno, the founder of the Carthusians. He was a brilliant student at Rheims, Tours and Cologne, and then became director of the school at Rheims. After twenty years at that post he became chancellor of the diocese. After unsuccessfully opposing the unworthy bishop, he decided to become a monk. He and some companions spent time at Molesmes with St. Robert, but Bruno wanted more solitude. His former pupil St. Hugh of Grenoble gave Bruno La Chartreuse. Another former pupil, Pope Urban II, called him to Rome. He founded several communities in Italy, and died at La Torre.

At Agen in southern France, in the third century, the martyrdom of St. Faith. In the fifth century, a basilica was built for her relics at Agen. In the ninth century her relics were stolen and taken to the monastery of Conques on the route to Compostela. She was widely venerated throughout the Middle Ages.

At Vilvoorde in the Duchy of Brabant, in 1536, William Tyndale, priest. Born in Gloucestershire in about the year 1494, William Tyndale studied first at Magdalen Hall, Oxford, and then at Cambridge. He became determined to translate the Scriptures from the Greek directly into contemporary English but was thwarted in this by the Bishop of London. So William settled in Hamburg in 1524, never returning to England. When the first copies of his translation arrived in England in 1526, it was bitterly attacked as subversive by the ecclesial authorities. He spent much of the rest of his life making revisions to his work, but also writing many theological works. His life's-work proved good enough to be the basic working text for those who, at the beginning of the following century, were to produce what became known as the Authorised Version of the Bible. He was eventually arrested in 1535 and imprisoned in Brussels on charges of heresy. He was first strangled and then burnt at the stake on this day in 1536. His last words were, "Lord, open the King of England's eyes."

October 7

Our Lady of the Rosary. Today's feast commemorates the great naval victory won by Christian forces over the Turks at Lepanto on Sunday, October 7, 1571. Pope Saint Pius V decreed that a feast in honour of Our Lady of Victories be celebrated each year on that day. His successor, Gregory XIII, transferred the feast to the first Sunday of October under the new title of the Most Holy Rosary, since it was precisely through the invocation of Our Lady of the Rosary that the victory was thought to have been gained. In the reform of the liturgy the feast was returned to its original day.

In the first centuries of the church, St. Justina, a martyr, who is venerated at Padua.

In 1152, in Spain, St. Martin of Valparaiso. He founded the monastery there and joined it to the Cistercian Order.

October 8

The commemoration of the prophet Simeon, who, when he saw the infant Christ, declared, "Now, Lord, you may dismiss your servant in peace."

In Antioch, in the first centuries of the church, St. Pelagia, martyr. Around her a vast web of legend was woven. The stories told how she had been a great sinner, then converted and lived a life of penitence.

At Sirmium, before the fifth century, the martyrdom of St. Demetrius, a deacon.

At Brechin, in 1875, Alexander Penrose Forbes, bishop. Alexander Penrose Forbes was born in Edinburgh, the son of Lord Medwyn, a judge of the Court of Session. He served with the East India Company for three years but returned to Britain on health grounds and studied at Brasenose College, Oxford. There he was strongly influenced by Pusey, who, after his ordination, appointed him to a slum parish in Leeds in 1847. A few months later, aged thirty, he was elected Bishop of Brechin, a diocese of eleven parishes, one of which (in Dundee) Forbes pastored himself. He exercised a notable ministry among the poor and among the victims of a cholera epidemic. He built the present cathedral for his own congregation, and founded several new congregations in the city. His doctrine of the presence of Christ in the eucharist led to controversy and in 1860 to a trial before his fellow bishops, at which he was supported by John Keble. His Tractarian theology had a growing influence upon the Scottish Episcopal Church for the rest of the century. His writings include doctrinal and devotional works, as well as research into the lives of the saints of Scotland. He died in the year 1875.

October 9

The commemoration of the patriarch Abraham, father of all believers.

In the first century, St. Dionysius the Areopagite. He became a Christian when Paul visited Athens. Late legend has him as the first bishop of Athens. Later still he was connected with a third-century martyr named Dionysius who was a missionary bishop in Paris. Around 500, an unknown writer, perhaps a Syrian monk, wrote under the pen name Dionysius the Areopagite. These influential writings are now called the works of Pseudo-Dionysius.

In the seventh century, St Cynog, abbot and martyr. Brychan Brycheiniog is said to have raped Banhadlwedd, daughter of Banadl and as a result she gave birth to Cynog. Brychan presented his son with a golden torque, which was preserved as a relic when Giraldus Cambrensis saw it in the year 1188. He apparently became a hermit. The legends linked to Cynog are colourful but confused. A story from the early eighteenth century depicts him as a 'fool for Christ' who deliberately gave up his golden crown for ragged clothes and an iron bolt twisted into a torque. Cynog was believed to have been murdered either by pagan Saxons or by fellow hermits irritated by the special favour that God had showed him. The church of Merthyr Cynog was built over his burial place. Several churches in or near Brycheiniog were dedicated to him.

At Buckden in Huntingdonshire in 1253, Robert Grosseteste, bishop. Robert Grosseteste (meaning 'large-head') was born at Stradbroke in Suffolk in about 1175. He studied at Oxford and Paris and held various posts until, after a grave illness, he returned to Oxford, where he taught at the Franciscan house of studies. He became Bishop of Lincoln in 1235, then the largest English diocese, which received from him a thorough visitation soon after his arrival. He met opposition in his attempts at vigorous reforms in the shape of his dean and chapter in the cathedral at Lincoln, who saw themselves as beyond his jurisdiction. The affair was settled in 1245 when the pope issued a bull giving the bishop full power over the Chapter. Robert attended the Council of Lyons that year and also travelled to Rome a few years later. His wide-ranging interests covered mathematics, optics and many of the sciences; he translated large numbers of theological works from Greek and wrote his own theological commentaries and philosophical works.

In 1581, in Valencia, St. Louis Bertrán. He was a very conscientious Dominican priest. Because of his heroic work among plague victims in Valencia in 1557, St. Teresa of Avila approached him regarding her projected reform. From 1562-1568, he worked as a missionary in Columbia and the Caribbean islands. He returned to Spain, where he lobbied on behalf of the native people in America and promoted the missions.

In 1609, in Italy, St. John Leonardi. A native of Lucca, he became a priest and served in the hospitals and prisons of the city. A group of young lay people helped him. He was assiduous in preaching and implementing the teachings and reforms of the Council of Trent. St. Philip Neri and St. Joseph Calasanctius helped him form a religious congregation. He promoted the Forty Hours' Devotion and frequent communion.

In 1934, in Spain, St. Cyril Bertrand Sanz Tejedor and companions, martyrs. They were members of the Brothers of Christian Schools and were killed during a rebellion. The man in charge of their execution testified to the calm dignity they showed as they were led to execution.

At Hildesheim, in Lower Saxony, in 1974, Oskar Schindler.

October 10

In 1572, in Rome, St. Francis Borgia. He was born in Spain in 1510, the great-grandson of both Pope Alexander VI and King Ferdinand of Aragon, and cousin of Emperor Charles V. He went into imperial service when he was 18 and married the next year. The death of Empress Isabella in 1539 brought home to him the vanity of earthly honour. He was appointed viceroy of Catalonia and proved to be efficient and honest. He came under the influence of St. Peter of Alcántara and Blessed Peter Favre, and his spiritual life deepened. When his wife died in 1546, he made provision for his eight children and then joined the Jesuits. For the rest of his life he felt a strong tension between his demanding administrative duties and his desire for seclusion. He was elected general of the Society of Jesus in 1565. He developed Gregorian University, began the building of Gesù church, established the Jesuits in several countries, and inaugurated their missionary work in America. He wrote many spiritual books both for lay people and for his fellow Jesuits.

In 644, St. Paulinus of York, bishop. He was sent by Pope Gregory the Great to England to help St. Augustine. He was instrumental in the conversion of the king and people of Northumbria. He died as bishop of Rochester.

At Teddington, Middlesex, in 1674, Thomas Traherne, priest. Thomas Traherne was born in Hereford in about 1636. After studying in Oxford and being a parish priest for ten years, he became private chaplain to the Lord Keeper of the Seals of Charles II. Thomas was one of the English Metaphysical poets and yet, in his lifetime, only one of his works was ever printed. It was at the beginning of the twentieth century that his poems, until then in manuscript, were published and he took on the mantle of an Anglican Divine. His poetry is probably the most celebratory among his fellow metaphysical poets, with little mention of sin and suffering and concentrating more on the glory of creation, to the extent that some regard his writings as on the edge of pantheism.

In 1881, in Khartoum, St. Daniel Comboni. He was born in Brescia, in 1831, the only surviving child of a poor family. He studied theology in order to become a missionary priest in Africa. He went to the Sudan in 1857. He believed that Africa should be converted by drawing on the best aspects of indigenous culture. He shuttled back and forth between Africa and Italy and founded missionary institutes for both men and women. He was appointed bishop of central Africa in 1872, and bishop of Khartoum in 1877. He wrote learned studies on central Africa, lobbied on behalf of the African people and missions, and kept up a voluminous correspondence.

October 11

In the first century. Philip, deacon. All that is known of Philip is recorded in the Acts of the Apostles. He was one of the seven Greek-speaking men of good standing, 'full of the Spirit and of wisdom', chosen to distribute food to the Greek-speaking widows, and who are regarded as the first deacons. He is listed second, after Stephen, and following the martyrdom of Stephen it is to Philip that the story turns. Having fled to Samaria, he proclaimed the gospel there to great effect, baptising many, and preparing the way for Peter and John to come, that the people might receive the gift of the Spirit at their hands. Then he went to Gaza, meeting the Ethiopian official to whom he explained the significance of the prophecy of Isaiah, and baptising him. The baptism of this African was an important demonstration that the good news is for all people.

In Ireland, about 600, St. Kenneth or Canice. His legend has it that he was born in Derry, became a monk under St. Cadoc in Wales, and studied with St. Finnian at Clonard. He did mission work in Scotland, where he was an associate of St. Columba, and founded a monastery at Kilkenny, whose cathedral is dedicated to him.

The details of the birth and death of James the Deacon are not known, though, since he accompanied Paulinus, he may well have been Italian. James seems to have been very active in assisting Paulinus on his mission in southern Northumbria and, when King Edwin was killed in battle and Paulinus had to flee south, James remained in the north. At some risk to his life, he continued the work of preaching and baptising around the area which is now north Yorkshire. As an old man, he attended the Synod of Whitby in 664 and, though not a monk and therefore without a community to perpetuate his memory, he seems to have had enough popularity among ordinary Christians to have had a continuing cultus long after his death.

At Barking, in 675, Ethelburga, abbess. Ethelburga was sister of Erkenwald, Bishop of London, and was probably of royal blood. As Bede describes her, it seems she may well have owned, as well as been made Abbess of, the joint monastery at Barking. There was a tradition developing of monks and nuns sharing monasteries, often with a woman superior, for example Hilda at Whitby and Cuthburga at Wimborne. Though they lived quite separate lives, often divided by high walls, they would occasionally celebrate the Daily Office or the Mass together. There was also probably an element of safety involved with the ever-present threat of marauding Danes. Bede relates many miracles occurring around Ethelburga but little else is known of her life.

In 965, at Rheims, St. Bruno of Cologne. He was the son of Henry the Fowler and brother of Emperor Otto I. He was made abbot of Lorsch and Corvey when he was still a young deacon, and he reformed both monasteries. He was elected archbishop of Cologne in 953, where he sought to reinvigorate the clergy and monasteries. Later, he was made Duke of Lorraine and extended his reforms there as well.

In 1592, in Italy, St. Alexander Sauli. He joined the Barnabites at seventeen and taught at Pavia. He became the leader of the Barnabite order, and then bishop of Aleria in Corsica, where he worked effectively for twenty years. He lived in great poverty. He was a friend of St. Philip Neri.

In 1887, St. Mary Soledad. She was born in Madrid, was educated by the Daughters of Charity, and eventually became head of the Handmaids of Mary, who devote themselves to nursing the sick in their homes free of charge.

In 1962 the opening of the Second Vatican Council.

At Rome, in 1963, on June 4th, Pope Saint John XXIII. Born in Northern Italy in 1881, Angelo Roncalli was trained in Roman Catholic schools from an early age. After military service, Roncalli was ordained a priest in 1904. His passion for social justice for working people and for the poor was formed early and remained an important commitment of his ministry. In 1953, at the age of 72, he was made a cardinal and appointed patriarch of Venice, the first time he had ever been the bishop ordinary of a diocese. In 1958, Cardinal Roncalli was elected Pope and took the name John XXIII. After the long pontificate of Pius XII, it was widely assumed that John XXIII would be a brief “placeholder” pope of minor consequence. During the first year of his pontificate, he called the Second Vatican Council for the purpose of renewing and revitalising the church.

October 12

In 709, in England, St. Wilfrid, bishop. When he was fourteen, he went to Lindisfarne for four years. He wasn't satisfied with the Celtic customs there and went to France and Rome, where he developed a more politically involved model of the bishop's role. Returning to England, he became abbot of Ripon, and introduced the continental ways there. After the Synod of Whitby, he was appointed bishop of Northumbria. He endowed a large monastery at Hexham. He ran afoul of both the king and Archbishop Theodore; on his way to Rome to plead his case he did missionary work in Friesland. Upon his return to England, he had further difficulties with kings, but ended his days as bishop of Hexham.

In 709, in England, St. Wilfrid, bishop. Wilfrid spent four years in the monastery of Lindisfarne, but was unsatisfied with their Celtic customs and moved on to France and Rome, developing a politically active model of the role of the bishop. Returning to England, he became abbot of Ripon, and introduced there the monastic and liturgical practices of Rome and Gaul. After the Synod of Whitby, he was appointed bishop of Northumbria. Because of conflicts with Archbishop Theodore and several rulers, he spent a great deal of his life in exile. He ended his days as bishop at Hexham.

In 670, St. Ethelburga, abbess of Barking.

At Ramsgate in 1845, Elizabeth Fry, prison reformer. Elizabeth Gurney was born at Earlham in Norfolk in 1780. At the age of twenty, she married Joseph Fry, a London merchant and a strict Quaker. She was admitted as a minister in the Society of Friends and became a noted preacher. The appalling state of the prisons came to her notice and she devoted much of her time to the welfare of female prisoners in Newgate. In 1820 she took part in the formation of a nightly shelter for the homeless in London. She travelled all over Europe in the cause of prison reform. She was a woman of a strong Christian and evangelistic impulse and this inspired all her work.

At Schaerbeek, Brussels, in 1915, Edith Cavell. Edith Cavell was born into a clergy family at Swardeston in 1865. After life as a governess, she trained as a nurse, ending up working with the Red Cross in Belgium in 1907. On the outbreak of the First World War, she became involved in caring for the wounded on both sides. She refused repatriation and then began smuggling British soldiers from Belgium into Holland. In 1915 she was arrested and brought to trial. Protecting those who worked with her, she was sentenced to death and executed by firing squad on this day in the year 1915. She went to her death calmly, forgiving her executioners, convinced she had been doing her duty as a Christian.

October 13

In 1066, near Westminster, St. Edward the Confessor. Edward was born in 1002, the son of the English King Ethelred and his Norman wife Emma. Living in exile during the Danish supremacy, he was invited back to

England in 1042 to become king, and was heartily welcomed as a descendant of the old royal line. Sustained by Edward's diplomacy and determination, his reign was a balancing act between the influences of stronger characters at home and abroad. His reputation for sanctity was built on his personal, more than his political, qualities. He was concerned to maintain peace and justice in his realm, to avoid foreign wars, and to put his faith into practice. He was generous to the poor, hospitable to strangers, but no mere pietist. Having vowed as a young man to go on pilgrimage to Rome should his family fortunes ever be restored, he later felt it irresponsible to leave his kingdom, and was permitted instead to found or endow a monastery dedicated to Saint Peter. Edward chose the abbey on Thorney Island, by the river Thames, thus beginning the royal patronage of Westminster Abbey. He died on 5 January 1066 and his remains were translated to the Abbey on this day in the year 1162.

In 909, in France, St. Gerald of Aurillac. He was a nobleman who received a clerical education. He lived frugally, said lauds and attended Mass daily, and ruled his territory justly. He founded a monastery at Aurillac. According to St. Odo of Cluny, his biographer, "The poor and the wronged always had free access to him, nor did they need to bring the slightest gift to recommend their cause."

In 1503, at Trino, in Italy, Blessed Maddalena Panattieri. She was a beautiful noblewoman who became a Third Order Dominican when she was twenty. She began by teaching children, but soon she was speaking to their parents and clergy. She often criticised usury.

October 14

In Rome, in 222, St. Callistus, pope and martyr. Although most of what we know about him is from his critics, especially St. Hippolytus, Callistus seems to have defended Catholic doctrine and church discipline, though he was no rigorist. His tomb was discovered in 1960.

About 390, St. Justus of Lyons, bishop. He was known as a severe upholder of discipline and doctrine. At one point he abdicated his episcopal office and went to live an eremitical life in Egypt.

In the Punjab, in 1960, Esther John, missionary and martyr. Esther John was born Qamar Zia on this day in 1929 in British-ruled India. She attended a Christian school, and her Christian faith grew secretly. Fearing marriage to a Muslim, she ran away, took the name Esther John and worked in an orphanage. Her family pressed her to return, but she moved to the Punjab and worked in a mission hospital. She studied in Gujranwala, and became a missionary, bicycling between villages, teaching women to read, and working with them in the cotton fields, but there was still tension with her family. On 2 February 1960 Esther John was found brutally murdered in her bed. She is remembered with devotion by the Christian community with whom she lived and worked.

October 15

At Alba de Tormes, in 1582, St. Teresa of Avila, doctor of the church. She was born in 1515. She had a happy childhood and was a charming young woman. Her mother died when she was thirteen, and Teresa was sent to a convent school. She joined a large, easy-going Carmelite convent. When she took ill, she left the convent to recover and was much influenced by reading Francisco de Osuna's Third Spiritual Alphabet. After three years she returned to the convent, where she had great difficulty praying, but began developing her ideas about convent life: she wanted small, poor, enclosed communities which would pray for the unity of the church. She fought for her ideas and in 1562 founded the convent of St. Joseph in Avila, the first of many she established. As her spiritual life deepened, she began to write, and in spite of much opposition, she collaborated with St. John of the Cross in reforming the male branch of the Carmelite Order.

About 790, St. Thecla of Kitzingen. She was an associate of St. Boniface, and accompanied him to Germany on his mission to the Saxons. After living under St. Lioba at Bischofheim, she became abbess of Ochsenfurt, and then of Kitzingen.

In 1584, the martyrdom of St. Richard Gwyn. He was married, had six children, and worked as a school teacher. He was arrested a number of times for his adherence to the Catholic faith, and eventually hanged, drawn and quartered at Wrexham. His wife told the court that condemned him that she was ready to die with him.

October 16

In 650, St. Gall, who was born in Ireland and became a monk at Bangor under St. Comgall and St. Columban. He went with St. Columban as a missionary to Gaul. When Columban moved to Bobbio, Gall stayed behind and became a hermit in Switzerland. Gradually disciples gathered around him and a renowned monastery bearing his name later grew up at the site of one of his hermitages.

In 786, St. Lull, who accompanied his cousin, St. Boniface, on the German mission. He succeeded Boniface as bishop of Mainz. He was a zealous bishop and a promoter of learning.

At Trebnitz, in 1243, St. Hedwig. She and her husband, the duke of Silesia, founded many religious houses, including a convent for Cistercian nuns at Trebnitz.

At Oxford, in 1555, Nicholas Ridley and Hugh Latimer, bishops and martyrs. Born into a wealthy Northumbrian family in about the year 1500, Nicholas Ridley studied at Cambridge, the Sorbonne and in Louvain. He was chaplain to Thomas Cranmer and master of Pembroke Hall in Cambridge before being made Bishop of Rochester in 1547. He had been clearly drawing closer to the Reformers as early as 1535 and, at the accession of King Edward VI, declared himself a Protestant. He assisted Cranmer in preparing the first Book of Common Prayer and was made Bishop of London in 1550. On the death of Edward, he supported the claims of Lady Jane Grey and was thus deprived of his See on the accession of Mary Tudor. He was excommunicated and executed in 1555.

Hugh Latimer was a Leicestershire man, also educated at Cambridge but fifteen years older than Nicholas Ridley. Hugh was articulate and yet homely in his style of preaching, which made him very popular in the university, and he received its commission to preach anywhere in England. He became a close adviser of King Henry VIII after the latter's rift with the papacy and was appointed Bishop of Worcester in 1535. He lost the king's favour in 1540, over his refusal to sign Henry's 'Six Articles', designed to prevent the spread of Reformation doctrines, and resigned his See. He returned to favour on the accession of Edward VI but was imprisoned in the Tower of London when Queen Mary ascended the throne in 1553. He refused to recant any of his avowedly reformist views and was burnt at the stake, together with Nicholas Ridley, on this day in 1555.

In 1690, in France, St. Margaret Mary Alacoque. When she joined the Visitation convent at Paray-le-Monial in 1671 she was already advanced in the ways of prayer. A series of visions of Christ instructed her to spread the love of Jesus' Sacred Heart. Her efforts to do so met with much opposition, but she received support from Blessed Claude de la Colombière. Just before she died she declared, "I need nothing but God, and to lose myself in the heart of Jesus."

In 1790, Daniel Rowland, priest. The son of a Cardiganshire clergyman, Daniel Rowland was born at Nantcwnlle in 1713. He was probably educated at Hereford Grammar School before becoming his brother's curate at Llangeitho. Rowland was profoundly influenced by Griffith Jones. In 1735, after the Welsh Methodist revival began in Llangeitho during a service of the Litany, Rowland started preaching and administering communion outside his parish, often using remote and neglected chapels-of-ease. For a time he and Howell Harris worked closely together. As Rowland's reputation grew, thousands travelled to Llangeitho to hear him and to receive the sacrament from him. In 1763, during a rekindling of the revival, Rowland was deprived of his curacy. He set up a 'New Church' where he held services until his death in 1790. He was buried in Llangeitho Parish Church, of which his son had become rector. Rowland's

deprivation by the Church authorities was probably the most disastrous mistake in the history of Welsh Anglicanism.

October 17

About 105, in Rome, St. Ignatius, bishop of Antioch. He was arrested and sent to Rome to be executed. On the way, he was welcomed by members of various churches and wrote seven surviving letters. One letter to the church of Rome asked Christians there not to interfere with his impending martyrdom. In his other letters, addressed to churches in Asia Minor, he urged unity with the bishop and in the Eucharist and stressed the reality of Christ's humanity and divinity. He told the Ephesians, "You are all bearers of God, bearers of his temple, bearers of Christ, and so you are adorned with no other ornament than the counsels of Jesus Christ."

In 409, in the Egyptian Desert, St. John Kolobos ("The Dwarf"). He was formed in monastic life at Skete under the Abba Ammos, and when the latter became feeble, John cared for him for twelve years. Later John moved to Nitria and formed a community of disciples. John taught that a monk should stay in his cell, keep God ever before his mind, and discipline his feelings and inclinations.

In 1794, at Valenciennes, eleven Ursuline sisters, who were guillotined for operating a Catholic school.

In the same year, at Laval, nineteen priests and religious, who were among hundreds executed in that region for their faith.

October 18

In the first century, St. Luke the evangelist. Luke wrote his carefully planned Gospel for a Gentile audience. The parables of the Prodigal Son and the Crafty Steward, which occur only in his gospel, are examples of his storytelling skill. He highlights the place of Jerusalem in the plan of salvation, Jesus' mercy to sinners and his concern for outcasts. He is a patron saint of the medical profession and of painters.

October 19

In Canada, Sts. Isaac Jogues, John de Brebeuf, four other Jesuit missionaries, and two missionary helpers. Amid great hardships, they did missionary work among the Huron Indians. They were murdered by hostile Iroquois between 1642 and 1649.

In Oxford, in 779, St. Frideswide. She was abbess of a double monastery, which was located on the present day site of Christ Church. The town grew up around her monastery.

In Spain, in 1562, St. Peter of Alcántara. He founded an extremely austere branch of Observant Franciscans. He was a friend and supporter of St. Teresa of Avila.

In 1595, St. Philip Howard, who died a prisoner in the Tower of London. He was raised a Protestant, under the tutelage of John Knox. Through the influence of his wife and the persuasion of St. Edmund Campion, he became a Catholic. He was arrested when he and his wife tried to flee to the continent.

In 1775. In Rome, St. Paul of the Cross, the founder of the Passionist Order. He wanted to combine austere monastic living and preaching to the poor.

At Tokat in the Ottoman Empire, in 1812, Henry Martyn, priest. Born in Truro in 1781, Henry Martyn went up to Cambridge at the age of sixteen. He became an avowed evangelical and his friendship with Charles Simeon led to his interest in missionary work. In 1805, he left for Calcutta as a chaplain to the East India Company. The expectation was that he would minister to the British expatriate community, not to the

indigenous peoples; in fact, there was a constant fear of insurrection and even the recitation of Magnificat at Evensong was forbidden, lest 'putting down the mighty from their seats' should incite the natives. Henry set about learning the local languages and then supervised the translation of the New Testament first into Hindi and then into Persian and Arabic, as well as preaching and teaching in mission schools. He went to Persia to continue the work but, suffering from tuberculosis, he died in Armenia on this day in 1812.

In 1956, the dedication of the Chapel of Mary and the Angels, at the Monastery of the Holy Trinity, Crawley Down, the Community of the Servants of the Will of God.

October 20

In Constantinople, in 766, St. Andrew of Crete, monk and martyr. He went to Constantinople to defend the veneration of images and was executed by Emperor Constantine V.

In 1889, in France, Blessed Mary Teresa de Soubiran. She was raised in a wealthy and devout family, and became a Beguine. In 1864 she founded the Society of Mary the Helper, inspired by the spirit of St. Ignatius of Loyola. The sisters devoted themselves to caring for young working women and orphans, and teaching poor children. In 1874, the assistant mother general convinced the congregation to expand very rapidly, and they fell into desperate financial straits. Mary Teresa was wrongly blamed for this and was expelled from the congregation. Mary Teresa eventually died as a member of another order. Later, the congregation righted itself and flourished.

In 1922, at Treviso, in Italy, Saint Bertilla Boscardin. She joined the Sisters of St. Dorothy and was sent to their hospital in Treviso. She seemed inept, so she was assigned to the kitchen. However, when a shortage of help forced her superiors to assign her to the children's ward, she suddenly blossomed. She died of cancer at the age of thirty-four.

October 21

In 371, in Cyprus, St. Hilarion. He spent some time with St. Antony in Egypt, then lived as a hermit in his native Palestine. When too many people came to visit and live with him, he took up a wandering life, and moved successively to Egypt, Dalmatia and Cyprus. St. Jerome wrote his life a few years after Hilarion died.

About 635, St. Fintan. He founded a monastery at Taghmon in Wexford. He was a staunch upholder of Celtic church customs.

In 1450, in Sicily, Blessed Matthew of Agrigento. He was born in Spain. As a young man he became an Observant Franciscan and a companion of St. Bernardino of Siena. He preached widely in his native Sicily and promoted devotion to the Holy Name of Jesus. He also founded Observant Franciscan Houses in Spain, where he had strong support from King Alfonso V of Aragon.

At Rome, on the 28th December, 1837, Gaspar del Bufalo, priest, founder. He was born in Rome on January 6, 1786. From his youth, motivated by apostolic zeal, he dedicated himself to the evangelisation of the children of the needy, the people in the fields, the poor, the sick; with special attention to those languishing in hospices and hospitals. He became a priest of the clergy of Rome on July 31, 1808. During the Napoleonic upheavals, because of his loyalty to the Holy Father, he was exiled and then held in jail in the northern part of Italy. Returning to Rome after Napoleon's demise, at the request of Pius VII, he, along with a group of priests, dedicated himself to the renewal of the clergy and the Christian faithful through popular missions and spiritual exercises. Imbued with a deep devotion to the blood of Christ and intending to apply more efficaciously the fruits of redemption to souls, in 1815 he founded the Congregation of the Missionaries of the Most Precious Blood. His preaching bore fruit even in the lower part of the Lazio region plagued by banditry. With his advice, he inspired and encouraged Maria De Mattias to found the Congregation of the Sisters Adorers of the Blood of Christ.

October 22

The Interior life of Our Lady.

At Rome on 2nd April 2005, Pope St John Paul II. Józef Wojtyła was born in 1920 in Wadowice, Poland. After his ordination to the priesthood and theological studies in Rome, he returned to his homeland and resumed various pastoral and academic tasks. He became first auxiliary bishop and, in 1964, Archbishop of Kraków and took part in the Second Vatican Council. On 16 October 1978 he was elected pope and took the name John Paul II. His exceptional apostolic zeal, particularly for families, young people and the sick, led him to numerous pastoral visits throughout the world. Among the many fruits which he has left as a heritage to the Church are above all his rich Magisterium and the promulgation of the Catechism of the Catholic Church as well as the Code of Canon Law for the Latin Church and for the Eastern Churches. In Rome on 2 April 2005, the eve of the Second Sunday of Easter (or of Divine Mercy), he departed peacefully in the Lord. He was canonised by Pope Francis on 27 April, the Second Sunday of Easter 2014.

About 200 AD, St. Albercius, bishop of Hieropolis in Phrygia. When he was 72, he journeyed to Rome and Mesopotamia. On his tombstone, he wrote how impressed he was by the faith and Eucharistic practice of the Christians he met.

At Engelberg, the commemoration of St. Eugene, a Roman martyr whose relics are at the abbey.

About 876, in Fiesole, St. Donatus, bishop. He was an Irish monk who stopped by Fiesole on the way back from a pilgrimage to Rome. He was elected bishop there and served in the capacity for several decades. He was a writer and poet, and wrote a life of St. Brigid, to whom he had a deep devotion.

At Camberley, in 1908, Ignatius of Jesus OSB, founder and abbot of the Abbey of Sts Mary and David, at Llanthony, Brecon, pioneer of the monastic life in the Anglican communion. Joesph Leicester Lyne was a friend of Pusey, who was his confessor, and Priscilla Lydia Seddon. Seeking to restore the Benedictine life to the Church of England Lyne is remembered as an eccentric enthusiast, Francis Kilvert in his diary describes him "as being a man of gentle simple kind manners, excitable, and entirely possessed by the one idea. [...] His head and brow are very fine, the forehead beautifully rounded and highly imaginative. The face is a very saintly one and the eyes extremely beautiful, earnest and expressive, a dark soft brown. When excited they seem absolutely to flame. He wears the Greek or early British tonsure all round the temples, leaving the hair of the crown untouched. His manner gives you the impression of great earnestness and single-mindedness. [...] Father Ignatius thinks every one is as good as himself and is perfectly unworldly, innocent and unsuspecting."

October 23

In the first century, James, bishop of Jerusalem, martyr. James, 'the Lord's brother', was a leader of the Church in Jerusalem from a very early date, and is regarded as its first bishop. Though not one of the Twelve, Paul includes James among those to whom the risen Lord appeared before the ascension, and records that James received him cordially when he visited Jerusalem after his conversion. He was regarded as the leader of the Jewish community when the Church expanded to embrace Gentiles, and was successful in bringing many of his fellow Jews to faith in Christ. He presided at the Council of Jerusalem. He is understood to have been stoned to death around the year 62.

In 1456, St. John of Capistrano. Born in the Abruzzi, he studied law at Perugia and became governor of the city in 1412, marrying the daughter of a leading family. During a civil war he was imprisoned. When he was released he became a Franciscan, studied under St. Benardino of Siena, and became an outstanding preacher and reformer. He wrote a Mirror for the Clergy. He worked in Hungary to convert the Hussites and helped to stop the invading Turks in the battle of Belgrade.

In 524, the death of St. Severinus Boethius. He was a public figure, but retired to a life of scholarship, writing influential theological treatises and translations of Aristotelian logical works. He fell afoul of the the Ostrogoth King Theodoric and was imprisoned. While he was in prison, Boethius wrote the Consolation of Philosophy.

In 877, St. Ignatius, patriarch of Constantinople. He was the son of Emperor Michael I. He was deposed by the Emperor for political reasons and replaced by Photius, who was more amenable to state control of ecclesiastical matters. They were alternately installed and deposed as patriarch several times.

In 1478, at Rome, Blessed Catherine, Queen of Bosnia. Her son, King Tomasevic, was captured by the invading Turks. He offered to convert to Islam, but they beheaded him anyway. Catherine escaped to Rome and there spent the rest of her life praying for her country and for her two sons, who disappeared when their stepbrother was killed.

October 24

In 1870, at the Cistercian monastery of Fontfroide, St. Antony Mary Claret. He was born in Catalonia, became a priest, and worked in Spain for ten years. In 1849 he founded the Claretian Order dedicated to the Immaculate Heart of Mary. He was very devoted to the printed word. From 1850 to 1857 he served as archbishop of Cuba, where he was a zealous leader of the church. He was then appointed confessor to Queen Isabella II of Spain. He preached at court and, whenever he could, elsewhere.

In 446, St. Proclus, Patriarch of Constantinople. He opposed the theological errors of Nestorius. He was known as a wise and gentle churchman, inclined to make peace rather than to argue.

In the sixth century, in Brittany, St. Maelor, an Irish monk who served as missionary there and on the Channel Islands.

October 25

About 285, in Rome, Saints Crispin and Crispinian, martyrs. Their relics were venerated at Soissons, and they are patrons of leather workers.

In 1497, Blessed Thaddeus MacCarthy, bishop. He went to Rome to appeal for papal help when political factions kept him from acting as bishop in his diocese. The pope supported him. Bishop Thaddeus traveled back toward Ireland as a simple pilgrim. He died on the way in the Italian Alps, at a hospice maintained by the Canons Regular of St. Bernard.

In 1631, Lewis Bayley, bishop. Lewis Bayley was born in 1565 and was a native of Carmarthen. Educated at Exeter College, Oxford, he received several church preferments in England and Wales before becoming Treasurer of St Paul's Cathedral and Chaplain to James I. In 1616 Bayley was appointed Bishop of Bangor, remaining there till his death in 1631. His episcopate was marred by his inept handling of Church and State politics, which led to a brief spell in the Fleet Prison in 1621. Bayley's devotional manual, The Practice of Piety appeared in 1611 and is said to have been based on a series of sermons that he had given while Vicar of Evesham. By 1842 it had gone through eighty English editions, and had been translated into several languages. The Welsh version was published in 1630 and reprinted five times in a hundred years. Among those who were strongly influenced by Bayley's book were John Bunyan and Howell Harris.

October 26

About 461, St. Rusticus, bishop of Narbonne. He studied at Rome and became a monk. St. Jerome wrote him a letter giving advice on the eremitical life. In 427 he was made bishop. He was discouraged by the Arianism

of the Goths and the quarrels among Catholics and asked to resign. Pope Leo the Great wrote him a letter telling him to carry on as bishop with the help of Christ.

In 664, at Lastingham, St. Cedd. Cedd was born in Northumbria in the late sixth century and joined the monastery of Lindisfarne where he served many years. When King Peada of the Middle Angles became a Christian, Cedd was sent with three other priests to preach the gospel in this new territory. Some time later, King Sigebert of the East Saxons was converted and Cedd, now an experienced missionary, went with another priest to Essex. After travelling through the region they reported back to Lindisfarne where Cedd was consecrated Bishop for the East Saxons. He returned to Essex to continue his work, building churches and two monasteries, and ordaining deacons and priests. While on a visit to Northumbria he founded his third monastery, at Lastingham, where he died of fever in the year 664 after attending the Synod of Whitby.

In 686, in Northumbria, St. Eata. He was trained by St. Aidan, and became abbot of Melrose, where he received St. Cuthbert into the noviciate. He succeeded St. Colman as abbot of Lindisfarne when Colman returned to Ireland rather than give up his Celtic customs.

At Winchester in 899, Alfred the Great, king. Born in the year 849, Alfred was the king of the West Saxons who effectively brought to an end the constant threat of Danish dominion in the British Isles. He came to the throne at the age of twenty-two and, after establishing peace, set about bringing stability to both church and state. He gave half of his income to founding religious houses which themselves acted as Christian centres for education, care of the sick and poor and respite for travellers. He was a daily attender at mass and himself translated many works into the vernacular. He evolved a legal code based on common sense and Christian mercy. His whole life was marked by the compassion of Christ.

October 27

About 380, in Ethiopia, St. Frumentius, bishop. His tutor took him and his brother Aedesius on a trip to Arabia. Most of the party were killed, but the brothers were taken to the royal court at Aksum. Frumentius prospered there and sought to spread the Christian faith. St. Athanasius appointed him bishop of Ethiopia. Known as Bishop Salama, he is venerated as the Apostle of Ethiopia.

In 563, St Otteran, abbot. Otteran, an abbot from Meath, was one of the companions who sailed with Columba from Lough Foyle. Soon after landing on Iona, he died on this day in the year 563. His burial place, the Realig Odhrain, later became also the burial place for kings of Dalriada, Scotland and Norway. Scandinavian links with Iona explain the special place Otteran has as patron of the See of Waterford, which was founded by the Danes.

October 28

In the first century, the Apostles Simon and Jude. Simon is referred to as "the Zealot" in the Gospel of Luke, which means he may have belonged to a radical anti-Roman group. Jude is referred to as the "son of James" in the Gospel of Luke, and in the Gospel of John he speaks with Jesus at the Last Supper. Jude is widely revered as the patron of hopeless causes.

October 29

In the twelfth century, St. Abraham of Rostov. Born in the Ukraine, he converted to Christianity when his prayer to be healed of a chronic disease was answered. He became a monk, and then proclaimed the gospel around Rostov. He built two churches for his converts. He is venerated as "the apostle of Rostov".

At Busoga in Uganda, in 1885, James Hannington, bishop. James Hannington was born in 1847 of a Congregationalist family but he became an Anglican before going up to Oxford. He was ordained and, after serving a curacy for five years, went with the Church Missionary Society to Uganda. He was consecrated

bishop for that part of Africa in 1884 and a year later began a safari inland from Mombasa, together with other European and indigenous Christians. The King of the Buganda, Mwanga, who despised Christians because they refused to condone his moral turpitude, seized the whole party, tortured them for several days and then had them butchered to death.

October 30

About 540 AD, St. Germanus of Capua. He may have been one of the legates sent to heal the Acacian Schism, which concerned the relationship of the divine and human in Christ. He was a friend of St. Benedict. The Dialogues of Gregory the Great tell that St. Benedict had a vision of Germanus' soul being carried to heaven. His tomb at Cassino was destroyed during World War II.

October 31

At Regensburg, about 994, St. Wolfgang, bishop. He was educated at Reichenau and then at Würzburg. He befriended a nobleman named Henry, and when Henry became archbishop of Trier, Wolfgang became a teacher in the cathedral school. He then became a monk at Einsiedeln. St. Ulric of Augsburg sent him to evangelize the Magyars. In 972 Otto II appointed him bishop of Regensburg. He proved himself a keen reformer and champion of the poor. He was a tutor to St. Henry II.

At Eisleben, in Saxony, in 1546, Martin Luther, reformer. Martin Luther was born in 1483 at Eisleben in Saxony and educated at the cathedral school in Magdeburg and the university in Erfurt. He joined an order of Augustinian hermits there and was ordained priest in 1507, becoming a lecturer in the university at Wittenberg. He became vicar of his Order in 1515, having charge of a dozen monasteries. His Christian faith began to take on a new shape, with his increasing dissatisfaction with the worship and order of the Church. He became convinced that the gospels taught that humanity is saved by faith and not by works, finding support in the writings of St Augustine of Hippo. He refuted the teaching of the Letter of James, calling it 'an epistle of straw'. Martin sought to debate the whole matter by posting ninety-five theses or propositions on the door of the Castle Church in Wittenburg on this day in the year 1517. The hierarchy chose to see it as a direct attack on the Church, which forced Martin into open rebellion. The Protestant Reformation spread throughout Germany and then Europe, many seeing it as liberation from a Church that held them in fear rather than love.

[In Wales: Catholic Saints and Martyrs of the Reformation Era.]

November

November 1

The Solemnity of All Saints. This feast, which might be called the fulfillment of Pentecost, honours all who are now with God, the great multitude beyond number, which all who wish may join. The feast seems to have succeeded earlier observance of a feast of all the martyrs. It first appeared in the seventh century.

In the second or third century, St. Benignus of Dijon. He spread the gospel in Burgundy and was martyred. A shrine and a monastery grew up at the site of his tomb.

In 1431, in Portugal, Blessed Nonius. He led the Portuguese to victory over Castile, a victory that firmly established Portugal as a nation. His daughter married the son of King João of Portugal. Then Nonius became a lay brother at a Carmelite friary he had established in Lisbon. He remained there the rest of his life.

November 2

The Solemnity of All Souls. 2 Maccabees 12.44-45 recommends prayers for the dead, and from earliest times Christians prayed for their dead. A feast for the dead, dedicated to prayers to help move them from what was later known as purgatory to heaven, first appeared in the seventh century. The commemoration of the dead on November 2 spread to the universal church from Cluny, where it was established by St. Odilo.

At Argentan, in 1521, St. Margaret of Lorraine. She was born into a noble family and married into another. Left a widow with three children when she was twenty-nine, she raised her children well and was a capable administrator of their patrimony. When her children were grown she retired to a convent, where she devoted herself to the poor and sick.

November 3

In 1639, in Lima, Peru, St. Martin de Porres. Martin was the illegitimate son of a Spanish nobleman and a freed black slave. He received training in medicine. He became a donatus, and later a lay brother, in the Dominican friary in Lima. He energetically fulfilled his community tasks, and untiringly cared for the sick in his community and the city. He extended practical charity to the hungry, to slaves, and to animals.

In Wales, about 650, St. Winefride. Winifred (Gwenfrewi) is said to have been the daughter of a soldier from Tegeingl (Flintshire) named Tyfid ab Eiludd. Her mother's brother was Saint Beuno. At her father's request, Beuno became Winifred's spiritual director. A nobleman named Caradog tried to force himself on Winifred, who ran to seek sanctuary in Beuno's cell at Sychnant. Caradog caught up with her and cut her head off. A spring gushed forth at the spot where her head landed. Beuno cursed the nobleman (who melted away like wax) and restored Winifred to life. The legend is colourful and curious. That Winifred was the superior of a community of holy women at Gwytherin seems beyond dispute. She was buried there, but in 1138 her relics were moved to Shrewsbury Abbey, and her cult became more widespread. Saint Winifred's well at Holywell was said to be the spring that appeared at her beheading.

In 753, in Germany, St. Pirmin. A refugee from Spain, he did missionary work in Baden. He rebuilt the abbey of Disentis, became the first abbot of Reichenau, and founded the abbey of Murbach.

In 1148, at Clairvaux, St. Malachy, bishop of Armagh. As a young priest he was involved in reforming and restructuring the Irish church. To qualify himself for this task, he studied canon law with St. Malchus, bishop of Lismore. After a year as abbot of Bangor, Malachy was appointed bishop, and served in that capacity successively at Connor, Armagh and Down. He introduced the canons regular to Ireland. On a trip to Rome he met St. Bernard, and then introduced the Cistercians to Ireland at Mellifont. On another trip to Rome, he became ill and died at Clairvaux. St. Bernard wrote his life.

In Switzerland, in 1226, St. Ida. Legend relates that she escaped an abusive husband and became a hermit. Years later, he asked her forgiveness. So many people came to visit her that she finally took refuge in the Benedictine monastery of Fischingen. Originally founded by monks from Petershausen in the 12th century and suppressed in the 19th century, Fischingen was refounded from Engelberg in 1977 at the urging of a zealous group of lay people.

At Bishopsbourne, in Kent, in 1600, Richard Hooker, priest. Born in Heavitree in Exeter in about 1554, Richard Hooker came under the influence of John Jewel, Bishop of Salisbury, in his formative years and through that influence went up to Corpus Christi College, Oxford, where he became a fellow. He was ordained and then married, becoming a parish priest and, in 1585, Master of the Temple in London. Richard became one of the strongest advocates of the position of the Church of England and defended its 'middle way' between puritanism and papalism. Perhaps his greatest work was *Of the Laws of Ecclesiastical Polity* which he wrote as the result of engaging in controversial debates. He showed Anglicanism as rooted firmly in Scripture as well as tradition, affirming its continuity with the pre-Reformation *Ecclesia Anglicana*, but now both catholic and reformed.

At Lima, Viceroyalty of Peru, in 1639, St Martin de Porres, priest. Born in Lima in Peru in 1579, Martin de Porres was the illegitimate son of a Spanish knight and a black, Panamanian freewoman. He joined the Third Order of the Dominicans when he was fifteen years old and was later received as a lay brother into the First Order, mainly because of his reputation for caring for the poor and needy. As the friary almoner, he was responsible for the daily distribution to the poor and he had a particular care for the many African slaves, whose lives were a dreadful indictment of the Christian conquistadores. Martin became sought after for spiritual counsel, unusual for a lay brother at that time. His care for all God's creatures led many to love and revere him and his own brothers chose him as their spiritual leader. He died of a violent fever on this day in the year 1639 and, because of his care for all, regardless of class or colour, is seen as the patron saint of race relations.

[In Wales, Martyrs and Confessors of our Time. In our own time there has been no shortage of people who have given their lives as witnesses to the light of Christ. Christians have been victims of persecution in Europe, of religious prejudice and dictatorial rule in Africa, of fanaticism in the Indian subcontinent; they have been killed in the brutalities of the Second World War in Asia, and the Cultural Revolution in China. Led by their faith and the imperative to work for the kingdom of God, Christians have borne witness against oppression and injustice. They have worked among the poor in the slums, among the diseased and terminally ill, at home and abroad. In these and countless other ways Christians have shown the enduring significance of the good news preached by Jesus Christ.]

November 4

In 1584, St. Charles Borromeo, bishop of Milan. His education was paid for by revenue from a Benedictine abbey of which he was made commendatory abbot when he was twelve. His uncle Pope Pius IV made him a cardinal when he was twenty-two, appointed him administrator of the diocese of Milan, and assigned him various curial responsibilities as well. He was an extremely efficient person who also found time for music and physical exercise. He was a dynamic presence at the last session of the Council of Trent and spent the rest of his life implementing its decrees in his diocese. He was particularly energetic in promoting Christian education. He died at the age of 46.

In the sixth century, St. John Zedazneli and companions. They were missionaries who were instrumental in establishing Christianity and monasticism in Georgia.

November 5

In the first century, Saints Zechariah and Elizabeth, the parents of John the Baptist.

At Holyhead, in the sixth century, St Cybi, abbot. Cybi's medieval hagiographer says that he was a native of Cornwall. He tells us that the saint came to Wales after some years as a pilgrim. Having visited David, Cybi went over to Ireland. He then crossed to Anglesey, eventually establishing his principal monastery at Caergybi (Holyhead). From there an Anglesey folk tradition says that he would visit his 'soul friend' Seiriol at the wells of Clorach halfway between their two monasteries. Another centre associated with Cybi was Llangybi in Caernarfonshire where his holy well drew many pilgrims hoping for healing from a variety of ailments. Many of the places connected with Cybi are on the coast and in a fifteenth-century poem he is described as the captain of a crew of holy men. Like many of the sixth-century saints he seems to have made extensive use of the seaways.

In 1707, at Constantinople, Blessed Gomidas Keumurgian. During the late 17th century in Constantinople there was a movement favouring reunion with Rome. A backlash against this movement led to persecution, and Blessed Gomidas was arrested, tried and beheaded. He was an Armenian priest, known for his eloquence and devotion. He converted to Catholicism when he was forty, and many Armenians in Constantinople, moved by his martyrdom, did the same.

In 1943, at Hof, Bavaria, Blessed Bernard Lichtenberg. As a parish priest in Berlin, he supported a pacifist Catholic group in 1931 and consistently opposed the Nazi mistreatment of the Jews from the outset. He was arrested several times, and died as the Gestapo were transporting him to Dachau.

November 6

At Dol, in Cornwall, in 530, St Illtud, abbot. Born in Brittany in the mid fifth century, Illtud received a good education in all branches of science and art, and seemed destined for academic life in a monastery. However, he chose a military career, leaving Brittany for the court of King Arthur, his cousin, in Somerset. Being spared death on a hunt, Illtud left the royal court for the service of a greater king, Jesus. He settled in a valley near what is now Llantwit Major in the Vale of Glamorgan, being instructed in the monastic life by Dyfrig, ordained priest, and once his monastic school was established, appointed abbot. The school was an important centre of learning, kings and chiefs from the whole country sending their children to be educated by Illtud. Among its pupils were David, Samson and Paulinus. The monks' and pupils' time at the monastery was divided between prayer, study and manual work; the whole valley was cultivated, Illtud inventing a new plough to halve the time taken to prepare the ground. Illtud made a number of visits to Brittany and founded churches there; he later retired to the land of his birth, dying in the monastery at Dol in the year 530.

According to an eleventh-century Life, Leonard was a sixth-century Frankish nobleman who refused a bishopric to become first a monk, then a hermit, at Noblac (now Saint-Léonard) near Limoges. The miracles attributed to him, both during his lifetime and after his death, caused a widespread cultus throughout Europe and, in England alone, over a hundred and seventy churches are dedicated to him.

In 1414, at Tours, Blessed Jeanne-Marie de Maillé. She was a devout girl who wanted to be a nun; her prayers were thought to have saved a boy who lived near her family. When they grew up, they married and lived as brother and sister. They adopted three children and lived happily for sixteen years. Then her husband, Robert, was wounded in the Hundred Years' War and their castle was pillaged. Robert was ransomed. Thereafter the two of them added ransom of prisoners to their charitable activities. When Robert died, Jeanne-Marie gave up all her property and lived in poverty in Tours, where she spent the rest of her life praying and visiting prisoners.

At Westgate on Sea in Kent, in 1944, William Temple, bishop. William Temple was born in 1881 and baptised on this day in Exeter Cathedral. His father was Bishop of Exeter and later Archbishop of Canterbury. William excelled in academic studies and developed into a philosopher and theologian of significance. After ordination, he quickly made a mark in the Church and at forty became a bishop. Within a decade he was Archbishop of York. He is especially remembered for his ecumenical efforts and also for his concern with

social issues, contributing notably to the debate which led to the creation of state welfare provision after the Second World War. He died two years after his translation to the See of Canterbury.

November 7

In 739, at the monastery of Echternach, St. Willibrord. When Willibrord was seven, his father decided to become a hermit, and Willibrord was sent to St. Wilfrid's monastery at Ripon to be raised. He studied in Ireland for twelve years, and then set off from England with twelve companions to work as a missionary among the Frisians in what is today the Netherlands. He made several trips to Rome to obtain papal approval and was ordained archbishop. In his old age he retired to the monastery he had founded at Echternach.

In 1581, Richard Davies, bishop. Richard Davies, the son of a north Welsh curate, was probably born in 1501. He was a graduate of New Inn Hall, Oxford, where he apparently first came into contact with Protestant ideas. In 1553, on the accession of Queen Mary, Davies was deprived of the English Crown livings to which he had been appointed in the previous reign. He and his family went into exile in Frankfurt. After Mary's death Davies returned and was appointed Bishop of St Asaph. In 1561 he moved to the See of St Davids. Richard Davies was a conscientious bishop and a gifted scholar. He collaborated with William Salesbury in producing the Welsh Prayer Book and New Testament of 1567. His preface to the latter was an Epistol at y Cembu ('Letter to the Welsh') which argued that the reformed Church in Wales had recovered the early Welsh Christianity of the period before Augustine of Canterbury. Davies also translated some of the Old Testament into English for the 'Bishop's Bible' of 1568. He died in the year 1581.

November 8

Around 300, the Four Holy Crowned Martyrs, to whom a church on the Coelian Hill is dedicated. Their legend indicates that they were Pannonian stonemasons who were martyred under Diocletian.

At the Abbey of Einsiedeln, in 996, St. Gregory, abbot. Gregory was born into the English royal family. He left England and became a monk at St. Andrew's on the Coelian Hill in Rome. From there he became a hermit in the Alps, and then abbot of Einsiedeln.

In 1115, at Soissons, St. Godfrey of Amiens. He was raised in a monastery, and became abbot of Nogent, which flourished under his leadership. He was appointed bishop of Amiens. He continued to live a monastic life and was a zealous, if severe, bishop. He became discouraged and was thinking about joining the Carthusians at the time he died.

In 1308, in Cologne, Blessed John Duns Scotus. He was born at Duns in Scotland, joined the Franciscans, and was educated and taught at Oxford and Paris. He then taught at Cologne, where he died at the age of forty-three. He was one of the most brilliant philosophers and theologians of his age. His theology is focused on love: God is love, and God's love is expressed in creation and in the Incarnation, through which human beings can love God in return.

In 1916, at the Carmelite monastery in Dijon, St. Elizabeth of the Trinity. She was a lively girl, with musical talent. From the time of her first communion she began leading a deep interior life, focused on awareness of the Trinity dwelling within her. She became a Carmelite when she was twenty-one, but shortly thereafter contracted a debilitating disease. She united her sufferings with those of Christ, and was joyful in spite of her pain until near the end, when she felt desolation. Her life, and the notes and letters that she left behind, were made known by a number of scholars, including Hans Urs von Balthasar.

[The Church of England observes today All Saints and Martyrs of England. The date when Christianity first came to England is not known, but there were British bishops at the Council of Arles in the year 314, indicating a Church with order and worship. Since those days, Christians from England have shared the message of the good news at home

and around the world. As the world-wide fellowship of the Anglican Communion developed, incorporating peoples of many nations and cultures, individual Christian men and women have shone as beacons, heroically bearing witness to their Lord, some through a simple life of holiness, others by giving their lives for the sake of Christ.]

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November 9

In 1989, the fall of the Berlin wall.

The commemoration of the dedication of the church of St. John Lateran. The Lateran palace was part of the estate of Constantine's wife Fausta. He donated it to the Christians of Rome in 312. Constantine financed the building of a large church next to the palace. It was dedicated to the Saviour, but later it received the name of John the Baptist, probably derived from the nearby baptistery. It has been the cathedral church of the bishops of Rome ever since.

In 467, in Ireland, St. Benen. He was a disciple and successor to St. Patrick, who named him Benignus, because of his kindly disposition. He is remembered as the first to bring the gospel to Counties Clare and Kerry.

In Deventer, in 917, St. Radbod. He was the great-grandson of the King Radbod, who opposed the missionary work of St. Willibrord. He was educated at Cologne, became a monk when he was about thirty, and then was chosen bishop of Utrecht. As bishop, he lived as a monk, became a vegetarian, and continued his studies amid his pastoral and charitable work. He wrote some hymns that survive.

At King's Lynn some time after 1438, Margery Kempe, mystic. Margery Kempe was born in Lynn in Norfolk in the late fourteenth century, a contemporary of Julian of Norwich. She received many visions, several of them of the holy family, one of the most regular being of the crucifixion. She also had conversations with the saints. She was much sought after as a visionary, was endlessly in trouble with the Church, rebuked by the Archbishop and was more than once imprisoned. Following the messages in her visions, she undertook pilgrimages to many holy places, including Walsingham, Canterbury, Compostela, Rome and Jerusalem, often setting out penniless. She was blessed with the gift of tears and seems to have been favoured with singular signs of Christ's love, whereby for long periods she enjoyed consciousness of a close communion with him and developed a strong compassion for the sins of the world. Her autobiography, *The Book of Margery Kempe*, recounts her remarkable life.

In 1875, George Hay Forbes, priest. The date when Christianity first came to England is not known, but there were British bishops at the Council of Arles in the year 314, indicating a Church with order and worship. Since those days, Christians from England have shared the message of the good news at home and around the world. As the world-wide fellowship of the Anglican Communion developed, incorporating peoples of many nations and cultures, individual Christian men and women have shone as beacons, heroically bearing witness to their Lord, some through a simple life of holiness, others by giving their lives for the sake of Christ.

November 10

In Germany, in 1938, Kristallnacht. The destruction of Jewish businesses and premises including synagogues and the deportation of some 25 000 to concentration camps.

In 461, at Rome, St. Leo the Great. He served as an advisor and ambassador for several popes. He was very energetic and big-hearted. He crystallised the belief that the bishop of Rome is heir of Peter with authority from Christ over the universal church. His Tome to Flavian, bishop of Constantinople, was read and approved at the Council of Chalcedon. He did not approve of the council's decision to make Constantinople a patriarchate. In 452 he convinced Attila the Hun to spare Rome, and helped those victimised when Gaiseric the Vandal looted Rome in 455. His letters and sermons are clear and well-written. He was declared a doctor of the church in 1754.

In 627, at Canterbury, St. Justus. He accompanied St. Augustine to England, and became bishop of Rochester, and then of Canterbury.

November 11

In 1918, Armistice Day.

In 397, at Tours, St. Martin, monk and bishop. According to his biographer, Sulpicius Severus, who knew Martin personally, Martin was born in Hungary, but raised in Pavia, Italy. His father forbade him to become a Christian and forced him to become a soldier like himself. He was serving near Amiens when he cut his cloak in half to share it with a beggar, an event which is often depicted in art. He left the army and settled as a hermit at Ligugé, near Poitiers. A community formed around him. In 362, over his objections, he was made bishop of Tours. As bishop he lived as a monk in a community he founded called Marmoutier. One of his key preoccupations was to bring Christianity to rural areas.

In 826, in Bithynia, St. Theodore the Studite. He became abbot of a monastery at an early age. He was several times exiled for rebuking moral lapses in Byzantine rulers and for his defense of images. Eventually he became abbot of the monastery of Studios at Constantinople. The wise and prudent observances he developed there were adopted by many monasteries.

About 1050, at the abbey of Grottaferrata, near Rome, St. Bartholomew, who with St. Nilus, was instrumental in founding that abbey.

At Copenhagen, in 1855, Søren Kierkegaard. One of the most influential philosophers of the nineteenth century, Søren Kierkegaard, the son of a devout Lutheran, spent most of his life in Copenhagen. Sometimes referred to as the "Father of Existentialism," Kierkegaard is known for his concept of "the leap of faith". His religious and theological works, such as *Practice in Christianity* and *Christian Discourses*, show his profound understanding of the significance of the teaching and sacrificial death of Jesus Christ and of the human call to live in imitation of the selfless, sacrificial life of Jesus. His work was influential on philosophers such as Martin Heidegger and on theologians such as Karl Barth.

November 12

In the sixth century, St Machar, bishop. Machar was born in Ireland of princely parentage, and was baptised by Colman. He accompanied Columba to Iona, from where he moved to Mull – allegedly because his sanctity aroused the jealousy of some of the other monks. Later he established a mission in the north-east of Scotland, on the site that came to be occupied by the cathedral in Old Aberdeen which is dedicated to him. Saint Machar's Well beside it traditionally provided water for local baptisms.

In the seventh century, St Tysilio, abbot. Tysilio was the son of Brochwel Ysgithrog, prince of Powys. Against his father's will he became a member of the religious community established by Gwyddfarch at Meifod. Tysilio succeeded Gwyddfarch as Abbot of Meifod and under his leadership it became the most important religious centre in Powys. Saint Beuno spent forty days there with Tysilio, after Berriew was overrun by the Saxons. The cluster of churches dedicated to Tysilio in Montgomeryshire and Denbighshire reflect his

influence in the area. Three other dedications (in Anglesey, Ceredigion and on the borders of Carmarthenshire and Pembrokeshire) give credence to the tradition that he left Powys for a time in order not to be forced to become its prince. After his death Tysilio became seen as the saintly protector of Powys. He is depicted as such in a famous poem written in the twelfth century by Cynddelw Brydydd Mawr.

In 1623, at Vitebsk, St. Josaphat, bishop and martyr. He was born in the Ukraine and educated at Vilnius in Lithuania, where he became a monk. He was a strong promoter of the union of the Ruthenian church with the Roman church. He was appointed bishop of Vitebsk. He was murdered by a rival who opposed union with Rome.

November 13

In 867, St. Nicholas I, pope. He was a staunch defender of the independence and primacy of the bishop of Rome. He stood up to kings in defense of the marriage bond and of the right of a woman to freely choose her husband. He contended with Photius, the patriarch of Constantinople. He sent a masterful reply to questions addressed him by Boris, the ruler of the Bulgarians. He was renowned for his care for the poor.

In 1004, St. Abbo, abbot of Fleury-sur-Loire. Because of his learning, he was invited by St. Oswald to direct the school of Ramsey. After two years he returned to Fleury, where he was soon elected abbot. He was very active in political and monastic affairs, and was killed while on a peacemaking mission to a monastery. He wrote the first life of St. Edmund, king and martyr.

In 1836, Charles Simeon, priest. Born in Reading in 1759, Charles Simeon was educated at Cambridge University and spent the rest of his life in that city. He became a fellow of King's College in 1782 and was ordained priest the following year, when he became vicar of Holy Trinity Church nearby. He had evangelical leanings as a boy but it was whilst preparing for holy communion on his entrance to College that he became aware of the redeeming love of God, an experience he regarded as the turning point in his life. Many of the parishioners of Holy Trinity Church did not welcome him, since he had been appointed through his own family links, but his patient care and love for them all overcame their antipathy and his preaching greatly increased the congregation. Charles had carved on the inside of the pulpit in Holy Trinity Church, where only the preacher could see, the words from John 12:21, when Philip brought the Greeks to our Lord, and they said "Sir, we would see Jesus." These words were a constant reminder to him that people came not to gaze on a great preacher or to admire his eloquence, but to seek Jesus. Charles became a leading Evangelical influence in the Church and was one of the founders of the Church Missionary Society. He also set up the Simeon Trust which made appointments to parishes of fellow Evangelicals. He remained vicar of Holy Trinity parish until his death on this day in the year 1836.

In 1917, in Chicago, St. Frances Xavier Cabrini. She was the tenth of eleven children born to farmers near Pavia. She became a school teacher, ran an orphanage, then founded an order called the Missionary Sisters of the Sacred Heart. The bishop of Piacenza, Blessed Giovanni Batista Scalabrini encouraged her to send her missionaries to minister to immigrants in America. She went to New York with six sisters. They were poor and at first unwelcome, but she gradually gained support. She worked very hard, traveling the country setting up schools, orphanages and hospitals. She returned to Italy nine times and also traveled to South America to set up schools and orphanages there.

November 14

In 532, St Dyfrig, bishop. Born about the year 460 in the area known as Erging (south-west Herefordshire), Dyfrig became the first bishop to have jurisdiction over the area which later became the diocese of Llandaff. He founded a number of monastic schools in Erging, from which his pupils would travel out and themselves begin new communities. They regarded Dyfrig as their spiritual leader – in other words, their bishop. Dyfrig himself would visit the communities his pupils founded, in particular that of Illtud at Llantwit Major. It was his custom to spend Lent on Caldey Island; but it was Bardsey Island, off the Lleyn Peninsula, that became

Dyfrig's place of retirement and eventually his death probably some time between 532 and 550. In 1120 the body of Dyfrig was brought from Bardsey to the new cathedral at Llandaff, and placed on the north side of the altar, becoming a place of pilgrimage.

In 1180, at the Victorine monastery of Eu in Normandy, St. Lawrence O'Toole, bishop. He was born of an important Irish family and christened Lorcán. When he was ten he was taken hostage by Dermot MacMurrough, king of Leinster. He was entrusted to the safekeeping of the bishop of Glendalough, and became a monk there. He was elected abbot when he was twenty-five. He became the second archbishop of Dublin in 1161. He introduced the Canons Regular of Arrouaise to his cathedral and shared their life. He was dedicated to preaching, the liturgy, and the poor. He acted as a mediator when the English invaded Ireland. Lawrence attended the Third Lateran Council in Rome in 1179, and when he tried to implement its decrees in Ireland, he ran afoul of Henry II. He was on his way to see the king in Normandy when he took ill and died.

In 1391, St. Nicholas of Sibenik and companions. Nicholas was a Franciscan sent to preach against the Bogomils in Bosnia. After twenty years he was sent on a mission to Palestine. When he and three other Franciscans proclaimed Christianity to a leading Muslim official, he had them burned at the stake.

Samuel Seabury, bishop. Samuel Seabury was born in Connecticut in 1729 and, after graduating from Yale, was ordained priest in England and assigned by the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel to a church in New Brunswick, New Jersey. During the American War of Independence, he remained faithful to the British Crown, serving as a chaplain in the British army. At a secret meeting of the clergy in Connecticut, Samuel was chosen to seek consecration as bishop but, after a year of fruitless negotiation with the Church of England, he was ordained bishop by the non-juring bishops in the Scottish Episcopal Church on this day in 1784. Returning to America, he held his first Convention in Connecticut the following August and the first General Convention of the American Episcopal Church in 1789. There, they adopted the Scottish eucharistic rite and a similar name to the Church which had proved itself their friend. Samuel died on 25 February 1796.

November 15

In 1280, at Cologne, St. Albert the Great, bishop and doctor. Albert of Lauingen was born in Swabia (Germany) at the beginning of the thirteenth century. While a student at the University of Pavia he was attracted to the Order by Blessed Jordan of Saxony. From 1242 until 1248 he taught at the University of Paris where Thomas Aquinas was one of his students. Albert helped to introduce Aristotelian physics as interpreted by Jewish and Arabian philosophers into Western thought. From 1248 he taught at Cologne and served as provincial of Germany (1254-1257). Together with Saint Bonaventure he defended the right of the Mendicant Orders to teach in the universities. He was named bishop of Ratisbon in 1260, but after two years he resigned because he considered himself unworthy. He continued his teaching at Wurzburg, Strasbourg and Cologne. In his attempts to blend the wisdom of the saints with human knowledge he was a distinguished writer and teacher, but he was even more distinguished in his life of holiness and his pastoral charity. He had a deep devotion to the Blessed Sacrament and to the Virgin Mary who according to legend led him to the Order of Preachers. Because of his writings he is called "the Great" and the "universal doctor." He died at Cologne on November 15, 1280. In 1459 Pius II declared him a doctor of the Church; in 1931 Pius XI declared him a saint; and Pius XII named him patron of those involved in the natural sciences.

About 600 AD, St. Malo, the apostle of Brittany.

About 879, St. Fintan, an Irishman who joined a community of hermits at Rheinau, near Schaffhausen.

In 1136, St. Leopold, the patron of Austria. He became margrave of Austria when he was twenty-three. He and his wife had eighteen children, one of whom was Otto of Freising, a Cistercian abbot. Leopold founded

the Cistercian monastery of Heiligenkreuz, the Augustinian priory of Klosterneuberg, and the Benedictine monastery of Mariazell, all of which still exist.

In 1628, in Paraguay, St. Roque González and companions, martyrs. Roque was born in Asunción and, after some years as a parish priest, joined the Jesuits. He and his companions were killed while doing missionary work among native people. He is the earliest native-born American saint.

In 1904, in France, Blessed Mary of the Passion. She was born into a noble French family; after trying the Poor Clares she joined the Society of Mary Reparatrix, who sent her as a missionary to India. There was dissension in the order, and she and nineteen others founded a new order known as the Franciscan Missionaries of Mary.

Saints, Martyrs and Missionaries of North America European. Settlers first brought Christianity to North America: Spanish, French, British and other settlers colonized the continent bringing their faith with them. In what is now Canada, French immigrants preached among the native Americans, and many, including Jean de Brébeuf and Isaac Jogues, were martyred by the Iroquois between 1642 and 1649. English settlers established various colonies, with different Christian perspectives, and a variety of ministers from the motherland ministered to them: George Fox, Thomas Bray and those sponsored by the SPG and the SPCK which he founded; and John Wesley, who preached his Methodist revival. After the American Revolution, many members of the Church of England fled to Canada, and those who remained organised themselves into dioceses. On 14 November 1784 Samuel Seabury was consecrated in Scotland as the first bishop in North America, and today we remember all who have preached the Christian gospel in that continent and ministered to its people.

November 16

Around 1300, at the monastery of Helfta in Saxony, Saints Gertrude the Great and Mechtild of Hackeborn. Both women were educated from early childhood at the monastery and joined it when they were old enough. Mechtild was in charge of the children in the monastery school, one of whom was St. Gertrude, and she was later Gertrude's novice mistress. Gertrude had a profound religious experience when she was twenty-five, and from that time on devoted herself to reading the Bible and the Fathers, and immersing herself in the liturgy. The influence of her reading and liturgical life is evident in her Revelations and Spiritual Exercises. Mechtild's religious experiences and teaching are contained in The Book of Special Grace. Their spirituality emphasised the love of Christ, symbolised by his Sacred Heart.

In 759, in Switzerland, St. Otmar. He introduced the Rule of St. Benedict to the Abbey of St. Gall. He was imprisoned by warring nobles and died in exile.

At Edinburgh in 1093, St Margaret, queen. Born in the year 1046, Margaret was the daughter of the Anglo-Saxon royal house of England but educated in Hungary, where her family lived in exile during the reign of Danish kings in England. After the Norman invasion in 1066, when her royal person still was a threat to the new monarchy, she was welcomed in the royal court of Malcolm III of Scotland and soon afterwards married him in 1069. Theirs was a happy and fruitful union and Margaret proved to be both a civilising and a holy presence. She instituted many church reforms and founded many monasteries, churches and pilgrim hostels. She was a woman of prayer as well as good works who seemed to influence for good all with whom she came into contact.

In 1240, at Soisy-Bouy, Seine-et-Maine in France in 1240, St. Edmund Rich, bishop. He studied at Oxford and Paris, and then became a professor in the arts faculty at Oxford. In 1222 he became canon and treasurer of Salisbury cathedral, where he also taught. He developed close ties with the Cistercians of Stanley Abbey, where one of his pupils, Stephen of Lexington, was abbot. He preached the Sixth Crusade in 1227. In 1233 he was appointed archbishop of Canterbury, where he proved to be a warm, peacemaking champion of justice. In spite of that, he had tense relations with King Henry III and the monks of Christ Church,

Canterbury. He died in France while on the way to a council in Rome and was buried at the Cistercian abbey of Pontigny. He wrote biblical commentaries and devotional works, the most read of which has been the *Speculum ecclesiae*, a summary of the teachings of Hugh of St. Victor on the spiritual life.

November 17

At Whitby, in 680, St Hilda, abbess. She was baptised by St. Paulinus, archbishop of York. When she decided to become a nun, St. Aidan gave her some land for a convent. She was successively abbess of the double monasteries at Hartlepool and Whitby. She was a great promoter of theological education, especially among the clergy. Several of her monks, including St. John of Beverley, became bishops. She encouraged the poet Caedmon and hosted the Synod of Whitby.

At London, in 1200, St Hugh, bishop. Hugh was born at Avalon in Burgundy in 1140 and at first made his profession with the Augustinian canons but, when he was twenty-five, he became a monk at Grande Chartreuse. In about 1175, he was invited by the English king, Henry II, to become prior of his Charterhouse foundation at Witham in Somerset, badly in need of reform even though it had been only recently founded. In 1186, Hugh was persuaded to accept the See of Lincoln, then the largest diocese in the land. He brought huge energy to the diocese and, together with discerning appointments to key posts, he revived the Lincoln schools, repaired and enlarged the cathedral, visited the See extensively, drew together the clergy to meet in synod and generally brought an efficiency and stability to the Church which was to be much emulated. Hugh also showed great compassion for the poor and the oppressed, ensuring that sufferers of leprosy were cared for and that Jews were not persecuted. He both supported his monarch and also held out against any royal measures he felt to be extreme, yet managing not to make an enemy of the king.

In 1231, St. Elizabeth of Hungary. The daughter of King Andrew II of Hungary, she was married to Ludwig, the duke of Thuringia. They had three children during their happy but brief marriage. Elizabeth gave away many of their possessions; Ludwig told those who criticised her that Elizabeth's generosity would bring God's blessings on them all. Ludwig died after only six years. The next year she joined the Third Order of St. Francis. Having provided for her children, she settled in a small house near Marburg to which she attached a hospice for the sick, the poor, and the old, whom she cared for. She came under the influence of Konrad of Marburg, who was a severe and domineering spiritual director. She died at the age of twenty-four.

November 18

In Rome, the dedication of the basilicas of Sts. Peter and Paul.

In the eighth century, St Fergus, bishop. There are a number of dedications in the Pictish lands of Caithness, Buchan and Angus recording the missionary work of Fergus in the north-east of Scotland. The three churches he founded in Strathearn are all dedicated to Patrick. He is generally identified with a Pictish bishop who attended a Council at Rome in the year 721. He was the patron saint of the burgh of Wick, and the Aberdeenshire village of St Fergus is probably the site of the small settlement from which his mission radiated.

November 19

The commemoration of the prophet Obadiah.

In 379, St. Nerses I, patriarch of the Armenians. He was a married court official before being appointed patriarch. As bishop he founded monasteries and hostels for the poor and for lepers. He held a synod whose purpose was to organise the rapidly growing Armenian church. This aroused royal opposition. When he refused a king entry to the church until the monarch reformed his life, the king poisoned him.

In 815, at the abbey of Ottobeuren, Blessed Tuto.

About 1282, in Germany, St. Mechtilde of Magedeburg. She was a Beguine before retiring to the monastery of Helfta in her old age. At Magedeburg she was guided by a Dominican friar. She recorded her extraordinary mystical insights in the Book of the Flowing Light of the Godhead.

November 20

In 869, in England, the martyrdom of St. Edmund. He was a revered king of East Anglia who was killed by the invading Vikings. His body was later found incorrupt, and he became venerated as a model of heroism and holiness. His life was written by Abbo of Fleury at the request of St. Dunstan, and about 1020, King Knut founded the abbey of Bury St. Edmund in his honour.

In 1002, St. Bernward, bishop of Hildesheim. He was ordained a priest by St. Willigis and served as a tutor for the future emperor Otto III. As bishop of Hildesheim, he was a wise and able pastor, and built the church and monastery of St. Michael in Hildesheim. He made profession as a Benedictine not long before his death.

In 1876, Priscilla Lydia Sellon, religious. She was born probably in 1821. Although never enjoying good health, she responded to an appeal from the Bishop of Exeter in 1848 for workers amongst the destitute in Plymouth. The group of women she gathered around her adopted a conventual lifestyle and, in the face of much opposition, she created the Sisters of Mercy. Her crucial rôle in the revival of Religious Life in the Church of England was enhanced when, in 1856, her sisters joined with the first community founded -- the Holy Cross sisters -- thereby establishing the Society of the Holy Trinity. She led her community in starting schools and orphanages, in addition to sisters nursing the sick in slum districts and soldiers in the Crimea.

November 21

The Presentation of the Blessed Virgin Mary. In unity with Eastern Christianity, and commemorating the dedication in 543 of the New Basilica of Saint Mary, built next to the Temple at Jerusalem, this feast celebrates Mary's "dedication" of herself to God from her infancy, inspired by the Holy Spirit, whose grace had filled her ever since her immaculate conception.

In 496, at Rome, Pope Gelasius I. He was of African descent. During his four-year papacy he had to deal with the Arian barbarians, especially Theodoric the Ostrogoth. He was inflexible in dealing with the repercussions of the Acacian schism over Monophysitism. He insisted on papal prerogatives and the independence of the church. Dionysius Exiguus reports that he was humble, prayerful, and very generous to the poor.

In the sixth century, St Paulinus of Wales, abbot. Paulinus (Peulin) was the tutor of Saint David. He is connected with the area around Llandovery in north Carmarthenshire and with Llan-gors, east of Brecon, where he may have spent some time as a hermit. It is probable that the monastic school at which he taught David was at Llanddeusant. Rhigyfarch, David's biographer, says that Paulinus had been a pupil of Germanus, and he describes how David cured his teacher of blindness. Paulinus was also said to be the 'aged bishop' who advised the Synod of Llanddewibrefi to send for David to address them. The ancient stone from Caio parish describing Paulinus as a 'guardian of the faith, always a lover of his homeland, most conscientious observer of all that is right' is now generally thought to refer to a godly layman of the same name. It does, however, reflect the ethos of the society of which Paulinus was a part.

November 22

In Rome, probably in the third century, the martyrdom of St. Cecilia. There is no solid historical information about this revered saint. Her legend says that before her wedding to Valerian, a pagan, she sat quietly, singing to God in her heart. For this reason she is venerated as the patron of musicians. She converted Valerian and followed him to martyrdom. An attempt to suffocate her failed, but she died from an attempted beheading.

In the first century, St. Philemon, to whom Paul wrote a short letter, appealing to Philemon to be generous toward Onesimus, a slave.

At Oxford, in 1963, Clive Staples Lewis, writer. Born in Belfast on November 29, 1898, Lewis was raised as an Anglican but rejected Christianity during his adolescent years. After serving in World War I, he started a long academic career as a scholar in medieval and renaissance literature at both Oxford and Cambridge. He also began an inner journey that led him from atheism to agnosticism to theism and finally to faith in Jesus Christ. Lewis's conversion inaugurated a outpouring of Christian apologetics in media as varied as popular theology, children's literature, fantasy and science fiction, and correspondence on spiritual matters with friends and strangers alike. In 1956 Lewis married Joy Davidman, a recent convert to Christianity. Her death four years later led him to a transforming encounter with the Mystery of which he had written so eloquently before. Lewis died at his home in Oxford on November 22, 1963. The inscription on his grave reads: "Men must endure their going hence".

November 23

About the year 100, in the Crimea, St. Clement, pope. He may be the Clement mentioned in Paul's Epistle to the Philippians (4:3). One of the earliest non-biblical Christian documents is a letter that he wrote in the name of the Roman church to the Corinthians, urging the church there to end its dissension.

In 400, St. Amphilochius, bishop of Iconium. He was a cousin of Gregory of Nazianzus a friend of St. Basil and a strong supporter of the orthodox faith.

In 615, at Bobbio, St. Columbanus, abbot. He was born in Ireland and, at the advice of a woman hermit, became a monk. He spent many years at Bangor, under St. Comgall. About 590 he and twelve companions went into voluntary exile in Gaul. They preached and founded several monasteries, the most famous of which is Luxeuil. St. Columbanus wrote a very austere monastic Rule and Penitential. He eventually came into conflict with some Frankish bishops over his Irish customs; he also offended the King of Burgundy when he rebuked him for keeping concubines. He moved to the area around Zurich, and from there to Bobbio in northern Italy. Several of his letters and poems survive.

November 24

At Aquileia, probably in 304, St. Chrysogonus, martyr. He is mentioned in the Roman Canon.

In 606, St. Colman, bishop of Cloyne. He was a bard at Cashel, and was baptised by St. Brendan at the age of fifty.

In Vietnam, in 1839, on December 21st, St Andrew Dung-Lac and companions. St. Andrew was one of 117 people who were martyred in Vietnam between 1820 and 1862. The last of the martyrs were 17 laypersons, one of them a 9-year-old, executed in 1862.

In 1954, Lucy Menzies. Lucy Menzies was born in 1882 at the manse of Inchtute, Carse of Gowrie, where her father, Allan Menzies, was parish minister, and later Professor of Biblical Criticism at St Andrews University. She became an Episcopalian, but her own life was the epitome of ecumenism. As a scholar and translator, she published many books on the lives of the saints and translated works of medieval and modern spirituality. She is remembered in particular for her work on Columba. She worked closely with Evelyn Underhill, and it was through her that she was made Warden of the Retreat House at Pleshey in Essex for ten years in the 1930s. But it is not only for her spiritual scholarship that she is remembered. Her life of prayer (which she professed always to find difficult) and her deep communion with God shone from her. As she wrote of another, she showed 'the divine charity working through an utterly selfless spirit, absolutely abandoned to God'.

November 25

This is the traditional day to celebrate St. Catherine of Alexandria. Legend has it that she was a brilliant philosopher who was killed about 310. At first the Emperor Maxentius tried to have her killed by placing her on a spiked wheel to be torn apart, but the wheel was struck by lightning. She was then beheaded, and milk flowed out instead of blood. She is the patron of St. Catherine's Monastery in the Sinai and of numerous churches. The story of her life was very popular in the Middle Ages. She is the patron of scholars, nursing infants and those suffering with migraine. She was one of the Fourteen Holy Helpers.

In 251, in Rome, St. Moses, martyr. He was a priest in Rome, and leader of a group of priests who were the first to suffer death for their faith during the persecution of Decius. Moses died after spending almost a year in prison.

At Stoke Newington in 1748, Isaac Watts, hymn writer. Born in Southampton in 1674, Isaac Watts was educated at the local grammar school and had the opportunity to go on to university, but declined because he preferred the dissenting academy at Stoke Newington. He received there an education of high academic standard and he went on to become the pastor to the Independent (or Congregationalist) Church at Mark Lane in London. Due to his deteriorating health, he resigned this post in 1712 and retired to Stoke Newington. Seven years later, he opposed the imposition of the doctrine of the Trinity on his fellow dissenting ministers, which led to the belief that he had become a Unitarian. Isaac wrote many collections of hymns and his own faith showed clearly through them: *When I survey the wondrous cross, Jesus shall reign where'er the sun* and many others still used in worship.

November 26

In 311, St. Peter of Alexandria, bishop and martyr. He led the church of Alexandria through the persecution of Diocletian and was executed under Maximinus Daia.

In 1267, St. Sylvester Gozzolini. He studied law for a while, then turned to theology. He became a diocesan priest, but at the age of fifty retired to live austere at a country hermitage. He then founded at Benedictine monastery at Monte Fano. The monastery developed into a small congregation of communities that stressed poverty and were more centrally organised than most later Benedictine congregations.

In 1751, St. Leonard of Port Maurice. He joined a group of reformed Franciscans in Rome and became a preacher. He promoted the Stations of the Cross, exposition of the Blessed Sacrament, devotion to the Sacred Heart of Jesus, and the Immaculate Conception of Mary.

At Battle Creek, Michigan, in 1883, Sojourner Truth. Isabella (Sojourner Truth) was the next-to-youngest child of several born to James and Elizabeth, slaves owned by a wealthy Dutchman in New York. For the first 28 years of her life she was a slave, sold from household to household. She fled slavery with the help of Quaker friends. When she was about 46, Belle believed she heard God say to her, "Go east." So, she set out east for Long Island and Connecticut. Stopping at a Quaker farm for a drink of water, she was asked her name. "My name is Sojourner," Belle said. "What is your last name?" the woman asked. Belle thought of all her masters' names she had carried through life. Then the thought came: "The only master I have now is God, and His name is Truth." Sojourner became a traveling preacher, approaching white religious meetings and campgrounds and asking to speak. Fascinated by her charismatic presence, her wit, wisdom, and imposing six-foot height, they found her hard to refuse. She never learned to read or write, but quoted extensive Bible passages from memory in her sermons. She ended by singing a "home-made" hymn and addressing the crowd on the evils of slavery. Her reputation grew and she became part of the abolitionist and women's rights speakers' network.

In 1971, in Rome, Blessed James Alberione. He was born into a farm family and entered the seminary as a teenager. He earned a doctorate in theology and worked in the seminary at Alba. He became editor of the

diocesan paper and from that time on dedicated himself to the apostolate of communications. He founded the Paulines and the Daughters of St. Paul, which were dedicated to printing and selling Catholic literature, and later helped found several other congregations.

November 27

In 784, St. Virgil of Salzburg. He was an Irish monk who became a pilgrim out of love for Christ. He became abbot of St. Peter's in Salzburg and eventually bishop of the diocese. St. Boniface quarreled with him on a number of points. He was a man of great learning and an active pastor.

In 1637, St. Humilis of Bisignano. He was an illiterate Franciscan lay brother, but so great was his theological knowledge that Pope Gregory XV summoned him to Rome to act as his advisor. Throughout his life he remained humble, prayerful, and a servant of the poor.

November 28

In 764, at Constantinople, St. Stephen the Younger. He was born in Constantinople. He joined a monastery in Bithynia and was elected abbot. After a dozen years as abbot, at the age of forty-two, he retired to a hermitage. When he refused to endorse iconoclasm, Emperor Constantine V arrested and exiled him. Eventually he was clubbed to death.

In 1876, in Paris, St. Catherine Labouré. She joined the Sisters of Charity of St. Vincent de Paul and was sent to Paris. There she had the visions which are depicted on the miraculous medal. The medal shows on one side Mary with shafts of light shining from her hands, and on the other an M with a cross above it, and below it two hearts, one with a crown, the other pierced by a sword. She lived quietly in her convent in Paris, avoiding all publicity.

November 29

In the third century, St. Saturninus of Toulouse. He was a missionary in the region around Toulouse and was martyred by being tied to an ox that was then goaded into running down a hill.

In 1742, St. Francis of Lucera. He was a conventual Franciscan who taught in his order's college at Lucera.

At New York, in 1980, Dorothy Day, writer and social activist.

November 30

In the first century, St. Andrew. He was a fisherman from Bethsaida, the brother of St. Peter, and one of the earliest of Jesus' disciples. He is a patron of Russia, Scotland and Greece.

In 1577, in England, St. Cuthbert Mayne. He was an Anglican priest who followed his friends Gregory Martin and Edmund Campion to Douai, where he was ordained a Catholic priest in 1576. He was sent to England, arrested a year later, tried, hanged, drawn and quartered. He was the first martyr from among the "seminary priests" educated at seminaries for English exiles founded on the continent after the Council of Trent.

December

December 1

At Tyburn, in 1581, St. Edmund Campion, He studied and taught at Oxford. He became uncomfortable with the Elizabethan religious settlement and went to Douai. He joined the Jesuits in Rome and made his novitiate in Bohemia. He was one of the first Jesuits sent to minister to Catholics in England. There he published several documents defending his faith and mission. After two years he was arrested and tortured, but would not relent. He and two companions were condemned and executed.

In 660, at Noyon, St. Eligius, bishop. He was a skilled goldsmith who became master of the mint for King Clotaire II in Paris. He became wealthy and founded several monasteries. He was made bishop about 640, at the same time his friend Audenus was made bishop of Rouen. Eligius was a zealous bishop who was especially concerned to disabuse his people of superstition. He worked with the saintly queen Bathilde to free and protect slaves. He is the patron of veterinarians.

At Tamanrasset in Algeria, in 1916, Blessed Charles de Foucauld, priest. Charles Eugène de Foucauld was born in 1858 and led a dissipated life as a young officer in the cavalry. In 1883, he went on an expedition to Morocco where he developed a passion for north Africa and its ways. Four years later, he returned to the Catholic faith of his infancy and, after a pilgrimage to the Holy Land, became a Trappist monk in 1890. Desiring an even more austere life, he left in 1897 and became a servant to the Poor Clares in Jerusalem and Nazareth. He was eventually ordained priest in 1901 and went to live as a hermit in Algeria, ending up at Tamanrasset. He became fluent in the local language and his care and concern for the local tribes-people made him accepted and then much loved, though he never sought converts. He composed Rules for brothers and for sisters, though none ever actually joined him. He was assassinated on this day in 1916, a victim of local religious wars. The Little Sisters of the Sacred Heart were founded in 1933, inspired by his rule for sisters. His writings also inspired René Voillaume and others to adopt a life based on his rule, eventually becoming The Little Brothers of Jesus in 1945.

December 2

About 407, St. Chromatius, bishop of Aquileia. He baptised Rufinus, was a friend and correspondent of St. Jerome, and a supporter of St. John Chrysostom. At his suggestion St. Ambrose wrote a commentary on the prophecy of Balaam. Some of Chromatius' treatises on the gospel of Matthew survive.

In 1381, at the monastery of Groenendael, Blessed John Ruysbroeck. When he was a boy, his mother, who became a Beguine, sent him to live with his uncle, John Hickaert, who was a canon in Brussels. Ruysbroeck was later ordained. After some years, he and his uncle and another man withdrew to Groenendael to lead a life of contemplation. John wrote many works, which only became well known after they were translated from Flemish into Latin. He wrote out of deep faith and mystical experience in a poetic but down-to-earth way.

[Saints, Martyrs and Missionaries of Asia The Christian revelation took place in Asia, and it was there that the first martyrdoms, and the first missionary journeys took place. After the time of the apostles, this continued with early saints such as Ignatius of Antioch and Polycarp. Christian communities have continued to exist in Asia, with many West and East Syrian Orthodox churches. The apostle Thomas is traditionally said to have visited India, and the Syrian Church there claims succession through him. Much later, missionaries from the west came to Asia, such as Francis Xavier whose missionary work extended to India, Japan and elsewhere, and whose feast is celebrated on 3 December. From Cornwall, Henry Martyn went to work in India and Persia. These and other initiatives led to the growth of Christian churches as far apart as India, China, Japan and Korea. We remember with them on this day the ancient Churches of the Middle East, some persecuted today as on occasion in the past, and pray for their continued witness to the living truth of the gospel.]

December 3

The commemoration of Zephaniah the prophet.

In 1552, in China, St. Francis Xavier. Francis was born in a castle near Pamplona. At seventeen he went to the University of Paris, where he became one of the first followers of his fellow Basque aristocrat, Ignatius of Loyola. In 1541, at the age of 35, he was appointed apostolic nuncio in the East and set sail for Goa, reaching that city after a thirteen-month voyage. Living as a poor man among the poor, he had considerable missionary success among the lower castes, whose cause he championed. He then worked for several years in Indonesia, India and Sri Lanka. He made many converts in Japan. He returned to India, and then went to China, where he died not long after. He was canonised in 1622, along with St. Ignatius of Loyola, St. Teresa of Avila and St. Philip Neri.

December 4

In 215, St Clement of Alexandria, priest and martyr. Clement was born in Athens of pagan parents in about the year 153. The apostles and their immediate successors laid the foundation on which, towards the end of the second century, Clement of Alexandria and others began to create a sophisticated literature in which they sought to explore the relation between Christian thought and the Greek philosophical tradition. Clement is honoured as Christianity's first religious philosopher. The reasons for his conversion are not known. He had travelled extensively to learn from the best teachers of his day before arriving in Alexandria in 190 where he became the head of the Catechetical School in succession to Pantaenus. He produced an impressive body of writing that drew extensively on both pagan and Christian writings and was centered on the idea of Christ, the Logos, as both the source of all human reason and the unique interpreter of God to humanity. Clement was forced to flee Alexandria by an outbreak of persecution in 202 and is supposed to have died as a martyr in about the year 215.

In 749, St. John of Damascus, doctor of the church. John was born of Christian parents in Arab-controlled Damascus, and lived during the Iconoclast troubles. He was well educated, and followed his father into service at the caliph's court. When he was in his early forties, John left court, gave his possessions away, and joined the monastery of St. Sabas, near Jerusalem. There he wrote in defense of icons, and produced many theological works, as well as hymns and poems, in the course of a long lifetime. He was very devoted to Mary.

At Little Gidding, Huntingdonshire, in 1637, Nicholas Ferrar, deacon. Born in London in 1592, Nicholas Ferrar was educated at Clare Hall, Cambridge and elected a Fellow there in 1610. From 1613, he travelled extensively on the continent for five years, trying his hand as a businessman and then as a parliamentarian on his return. In 1625, he moved to Little Gidding in Huntingdonshire, then a derelict manor-house with a chapel which was being used as a hay barn. He was joined by his brother and sister and their families and by his mother, and they established together a community life of prayer, using The Book of Common Prayer, and a life of charitable works in the locality. He was ordained to the diaconate by William Laud the year after they arrived. He wrote to his niece in 1631, "I purpose and hope by God's grace to be to you not as a master but as a partner and fellow student." This indicates the depth and feeling of the community life Nicholas and his family strove to maintain. After the death of Nicholas on this day in 1637, the community was broken up in 1646 by the Puritans, who were suspicious of it and referred to it as the Arminian Nunnery. They feared it promoting the return of Romish practices into England, and so all Nicholas's manuscripts were burned.

December 5

In 532, at his monastery near Jerusalem, St. Sabas. He was born in Cappadocia and was attracted to monastic life at an early age. He joined the monastery of St. Euthymius in Jerusalem, where he proved to be hardworking and prayerful. Four years after Euthymius' death, Sabas was prevailed upon to form a semi-eremitical laura. He was appointed archimandrite over the hermits of Palestine, and sent on a number of

missions to Constantinople and elsewhere. His monastery, the Great Laura, still exists in the desert ten miles from Jerusalem.

In 304, at Theveste in North Africa, St. Crispina, martyr. She was a married woman with several children. An account of her trial shows her to have been a brave and outspoken woman.

In 1161, St. Christina of Markyate. When she was sixteen, her parents took her to the shrine of St. Alban. She was impressed with the life of the monks there, and determined to seek such a life for herself. She made a private vow of virginity. Her parents forced her to go through a marriage ceremony, but she would not consummate the marriage. The case was taken before several church officials, and then to the bishop of Lincoln, who at first sided with her but then changed his mind. She escaped with the help of a hermit, and her appeal to the archbishop of Canterbury was upheld. She went into hiding from her parents, first with an anchoress, and then with a hermit. She spent the rest of her life as a hermit at Markyate. She became a friend and guide to Abbot Geoffrey of St. Alban's.

December 6

In the fourth century, St. Nicholas, bishop of Myra. Around this very popular saint wonderful legends have accumulated: how he saved three girls from prostitution by throwing dowry money through a window of their house, and how he saved three young clerks from being murdered and ground into sausage. His relics were stolen from Muslim-controlled Myra and taken to Bari. The custom of exchanging gifts on his feast day may have originated among Dutch Protestants, who brought it to New York.

In 558, St. Abraham, bishop of Kratia in Bithynia. He went from Emesa to Constantinople with his mentor, and there both became monks. Abraham tried to flee from being elected abbot and then bishop, but was prevailed upon to accept these offices. After thirteen years as a conscientious bishop, he fled to a monastery and spent the last twenty years of his life as a hermit.

In 1300, in Granada, Blessed Peter Pascual. He received his doctorate in Paris, and then returned to his native Valencia. He taught theology at Barcelona and was appointed bishop of Jaén, which was under Moorish control. His efforts on behalf of Catholic captives and his missionary work led to his arrest while he was making a visitation. He was ransomed, but he applied the money to free other captives. He died from the deprivations of his captivity, or perhaps was murdered.

December 7

At Milan, in 397, St. Ambrose, bishop and doctor of the church. Ambrose was the son of a high Roman official. When his father died, he was raised in Milan by his mother and his sister St. Marcellina. When he was about 35 and still a catechumen, he was selected by popular acclaim to be bishop of Milan, which was divided between Catholic and Arian Christians. He was generally a conciliator, though he opposed efforts to turn Catholic churches over to Arians, and on several occasions stood his ground against Emperor Theodosius, for whom he preached a laudatory eulogy. He gave away all the church's gold vessels to help victims of the Gothic invaders, saying, "If the Church possesses gold, it is in order to use it for the needy, not to keep it." Under the tutelage of St. Simplician, he studied theology, especially the writings of Origen and Basil.

In Gaul, in 657, the abbess St. Fare. St. Columbanus baptised her. When she insisted on becoming a nun, her father founded for her the double monastery that became known as Faremoutier-en-Brie, of which she was abbess.

December 8

The Feast of the Immaculate Conception of Mary. A feast honouring Mary's conception by St. Anne seems to have been celebrated in Palestine at a fairly early date. Justin Martyr, Irenaeus and John of Damascus speak of Mary as the "new Eve" who was free from sin. The feast came to Rome in the ninth century and was celebrated as the "Conception of Our Lady" in England in the first half of the eleventh century. St. Bernard and most early Dominican theologians opposed the feast, but the Franciscans adopted it in 1263. Gradually the feast won universal approval, and the Council of Trent declared that a decree on original sin did not apply to Mary. The Immaculate Conception of Mary was declared a dogma of the church in 1854.

In the seventh century, St Cynidr, bishop. There is some confusion about Cynidr's parentage. Some manuscripts describe him as the son of Ceingar, daughter of Brychan Brycheiniog. Another genealogy claims that he was the son of Gwynllyw and Gwladys and the brother of Cadoc. His most important foundation was at Glasbury, where he was buried. Breconshire was the centre of his activities but he is also linked with Herefordshire. He seems to have spent some time as a hermit on an island in the river Wye at Winforton. It is clear that he was an important ecclesiastical figure in his area, but little else can be said about him with any certainty.

At Toulouse, France, in 1751, Jean-Pierre de Caussade, Jesuit, priest. Born in Cahors. He was spiritual director to the Nuns of the Visitation at Nancy from 1733 to 1740. During this time and after he left Nancy, he wrote letters of instruction to the nuns. Some material ascribed to him was first published in 1861 under the title "L'Abandon à la providence divine".

However, according to recent research on *The Treatise on Abandonment to Divine Providence*, "it now seems almost impossible that the author was in fact the Jesuit Jean-Pierre de Caussade".

Whoever the author was, he or she believed that the present moment is a sacrament from God and that self-abandonment to it and its needs is a holy state.

Abandonment to Divine Providence has now for many years been read widely and is considered a classic in the spiritual life by Catholics and many others.

Jean Pierre de Caussade spent years as preacher in southern and central France, as a college rector (at Perpignan and at Albi), and as the director of theological students at the Jesuit house in Toulouse, which is where he died.

December 9

In 1548, in Mexico, St. Juan Diego Cuauhtlatotzin. Juan Diego is said to have been a poor, childless widower and a devout convert to Christianity. In 1531, on his way home from Mass, an olive-skinned girl of fourteen told him to tell his bishop that she wanted a church built on the spot, where she, the mother of all nations, would show her compassion to them. The bishop was not convinced. Another day Juan was bringing a priest to bless his uncle, who had smallpox, when the girl appeared again and told him she would take care of the uncle. He was to pick flowers in his cloak and take them to the bishop. When he opened the cloak and flowers fell out before the bishop, the Virgin's image was instantaneously imprinted on the cloak.

December 10

In 741, St. Gregory III, pope. He was a Syrian, an educated and charitable man, whose acclamation as successor to Gregory II in 731 was confirmed by the Byzantine ruler of Ravenna. The year before, in Constantinople, Emperor Leo the III had forbidden the veneration of holy images. Gregory sent messengers to Leo protesting his decree, but they were rebuffed. Gregory then summoned a synod, which approved the excommunication of anyone condemning the veneration of images or destroying them. In retaliation, Leo seized all the papal estates in southern Italy, asserted the jurisdiction of the patriarch of Constantinople over Illyricum, and sent an army in a failed attempt to capture Gregory and bring him to Constantinople. Gregory encouraged the missionary and organisational work of St. Boniface in Germany and sent St. Willibald to help him.

In 1591, seven martyrs executed in London for their Catholic faith, and in 1610, also in London, St. John Roberts, executed at Tyburn with Blessed Thomas Somers, a diocesan priest. John Roberts was born in Wales, studied at Oxford, taught school, and then went to Douai, where he was received into the Catholic church. He studied at the English College at Valladolid, and joined the Benedictine monastery of San Benito there. He went to England five times as a missionary, but each time was arrested and deported. He helped found the English monastery at Douai, which was eventually transferred to Downside. In 1610 he returned to England during a time of plague and a persecution resulting from the Gunpowder Plot. He put up a spirited defense at his trial, but was condemned to death. A Spanish lady arranged a joyful dinner for him and twenty other Catholic prisoners at Newgate prison, then washed the feet of all the martyrs-to-be. The next day they were hanged, and their heads were then displayed on London Bridge.

At Basel, Switzerland, in 1968, Karl Barth, theologian.

At Bangkok, Thailand, in 1968, Thomas Merton, priest and monk. Merton's 1949 best seller *The Seven Storey Mountain*, launched this Trappist monk as an internationally known writer. A mentor to many in the peace movement, Merton was a friend, by correspondence with many from other faith communities, poets and activists. Convinced of the link between contemplation and action he prepared the way for new expressions of the monastic charism.

December 11

In Rome, in 384, Pope Damasus I. He was elected in a contested election; some said that Damasus was responsible for the ensuing violence. He lived in great splendour. He promoted devotion to the martyrs, provided inscriptions for their tombs, and made the catacombs more accessible to pilgrims. He legislated for the wider church through decretals. He commissioned Jerome to prepare a new Latin translation of the Bible.

In 493, in Syria, St. Daniel the Stylite. He joined a monastery when he was twelve. Later, he accompanied his abbot to another monastery, where they had a discussion about whether St. Simeon the Stylite's witness was self-promotion, or genuine asceticism and witness. About ten years later Simeon died, and Daniel himself took up residence on a pillar. There he was ordained by Gennadius, patriarch of Constantinople. He became a great celebrity, and many people, including Emperor Leo I, came to see him. Daniel died at the age of 84, after spending 33 years on his pillar.

December 12

The feast of Our Lady of Guadalupe. At Tepeyac, northwest of Mexico City, Juan Diego had a vision of a beautiful lady: "Her clothing appeared like the sun." She asked him to tell the bishop to build a church there: "In it, I will show...all people all my love, my compassion, my help and my defence.... There I will hear their laments and remedy and cure all their miseries, misfortunes and sorrows." Later she appeared again, and her image suddenly was imprinted on his cactus-cloth cloak. A shrine was built on the spot, and in 1945 Our Lady of Guadalupe was declared patron of the Americas.

In 549, St. Finnian of Clonard. Renowned as one of the greatest teachers and scholars Ireland has ever had, Finnian was responsible for encouraging the growth of monasticism in Ireland. His great foundation was at Clonard close to the centre of political power, but it was as a centre of Biblical study that it was pre-eminent, and, as a result, Finnian has been called by the title 'Teacher of the Saints'. One of the earliest of the Irish 'Penitentials' (a book suggesting ways in which Christians could seek forgiveness for their sins with programmes of self-discipline) is associated with him, but there may be confusion with Finnian of Movilla. Finnian died on this day in about the year 549.

In 1641, St. Jane Frances de Chantal, foundress. Jane Frances de Chantal was born at Dijon in France in 1572. As a young woman she married happily, and had four children. In 1601, however, her husband was killed in an

accident. In her widowhood she resolved to give herself more profoundly to the spiritual life, and took a vow of chastity. In 1604 she met Francis de Sales, and placed herself under his spiritual direction. The correspondence between them which has survived reveals a quite remarkable friendship. In 1610, whilst still maintaining her duties as a mother, she founded the first convent of the Visitation at Annecy in Savoy for women and widows unsuited to the severe ascetic life of many religious congregations. She devoted the remainder of her life to visiting the sick and the poor, and fostering the Order. She had considerable administrative ability, and by the time of her death in 1641 a further sixty-four convents had been founded. Vincent de Paul, who knew her personally and well, said that she was 'one of the holiest people I have ever met on this earth'.

December 13

About 304, in Sicily, St. Lucy. Her legend recounts that she was born in Syracuse of well-to-do parents and raised a Christian. She wanted to devote her life to God and give her possessions to the poor. When she resisted a Roman soldier's sexual assault, he denounced her as a Christian. She was arrested and executed. Her name derives from a word meaning 'light', and she is a patron of those with eye troubles.

About 720, St. Odilia, abbess. According to her legends, she was born blind, and her father, a Frankish nobleman, wanted her killed. Her mother saved her, and Odilia was raised by the nuns at Baume-les-Dames near Besançon. She was cured of her blindness by Bishop Erhard of Regensburg, and thenceforth was called Odilia, "daughter of light". She founded a monastery in an old castle called the Hohenburg in the diocese of Strasbourg. The monastery of St. Ottilien is located on the site of a chapel dedicated to her.

In London, England, in 1784, Samuel Johnson, writer. Samuel Johnson was born in 1709 and is best known as a writer of dictionaries and a literary editor. Yet in his lifetime he was renowned for his religious beliefs and as a firm supporter of the practice and order of the Church of England. He had been converted to Christianity as young man after reading William Law's *A Serious Call to a Devout and Holy Life*, and his support of the High Church party was unstinting. Amongst his other writings, his essays entitled the *Rambler*, which appeared twice-weekly between 1750 and 1752, earned him the nickname 'The Great Moraliser', then a term of affection and honour.

December 14

In 1591, at Úbeda in Spain, St. John of the Cross, doctor of the church. John's mother was a poor widow who sent him to an orphanage. He went to work as an aide in a hospital that treated venereal diseases. He was so dedicated and joyful that the director sent him to be educated as a priest. He joined the Carmelites, studied at Salamanca, and was ordained. He met St. Teresa of Avila. He was a member of the first of her reformed friaries for men; however, so great was the opposition to reform that his order imprisoned him for a year in deplorable conditions. He escaped nine months later, but all of his subsequent writings, including the famous poem *Spiritual Canticle* written at this time, reflect his suffering.

In 605, in Poitiers, St. Venantius Fortunatus, bishop. He was educated at Ravenna and cured of eye trouble through the intercession of St. Martin of Tours. He went on pilgrimage to Tours to give thanks at St. Martin's shrine. He settled near St. Radegonde at Poitiers, and became the chaplain of her convent, where the sisters treated him very kindly. He was elected bishop of Poitiers when he was sixty-nine, and died within a year. Venantius Fortunatus is known mainly for his poetry, particularly the *Vexilla regis prodeunt* ("The royal banners forward go") and *Pange lingua gloriosi* ("Sing, my tongue, the glorious battle"), which are sung during Passiontide, and his Easter hymn, *Salva festa dies* ("Hail this festival day").

In 1858, at the monastery Kfifan, in Lebanon, St. Nimatullah (Youssef) Al-Hardini. One of five sons to become a priest or monk, Youssef became a Maronite monk in 1828 and received the name Nimatullah. He said: "A monk's first concern, night and day, should be not to hurt or trouble his brother monks." He was devoted to the Eucharist and the Immaculate Conception.

In 1876, in Germany, Blessed Frances Schervier. The daughter of an industrialist, she was devoted to alleviating the lot of those whom industrialisation displaced or exploited. She founded a religious order, the Sisters of the Poor of St. Francis, which consisted of two "families", one of which prayed and the other of which did works of mercy. She visited a foundation of the order in the United States and helped her sisters minister to soldiers during the American Civil War. She also did hospital work with her sisters during the Franco-Prussian War.

December 15

In Asia Minor, in 956, St. Paul of Latros. He sought solitude, but disciples came and he organised a laura for them at Latros. He then retreated further into solitude, but at the urging of his monks, he finally returned to Latros.

December 16

In 999, St. Adelaide of Burgundy. She was married for dynastic reasons to Lothair, the nominal king of Italy. When he died, his rival Berengarius of Ivrea wanted to marry her to his son. When she refused, he put her in prison. She was freed by Otto the Great, whom she married. They were happily married for twenty years and had five children. When she was sixty, she became regent for her young grandson, Otto III. She worked for peace, founded monasteries and attempted the conversion of the Slavic nations.

December 17

In 779, St. Sturm, the first German known to have become a Benedictine monk. He was entrusted to St. Boniface, who had him educated at the monastery of Fritzlar. He was ordained and then became a hermit. At Boniface's suggestion, he built a monastery at Fulda, where Boniface made him abbot in 744. Sturm went to study Benedictine life at Monte Cassino for several years, and returned to serve as abbot for 30 years.

In 1213, in Rome, St. John of Matha. He was born in Provence, lived as a hermit, studied theology in Paris, and was ordained. While celebrating his first Mass, he received the inspiration to devote his life to ransoming Christian slaves from the Muslims. For this purpose he founded the Order of the Most Holy Trinity.

At Geneva in 1928, Eglantine Webb, social reformer. Eglantine Jebb was born in 1876. After studying at Oxford, she became a teacher for a few years until ill-health led to her resignation. She then devoted her energies to charitable works and in 1913 went to Macedonia to help refugees in the Balkan wars. After the First World War, she and her sister Dorothy Buxton founded the Save the Children Fund, which aimed to help children who were suffering in the post-war famine in Europe, a charity which is now global in its scope. Eglantine fought for the rights of children to be recognised, the League of Nations passing her 'Children's Charter' in 1924. She inspired many by her personal spirituality

December 18

In the seventh century, St. Flannan, bishop of Killaloe. Flannan is one of the many travelling Irish saints who embarked on long journeys, often by water as well as overland, partly as missionaries but also as pilgrims, making a spiritual 'peregrination' to witness on the way for Christ. Flannan succeeded Mo-Lua who founded Killaloe Cathedral in County Clare on the river Shannon. St Flannan's Oratory beside the cathedral is an impressive example of early Irish architecture. Its large size and sound, stone construction have been widely admired. Flannan died on this day in about the year 640.

In 761, in Germany, St. Winnibald, abbot of Heidenheim. His father Richard took him and his brother Willibald on a pilgrimage to the Holy Land. When Richard died at Lucca, the brothers went to Rome.

Winnibald stayed on in Rome, and St. Boniface enlisted his help in the German mission. He did missionary work in Bavaria, and with his sister Walburga founded the double monastery of Heidenheim, at the request of Willibald, who was then bishop of Eichstätt.

December 19

In 401, Pope Anastasius I. He was pope for only two years, but earned the respect of Sts. Jerome, Augustine and Paulinus of Nola.

In 1370, Blessed Pope Urban V. Born in Languedoc, he became a Benedictine. He was highly educated in theology and canon law. In 1352 he became abbot of St. Germain in Auxerre, and in 1361 of St. Victor in Marseilles. After the College of Cardinals deadlocked trying to elect one of their own as successor to Pope Innocent VI, they chose him. At Avignon, he continued to live as a monk. In 1366, partially at the urging of Petrarch, Urban returned to Rome, which was almost in ruins. He tried to organise the starving city, but in the end the chaos seemed overwhelming. In spite of urging from Petrarch and St. Bridget of Sweden, he fled back to France, where he died a few months later.

December 20

In 250, at Alexandria, St. Ammon and companions. A Christian was on trial, and a group of Christian soldiers tried to bolster his resolve. The magistrate noticed this; Ammon and his companions declared themselves Christians and were executed with the prisoner.

In 1073, St. Dominic of Silos. He was born in the Pyrenees and became a shepherd. He liked solitude and silence and became a monk at San Millán de la Cogolla. He became prior, but was exiled by the King of Navarre for defending the monastery's property. He found refuge at a decaying monastery at Silos, which then revived. St. Dominic, the founder of the Dominicans, was named after him.

December 21

In Fribourg, in Switzerland, St. Peter Canisius, doctor. He was born in Nijmegen and studied at Cologne. He joined the Jesuits, published editions of St. Cyril of Alexandria and St. Leo the Great, and was ordained. He took part in two sessions of the Council of Trent, and taught at Messina in the first Jesuit school. He ministered to the students at Ingolstadt, and to the poor of Vienna. He wrote an immensely popular and influential catechism. After two years founding a school at Prague, he settled at Augsburg. In 1580 he was sent to Fribourg where he preached and oversaw the college that became the University of Fribourg.

December 22

In 1136, Blessed Jutta of Diessenberg. She was a noblewoman who became a recluse near the monastery of St. Disibod. There she brought up St. Hildegard. A community of Benedictine nuns grew up around her, and after her death, pilgrims came to her tomb. Hildegard succeeded her as magistra of the women's community at St. Disibod, and later moved the community to Bingen.

December 23

In 250, ten martyrs of Crete, who were tortured and executed by the sword at the order of the governor of Gortyna.

At Skalholt in Iceland, St. Thorlac, bishop. He was ordained at twenty, and studied abroad before returning to Iceland. He formed a monastery of Canons Regular at Thykkvibaer, and in 1174 was elected bishop of Skalholt. He introduced the Gregorian Reform to Iceland, insisting on the financial independence of the church, clerical celibacy, and the sanctity of Christian marriage.

In 1473, in Poland, St. John of Kanty. He studied at Krakow, was ordained, and became a professor. He modeled his austere lifestyle on the teachings of the Desert Fathers. He came to be highly revered by people of all social strata.

In 1771, in Montreal, St. Margaret d'Youville. She was born in Canada into a poor family. At twenty-one she married a fur trader, but the marriage was not happy. She was appalled at her husband's dealings with the native people. Her husband died, leaving her to raise two sons. She supported the family by operating a small store. When her sons entered the seminary, Margaret and some other women rented a house in a poor part of town and began taking care of sick and impoverished women. At first they were derisively called "Grey Sisters", and as the order developed she kept the name. They took over the operation of the General Hospital in Montreal, and when it burned down, they received great public support from English, French and native people to rebuild it. By then the charity of the Grey Sisters was legendary.

December 24

About 550, St. Tharsilla, the aunt of St. Gregory the Great, who lived with her sister Emiliana as a nun in her father's house.

In Lebanon, in 1898, St. Sharbel Markhlouf. He was born of a poor family in a remote village. He joined a monastery when he was twenty-three, trained at several others, and was ordained a priest. He spent the rest of his life as an austere hermit, devoting his days to preparation, celebration and thanksgiving for the Eucharist. His grave became a much-visited pilgrimage shrine. He was beatified at the Second Vatican Council.

December 25

See also the Solemn proclamation of the Nativity.

The Nativity of Our Lord Jesus Christ. After the passage of countless ages from the creation of the world, God created humankind in his image and likeness, then made covenants with Noah and Abraham, and Moses. At a time when the world was at peace under Augustus Caesar, the eternal Son of the eternal Father, wishing to consecrate the world by his coming, was conceived by Holy Spirit, and nine months later was born in Bethlehem of Judea, becoming man from the womb of the Blessed Virgin.

In Rome, around 304, St. Anastasia, veneration of whom began at Sirmium in Pannonia. Later, the popes celebrated the second Mass of Christmas at a church dedicated to her in Rome.

In 1258, St. Peter Nolasco, the founder of the Mercedarian Order, dedicated to ransoming Christians enslaved by the Moors.

About 1306, Blessed Jacopone of Todi. Jacopone often wished that his wealthy father, who frequently beat him, were dead. He completed his university studies, but lived a disordered life. When he was about thirty-eight he married Vanna di Guidone, who was a devout young woman. When she was accidentally killed a year later, Jacopone was shattered and for ten years he lived eccentrically and penitentially. He joined the Spiritual Franciscans, and was active in their opposition to Pope Boniface VIII, for which he was imprisoned for five years. During those years he overcame his guilt and anger and experienced intense contemplative union with God. While in prison he wrote many religious lyrics or Laude.

December 26

About the year 34, in Jerusalem, St. Stephen, the first Christian martyr. He was a Greek-speaking Jew and is listed first among the deacons created to serve the Hellenist Christians in Jerusalem. His arrest, trial and execution are described in the Acts of the Apostles.

In 268 or 269, St. Dionysius, pope. He oversaw the rebuilding of the church in Rome after the persecution of Decius. He also had to deal with several Christological errors. Dionysius of Alexandria described him as a praiseworthy and learned person. He was generous in giving aid to the church of Cappadocia, which suffered from an invasion of Goths.

December 27

About the year 100, St. John the Evangelist. He is traditionally regarded as the author of the Fourth Gospel, and is identified with the Beloved Disciple mentioned in that Gospel. Tradition has it that he died at an advanced age in Ephesus.

In 399, St. Fabiola, a wealthy and restless Roman matron, who was a friend of St. Jerome. She devoted her wealth to churches and hospitals.

December 28

The Feast of the Holy Innocents. Herod 'the Great' was appointed King of the Jews by the Roman authorities in Palestine and he proved to be ruthlessly efficient in his thirty-three years of dealing with his subjects. In the Gospel according to Matthew, Herod tried to persuade the Magi, to whom he played host on their journey seeking the one 'who has been born king of the Jews', to bring word to him once they had found the child. His desire was to eliminate Jesus and, when he realised that the Magi had tricked him and left the country, Herod killed all the children under the age of two in and around Bethlehem. These were God's 'innocent' ones, paralleling the story of Pharaoh slaughtering the Hebrew children in Egypt.

In 368, in Upper Egypt, St. Theodore, a disciple and successor of St. Pachomius.

In 1837, in Rome, St. Gaspar del Bufalo. As a young priest he was jailed for four years by Napoleon's army because he would not change allegiance from the pope to Napoleon. Once he was released, he devoted himself to preaching missions. He was particularly devoted to the Precious Blood of Christ, and founded the Congregation of the Most Precious Blood.

December 29

The commemoration of the prophet Nathan and King David.

In 1170, in England, St. Thomas Becket. He was a Norman educated by the Canons Regular of Merton Abbey. He became archdeacon under Archbishop Theobald of Canterbury. He was sent to Rome to secure approval of Pope Eugene III for the succession of Henry II to the throne. Henry made Thomas his chancellor. He lived in splendid fashion, though he was also generous to the poor. Thomas tried to warn the king not to make him archbishop of Canterbury, because inevitably he would be required to resist the king's encroachments on the rights of the church. The king appointed him anyway, and Thomas changed his way of life. He wore a hair shirt, rose early to read the Scriptures, said or attended Mass daily, and distributed alms. When conflict with the king became too intense, Thomas went into exile for six years. He returned to England, aware he would probably die. Four knights, who heard the king denounce Thomas, murdered him in his cathedral.

About 485, near Constantinople, St. Marcellus. He was abbot of a monastery near Constantinople. The monks there akoimetoï, that is, they sang the office continuously day and night.

In Normandy, in 596, St. Evroult. He was an official at the court of King Childebert I. He entered a monastery at Bayeux, but found the esteem he received there a temptation, and so left with three others to become a hermit. A community grew up around him and over the course of the time he established fifteen other monasteries.

At Oxford, in 1968, Austin Farrer, priest.

December 30

In the sixth or seventh century, St Tathan (sometimes known as Tatheus or Meuthi) was the son of an Irish king named Tathalius (Tuathal). He settled in Gwent, where King Caradog gave him a grant of land at Caerwent. Tathan established one of the most famous of the Welsh monastic schools there. Among those whom he taught was Cadoc. It is said that Gwynllyw, Cadoc's father, had stolen Tathan's cow and then tried unsuccessfully to play a practical joke on the holy man when he tried to claim it back. Feeling ashamed, Gwynllyw asked Tathan to baptise the new-born child, who later became his pupil. Another tradition tells how Tathan built a church at Llanvaches, near Caerwent, in memory of the murdered shepherdess Maches or Machuta.

At Esztergom, in Hungary, in 1036, Blessed Sebastian, bishop. Sebastian became bishop in 1102, a year after St. Stephen was crowned king. The two of them worked together for the evangelization of Hungary and the organization of the church there.

In 1280, at Palestrina, Blessed Margaret Colonna. She was the daughter of a prince who died young and left her to be raised by her brothers. She did not want to marry, and devoted her short life to the poor and to establishing a Poor Clare convent.

December 31

At Rome, in 335, St. Silvester I, pope. He was pope for twenty-two years during the reign of Constantine. He received his residence at the Lateran from Constantine.

About 440, in Palestine, Saints Melania the Younger and Pinian. Melania, the granddaughter of Melania the Elder, was married to Pinian. Melania had wished to remain celibate, but her father insisted on the marriage. The couple had two children, both of whom died. Along with her mother Albina, Melania and Pinian took up a monastic form of life on a country estate. They were generous to the poor, and gradually a community of single and married people grew up around them. They eventually sold off their very extensive properties, gave the money to charitable causes and freed their slaves. About 408, when Alaric's Goths invaded Italy, they removed to their estate at Tagaste. In 417 they went to Jerusalem. By then they had given away their immense wealth and were paupers. After visiting the monks of Egypt, they settled in Jerusalem, where Melania became a close associate of St. Jerome. She established several monasteries, and lived in one.

At Lutterworth, in Leicestershire in 1384, John Wyclif, priest, reformer. John was a member of the Wyclif family of Richmond in Yorkshire and was born in about the year 1330. He was a fellow of Merton College Oxford, and Master of Balliol, but his expulsion from the Wardenship of Canterbury Hall (later incorporated into Christ Church) in favour of a monastic foundation led to a lawsuit and a life-long hatred of things monastic. He was much in favour with members of the royal family and, when disputes arose owing to his attacks on the clergy of the day, he was protected by them from the otherwise inevitable consequence of deprivation of his posts. However, he went on to deny the Church's teaching of the presence of Christ at the eucharist, the doctrine known as transubstantiation, and it was this that lost him his royal protection. His opinions were formally condemned in 1381 and he was forced out of office by the university the following year. John had already moved to Lutterworth in 1380 and from there he gave his support to such projects as the translation of the Bible into contemporary English. He died on this day in 1384, whilst at Mass.

In 1876, in Paris, St. Catherine Labouré. She joined the Sisters of Charity of St. Vincent de Paul and was sent to their convent on the rue du Bac in Paris. Soon after arriving, she had the first of several visions. In them, the Blessed Virgin Mary asked to have a medal struck depicting what Catherine saw. This became the "miraculous medal". On one side it shows Mary with shafts of light shining from her hands. On the other is

an M with a cross above and two hearts below, one with a crown, the other pierced by a sword. Catherine spent the rest of her life in voluntary obscurity, serving her community as portress and poultry farmer, and caring for old people in a hospice.

At Lagos, in 1891, Samule Ajayi Crowther, bishop. In Canterbury Cathedral on St. Peter's Day, June 29, 1864, Samuel Ajayi Crowther (c. 1807 – 1891) was ordained the first African bishop in Nigeria for “the countries of Western Africa beyond the limits of the Queen's domains.”

Crowther's gifts to the church were many. A skilled linguist, he helped translate the Bible and Book of Common Prayer into Yoruba and other West African languages. He founded schools and training colleges, where he encouraged the study of the Gospel, traditional subjects, and farming methods that allowed students to raise basic crops and cotton as sources of income. As a child, Crowther had been captured in 1822 during a Nigerian civil war and sold to Portuguese slave traders. Intercepted by a British anti-slavery patrol, the ship and its human cargo were taken to Freetown, Sierra Leone, a haven for freed captives after the British Parliament abolished the slave trade in 1807. There Crowther was educated at a Church Missionary Society (CMS) school, was baptised in 1825, and became a teacher in Sierra Leone. Crowther's leadership skills were soon evident, and in 1842 the CMS sent him to their Islington, England, training college. He was ordained a year later, returned to Sierra Leone, and then moved on to Yoruba territory. He also made extended mission journeys to the interior of Nigeria, where in encounters with Muslims he was known as a humble, patient listener and a thoughtful, non-polemical partner in dialogue.